WESGRO
cape town & western cape
tourism, trade & investment



RESEARCH REPORT

# Unlocking Tourism Growth

## An Action Plan for the Western Cape to 2035

Draft for discussion | November 2026

**DRAFT FOR DISCUSSION.**

# Foreword

[Foreword by the Chief Executive Officer of Wesgro, one page. To be drafted by Wesgro or ghost-written by Letsema for sign-off, SLA Annexure B clause 1.1.14.5.]

# Contents

**Executive summary** ..... **9**
- Where the province stands ..... 10
- What constrains growth ..... 10
- A viable target to 2035 ..... 11
- Three strategic shifts ..... 12
- Goals and objectives at a glance ..... 13
- Sequence and timing ..... 15
- How progress is tracked ..... 16
- Risks to delivery ..... 17

**Context** ..... **18**
- 1.1 The Western Cape tourism system today ..... 19
- 1.2 From recovery to growth ..... 25
- 1.3 Mandate and objective ..... 28
- 1.4 Approach and method ..... 31
- 1.5 How to read this report ..... 36

**Analysis and insights** ..... **37**
- 2.1 Global benchmarks and their lessons ..... 38
- 2.2 Demand-side factors ..... 45
- 2.3 Supply-side factors ..... 52
- 2.4 The enabling environment ..... 62

**Findings and recommendations** ..... **70**
- 3.1 Goal 1: Reshape demand ..... 71
- 3.2 Goal 2: Transform supply ..... 88
- 3.3 Goal 3: Build enabling capability ..... 106
- 3.4 The integrated case ..... 129

**Execution plan** ..... **131**
- 4.1 From objectives to initiatives ..... 132
- 4.2 Sequencing and phases ..... 134
- 4.3 Initiative charters ..... 135
- 4.4 Roles and accountabilities ..... 145
- 4.5 Tactical wins for the first 24 months ..... 147
- 4.6 Funding and investment ..... 148
- 4.7 Delivery governance ..... 149
- 4.8 Risks and dependencies ..... 151

**Monitoring and evaluation framework** ..... **154**
- 5.1 Results chain ..... 155
- 5.2 Indicator set ..... 156
- 5.3 Baselines and targets ..... 160
- 5.4 Data sources and gaps ..... 162
- 5.5 Tracking mechanism ..... 164
- 5.6 Evaluation and learning ..... 165
- 5.7 Toolkit handover ..... 166

**Appendices..... 167**
A1 Evidence behind the objectives..... 168
A2 Demand model..... 171
A3 Benchmark cases..... 177
A4 Readiness scores..... 183
A5 Inclusion fact base..... 187
A6 Stakeholder inputs..... 191
A7 Initiative charters and action register..... 194
A8 M&E toolkit..... 202
A9 Glossary and references..... 204

# Figures

Figure ES.1. Arrivals paths to 2035....12
Figure ES.2. Strategic goals and objectives....13
Figure 1.1. International arrivals, FY15/16 to FY25/26....19
Figure 1.2. Overseas arrivals by market, 2025....21
Figure 1.3. Spend per visitor by market, 2024....21
Figure 1.4. Base case against the seat line....26
Figure 1.5. How the research evidence informs the action plan....33
Figure 1.6. Theory of change for inclusive and resilient tourism growth....35
Figure 2.1. Comparator growth, 2023 to 2024....41
Figure 2.2. Growth scenarios to 2035....48
Figure 2.3. Base-case growth by market group....49
Figure 2.4. Route load factors to November 2025....53
Figure 2.5. International seats by month, 2025....55
Figure 2.6. Readiness and accessibility by district....58
Figure 2.7. Objectives stakeholders raised....65
Figure 2.8. Binding constraints in 20 communities....67
Figure 3.1. Meetings, seats and visitors by month....76
Figure 4.1. Initiative timeline, 2027 to 2035....134
Figure 4.2. Initiatives by main funding source....149
Figure 4.3. Delivery governance structure....150
Figure 5.1. Results chain for the plan....155
Figure 5.2. Arrivals paths and milestones to 2035....160
Figure 5.3. Quarterly scorecard layout....165

# Tables

Table ES.1. Goal 1: Reshape demand....13
Table ES.2. Goal 2: Transform supply....14
Table ES.3. Goal 3: Build enabling capability....15
Table ES.4. What happens when....15
Table ES.5. Impact indicators and targets....16
Table 1.1. Month of travel, 2024 and 2025....22
Table 1.2. District economy, assets and access....23
Table 1.3. Wesgro's targets beside this report....29
Table 1.4. Evidence streams and their products....32
Table 2.1. The six comparators at a glance....39
Table 2.2. Comparator growth and recovery....40
Table 2.3. April to September passenger movements at Cape Town International, 2015 to 2025 ....46
Table 2.4. Market capture, 2022 to 2024....47
Table 2.5. Four traveller segments....50
Table 2.6. Flagship visitors, 2023 and 2024....57

Table 2.7. District strengths and weaknesses....58
Table 2.8. Touring route readiness....60
Table 2.9. Cape Town listings in six wards, September 2026....60
Table 2.10. The 20 shortlisted communities....68
Table 3.1. Evidence for objective 1....72
Table 3.2. Evidence for objective 2....75
Table 3.3. Evidence for objective 3....78
Table 3.4. Evidence for objective 4....81
Table 3.5. Evidence for objective 5....84
Table 3.6. Evidence for objective 6....86
Table 3.7. Evidence for objective 7....89
Table 3.8. Evidence for objective 8....92
Table 3.9. Evidence for objective 9....95
Table 3.10. Evidence for objective 10....98
Table 3.11. Evidence for objective 11....100
Table 3.12. Evidence for objective 12....103
Table 3.13. Evidence for objective 13....107
Table 3.14. Evidence for objective 14....111
Table 3.15. Evidence for objective 15....113
Table 3.16. Evidence for objective 16....116
Table 3.17. Evidence for objective 17....119
Table 3.18. Evidence for objective 18....121
Table 3.19. Evidence for objective 19....123
Table 3.20. Evidence for objective 20....127
Table 4.1. The eighteen initiatives....132
Table 4.2. Accountability by initiative and tier....145
Table 4.3. First-24-month actions and funding....147
Table 4.4. Decision gates and reviews....150
Table 4.5. Risks and their mitigation....151
Table 5.1. Results chain by initiative....155
Table 5.2. Tier 1 impact indicators....157
Table 5.3. Tier 2 outcome indicators....157
Table 5.4. Tier 3 output indicators....159
Table 5.5. Tier 1 baselines and targets....160
Table 5.6. Data sources and holders....162
Table 5.7. Data gaps and owners....163
Table A.1. Strength of evidence by objective....168
Table A.2. Traceability by objective....169
Table A.3. Growth model scenario definitions....172
Table A.4. Model end points by base year....172
Table A.5. Base case by market group....173
Table A.6. Acceleration and mature market paths....173
Table A.7. Regional market paths....174
Table A.8. Base-case spend by group....175
Table A.9. Arrivals figures in circulation....176
Table A.10. Benchmark selection criteria....178

Table A.11. How the six comparators were chosen....178
Table A.12. Comparator growth, recovery and levers....179
Table A.13. Transferable levers by case....181
Table A.14. Additional comparators....182
Table A.15. Asset database structure....183
Table A.16. Dimension scores by district....184
Table A.17. Overall readiness by district....185
Table A.18. Touring route scorecards....186
Table A.19. Asset counts by district....186
Table A.20. Community shortlist criteria....187
Table A.21. Archetypes, responses and benchmarks....188
Table A.22. Shortlist readiness ratings....189
Table A.23. Insights by organisation....191
Table A.24. Insights by objective....193
Table A.25. Lines of enquiry by area....193
Table A.26. Chapter 3 action register....194
Table A.27. Tier 2 indicator register....202
Table A.28. Glossary of terms....204
Table A.29. Documents and sources cited....205

# Abbreviations

| Abbreviation | Meaning |
|---|---|
| ACSA | Airports Company South Africa |
| CAGR | Compound annual growth rate |
| CATHSSETA | Culture, Arts, Tourism, Hospitality and Sport Sector Education and Training Authority |
| CTIA | Cape Town International Airport |
| CTICC | Cape Town International Convention Centre |
| CTT | Cape Town Tourism |
| DEDAT | Department of Economic Development and Tourism, Western Cape Government |
| ETA | Electronic Travel Authorisation |
| FY | Financial year (April to March) |
| G4J | Western Cape Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023 to 2035, Western Cape Government |
| GCC | Gulf Cooperation Council |
| GDPR | Gross domestic product by region |
| ICCA | International Congress and Convention Association |
| JAMMS | Joint Association Members Meeting Sessions |
| LTO | Local tourism organisation |
| M&E | Monitoring and evaluation |
| MERO | Municipal Economic Review and Outlook |
| MICE | Meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions |
| OAG | Official Airline Guide (schedules and capacity data) |
| OTA | Online travel agency |
| Pero | Provincial Economic Review and Outlook |
| RACI | Responsible, accountable, consulted, informed |
| SAT | South African Tourism |
| SLA | Service level agreement |
| SMME | Small, medium and micro enterprise |
| Stats SA | Statistics South Africa |
| TGCSA | Tourism Grading Council of South Africa |
| TOMSA | Tourism Marketing South Africa |
| TSA | Tourism Satellite Account |
| TTOS | Trusted Tour Operator Scheme |
| UIA | Union of International Associations |

# Executive summary

International visitors have returned to the Western Cape in record numbers. About 1.57 million arrived through Cape Town International in FY25/26, 35% more than in FY19/20, the last year before the pandemic, and each spends about 1.6 times the national average. The recovery is complete. Growth is the harder task. The seats and flagship sites that carried the recovery are full in summer. Beyond the Metro much of the province is hard to reach, and no one yet measures how well its product is found and sold.

Interest is not what holds the province back. About 97 million high-value travellers in 34 markets are interested in South Africa, yet only about one in seventy of them, some 1.4 million, turns that interest into a trip. Over the three years 2022 to 2024 the province took about 0.1% of the world's tourist arrivals. Even from the UK, the best captured of its large air markets, it drew 0.27% of air outbound trips. Seats and bookings stand in the way. Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load across the year and at the summer peak one main runway caps movements at about 30 an hour. In winter, carriers reduce available seats. June holds 6.4% of the year's international capacity, against 10.8% in December. Beyond the three core touring routes, regional rooms are listed on the booking platforms, but community products and many guides still sell only by phone.

On the growth model's count, arrivals can grow from about 1.5 million in 2025 to 2.5 million by 2035, if the province wins the seats. That makes the action plan a supply programme before it is a marketing programme.

## Where the province stands

The Western Cape earns more per visitor than the rest of South Africa. The province takes about a quarter of national foreign spend from about a seventh of the arrivals. Its foreign visitors spend roughly 1.6 times the national average. That is about US$890 per arrival, against US$500 for the rest of South Africa. Foreign direct spend rose 14% in a year, from R22.7bn in FY2024 to R25.9bn in FY2025.

Yet the premium rests on a few markets, six months and one metro. Five markets supply 63% of overseas arrivals, and the UK, Germany and the USA alone 52%. More than half the arrivals on the ten largest routes come through someone else's hub: the routes through Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul carry 53% of them. October to March carries between 61% and 62% of overseas visitor travel. The Cape Metro holds 20,281 of the province's 50,332 tourism assets, or 40.3%, and visitors disperse from there. Growth now needs new markets, new seasons and new regions.

Domestic travel sits beside this picture. Domestic trips recovered in volume in 2025 but fell in value, with nominal overnight spend down 31.9% to R12.7bn. This study's mandate and target are international, so domestic trips and spend are tracked as context (section 1.3).

## What constrains growth

Five constraints cap the case, and none of them is a lack of interest in the province.

**The gateway.** The growth model draws air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base path crosses it around 2030. In practice the runway binds first, at peak hours. Runway relief comes from about 2033. Airports Company South Africa (ACSA) now schedules the realigned runway for December 2029, subject to contract award. The plan's phasing assumes about 2033 and counts the earlier date as upside. George Airport is domestic only. Cape Winelands Airport cleared its environmental appeals in May 2026, but its finance, licensing and carriers are not yet shown.

**Full routes.** Five of the eleven full routes are mature long-haul services, led by Newark at 88.6%, Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%. On full routes, carriers are expected to raise fares before they add seats.

**Seasons.** The green season, April to September, is a seat problem and a demand problem at once: seats and visitors fall away together. Yet the quieter months are a proven market. Their passenger traffic has more than doubled since 2015, though their share of the year has eased since 2023. Connecting traffic is especially critical in the low season. That ties winter seats to the hub carriers' own priorities. The 2026 Gulf disruption showed the exposure: at the end of September Emirates was flying 91% of its previous network.

**Reach.** Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo and one touring route of six is rated Ready. Beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only. Inside the Metro, the MyCiTi airport service is suspended and its operating grant ends in 2027/28, and regular trains on the Simon's Town section are unconfirmed.

**Levers held elsewhere.** National government and its state-owned entities hold visas, air service agreements and the airport and port programmes. Entry moved to the Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) in August 2026, and no performance data is published yet. Indian and Chinese arrivals to South Africa fell 30.0% and 23.7% in the first nine months of 2026. Mobility mandates are split across three tiers, and building provincial measures of tourism jobs and GDP is among the first tasks of execution.

## A viable target to 2035

Wesgro commissioned this study to establish a viable growth target for international arrivals to 2035. The evidence sets it at 2.5 million, about two thirds above the 1.5 million of 2025, and the target holds only if the province wins the seats to carry it. The target serves the Growth for Jobs Strategy, whose quantified goal is to triple the province's goods and services exports, tourism included, by 2035.

The gateway sets the pace in the summer peak and demand and conversion set it in the green season and beyond the Metro. The growth model draws three paths from a 2025 base of about 1.5 million. By 2035 the conservative path reaches about 1.8 million, the base path about 2.2 million and the accelerated path about 2.5 million. Chapters 1 to 5 call the last two the base and accelerated cases.

The paths differ by intervention, not by demand potential. The base path assumes Wesgro holds its current effort while Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines keep adding capacity. The accelerated path also needs direct India and China routes and dedicated activation in India, China, the USA and the Gulf. Without confirmed routes, it reverts to base.

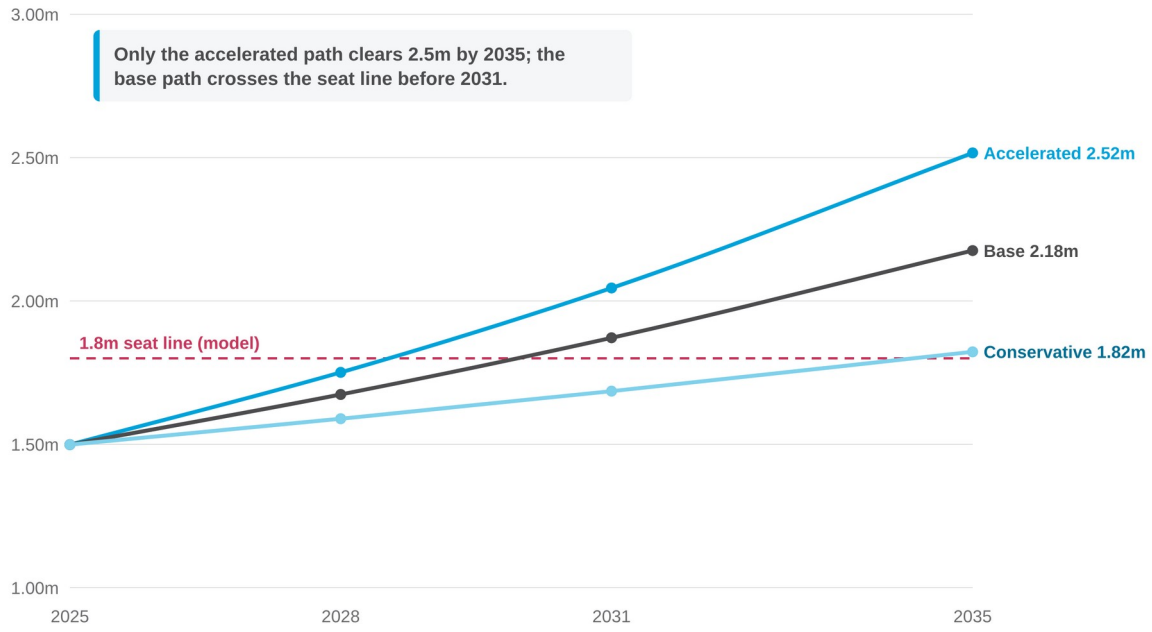



**Figure ES.1.** Arrivals paths to 2035

On the eleven full routes, marketing cannot make up for missing seats, but on the Dubai, Addis Ababa and Doha routes, at 65% to 72% load, it can. The hub markets supply about 30% of the arrivals the base path adds, the largest share of any market group.

The base path implies growth of 3.8% a year and the accelerated path 5.3%, against a global norm of 3% to 5%. Faster growth has been sustained outside a recovery. Santiago's airport grew from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019, at least 5.5% a year. Chile's international seat capacity rose about 40% to 50% from 2013 to 2019. The fastest growers aimed institutions, marketing and air access at one binding constraint. For Chile that constraint was long-haul access. The Western Cape's constraint has the same shape: seats into one gateway airport.

## Three strategic shifts

In Goal 1, Reshape demand, the work moves from awareness to conversion. The province is under-sold in its growth markets, and outside its core its product is listed but of unmeasured reach. Three of its six objectives aim at conversion: green-season events, bookable product and hub traffic already in the air. About 101,000 air journeys a year from India and China already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs. Singapore shows how a hub can turn transit into visits and Melbourne uses its events calendar to steady demand.

In Goal 2, Transform supply, the work moves from new attractions to seats and finished experiences. The goal has one capacity entry: frequency and larger aircraft on the full routes ahead of runway relief. Following Chile, Initiative I6 designs a public-private air access fund in 2027 and 2028 to back it (section 4.3). Five more cover cruise, reach, product and experience. Cruise grows through the regional circuit and shore capacity rather than port capital. At the flagship sites the task is to manage flows, because Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues run up to three hours. Elsewhere it is to turn existing assets into complete visitor experiences.

In Goal 3, Build enabling capability, the work moves from separate mandates to shared decisions, capital and data. The goal answers four questions. First, who benefits: twenty township and rural communities

hold 18.4% of the province's residents, but the spend traced to them is just 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend. Second, who pays: the capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads and rail, but almost none of it reaches the beds, booking and product the regions lack. Third, who decides: with visas and air service agreements held nationally, the province leads by escalation. Fourth, who measures: more than twenty bodies produce tourism data, yet no one holds a single view of visitor behaviour. The New Zealand case argues for yield over arrivals, so the plan tracks spend, season and spread beside arrivals (section 5.3).

The three goals make one case. Demand work fills seats only if the seats exist and supply work pays only if the product can be booked. Both need the enabling base to last.

## Goals and objectives at a glance

The strategy sets three strategic goals, one for each shift, and twenty objectives beneath them in six themes (Figure ES.2). Each objective rests on the evidence of a named workstream, and Appendix A1 traces each to its sources. The tables give each objective's finding and the initiative that delivers it.

**Figure ES.2.** Strategic goals and objectives

| Accelerating tourism growth: toward 2.5 million international arrivals by 2035 | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Goal 1 Reshape demand**<br>More segments, markets, months and places | **Goal 2 Transform supply**<br>Seats, reach, product and experience | **Goal 3 Build enabling capability**<br>Inclusion, capital, governance and data |
| **1.1 Traveller, brand and proposition** | **2.1 Access and infrastructure** | **3.1 Inclusion and sustainability** |
| **1** Respond to growth segment traveller preferences | **7** Win direct routes and add seats on full routes | **13** Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion |
| **2** Create green-season demand with MICE and events | **8** Grow cruise calls and ports | **14** Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk |
| **3** Make the whole province findable and bookable | **9** Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility | **15** Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies |
| **1.2 Source market growth** | **2.2 Product and capacity** | **3.2 Governance and leadership** |
| **4** Convert India and China hub traffic | **10** Support diversified route and product development | **16** Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers |
| **5** Increase yield in mature markets | **11** Align visitor experience in-destination | **17** Strengthen industry and government collaboration |
| **6** Build a regional foundation (Africa) | **12** Balance impact on nature-based attractions | **18** Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing |
| | | **19** Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits |
| | | **20** Develop workforce and service skills |

**Table ES.1.** Goal 1: Reshape demand

**Conversion, not awareness, holds back the growth markets, the green season and the province beyond its core.**

| Objective | What the evidence shows and what follows | Initiative |
|---|---|---|
| **1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences** | Four traveller segments, each concentrated in named home markets, give Wesgro a sharper target than country alone and the province scores 3.7 to 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win them. Cape Town's reputation is not yet recognition of the province, so the brand aim adds nights beyond the city. | I1 |

| Objective | What the evidence shows and what follows | Initiative |
|---|---|---|
| **2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events** | The green season is a seat problem and an events problem at once. Quieter-month traffic has doubled since 2015, but winter rooms in Cape Town filled less in 2025 than in 2019. June holds 6.4% of the year's international seats and business events are the lever best placed to fill the trough, though international meetings now peak from September to November. Wesgro secured 36 bids in 2024/25, but bids won are not winter nights, so sales are organised by buyer type, with May to August first. | I2 |
| **3 Make the whole province findable and bookable** | Regional rooms are listed on the booking platforms, but their prominence, inventory and sales are unmeasured and no profiled community rates Ready on bookability, so support follows an audit from discovery to sale. | I3 |
| **4 Convert India and China hub traffic** | About 101,000 air journeys a year from India and China already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs and with no direct Indian route, converting that flow is an important lever. Arrivals from both markets fell in 2026, so a joint route, fare, visa and product diagnosis comes first. | I4 |
| **5 Increase yield in mature markets** | The mature markets already pay the most and fill the fullest routes, so growth there comes from more value per visitor and more seats on existing routes. | I1 |
| **6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)** | Regional Africa is the province's steadiest volume and its least developed premium market. Zimbabwe and Namibia supply 62% of African arrivals, while West African visitors spend the most per visit. | I5 |

**Table ES.2.** Goal 2: Transform supply

**The gateway binds first, and beyond the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach and unevenly sold.**

| Objective | What the evidence shows and what follows | Initiative |
|---|---|---|
| **7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes** | Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load and carriers are expected to price before adding seats, so the province must win frequency and larger aircraft. The 2026 Gulf disruption showed that hubs in one region share risk, so route support carries resilience conditions. | I6 |
| **8 Grow cruise calls and ports** | The Western Cape received 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26, down from 79 a season earlier, and Cape Town's berth has room for 150 or more calls, so the berth is not the limit. Growth is set by the regional circuit that makes a Southern African season worth a ship's deployment, and by shore capacity on call days, when passengers converge on flagship sites already full in season. | I7 |
| **9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility** | Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo and beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only. The airport bus is suspended and its grant ends in 2027/28, so funded service specifications come before new rail products. | I8 |
| **10 Support diversified route and product development** | The province does not lack attractions; it lacks finished experiences around them, with assets outside the Metro left without guides, interpretation or bookable product and one touring route of six rated Ready. | I9 |
| **11 Align visitor experience in-destination** | The gap in the middle of the accommodation market is a product question that differs by place, not a missing tier. Service, interpretation and language readiness thin out with distance from Cape Town, and an accessible building is not yet an accessible trip. | I10 |
| **12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions** | Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours, so growth at the flagship nature sites must come from managing flows. Repairs come before new product, and receiving reserves pass a readiness assessment before visitors are steered to them. | I11 |

**Table ES.3.** Goal 3: Build enabling capability

**Inclusion, capital, governance and data are thin, and several levers sit with national government.**

| Objective | What the evidence shows and what follows | Initiative |
|---|---|---|
| **13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion** | Twenty communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive only a small documented share of foreign direct spend and in eleven the binding constraint is organisation, not distance or product. Local tourism bodies are kept in service through lawful procurement, the route MFMA Circular No. 131 leaves open. | I12 |
| **14 Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk** | Growth has to last. Water already caps visitor load in nodes such as the Garden Route and the flagship nature sites run near capacity in season, while floods, fire and wind close sites and routes. Readiness is therefore assessed node by node before publicly supported demand is added, and resource use and emissions are reported in absolute terms. | I13 |
| **15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies** | The province's capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets, where the growth case needs investment. A levy follows a statutory route that can take more than a year, so it cannot fund near-term operations. | I14 |
| **16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers** | Air service agreements and visas sit with national government, mandates are split across three tiers and the national marketing body is under strain, so the province needs one shared agenda. | I15 |
| **17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration** | Fifteen of the sixteen organisations heard raised collaboration and the channels already exist in the industry associations' joint forum (JAMMS), the bid teams and the tour-operator forums, so the task is to turn existing forums into one joint plan. | I15 |
| **18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing** | Provincial measures of tourism GDP and jobs are still to be built, operators cannot see their own customers and the arrivals series run unreconciled, so a data-sharing protocol is the precondition for every target. | I16 |
| **19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits** | Visas, air rights, the runway and policing sit with national government, so the province leads by escalation backed with evidence. The visa ask now rests on how the ETA performs, and the safety services that already run are joined through one referral pathway. | I17 |
| **20 Develop workforce and service skills** | The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition needs a measure before it becomes a target, so the first step is an employer-linked labour analysis in 2027 that sets the baseline, and the skills plan follows from it. | I18 |

## Sequence and timing

Seats and bookability move first, because every other lever runs through them. Each step below opens a seat, a baseline or a booking path that a later step needs.

**Table ES.4.** What happens when

| When | What must happen |
|---|---|
| **2027, first half** | Hold winter seats on the full routes through joint marketing with carriers, track runway milestones quarterly and complete correlated hub-closure scenarios. Publish a green-season events calendar and aim bids at May to August first. Set up the Tourism Growth Steerco, table the first national escalation agenda with a request for ETA performance data and agree the data-sharing protocol. Build the regional inventory and start the discovery-to-sale audit, set flagship carrying capacity beside visitor counts and start a costed condition register. |
| **2027, second half** | Package the Garden Route and Route 62 with a shuttle transfer, and seek a PRASA-signed timetable before any Southern Line product. Agree funded service specifications for the airport link. Choose two or three pilot communities. Agree one referral pathway across the tourism safety services. Run two flow pilots, at Boulders and one other constrained site, in summer 2027/28 at the earliest. |

| When | What must happen |
|---|---|
| **2028** | Give each pilot community one live booking route and paid departures before any promotion. Test accessible journeys end to end, and assess receiving reserves for readiness before dispersal marketing. Complete the design of the public-private air access fund, with its resilience conditions. Review the safety workstream before it expands. Gate 1, at the end of 2028, turns the new baselines into targets and decides what Phase 2 funds. |
| **2029 to 2031** | Scale what works and meet the seat line at the 2030 mid-term review. Extend flow management and the safety pathway where the pilots held. Gate 2 closes the phase at the end of 2031. |
| **2032 to 2035** | Take direct route cases to carriers as the international terminal (about 2032) and the realigned runway (about 2033) add capacity. The terminal evaluation reports in 2035. |

Nine of the twelve actions for the first 24 months sit inside Wesgro's current mandate and budget. Dates are proposals for Steerco to confirm (section 4.5).

## How progress is tracked

Progress is tracked at three levels: seven impact indicators for the 2035 case, twenty-nine outcome indicators and forty-one output indicators. Today only arrivals and spend carry a modelled value for 2035. A quarterly scorecard reports each indicator against both growth paths. Decision gates at the end of 2028 and 2031, a mid-term review in 2030 and a terminal evaluation in 2035 decide what each phase funds.

**Table ES.5.** Impact indicators and targets

**Arrivals carry targets on both paths, while jobs wait on the labour analysis and season, spread and community spend start from dated baselines.**

| Impact indicator | Baseline | 2028 base / accelerated | 2035 base / accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|
| **T1-01 International arrivals** | 1,498,829 (2025, model value) | 1,673,855 / 1,750,871* | 2,175,778 / 2,516,282 |
| **T1-02 Arrivals by market group** | Five groups, 2025 | Base path by group | Base path by group; accelerated not split |
| **T1-03 Direct foreign spend** | R25.9bn (FY2025, nominal) | Not printed | R40.6bn (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand) |
| **T1-04 Tourism jobs** | Set by the labour analysis (I18) | Set at Gate 1 | Set at Gate 1 |
| **T1-05 Green-season nights and share** | 38.1% (2025, normalised); 39% (2024) | Level set at Gate 1 | Nights rising; share reported beside volumes |
| **T1-06 Share outside the Metro** | Not in hand; due in 2027 | Baseline set | Rising |
| **T1-07 Community share of spend** | R4m to R10m a year (documented floor) | Pilots measured | 1% (R259m) reference point |

The table shows the model's arrivals baseline, and the airport count is tracked beside it, from 1.44 million in FY24/25 (section 5.3). The spend target needs the same care. The model's 2024 spend of R27.12bn sits 19% above the R22.7bn reported for FY2024, so R40.6bn is not measured from R25.9bn. [Open item: Skift to rebase the spend path on the FY2025 actual of R25.9bn.]

The first two years also build the measures the plan still needs. The labour analysis (I18) and the data-sharing protocol (I16) set provincial measures of tourism jobs and GDP in 2027, and Gate 1 turns them, with the share of visitors outside the Metro, into targets. The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition is tested against that measure before it becomes a target.

## Risks to delivery

Twelve of the sixteen material risks sit outside Wesgro's control, so the response to most is early warning and a route to the tier that can act. Two are rated high on both likelihood and impact. Restrictive bilateral air agreements and the US carrier cap call for an escalation agenda with stated asks, plus route work inside existing rights. Gulf hub disruption, which occurred in 2026, calls for correlated hub-closure scenarios, hub work spread beyond the Gulf and resilience conditions in the air access fund.

Six are rated medium likelihood and high impact, in three groups; first, two sit with the national tier and ACSA. Runway relief may slip past about 2033, so its milestones are tracked quarterly. ETA processing may prove slow or stay unmeasured, so the escalation agenda asks for its performance data. Second, one sits in the markets. A downturn in the UK, Germany and the USA would hit 52% of overseas arrivals, so activation shifts towards Africa and the hub markets. Third, three sit closer to delivery. Safety incidents could deter visitors, so safety gates come before any pilot launch and the running safety services share one referral pathway. A cut to Wesgro's operating budget would hit thirteen initiatives, so rand bands and a stop list are due before Gate 1 (section 4.6). Partners may not deliver the plans this action plan builds on, so Steerco confirms before Gate 1 which of them are adopted, funded and running.

Two more are rated high likelihood and medium impact. Climate events that close sites and routes call for a climate risk register and node readiness assessments. LTO services may lapse where municipalities do not use the procurement route under MFMA Circular No. 131, which calls for a provincial practice note and service agreements. Two risks rated medium on both measures bear on daily operations. MyCiTi's operating grant ends in 2027/28, so funded service specifications come before products are sold on its services. Load shedding has eased, with 539 days free of it by November 2026, but water restrictions and grid constraints can still bind at the peak. Likelihood and impact are Letsema's assessment, and Steerco reviews the register each quarter (section 4.8).

Several items remain open, from page references still to confirm to the basis of the model's arrivals count and the rebasing of the spend path. Each is marked in square brackets where it occurs and listed with an owner in the accompanying open-items register. The chapters that follow give the source of every figure in this summary.

Chapter 1

# Context

# 1.1 The Western Cape tourism system today

International visitors have returned to the Western Cape in record numbers, yet the system that carried the recovery rests on five source markets, six summer months and one metro.

The report tracks international arrivals at Cape Town International as its baseline series and uses the growth model for the paths to 2035. Appendix A2 lists every arrivals figure in circulation and its basis.

## Arrivals and recovery

About 1.44 million international visitors arrived through Cape Town International in FY24/25 on the airport's count, against 1.16m in FY19/20, the last pre-pandemic year. Arrivals passed the pre-pandemic peak of 1.19m, set in FY18/19, during FY23/24, when they reached 1.36m. FY25/26 added a further step to 1.57m.[1]

The fall and the climb were both steep. Arrivals dropped to 80,400 in FY20/21 and 378,500 in FY21/22, then returned to 1.07m in FY22/23. Two-way international passengers reached 2.90m in FY24/25, 29% above FY17/18, and 3.3m in calendar 2025 inside a total of 11.1m, both up 7% on the year.[2]

Cape Town's recovery also ran ahead of the national one, so the destination gained share as it recovered. In the first half of 2024 its air arrivals had recovered further against 2019 than South Africa's in eight of the ten largest markets. The USA stood at 162% and Australia at 172% of their 2019 level.[3]

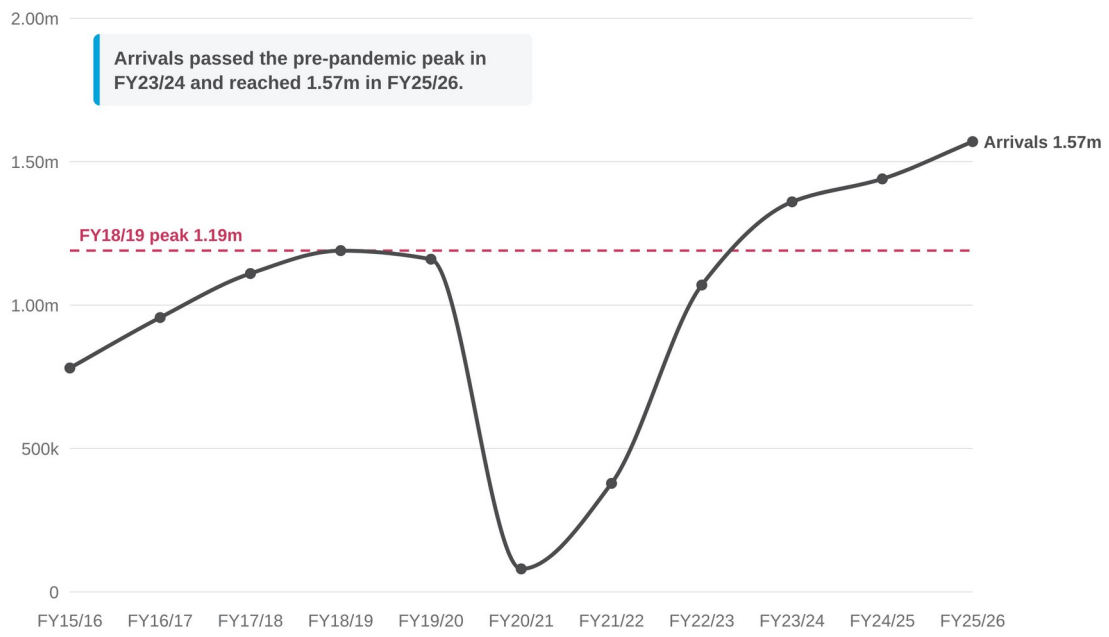



**Figure 1.1.** International arrivals, FY15/16 to FY25/26

## Spend and value

Foreign direct spend in the province rose from R22.7bn in FY2024 to R25.9bn in FY2025, a gain of 14% in one year. The Western Cape earns that spend from a modest share of the national market. Across the four quarters of 2025 it took 16%, 13%, 13% and 16% of South Africa's foreign arrivals and 26%, 20%, 22% and 27% of foreign direct spend.[4]

[1] Diagnostic, p25; Demand-Side Analysis, p11.
[2] Diagnostic, p25, p35; Infrastructure Report, p22.
[3] Diagnostic, p26.
[4] Demand-Side Analysis, p11.

The gap between the two shares is the province's premium. About a quarter of national spend from about a seventh of arrivals means the average foreign visitor to the Western Cape spends roughly 1.6 times the national average. The province earns about US$890 per international arrival, against US$500 for the rest of South Africa and US$630 for Morocco, though below Kenya's US$1,460.[5]

More than a quarter of overseas visitors stay between 7 and 21 days, on printed bands that sum to only 48%. Some 5% stay 1 to 2 days, 12% 3 to 4, 14% 7 to 10, 3% 11 to 14, 13% 15 to 21 and 1% other. The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey gives the same distribution, and 52.33% of its respondents gave no length of stay, so the bands describe about half the sample.[6]

The modal visitor in the 2024 Wesgro survey spends R1,000 to R2,000 a day, is aged 36 to 50 and travels as a pair. Nearly 40% spend more than R1,000 a day. Self-catering at 17.4% and guesthouses at 9.7% lead accommodation choice, ahead of hotels at 3.6%; together these shares cover under a third of respondents.[7]

## Source markets

Five markets supply 63% of overseas arrivals. In 2025 the UK held 19%, Germany 17%, the USA 16%, the Netherlands 7% and France 4%, and the three largest alone held 52%. The report uses 63%, the sum of the printed shares.[8]

Concentration is not new. On the Cape Town overseas air-arrivals basis for January to August 2024 the same five markets held 61%, with the UK and the USA at 18% each and Germany at 15%. The growth markets remain small: India supplied about 2.6% of South Africa's overseas tourists in September 2025, the Middle East 2.3% and China 1.4%.[9]

The mature markets also pay the most. Average spend per visitor in 2024 ran from R32,900 for the USA, R26,500 for the UK and R25,600 for Germany down to R8,600 for Namibia and R8,500 for Zimbabwe. The spread is 3.9 times, and the two regional markets compensate with stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume. The Provincial Treasury puts the 2024 average at R17,000 for all international tourists, with Europe at R19,900 and North America at R16,100. The report uses the Demand-Side Analysis figures because they are by country; section 2.2 carries the open item on their basis.[10]

Most of these visitors arrive through someone else's hub. The UAE route carried 222,923 air arrivals into Cape Town in 2025, the UK 158,448, Qatar 126,078, Ethiopia 123,250 and Turkiye 89,090. The four hub routes through Dubai, Doha, Addis Ababa and Istanbul carried 53% of arrivals on the ten largest routes, so the hubs, not the source markets, are the province's working gateways.[11]

[5] Computed from Demand-Side Analysis, p11; Demand-Side Analysis, p15.
[6] Demand-Side Analysis, p12; Diagnostic, p25.
[7] Diagnostic, p25, p27.
[8] Demand-Side Analysis, p13.
[9] Diagnostic, p29, p30.
[10] Demand-Side Analysis, p14; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p67.
[11] Demand-Side Analysis, p13; Computed from Demand-Side Analysis, p13.

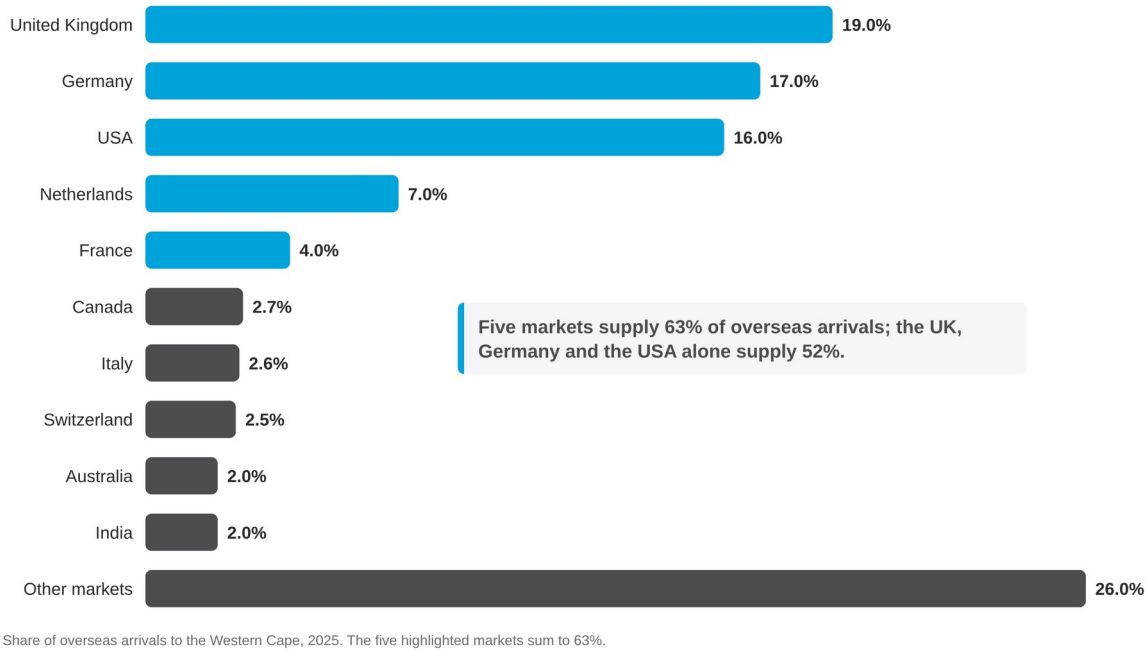



**Figure 1.2.** Overseas arrivals by market, 2025

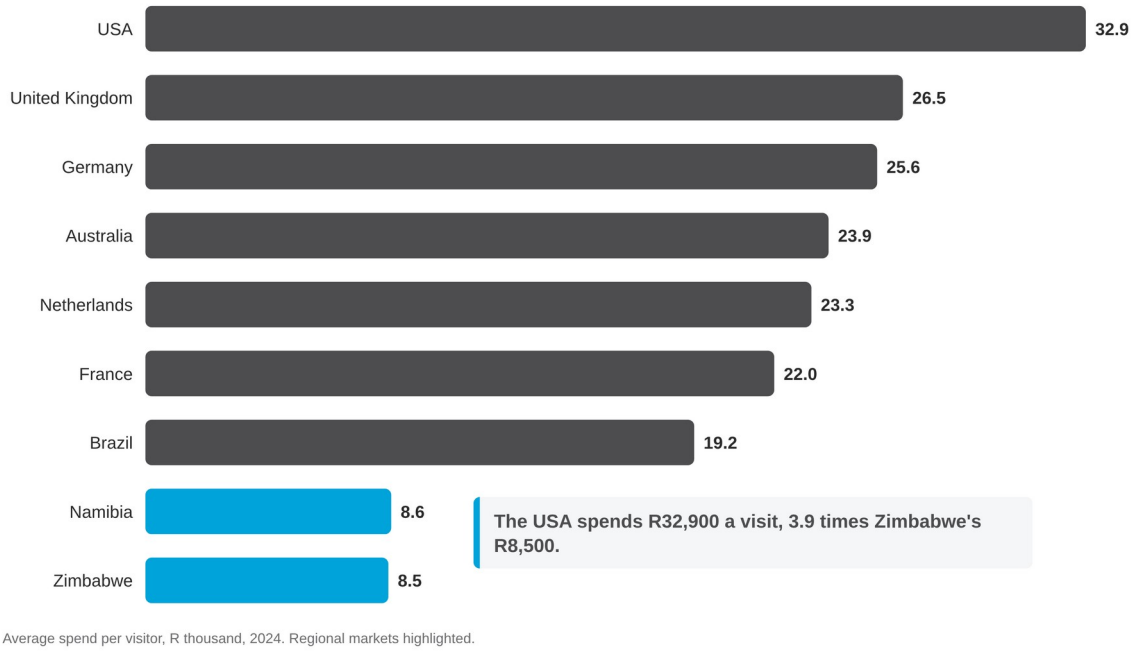



**Figure 1.3.** Spend per visitor by market, 2024

## Seasonality

Demand peaks in the southern summer. In 2025, 12.7% of overseas visitors travelled in December, 11.5% in January and 11.3% in November, against 6.1% in June and 6.5% in August. October to March together account for about 62% of the year once the twelve printed shares, which sum to 104.9%, are scaled to 100% [Wesgro Research to confirm the 2025 month-of-travel shares].[12]

[12] Demand-Side Analysis, p12.

The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey, whose monthly shares sum to 100%, gives 61% for October to March and 39% for April to September.[13]

Supply follows the same curve. June carries 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity into Cape Town. Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023 and 45.1% in June 2025, on the Cape Town Tourism sample. The Demand-Side Analysis concludes that growth depends on better conversion from April to September, not on pushing more demand into the busy peak months.[14]

**Table 1.1.** Month of travel, 2024 and 2025

**Six summer months, October to March, carry between 61% and 62% of overseas visitors' travel in the two years for which month of travel is recorded.**

| Year | Jan | Feb | Mar | Apr | May | Jun | Jul | Aug | Sep | Oct | Nov | Dec | Oct to Mar |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **2024** | 9% | 13% | 12% | 8% | 7% | 4% | 6% | 7% | 7% | 10% | 10% | 7% | 61% |
| **2025 (provisional)** | 11.5 % | 9.9% | 10.3 % | 6.9% | 6.8% | 6.1% | 6.7% | 6.5% | 7.0% | 9.2% | 11.3 % | 12.7 % | 62% |

Source: 2024: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25 and p32 (Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey 2024; shares sum to 100%). 2025: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12 (Stats SA and SAT 2025; the printed shares sum to 104.9%, and the October to March share is computed with the 2025 shares normalised to 100%).

## Air and sea access

Ten airlines fly to Cape Town International from Africa, nine from Europe, three from North and South America, two from the Middle East and one, Singapore Airlines, from Asia. None flies nonstop between Cape Town and Asia, and the MIDAS assessment finds no direct capacity to any Asian market, India and China included. Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026. In 2026 disruption at the Gulf hubs cut into that network (section 2.3).[15]

Cape Town International itself is now the physical ceiling. One main runway with no parallel taxiway caps movements at about 30 an hour, and ACSA's programme of about R11.3bn brings relief from about 2032 for the international terminal and about 2033 for the runway. ACSA's latest schedule sets December 2026 to December 2029 for the realigned runway, subject to contract award. The secondary gateways do not change the picture. George, above its design limit at 911,000 passengers in 2025, doubles by 2028 or 2029, with construction from October 2026. Cape Winelands Airport targets 2028. Environmental appeals against it were dismissed in May 2026, but financial close, aviation licensing and airline commitments are not yet evidenced.[16]

Cruise visits fell back in 2025/26 with no change in berth capacity. The province hosted 70, 67 and 79 vessels in the 2022/23, 2023/24 and 2024/25 seasons, carrying 144,125, 109,884 and 127,178 passengers. Wesgro counts 64 cruise liner visits and about 106,000 passengers for 2025/26. [Cruise Cape Town to supply the StratEcon 2025/26 study: vessel calls, unique and international passengers, the basis of GDP-R and the jobs definition. The prospectus prints the passenger count as 106 00.] That season added R1.35bn to provincial GDP-R from R1.47bn of spending and supported 1,701 full-time equivalent jobs in the province. The season before, Wesgro counted 79 cruise liner visits and 83 vessel calls, and cruise added R1.79bn to GDP-R after displacement, with 1,234 direct and 2,345 total jobs.[17]

Berth space is not the limit. The berth has room for 150 or more calls a season, and its limits are a 300m ship length and the South-Easter wind. Growth is set by the regional circuit that brings a ship for a season

[13] Diagnostic, p25, p32.
[14] MIDAS, "Seasonality"; Demand-Side Analysis, p34; Diagnostic, p32.
[15] Diagnostic, p35; MIDAS, "The Capetown Market", "Executive Summary".
[16] Infrastructure Report, p101 to p103, p104, p105, p106, p107; ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News, Aug 2026; George Herald, Jul 2026.
[17] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29; Diagnostic, p37; StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p8, p9, which counts 127,128 passengers for 2024/25 and 106,315 unique passengers once double counting is removed, the measure Chapter 5 tracks, p19, p22, p24, p27; Infrastructure Report, p110; Wesgro, 2024/25 Cruise Season Injects R1.79 Billion into Western Cape Economy, 13 Sep 2025, public source.

and by shore capacity on call days (section 2.3). Port reliability is a further risk: the Diagnostic rates the Port of Cape Town a binding constraint, with congestion and equipment failures affecting export and cruise reliability.[18]

## Geography of the system

The Cape Metro generates 72.5% of provincial GDPR, a whole-economy share rather than a tourism one. The Cape Winelands follows at 11.2%, the Garden Route at 7.6%, the West Coast at 4.8%, the Overberg at 3% and the Central Karoo at 0.5%. Only the Garden Route share is dated, to 2023, while the Metro chart is titled 2024 and the rest carry no year.[19]

Tourism supply is concentrated in the same way. The province holds 50,332 mapped tourism assets across the six regions, of which the Metro holds 20,281, or 40.3%. The Garden Route holds 9,875, the Cape Winelands 7,730, the Overberg 6,176, the West Coast 4,752 and the Central Karoo 1,518.[20]

Tourism weighs most in the smaller district economies. In 2023 tourist spend equalled 16.8% of GDPR on the West Coast and 15.6% in the Overberg. It equalled 7.0% in the Cape Winelands and 6.7% in the Metro. The district reviews print identical series for the Garden Route and the Central Karoo. [Open item: Provincial Treasury to confirm the Garden Route and Central Karoo shares.] The Metro holds the volume, but a fall in visitors costs the outer districts more of their economy.[21]

Cape Town is the axle of the system. The Infrastructure Report calls it the province's global shopfront and main dispersal hub, so a capacity failure there becomes a provincial risk, not only a city problem. International visitors land there and disperse from there, and readiness falls with each step away: accessibility scores drop from 4.7 in the Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo.[22]

Beyond the Metro the visitor drives. The Infrastructure Report finds the N2 to be the only continuous tourism corridor between regions, and so a single point of failure. Large parts of the province outside the Metro and the Garden Route remain effectively car-only destinations. The further from Cape Town, the faster the infrastructure falls away.[23]

**Table 1.2.** District economy, assets and access

**The Cape Metro holds 72.5% of provincial GDPR and 40% of the province's tourism assets, and accessibility falls with each step away from it.**

| District | Share of provincial GDPR | Tourism assets | Share of assets | Accessibility score (1 to 5) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Metro** | 72.5% | 20,281 | 40.3% | 4.7 |
| **Cape Winelands** | 11.2% | 7,730 | 15.4% | 3.3 |
| **Garden Route** | 7.6% | 9,875 | 19.6% | 3.0 |
| **West Coast** | 4.8% | 4,752 | 9.4% | 1.7 |
| **Overberg** | 3% | 6,176 | 12.3% | 2.0 |
| **Central Karoo** | 0.5% | 1,518 | 3.0% | 1.0 |
| **Western Cape** | | 50,332 | 100% | |

Source: GDPR shares: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p39, p42, p44, p46, p48, p50 (year not printed; Garden Route share is for 2023). Asset counts: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p2, p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 (Winelands share computed: 7,730 of 50,332 is 15.4%). Accessibility: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90, attractions and services basis; the Metro scores 5.0 on transport.

[18] Infrastructure Report, p110; Diagnostic, p34.
[19] Diagnostic, p39, p42 to p50, p42; Infrastructure Report, p22.
[20] Infrastructure Report, p2, p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78.
[21] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, West Coast, p131; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Overberg, p119; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Winelands, p113; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p72.
[22] Infrastructure Report, p22, p88 to p90; Diagnostic, p41.
[23] Infrastructure Report, p98, p99, p90.

## Rail, roads and utilities

Passenger rail has collapsed as a mode. Trainsets fell from about 110 in 1995 to about 91, pushing some 400,000 commuters onto saturated roads, and congestion in the Metro costs an estimated R2.8bn a year. Metrorail still runs 460km, five lines and 104 of 121 stations, with 22.7m passenger trips in FY2025, but no line reaches the airport and it is rated functionally unusable for tourism. The MyCiTi bus service to the airport remains suspended.[24]

Utilities cap the periphery before demand does. The Diagnostic found in December 2025 that water scarcity sets a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes such as the Garden Route. It also found that load shedding raised costs and degraded the experience in peripheral districts. Power has since steadied: Eskom reported 539 days without load shedding in November 2026, though GreenCape finds that grid-connection constraints remain. The airport has no fuel pipeline and depends on road tankers, and the 2017 to 2018 water crisis left a lasting perception of resource pressure.[25]

Water is stable for now, but the margin is narrowing. The City of Cape Town reported on 19 August 2026 that immediate supply is stable, yet restriction risk has risen and demand runs above the City's growth target. The first water from the Faure scheme arrives in 2031, with further augmentation milestones to 2036. Planned supply is not commissioned headroom.

The remedies are named but not scheduled. Four transport enablers are listed, none dated or costed: the Cape Town Integrator, rail restoration and devolution, a high-speed city to airport link and George to Cape Winelands passenger rail. PRASA's R21.1bn programme and the City's R123bn, 30-year devolution case cover fleet and lines, and neither carries a tourism product or an airport link.[26]

## Institutions

Wesgro runs the demand side of this system through six units: Cape Town Air Access, Cruise Cape Town, the Convention Bureau, Destination Marketing, Research and Tourism. Around them sit fifteen external organisations across three spheres of government and industry. Cape Town Air Access is itself a partnership, formed in 2015, of the City of Cape Town, the provincial government, ACSA, Cape Town Tourism, South African Tourism, Wesgro and the private sector.[27]

The levers that bind the system sit with those partners. National government and its agencies, among them South African Tourism, ACSA and Transnet, hold visa rules, air service agreements, route rights and airport and port operations. The province holds jobs, inclusion and spatial outcomes, sector development, safety programmes and infrastructure planning. The City delivers services, manages precincts and readies events. Industry, from Cape Town Tourism, the V&A Waterfront and the flagship sites to the cruise lines and hotels, holds route viability, demand generation and product standards. Wesgro's plan names energy, ports, rail, digital infrastructure and visas as levers the province influences but does not control. Wesgro has set up an Advocacy and Advisory unit to build the evidence and relationships to influence them.[28]

Alignment across those tiers is thin. Stakeholders described strain at SA Tourism and a lack of fiscal space. More than twenty bodies produce tourism data, yet the Diagnostic finds no single view of visitor behaviour, which leaves strategy reacting rather than predicting. Fifteen of the sixteen organisations interviewed raised industry and government collaboration, and the Department of Economic Development named restrictive bilateral air agreements and below-peer destination funding as high-impact constraints.[29]

[24] Diagnostic, p38; Infrastructure Report, p100, p90.
[25] Diagnostic, p38, p55.
[26] Diagnostic, p38; Infrastructure Report, p100.
[27] Inception Report, p7; organisations as shown on the stakeholder map and grouped by this report; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 1.
[28] Diagnostic, p58; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p27.
[29] Diagnostic, p58, p56, p57; Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, p24, p25; the count is of organisations with at least one insight under the theme.

None of these constraints is a shortage of visitors. The runway, the single corridor, a rail network visitors cannot use, the thin winter schedule and decision rights split across three tiers all sit outside a marketing budget. The system has recovered; its constraints are now physical and institutional.

## 1.2 From recovery to growth

The recovery is complete. Gateway capacity now caps growth in the summer peak, and demand and conversion cap it in the green season.

### The limits of recovery

The action plan's task is to move the Western Cape from recovery to growth. The first half is done. On the airport's count, international arrivals through Cape Town International reached 1.44m in FY24/25 against 1.16m in FY19/20, and 1.57m in FY25/26. On South African Tourism's provincial count the province still stood below 2019 in 2025 (Appendix A2).[30]

Recovery logic assumed capacity waiting to be refilled. Arrivals fell to 80,400 in FY20/21, and the task was to refill idle seats, rooms and routes. That slack is gone. South Africa's international seat capacity is back at pre-pandemic levels, and Cape Town International shares with Lanseria the highest load factor of the country's five largest airports, 79% across all its seats in 2025.[31]

Cape Town did more than refill its seats. It added 17 mainline international routes between 2015 and 2025, more than any of eight peer airports, and the MIDAS assessment now asks what comes next. The rebound that a recovery plan is built to capture has already happened.[32]

China has not recovered. On Cape Town Air Access's count, Cape Town handled 25,107 Chinese air passengers in 2024, 55% of the 2019 level, though January to May 2025 ran 19% above the same months of 2024. For that market, recovery logic still applies.[33]

### Seasonal seats and demand

Growth is now supply-constrained in the summer peak and demand-constrained in the green season, when airlines withdraw seats. A survey of 34 outbound markets counts 97 million high-value, South Africa-interested travellers, of whom only 1.4 million convert into arrivals. The Market Assessment concludes that the challenge is converting interest into visits, not generating demand. Over the three years 2022 to 2024 the province took about 0.1% of the world's tourist arrivals and 0.05% of its tourist spend. Its best share of any large air market was the UK's, at 0.27% of air outbound trips.[34]

The binding supply is peak capacity at the gateway. The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case, in which Wesgro maintains current activity, reaches 1,802,929 arrivals at the 2030 plotted year. The chart below sets the base case against that line.[35]

[30] Demand-Side Analysis, p11.
[31] Demand-Side Analysis, p11; MIDAS, "The South African Market".
[32] MIDAS, "International Comparisons"; "In Conclusion".
[33] Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slides 14 to 16.
[34] Market Assessment, p41; Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p2, p4.
[35] Market Assessment, p20.

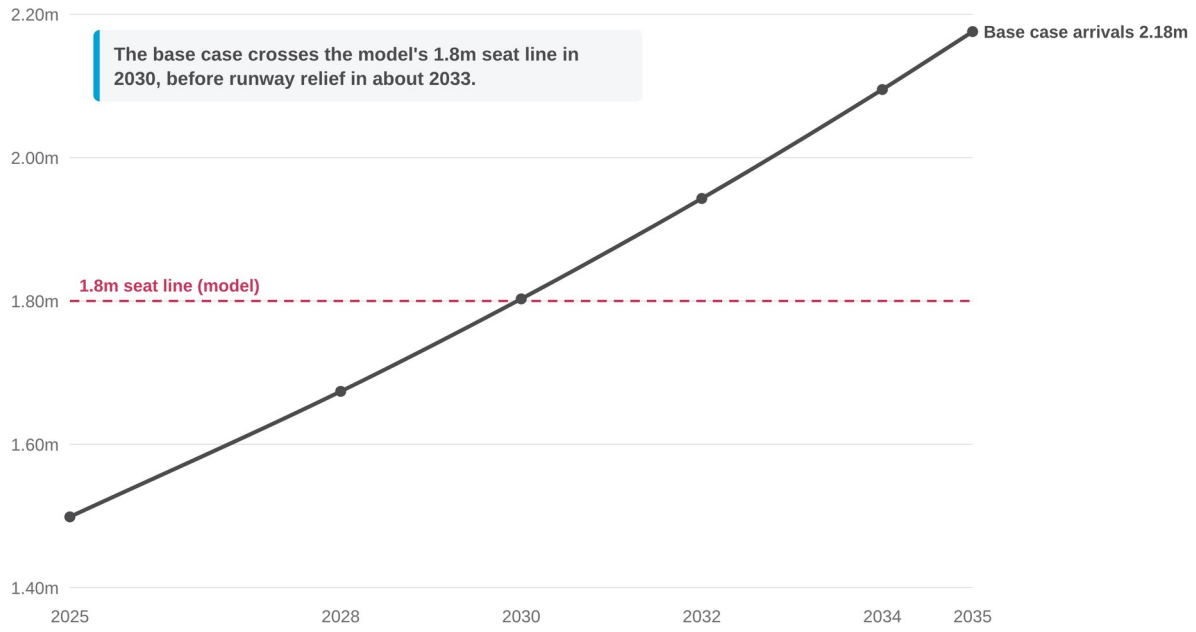



**Figure 1.4.** Base case against the seat line

The line is the model's assumption, not a measured cap. At the international routes' 76.0% load factor, 1.8 million inbound seats would carry about 1.37 million arrivals, fewer than the 1.57 million ACSA recorded in FY25/26. The route table counts 3,816,797 international seats for the year to November 2025, more than 1.8 million each way even if that total counts both directions. What binds is the runway at peak hours in the summer peak, at about 30 movements an hour. [Open item: ACSA or OAG to supply peak-hour and seasonal slot headroom at Cape Town International.][36]

The routes that exist are full. Eleven of the 27 international routes in the load-factor table ran above 80% in the year to November 2025. Together they averaged 76.0% on the printed total, below the airport's 79% across all seats. Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026. Five of the eleven are mature long-haul routes, led by Newark at 88.6%, Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%.[37]

Full routes do not add seats of their own accord. The MIDAS assessment expects carriers to raise fares on them before they add capacity or new services. Airlines also pull seats out of winter: June carries 6.4% of the year's international capacity and December 10.8%.[38]

Yet traffic outside the peak months has grown faster. Comparing 2024 with 2015, monthly international passengers rose by an average of 88% in the airlines' summer season of April to October and 73% in their winter season of November to March. The quieter months are therefore not a fixed weakness, and growth there does not wait for runway relief.[39]

A calendar series confirms the direction. April to September passenger movements at Cape Town International rose from 662,771 in 2015 to 1,342,770 in 2025, international and regional traffic together. That is growth of 102.6%, against 85.7% for the other six months. The quieter months are a market already won once, which makes further growth credible (section 2.2).

[36] MIDAS, "Seasonality"; Demand-Side Analysis, p11, computed; Infrastructure Report, p101.
[37] MIDAS, "Seasonality".
[38] MIDAS, "In Conclusion", "Seasonality".
[39] Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 6.

Behind the routes sits the runway. The Infrastructure Report finds that the airport, not a shortage of visitors, now caps Cape Town's tourism growth. The airport's one main runway caps movements at about 30 an hour until relief arrives in about 2033 (section 1.1).[40]

The secondary gateways do not close the gap in time. The Infrastructure Report finds that the certain fix comes last and the earliest large option is the least certain. Route rights sit a tier up: air service agreements are a national function. The Department of Economic Development rates restrictive bilateral agreements a high-impact constraint on airlift.[41]

## Reach and booking beyond the Metro

Beyond the Metro the constraint changes shape, not nature: accessibility falls from 4.7 in the Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and the visitor drives.[42]

What the car can reach is listed more widely than it is known to be found. Accommodation is widely listed on platforms such as Airbnb and Booking.com. A March 2026 snapshot of one platform counted 1,953 listings in Overstrand, 1,413 in Knysna, 1,404 in Stellenbosch and 1,226 in Bitou (section 2.3). A desk test of 13 accommodation cases outside the core found a property-specific platform listing for every one. Experiences differ. Of eight named attractions outside the core, three appeared on an experience marketplace, each as a stop on a tour [listing coverage by district for experiences: to be measured by the I3 audit]. Guides and community product often sell only by phone, Route 62 has the lowest online bookability of the six touring routes and even CapeNature takes about 70% of its reservations through a call centre.[43]

## Growth above the norm

Global tourism grows 3% to 5% a year under stable conditions, the band the benchmarking work calls organic growth. In 2024 the world grew 11% as recovery ran on, and only Chile, at 40.4%, and Singapore, at 21%, grew far faster. The longer record is the better test (section 2.1). Santiago's airport grew from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019, at least 5.5% a year.[44]

The Western Cape's two paths straddle the band. The base case implies 3.8% a year from 2025 to 2035 and the accelerated case 5.3%, and the accelerated case reverts to base unless routes are confirmed. The benchmarking work counts growth as structural only above that band, and only when deliberate changes to demand drivers, access or product drive it, not cyclical recovery or short-term promotion.[45]

Cape Town remains the engine of the system, but the Infrastructure Report warns that growth cannot keep concentrating there. The Department of Economic Development already reads the growth framing as overweight on volumes and asks for a value and spend lens in place of arrivals. Growth now needs new markets, new seasons and new regions, and each of those is a supply problem before it is a marketing problem.[46]

[40] Infrastructure Report, p101.
[41] Infrastructure Report, p104 to p109; Diagnostic, p58; Stakeholder Insights, p24.
[42] Infrastructure Report, p88 to p90, p99.
[43] Infrastructure Report, p87; Inclusion Plan, p34, p47; Stakeholder Insights, p42.
[44] Benchmarking, p7, p24 to p26, computed; UN Tourism, World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025; Sernatur, Anuario de Turismo 2024, Dec 2025; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[45] Market Assessment, p19; Benchmarking, p8.
[46] Infrastructure Report, p114; Stakeholder Insights, p24.

## 1.3 Mandate and objective

Wesgro commissioned this study to establish a viable growth target for international arrivals to 2035 and to set out the strategy and action plan to reach it. The evidence sets the target at 2.5 million arrivals by 2035, paced by gateway capacity in the summer peak and by demand in the green season.[47]

### Wesgro's mandate

Wesgro promotes tourism, trade and investment for Cape Town and the Western Cape, so its tourism work sits inside a wider economic brief. Its mission is to work with partners to drive inclusive and sustainable economic growth, strengthen competitiveness and create jobs in Cape Town and the Western Cape. Its vision is to be a leading regional agency for tourism, trade and investment promotion. Two points in the mission shape the recommendations: growth is a means to jobs, and Wesgro acts through partners rather than holding the levers itself.[48]

Four of Wesgro's eight strategy statements bear directly on this study. The first sets the destination proposition: Cape Town and the Western Cape as a leading business and tourism destination with premium products and services. The fourth names new markets and buyers in China, ASEAN, India, Brazil and the Middle East, alongside a continued focus on established markets. The sixth commits Wesgro to track and address systemic challenges to economic competitiveness, and the seventh to provide economic data, insights and analytics for the Western Cape. The growth-market work in objective 4 centres on two of them: India and China, whose travellers already reach Cape Town through Gulf and African hubs. The growth model's acceleration group holds the Gulf, China, India and Brazil.[49]

### Setting a viable target

The objective, set in November 2025, is an evidence-based tourism strategy that grows international arrivals through demand, supply and enablement, and makes that growth inclusive, sustainable and geographically dispersed in line with Wesgro's strategic priorities. Those three terms fix the strategic goals the report keeps throughout.[50]

Four headline ambitions sat under the objective: more international visitors, 300,000 tourism-linked jobs, 10,000 SMMEs onboarded and twice the airlift and cruise volumes. The report carries all four forward. The evidence sets the target for the first and shapes how the other three are measured.[51]

**Arrivals.** The growth model supports 2.2 million to 2.5 million by 2035. From 1,498,829 arrivals in 2025, its base case reaches 2,175,778 by 2035 and its accelerated case 2,516,282, above a conservative floor of 1,822,634. The base case holds Wesgro's effort at 2025 intensity, with selective frequency gains and continued hub expansion. The accelerated case needs confirmed direct routes to India and China, above-baseline activation and more hub capacity into Cape Town; without the routes, volume reverts to base. Growth to 2.5 million is that case rounded, and it is the target the report carries.[52]

Even the base case outruns the model's air access. The model draws a seat line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case first passes it at the 2030 year point, at 1,802,929 arrivals. The line is an assumption rather than a measured cap. In practice the runway binds first, at peak hours (section 1.2). Growth to 2.5 million is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing programme.[53]

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[47] Inception Report, p4.
[48] Inception Report, p5.
[49] Inception Report, p5; Demand-Side Analysis, p46, p48; Market Assessment, p20.
[50] Inception Report, p4.
[51] Inception Report, p4.
[52] Market Assessment, p19, p18; Demand-Side Analysis, p20; this source prints the same 2035 points from a 2024 base.
[53] Market Assessment, p20.

**Jobs and GDP.** Arrivals are the first measure of success, not the last. The plan needs reliable measures of the jobs and GDP that tourism creates in the province, and building them is part of execution. The labour analysis (I18) and the data-sharing protocol (I16) set a provincial method and baseline in 2027, and Gate 1 turns them into targets, including a test of the 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition.

**SMMEs and inclusion.** The ambition of 10,000 SMMEs onboarded is carried as community inclusion, measured by the visitor spend that reaches priority communities (Chapter 5). [Wesgro to confirm the baseline count and definition of SMMEs onboarded]

**Airlift and cruise.** The ambition was twice the airlift and cruise volumes. Section 3.2.1 sets airlift as the seats and routes needed to lift the model's 1.8 million seat line. It sets cruise as calls and ports. Wesgro's plan targets 250 ship calls over FY26 to FY30, or 50 a year. [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026: Cruise Cape Town to confirm that the deck's 250 calls are the plan's five-year total.] The cruise baseline is 64 cruise liner visits in the 2025/26 season, against 79 in 2024/25. Arrivals carry a target today. The other three take their baselines in the first phase of execution.[54]

## Wesgro's five-year targets

Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan sets six tourism targets over its five years, among them 800,000 to 1 million new international arrivals, 161 business-event bids, 250 ship calls and 10 new air routes. The activity targets hold at or below today's pace: 36 bids secured in 2024/25, 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26 and about three route launches a year since 2015. The step change therefore has to come in conversion and value, and Wesgro's plan would gain from stating its arrivals outcome that way.[55]

**Table 1.3.** Wesgro's targets beside this report

> **Wesgro's activity targets hold or fall below today's pace; its arrivals target asks for a step change only if read as a rise in yearly arrivals by 2030.**

| Wesgro target | FY26 to FY30 | What this report carries |
|---|---|---|
| **New international tourist arrivals** | 800,000 to 1 million | As a rise in yearly arrivals by 2030, 2.6 to 3.3 times the base case's gain; as a sum over five years, about what the base case adds; T1-01 |
| **Business event bids** | 161 secured, worth an estimated R4.5bn | About 32 a year, against 36 conference bids secured in 2024/25; T2-02 tracks association meetings |
| **Ship calls** | 250 | 50 a year, against 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26 and 79 vessels in 2024/25; T2-11 |
| **New air routes** | 10 | Two a year, against about three a year counted by Cape Town Air Access since 2015; T2-09 |
| **International tourism marketing campaigns** | 3 | Segment-led activation and hub conversion in I1 and I4, conversion before awareness; T3-01, T3-02, T3-07 and T3-08 |
| **International tourism trade engagements** | 12,500 | 2,500 a year, flat on the 2,500 of FY24; T3-37 |

Source: Targets and the FY24 trade count: Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; route definition, p59. Arrivals paths: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19, p20. Bids: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p36. Cruise: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p37; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29. Routes: Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 5. Annual rates and multiples are computed.

## The Growth for Jobs mandate

The Western Cape Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023 to 2035 (G4J) is the strategic point of departure for this plan. G4J treats tourism as an important service export within a framework for private-sector-led growth,

[54] Market Assessment, p20; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; Diagnostic, p37; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[55] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p19, p20, p59; Inception Report, p6; Market Assessment, p19, p20, p25, p26; Demand-Side Analysis, p36, p37; Diagnostic, p37; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 5, computed.

and seeks a destination known for quality, reliability and cost-effective offerings, supported by competitive business conditions. Its quantified goal is to triple the province's goods and services exports, tourism included, by 2035. It sets no separate tourism arrivals target.[56]

The two share a focus on air access, source-market diversification, stronger tourism offerings, economic intelligence and collaboration between government and business. Both tie growth to investment, inclusion, sustainability and working infrastructure. G4J's call for tourism plans, country strategies and coordinated promotion gives this plan its policy foundation, and its emphasis on Wesgro's leadership and on cooperation across government supports the proposed delivery approach.[57]

This plan turns that direction into a tourism diagnosis and a delivery programme. It names four constraints: air capacity, seasonal imbalance, unproven regional distribution and fragmented responsibilities. It sets three strategic goals, Reshape demand, Transform supply and Build enabling capability, with twenty objectives delivered through eighteen initiatives, and it puts seats and bookings alongside promotion. Market diversification becomes segment-led conversion, yield in mature markets, conversion of India and China hub traffic and development of African markets (Chapter 3).

The plan also gives G4J's aims for spread and inclusion an operational form: bookable regional experiences, internal mobility and community pilots. It adds proposals for cruise and for managing visitor flows at the nature sites, ties green-season events to retained airline capacity and supports destinations beyond the main centres through local tourism bodies, investment preparation and work on sustainability and climate resilience.

Delivery takes concrete form in proposed initiative owners, a Tourism Growth Steerco and programme office, a national escalation agenda and three phases from 2027 to 2035 (Chapter 4). Decision gates, a data-sharing protocol and indicators for arrivals, spend, season, spread and community benefit give G4J's outcome focus a measurable form. Conditional growth paths tie the target to the capacity and market interventions needed to reach it (Chapter 5).[58]

G4J supplies the approved provincial mandate; this plan sets out tourism delivery within it. Costing the initiatives, confirming owners with mandate holders and building measures of tourism jobs and GDP are the first tasks of execution (sections 4.6 and 5.4). The plan's mandate is international. The next subsection sets out how G4J's domestic-tourism agenda, which uses domestic demand to smooth the seasons and buffer global shocks, bears on it.

Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan and the Tourism Blueprint 2030 point the same way. The plan's first decision gate, at the end of 2028, falls inside Wesgro's plan period and is the point to map initiative outputs to its six targets. The Blueprint's objectives map onto the three goals.[59]

## Domestic tourism and study scope

Domestic tourism is the larger market by trips. In 2025 South Africans made about 4.0 million overnight trips in the Western Cape, 15.4% more than in 2024, and spent 14.3 million bed nights there at an average stay of 3.6 nights. Holidays accounted for about 1.6 million trips and visits to friends and relatives for 1.5 million. The 2024 count of 3.458 million trips was 6.1% below the start of 2020, and provinces such as the Eastern Cape drew more of the budget-conscious recovery.[60]

Volume recovered in 2025; value did not. Nominal domestic overnight spend fell 31.9% to R12.7 billion. Survey evidence points to tighter household budgets, more drive travel and shorter booking windows. These are provincial estimates of trips, not unique visitors, paid hotel rooms or day visits.

[56] G4J, p48, p87.
[57] G4J, p25, p26, p88 to p92.
[58] G4J, p53, p192 to p195.
[59] Tourism Blueprint 2030, p9.
[60] Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p69 to p70.

Domestic demand touches the plan at four points; first, the green season. Domestic and visiting-friends trips can fill winter rooms, but school and public holidays recreate peaks, so domestic demand is not counter-seasonal by default. Second, regional spread. A resident's regional break strengthens businesses outside the Metro while moving spend within the province, whereas an interprovincial visitor brings new money. Third, mobility. Domestic visitors without cars need the same shared transport and airport links as international visitors (objective 9). Fourth, inventory. Domestic offers and winter business events draw on the same rooms and experiences, so a night sold should be counted once.

The channels already exist. Wesgro's With Love from the Locals campaign tells regional stories and Cape Town Tourism's My Cape Town campaign pairs local content with a booking hub. CapeNature and SANParks run access offers for South African visitors. DEDAT's 2026/27 Annual Performance Plan places domestic marketing with the provincial tourism agencies, alongside collaboration with South African Tourism abroad.

This study's mandate is international. Its target, growth paths and indicators are built on international arrivals. Domestic tourism matters to that case as a source of green-season and regional demand, and as a market that rising peak prices could crowd out. The report therefore tracks domestic trips and spend as context (Chapter 5). It leaves a domestic strategy to DEDAT and the provincial tourism agencies, in line with G4J's domestic-tourism agenda.

## 1.4 Approach and method

The study combines quantitative analysis, stakeholder insight, spatial assessment and comparative destination cases to build an action plan for tourism growth in the Western Cape. It identifies where growth is constrained, which opportunities the province can pursue and what coordinated action turns them into economic and destination benefits.

### Purpose and approach

Three interdependent dimensions structure the analysis: demand, supply and enablement. The study mandate set them, and they give the specialist workstreams a common framework. The final synthesis organises the findings into objectives, recommendations, initiatives and a monitoring framework. The theory of change below explains how the proposed interventions are expected to produce outcomes. Implementation will test it.

### Why demand, supply and enablement

Tourism growth depends on visitors choosing the destination, businesses being able to deliver the visit and institutions sustaining the conditions that allow both. Examining any one of these dimensions alone would give an incomplete explanation of performance.

Demand asks who the province can attract, what visitors value, when and where they travel and how interest becomes a booking. It covers source markets, traveller segments, reasons to travel, distribution channels, affordability and conversion. Supply asks whether visitors can reach and move through the destination and buy experiences that can be delivered reliably. It covers air access, accommodation, mobility, attractions, supporting services, product quality, bookability and usable capacity. Enablement asks which shared conditions make demand and supply viable: institutional coordination, policy, investment, skills, safety, intelligence, local participation and destination management.

These are complementary lenses, not mutually exclusive industry categories. Air seats are a supply consideration, while air rights and the public decisions that affect them are enabling conditions. Bookability

connects distribution with product delivery. Skills support service quality, and local participation affects both the offer and the spread of benefits. A workstream can therefore inform more than one goal.

The framework does not assume that supply always leads demand, that all constraints bind at once or that each goal deserves equal spending. The limiting factor varies by market, season and destination. Promotion converts demand where suitable capacity exists; elsewhere it meets unavailable transport, incomplete products or service constraints. Capacity investment in turn needs a credible market and a capable operator. Enablement supports every pathway throughout implementation. This systems reading is consistent with international guidance on integrated destination governance, competitiveness and community benefit.[61]

## Workstreams and interim outputs

The research architecture comprises overlapping workstreams supported by a shared mandate and a current-state baseline. The study ran in four phases from November 2025 to November 2026: inception, demand-side analysis, supply-side analysis and enablement with final reporting. That sequence gave the work its organisational structure; the evidence is integrated by theme, not treated as a set of isolated studies. Table 1.4 lists the workstreams and Figure 1.5 shows how they relate.[62]

**Table 1.4.** Evidence streams and their products

**Each evidence stream answers a different question and feeds one synthesis.**

| Evidence stream | Principal products | Contribution to the synthesis |
|---|---|---|
| **Mandate and baseline** | Inception Report; Current State Diagnostic, version 2 | Define objectives, policy context, starting performance and initial constraints |
| **Markets, travellers and aviation** | Demand-Side Analysis; MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment | Assess opportunity, segments, channels, seasonality, routes and access constraints |
| **Supply and spatial readiness** | Infrastructure Report | Examine the visitor offer, district and route readiness, connectivity and investment gaps |
| **SME and community inclusion** | SME and Community Inclusion Plan | Identify participation barriers, community priorities, local selling capability and pilot principles |
| **Stakeholder and institutional insight** | Stakeholder Insights Report, phase 1 | Explain operating experience, coordination problems, implementation constraints and areas for further enquiry |
| **Comparative destinations** | Global Benchmarking Report | Identify relevant mechanisms and delivery models and assess their transferability |
| **Integration and delivery design** | This report, its initiative charters and its M&E framework | Connect findings to actions, dependencies, responsibilities, decision gates and measures |

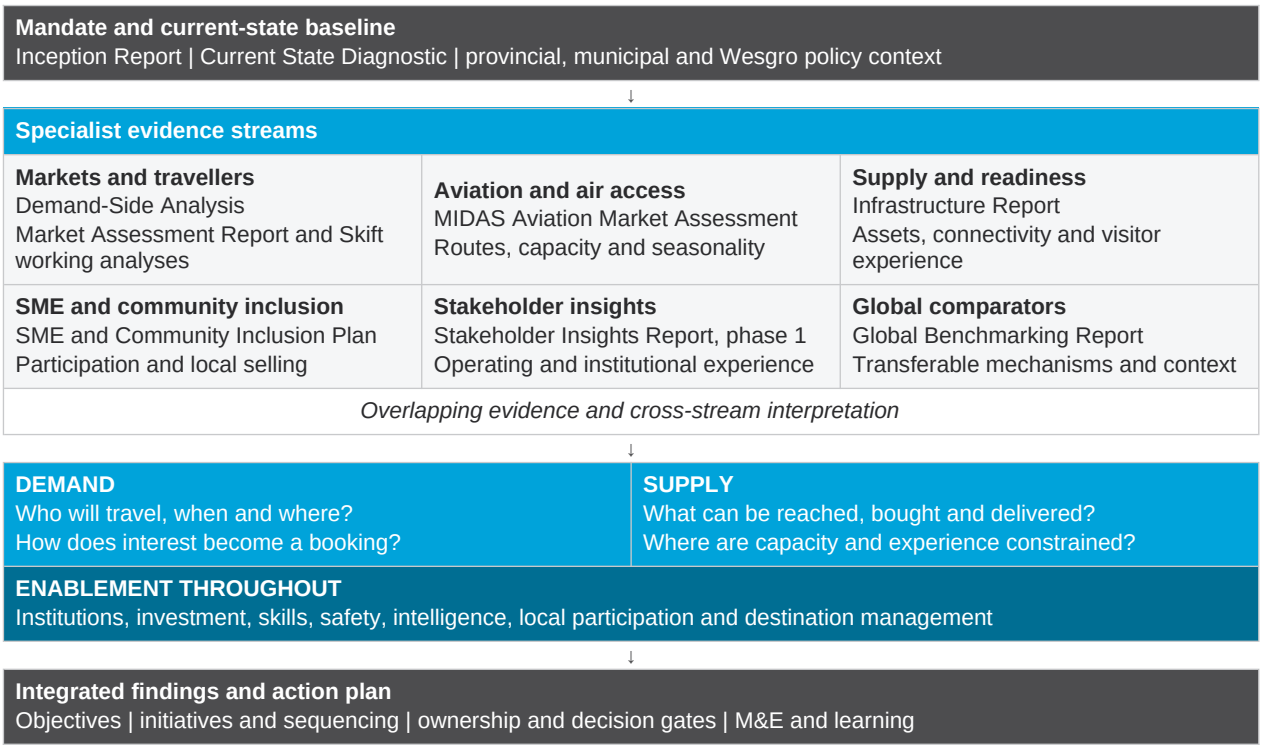
Source: Letsema. Product names follow the document register in Appendix A9.

The May 2026 Market Assessment Report and Skift's digital and search, segmentation and African-market analyses are supporting working analyses. They develop or inform the formal workstream outputs and keep their own assumptions and scope, so they do not count as further independent studies where later deliverables reproduce their evidence. The enabling analysis draws across the diagnostic, stakeholder, infrastructure, inclusion and policy material; it has no standalone enablement report.

The products answer different questions. Market analysis explores demand and conditional growth opportunities, and aviation analysis tests access constraints and route options. Spatial assessment identifies where the destination can receive and service visitors. Inclusion analysis examines who can participate and retain value. Benchmarking and stakeholder insights supply the contextual and institutional explanations that help interpret the quantitative findings and identify feasible responses.

[61] OECD (2026), Tourism Trends and Policies 2026, OECD Publishing, Paris.
[62] Inception Report, p11, p12.

**Figure 1.5.** How the research evidence informs the action plan




*Analytical relationships; workstreams overlap and findings have different evidential strength.*

## Stakeholder engagement

Stakeholder engagement was planned in four phases: introduction and framing, sense-making and validation, socialisation of draft recommendations and mobilisation. The Stakeholder Insights Report documents the first phase, with insight tables for sixteen organisations from Mossel Bay to the CTICC.[63]

The method was strict about what an insight is. Sessions were run, insights extracted, each coded to a goal and a category of the framework and then aggregated. The 223 statements are the project team's paraphrases rated High, Medium or Low, not quotations, so this report attributes them to organisations and never to named individuals.[64]

Two gaps in the record matter: phase 1 engaged no airline, online travel agent or tour operator, and the six demand-side engagements were proposed for phase 2. [Open item: test the gateway and governance chapters with ACSA, the Cape Town Air Access airline partners, the City of Cape Town and Cape Town Tourism before Steerco.] The Cape Town Air Access pipeline gives that test its agenda. As reported in November 2025, it targets routes from Africa, Saudi Arabia, Asia and Australia and has engaged Cathay Pacific, China Southern, Air India and IndiGo. The demand work drew instead on discussions with more than 20 stakeholders of its own. The outcomes of engagement phases 2 to 4 sit in no document in hand [Letsema to supply the phase 2 to 4 engagement record for Appendix A6].[65]

## Evidence assessment

The synthesis brings together administrative and published tourism data, market and aviation analysis, spatial inventories, comparative readiness judgements, stakeholder insights and policy documents. Each finding is traced to its sources and linked forward to its recommendation, initiative and indicator (Appendix A1). Agreement across documents is read in light of shared underlying sources, because repetition is not independent corroboration.

[63] Stakeholder Insights, p4, p17, p20 to p46.
[64] Stakeholder Insights, p5, p20 to p46.
[65] Stakeholder Insights, p16; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slides 12, 13; Demand-Side Analysis, p7.

Stakeholder material is used to understand mechanisms, operating conditions and priorities within the engagement record. The 223 documented insights are paraphrases written and coded by the study team, so their counts show where views cluster among the organisations represented and do not confirm an objective on their own. They do not measure prevalence across the industry or the economic size of a constraint. Survey-based segmentation keeps the population and scope of the original research. District and route readiness scores are comparative screening judgements, not engineering capacity certificates.[66]

Benchmark cases are selected for relevance to the Western Cape's market, access, product, spatial and institutional conditions. Their purpose is to examine how an intervention might work and under what conditions it could transfer. Reported growth alongside a policy or programme does not, on its own, establish that the intervention caused it.

The study began with a hypothesis tree: each entry named a lever on growth and was framed so the evidence could test it. The tested tree became the strategy's framework of three strategic goals, six themes and twenty objectives (Figure ES.2). Appendix A1 rates the evidence behind each objective. Objective 20, on workforce and service skills, rests on a labour analysis that execution commissions first (I18).

Growth scenarios are used as conditional planning cases. Their access, market-growth and activation assumptions show what would need to change for a different growth path to be plausible. Scenario differences are not a quantified estimate of the eighteen initiatives' separate or combined effects. Where definitions, coverage or baselines are uncertain, the limitation is kept and the decision is matched to the strength of the evidence.

## From findings to the action plan

Integration connects a market opportunity with the supply and enabling conditions needed to realise it. Seasonal demand activation depends on saleable transport and accommodation in the relevant months. Regional dispersal depends on bookable experiences, reliable onward access and a receiving destination that is ready. Community participation depends on a viable seller, market access and safe fulfilment. These links show which interventions must proceed together and which depend on earlier decisions.

The action plan translates findings into initiative charters, sequencing, proposed responsibilities, funding routes and decision gates. Its implementation choices should be assessed against the materiality of the opportunity or constraint, commercial feasibility, dependencies, evidence strength, public cost and expected local benefit. Owners and funding routes are proposals until mandate holders commit to them.

## Theory of change

The action plan's central proposition is that coordinated demand, supply and enabling interventions can improve both the visitor journey and the ability of businesses and communities to deliver it. If suitable travellers are reached through effective channels, the offer is accessible and saleable and partners sustain the operating conditions, more journeys can be chosen, booked, reached and enjoyed in the intended seasons and places.

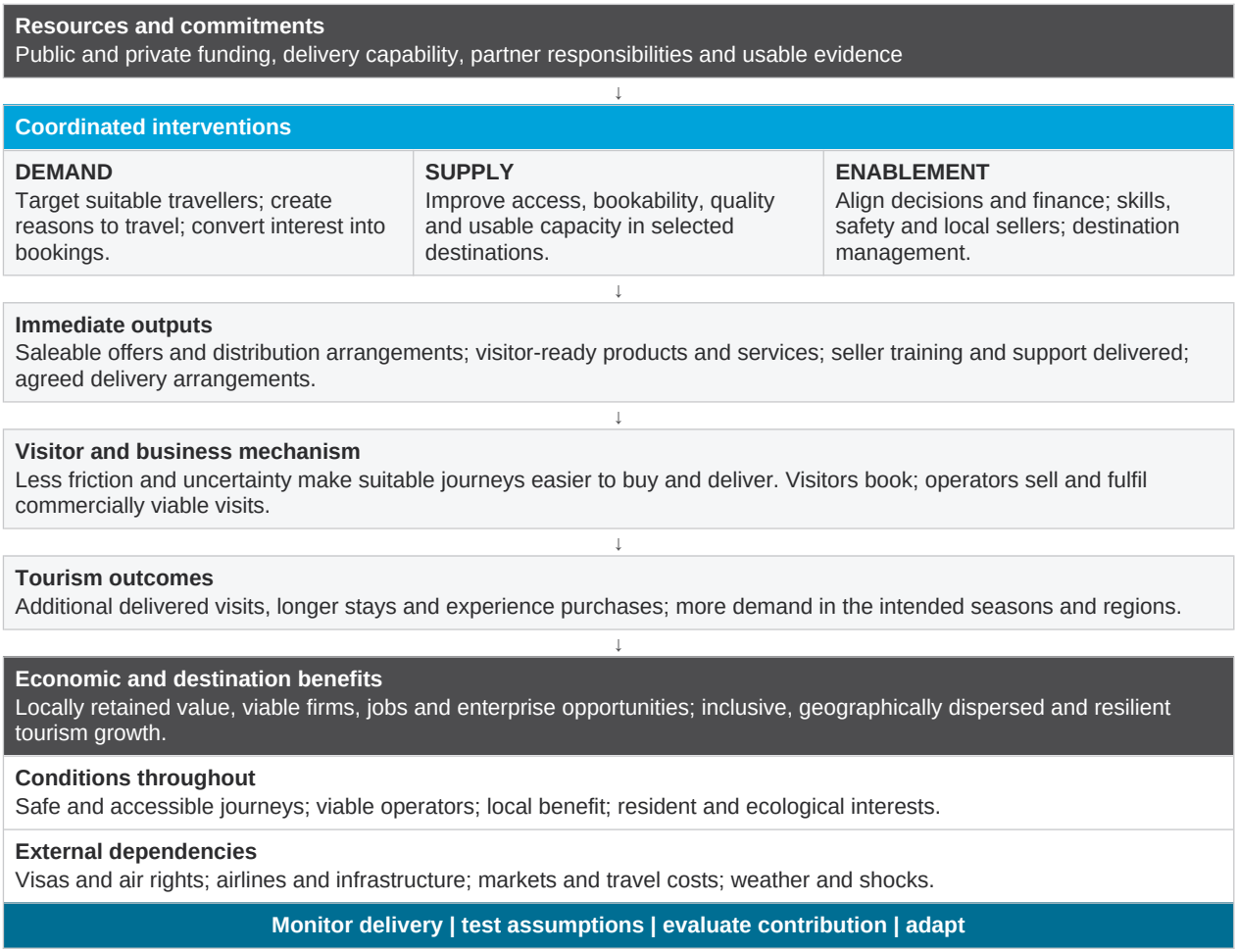
Resources and partner commitments support three connected activity pathways. Demand interventions improve targeting, reasons to travel and conversion. Supply interventions improve access, product, service quality and usable capacity. Enabling interventions align decisions, investment, capability, safety, local participation and destination management. Their immediate outputs include saleable offers, distribution arrangements, operational improvements, agreed delivery arrangements and seller training and support.

[66] Stakeholder Insights, p5, p20 to p46.

The proposed mechanism is that better-matched offers and fewer information, booking and journey barriers reduce friction and uncertainty. Visitors are then more able and willing to buy and complete suitable journeys, while operators can sell and fulfil them commercially. Where this produces additional visits, longer stays or experience purchases, it can raise visitor value and sustain viable businesses and investment. Geographic and seasonal benefits depend on where and when the additional activity occurs.

Employment, inclusion and resilience require further mechanisms. Locally retained value depends on ownership, procurement and supplier participation. Employment depends on viable firms, workforce access and capability. Destination continuity depends on resource management, maintenance and preparedness. These benefits are explicit conditions of successful growth, not automatic consequences of higher arrivals. Figure 1.6 sets out this proposed causal logic.[67]

**Figure 1.6.** Theory of change for inclusive and resilient tourism growth




*Arrows show proposed pathways to be tested; benefits depend on implementation and context.*

The pathway rests on five assumptions that must be tested. Travellers can afford and book the offer. Operators find the commercial case viable. Transport and destination capacity are usable. Mandated owners commit resources and make decisions. Local benefits are not absorbed by leakage, displacement or unacceptable social and environmental costs. National visa and air-service decisions, airline strategies, infrastructure delivery, source-market conditions, travel costs, weather and other shocks also affect results. The province can influence some of these conditions but cannot control them all.

[67] HM Treasury (2020), Magenta Book Supplementary Guide: Handling Complexity in Policy Evaluation (CECAN).

### Monitoring, evaluation and learning

Monitoring separates activities and outputs from changes in behaviour and performance. A signed agreement, a completed training programme or a live booking channel is an output; use of that channel, fulfilled sales, sustained jobs and higher retained earnings are outcomes. The quarterly scorecard, decision gates, annual plan refresh and independent reviews in Chapters 4 and 5 form the learning cycle, and their results feed back into intervention design, sequencing and resource allocation.

## 1.5 How to read this report

The report is built so that a Board member can read the summary and any one objective on its own, and a programme owner can run the plan from Chapters 3 to 5.

### Chapter map

The report moves from context to evidence to recommendations to delivery.

The executive summary tells the case in short: where the province stands, what caps growth and what 2.5 million arrivals would take. It then sets out the three shifts and the twenty objectives, the first 24 months, the headline indicators and the main risks. It stands alone, for the Board, Exco and the February 2027 launch audience. Chapter 1 is for every reader, and is the chapter of the body a Board member should read if they read no other. It sets out where the system stands after recovery, why the next step is constrained by peak capacity, what Wesgro asked for and how the study ran.

Chapter 2 sets out what the analysis found, in four parts: the global benchmarks and their lessons, demand, supply and the enabling environment. It serves readers checking the evidence behind a Chapter 3 entry, and each part closes with a box naming the objectives it supports. Chapter 3 takes the twenty objectives in turn. Each entry sets out the challenge or opportunity, the evidence, the course of action, why it can work and the link to the plan. The Board and Exco can read it entry by entry and the programme owner in full; section 3.4 gives the sequence.

Chapter 4 sets out which initiatives run, in what order, owned by whom, at what cost and with which decision gates, for the programme owner, Steerco and the partners named in the RACI. Chapter 5 sets out how progress is measured, through indicators, baselines, targets, data sources, the scorecard and the 2030 mid-term review, for Wesgro Research, the programme office and Steerco. Appendices A1 to A9 hold the traceability table, the demand model, the benchmark cases, readiness scores, the community fact base, stakeholder inputs, charters, the toolkit and references, for analysts and anyone checking a figure. Highlighted text in square brackets marks an open item, with the figure needed and who holds it. Initiatives run I1 to I18 and indicators T1-01 onwards for impact, T2-01 for outcome and T3-01 for output.

Chapter 2

# Analysis and insights

Four parts build the case for the recommendations in Chapter 3. Section 2.1 draws lessons from comparator destinations; sections 2.2, 2.3 and 2.4 then examine demand, supply and the enabling environment, on which Goals 1, 2 and 3 rest.

Demand is not what holds the province back. Its shape and the system that serves it do. Five markets and six months carry most overseas visits and seats into Cape Town run out at the peak. Beyond the Metro, product is hard to reach and book, and in townships and rural settlements the missing piece is a local seller. The institutions that should hold the system together have thinned. Section 2.1 first shows how the fastest growers dealt with their own binding constraint.

Stakeholder evidence runs through sections 2.2 to 2.4. The first of four engagement phases ran from January to March 2026. In it, 16 organisations from Mossel Bay to the CTICC gave 223 rated insights: 115 High, 102 Medium and 6 Low. Each stakeholder statement in this chapter is the project team's paraphrase of a point an organisation made, attributed to that organisation and never to a person. [Open item: each organisation named here to approve its paraphrase before publication.] Each part ends with a box that links the part's evidence to each objective it touches.[68]

## 2.1 Global benchmarks and their lessons

The destinations that grew fastest ran institutions, marketing and air access as one system aimed at a single binding constraint. For the Western Cape that constraint is seats into one gateway; in its townships and rural settlements it is the lack of a local seller.

### Purpose of the benchmarks

The action plan aims at 2.5 million international arrivals by 2035, 5.3% a year on the accelerated path and just above the world's norm (sections 1.2 and 1.3). Growth above trend is rare across whole regions; where it happens, it is specific to a destination. Benchmarking asks which deliberate choices let comparable destinations outgrow the world, and which of them the Western Cape can adapt. It looks for how each destination removed what bound its growth, not for isolated good practice.[69]

The yardstick is the world's own growth. Growth of 3% to 5% a year is the norm under stable conditions; above 5% marks structural acceleration and 10% or more a structural shift. UN Tourism puts global growth at 11% in 2024, while recovery was still running, and about 4% in 2025. Growth counts as structural only when deliberate changes to demand drivers, access conditions or product systems drive it, not cyclical recovery or short-term promotion. Each case was read for its demand profile, two proven growth levers and how far they transfer to the Western Cape.[70]

### Choosing the comparators

The screen scored 30 destinations across Africa, Europe, the Americas and Oceania against 12 criteria in four groups. Market and access asks whether visitors arrive as the Western Cape's do, by long-haul air through hubs from the same markets. Destination and product structure asks whether a gateway city leads into several regions with a similar mix and price. Growth and inclusion compares growth stage, seasonality, community participation and climate pressure; performance compares volume, yield and infrastructure. Appendix A3 lists all twelve.[71]

Each destination received one average score across the twelve criteria, and the 30 were ranked on it. Chile, Melbourne and Victoria, Valencia and Singapore came from the top of that ranking. Partial likeness

[68] Stakeholder Insights, p4, p17, p20 to p46, counted; the record of the three later phases is not yet in hand.
[69] Benchmarking, p7, p6.
[70] Benchmarking, p7, p8, p13; World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025 and Jan 2026.
[71] Inception Report, p29 to p31, p30; Benchmarking, p11, p12.

ruled out others in the upper half. Namibia lacks city, wine and cultural depth. Reykjavik and Iceland sell one nature product with extreme seasonality. The Eastern Cape and Garden Route have no long-haul hub or global brand role. The screen chose on likeness to the Western Cape, not on growth, so a comparator can teach stability as well as speed.[72]

Score alone did not settle the set, which also had to be balanced and grounded in Africa. New Zealand, ranked seventh at 3.67, is remote, long-haul and entered through one gateway, as the Western Cape is, though its source markets and cruise trade differ. Kenya, ranked eleventh at 3.50, gives the set its African case: a gateway city leading to coast, wildlife and culture, with long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism. It is weaker on wine and agri-tourism and differs on price and governance, so it is read for access, dispersal and inclusion rather than product.[73]

The six cover the constraints the province faces. Chile and New Zealand show how a gateway wins long-haul seats and fills them; Singapore shows how hub traffic becomes visits, and Kenya how a gateway carries visitors beyond its best-known product. Melbourne shows how events spread demand across the year, and Valencia how quality is governed.

**Table 2.1.** The six comparators at a glance

**Each comparator shares a core trait with the Western Cape and shows one way through a challenge the province also faces.**

| Comparator | Shares with the Western Cape | Challenge it addressed | Lead lever | Reported outcome |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Chile | Long-haul city gateway to coast, wine and wilderness; Mediterranean seasons; dispersal beyond the capital | Long-haul access from distant markets | Gateway airport funded by concession; open skies; regions sold as one portfolio | Santiago traffic from about 16 million passengers (2010) to more than 26 million (2019); international seat capacity up about 40% to 50%, 2013 to 2019 |
| Melbourne and Victoria | Gateway city leading into wine, food, wildlife and touring regions; long-haul dependence | Spreading demand beyond the summer peak | Year-round event portfolio and a knowledge-led conference brand | Hotel stock up 21%; monthly share of arrivals between 7% and 12% |
| Valencia | Coastal city of culture and food; comparable climate, product mix and price point | Fragmented governance and uneven quality | Destination-wide quality system under a permanent public-private body | 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 24.4% above 2019; spend up 21% |
| Singapore | Integrated air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation | Turning transit into stays; moving up from low-value tourism | Stopover programme run by tourism board, airport and airline; hotel quality drive | 16.5 million visitors and record receipts of about S$29 billion in 2024 |
| Kenya | Gateway city linked to coast, wildlife and culture; long-haul reliance; community-based tourism | Gateway concentration and dispersal beyond safari | Conservation run as national economic infrastructure; Nairobi as regional hub | 14.6% growth in 2024; about US$1,460 per international arrival |
| Auckland and New Zealand | Remote long-haul gateway that concentrates arrivals; coast, wine, nature and culture close together | The economics of long-haul air access | Marketing budgets tied to long-haul routes; premium regional circuits | More than 16,000 incremental bookings and about NZ$55 million return in 2023/24 |

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12 (rationale), p15, p22, p30, p39, p46 and p51 (what each shares with the Western Cape), p15, p17, p18, p23 to p26, p30, p33, p34, p39 to p41, p46, p47, p54, p55 and p59 (challenges, levers and outcomes). Singapore: Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025. Kenya growth: Kenya Tourism data as reported, May 2025; revenue per international arrival: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p15. Rationales shortened from the printed text.

[72] Inception Report, p29, p31, p32; Benchmarking, p12; ranks 1 to 6 and their scores are not printed.
[73] Diagnostic, p62; Inception Report, p31; Benchmarking, p51, p12.

## Community and airport cases

Five community cases ask what keeps tourism income in townships and rural settlements. Each matches one of four types among the province's 107 long-listed communities. The types turn on two facts: whether a community lies within 45 minutes of a tourism node, and whether it holds an attraction. Vilakazi Street in Soweto and Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro speak to communities near a node whose assets are underused. Kliptown speaks to communities near a node with no attraction of their own. Comuna 13 in Medellín, remote by access rather than distance, speaks to remote communities with assets, and Costa Rica's rural network to remote communities without them.[74]

Cape Town's route record was set against eight peer airports: Calgary, Christchurch, Edinburgh, Keflavik, Larnaca, Marrakech, Santiago and Valencia. Five are not their country's main airport, and most serve seasonal or fast-growing inbound leisure markets. Santiago and Christchurch share Cape Town's remote geography, and Santiago targets tripling its passenger volumes in twenty years.[75]

## Route wins against peer airports

Between 2015 and 2025 Cape Town added 17 mainline international services, more than any of the eight peer airports. Santiago added 14 services, Valencia 12 and Calgary 8. Yet winning routes is not the same as holding seats through the winter, and the routes won now run full (section 2.3). Low-cost carriers tell a different story: Edinburgh added 121 routes from 2015 to 2025, and low-cost carriers fly 81% of its routes. At Cape Town, the MIDAS assessment sees low-cost entry as a longer-term opportunity. The Western Cape does not need to learn how to win mainline routes. It needs what the leaders added: access funded as infrastructure and marketing tied to each route.[76]

## Recovery and structural growth

Only Chile and Singapore grew far faster than the world in 2024: Chile by 40.4% and Singapore by 21%, against the world's 11%. Neither rate proves structural growth. Singapore was still at 86% of its 2019 arrivals, and most of Chile's arrivals came overland, 40% of them from Argentina. Kenya, Valencia and New Zealand grew only slightly faster than the world, and Melbourne's 4.3% is an Australia-wide forecast rather than an actual. The lessons that follow come from what the leaders built over a decade, not from one year's rate.[77]

**Table 2.2.** Comparator growth and recovery

**Against global growth of 11% in 2024, only Chile and Singapore grew far faster, and three of the six were still below 2019.**

| Destination | Growth 2023 to 2024 | Against 2019 | Primary lever | System type |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Chile** | 40.4% | 116% of 2019; 55.6% of arrivals overland, 40% from Argentina | Gateway-led air concentration | Connectivity-led |
| **Singapore** | 21% | 86% of 2019; receipts at a record | Aviation hub and stopover conversion | Orchestrated experience |
| **Kenya** | 14.6% | About 102% recovered | Conservation-led wildlife product | Product-led |
| **Valencia** | 13% to 14% | 124% recovered | Institutionalised quality governance | Governance-led |

[74] Inclusion Plan, p4, p14, p15.
[75] MIDAS, "International Comparisons", counted.
[76] MIDAS, "International Comparisons", "Executive Summary"; other study documents count new routes from 2014 on a different basis.
[77] Benchmarking, p9, p17, p53; Sernatur, Dec 2025; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025; the 12% shown for New Zealand matches its 2025 holiday-arrivals growth, with total arrivals up 5.9%.

| Destination | Growth 2023 to 2024 | Against 2019 | Primary lever | System type |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **New Zealand** | About 12% (matches 2025 holiday arrivals; total 5.9% in 2025) | 90% recovered, higher yield | Demand-led route development | Value-led |
| **Melbourne and Victoria** | 4.3% (Australia, forecast) | Near full recovery | Event-led demand | Events-led |

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9 (growth, recovery and levers), p53 (New Zealand arrivals), p17 (Australian forecast) and p61 (system type). Chile: Sernatur, Anuario de Turismo 2024 (Dec 2025). Singapore: Singapore Tourism Board (Feb 2025). Kenya growth: Kenya Tourism data as reported, May 2025.

The Western Cape should apply the same test to its own record: growth counts when deliberate change drives it, not when recovery returns lost visitors. The province has its own precedent above the 5% mark. International two-way passengers at Cape Town International rose from 1.71 million in 2015 to 3.1 million in 2024, about 6.8% a year. Most of the rise came before COVID: traffic grew about 11% a year from 2015 to 2019 and about 3.5% a year from 2019 to 2024, inside the norm. The faster years followed the forming of the Cape Town Air Access partnership in 2015. It counts 33 route launches since, and 16 more destinations were served in 2025 than in 2015, close to the 17 mainline routes in the peer comparison above. Outside a recovery, 2015 to 2019 is the province's own case of growth above the norm.[78]

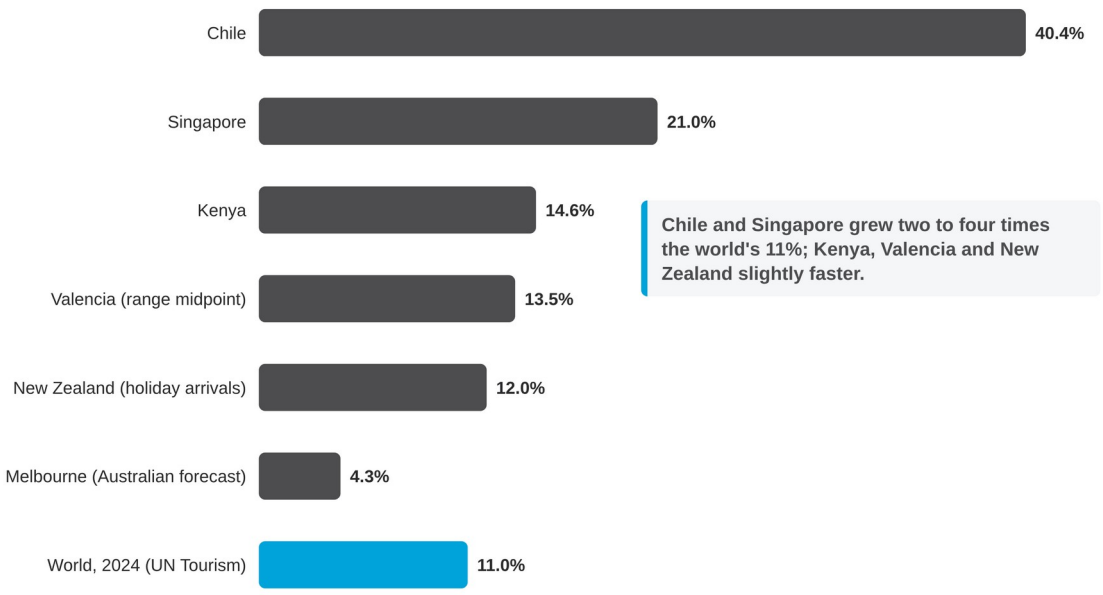



**Figure 2.1.** Comparator growth, 2023 to 2024

## The six comparators

### Chile: access first

Chile was chosen as a long-haul city gateway to coast, wine and wilderness, with Mediterranean seasons like the Western Cape's. South America supplies 55% to 60% of its arrivals. Yet long-haul access was its binding constraint, and Chile treated it as infrastructure. Santiago's airport traffic rose from about 16 million passengers in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019. A private concession won in 2015 funded about US$900 million of expansion, under one of the world's most liberal aviation systems built on open-skies

[78] Benchmarking, p8; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 4, computed; these are calendar-year international terminal passengers, a different basis from the 2.90m of FY24/25 in section 1.1; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 1, slide 2, slide 5.

agreements. Direct routes now link Santiago with Europe and Australia, and a domestic network carries visitors on to Patagonia and the wine valleys. The lesson is blunt: tourism demand follows air access.[79]

### New Zealand: marketing tied to routes

New Zealand holds coast, wine, nature and culture within short travel distances, as the Western Cape does. Air access economics bind its growth. It moved from awareness-driven marketing to demand generation that answers for specific routes, tying budgets to long-haul corridors and designing campaigns around airline breakeven and shoulder-season loads. The programme reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24. Government-backed early-stage route incentives and data shared between tourism bodies and airlines support it. In the regions it curates premium multi-day circuits and limits capacity to protect price.[80]

### Singapore: from hub to destination

Singapore was chosen for joining air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation in one approach. Its question was how to turn transit through Changi into stays. Its answer is a stopover programme that the tourism board, Changi Airport Group and Singapore Airlines run under one coordinated strategy. It received 16.5 million international visitors in 2024 and record tourism receipts of about S$29 billion. A hotel transformation map and fund lifted quality alongside, moving Singapore from lower-value stopovers toward longer stays and higher spend.[81]

### Kenya: governed wildlife tourism

Kenya is the African case, chosen for its long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism. African markets supply 41% of its arrivals, while long-haul visitors spend more per head. Kenya made conservation part of its national economic infrastructure, joining wildlife protection, tourism and community participation in one governed system. It positioned Nairobi as East Africa's aviation, diplomatic and business hub, and its main airport now carries 68% of arrivals. Despite meaningful reforms, fragmented investment and regulatory hurdles remain ongoing challenges. Kenya earned about US$1,460 per international arrival in 2024, against about US$890 for the Western Cape.[82]

### Melbourne and Victoria: year-round events

Melbourne plays the part for Victoria that Cape Town plays for the province: main point of entry, brand anchor and engine of demand. Summer still brings the largest spike in international demand, so Victoria curates a portfolio of events that bring repeat, predictable demand peaks across the year. Behind the calendar, hotel stock grew 21%, about 5,000 rooms. Melbourne uses its event calendar to lower the risk of new air services and to stimulate aviation demand. Its quietest months still hold 7% of arrivals and its busiest 12%, against 6.1% and 12.7% for the Western Cape on the provisional 2025 shares. The gap is modest, so the lesson is less a flatter curve than an events calendar airlines can plan seats around. Its case rests on stability and yield rather than speed.[83]

### Valencia: destination-wide quality

Valencia, a coastal city of culture and food, matches the province on climate, product mix and price. It faced a familiar problem: fragmented governance and uneven quality across regions, operators and seasons. It adopted a destination-wide quality system across its tourism businesses. Coordination sits in a permanent public-private structure led by Visit València, which joins municipal, provincial and regional authorities in one decision-making system. It received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 13.9% more than in 2023 and 24.4% above 2019. Spend rose faster still, by 21%.[84]

[79] Benchmarking, p12, p22, p24, p59, p25, p23, p26; the source prints about 90% to 95% of 5.2 million international arrivals through Santiago, which can hold only for air arrivals, since land borders carried 55.6% in 2024.
[80] Benchmarking, p51, p54, p55.
[81] Benchmarking, p12, p40, p41; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[82] Benchmarking, p12, p32, p33, p34, p31; Demand-Side Analysis, p15.
[83] Benchmarking, p15, p17, p18, p59; Demand-Side Analysis, p12.
[84] Benchmarking, p12, p46, p47.

## Air access as infrastructure

The Western Cape faces both halves of the access problem Chile and New Zealand attacked: too few seats at the peak and thin demand off it. On the growth model, the base case passes a line of 1.8 million inbound seats by 2030. That line is the model's assumption; in practice the runway binds at peak hours (section 2.3). Off-peak, June carries only 6.4% of the year's international capacity.[85]

The two cases point to three changes. Air access should be treated as core economic infrastructure, not a tourism add-on, and backed by a permanent, well-funded public-private air access fund. The province should lobby for air service liberalisation and simpler visa regimes. Marketing budgets should be ring-fenced around priority long-haul corridors, with an aviation partnership framework and early-stage route support.[86]

## Turning transit and events into demand

Singapore shows how a hub becomes a destination: its tourism board, airport and airline run one stopover programme under a coordinated strategy. Cape Town's seven largest international routes all connect to global hubs, so the same partnership with the hub carriers is open to it. Government, aviation, events and industry should work to shared KPIs, linking air access, major events and joint marketing. City, provincial and national actors should align around one gateway strategy, with MICE treated as a system lever.[87]

Events do the same work across the calendar, and the Western Cape has the green-season gap they address (section 2.2). The province needs one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province, with conference bidding aligned to sector strengths.[88]

## Governing quality and value

The leaders manage quality as a deliberate outcome. Valencia and Singapore set standards through standing bodies rather than leaving them to operators. The results reported for Singapore include longer stays and higher spend per visitor; those for Valencia include more consistent service, a stronger reputation and more repeat visits.[89]

The cases ask the Western Cape first for a province-wide quality and standards framework led by Wesgro. Within it would sit a provincial quality charter phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms, alongside standing sector councils for wine, MICE, adventure and culture. The cases also ask the province to measure its regions by yield rather than arrivals and to build conservation and community inclusion into the offer.[90]

## Lasting sellers in communities

In communities the binding constraint is the seller. The five cases show that local sellers outlast the programmes that launch them. In Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and outside jeep firms had left. The guides kept selling after the launch programme ended, while assets and training without a route to market did not last. Access and safety were preconditions, not product.[91]

Scale brings its own limits. Medellín's Comuna 13 drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025, 52% of them international, with about 300 professional guides. Mobility built for residents became the stage, but

[85] Market Assessment, p20; MIDAS, "Seasonality".
[86] Benchmarking, p28, p56.
[87] Benchmarking, p40, p42, p35; MIDAS, "Executive Summary", "The Capetown Market".
[88] Benchmarking, p20.
[89] Benchmarking, p41, p47.
[90] Benchmarking, p42, p49, p35, p55, p56.
[91] Inclusion Plan, p7 to p11, p7, p30.

carrying-capacity limits came late. On Vilakazi Street in Soweto, ten restaurants employ more than 800 people. Public space upgrades amplify existing assets, but benefits concentrate on street-front owners.[92]

Neither capital nor donor money lasts without a seller that can stand alone. Costa Rica's community network turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 and dissolved at the end of 2018; it did not survive donor exit, though the record names no single cause. Kliptown in Soweto received a first allocation of R436 million and was projected to draw almost 200,000 international visitors a year. By 2017 its museum drew about 4,000 visitors a year, because capital built before an operator yields no operating income.[93]

The cases converge on one order: a seller with a stake, a safe and workable visit, product that keeps spend in the community and only then exposure. In the Western Cape's communities, the seller therefore comes before the asset (section 2.4). In Doringbaai and Elands Bay, a local entity comes before more product, with its own selling channel and a succession plan that does not rest on a donor. Assets follow proven demand.[94]

## The system over single levers

No single lever explains the leaders' growth. The benchmarking work finds that sustained growth comes from a coordinated destination system in which governance, demand generation and access reinforce one another, not from fragmented interventions. Chile's coordination works best when anchored on a single strategic constraint. The Western Cape's constraint has the same shape as Chile's long-haul access: seats into one gateway airport (section 2.3).[95]

Yet coordination is hard everywhere. Victoria reports tension between national and state bodies over roles and branding. Valencia struggles to join its data across institutions. The Western Cape's three tiers of government show the same strain (section 2.4). The province should anchor its plan on one constraint, as Chile did: peak seats into Cape Town first, one system built around them and, in the communities, a seller before any asset.[96]

## Limits of the comparison

The cases show what worked elsewhere; they cannot prove it will work here. Singapore's tourism board answers to one ministry, in a system strongly directed by the state yet closely tied to the private sector. The Western Cape works across three tiers, and air rights and visas sit with national government (section 2.4). New Zealand's governance differs too, and transfer means adapting governance, data and capability to local realities.[97]

The evidence also has gaps. No score by criterion is printed, and among the six only New Zealand (3.67) and Kenya (3.50) have a printed score. The margins behind the choice cannot be checked. No case of failure was studied. The nearest local record is the City's own. Its Tourism Development Framework reports uneven past progress and links it to restructuring, thin resources, little support from other departments and weak monitoring. That is a plan, not a destination, so the gap remains. [Open item: add one comparator that underperformed, as the study plan asked.] Several comparator charts are unlabelled, so only printed figures are quoted here, and Valencia's figures name no primary source. The recommended air access fund carries no amount. None of the cases holds Western Cape data, so the province's side of each comparison comes from sections 2.2 to 2.4. The six cases point the same way; the precise rates are indicative.[98]

[92] Inclusion Plan, p8, p9.
[93] Inclusion Plan, p10, p11.
[94] Inclusion Plan, p12, p10, p31.
[95] Benchmarking, p58, p59.
[96] Benchmarking, p16, p45.
[97] Benchmarking, p38, p51.
[98] Inception Report, p31, p16; Benchmarking, p12, p24, p39, p46, p53, p28; the plan asked for four success cases and two that underperformed; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p3.

**What this means for the objectives**

**Objective 2, Create green-season demand with MICE and events.** Melbourne's events-led system and unified calendar.

**Objective 4, Convert India and China hub traffic, and objective 6, Build a regional foundation (Africa).** Singapore's joint strategy with its airport and airline; Kenya's hub strategy and African base.

**Objective 5, Increase yield in mature markets; objective 12, Balance impact on nature-based attractions; objective 14, Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk.** Yield-based metrics, capacity discipline and conservation-led product.

**Objective 7, Win direct routes and add seats on full routes, and objective 15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies.** Chile's airport concession and air access fund; New Zealand's route-tied marketing. Cape Town's own international traffic grew about 6.8% a year from 2015 to 2024, most of it before COVID.

**Objective 10, Support diversified route and product development.** Chile's regional portfolio; New Zealand's premium circuits.

**Objective 11, Align visitor experience in-destination, and objective 3, Make the whole province findable and bookable.** Valencia's governed quality and certification visible on booking platforms.

**Objective 13, Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion.** Resident sellers outlasted the programmes that launched them, and capital built before an operator, as in Kliptown, earned no operating income.

**Objective 16, Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers; objective 17, Strengthen industry and government collaboration; objective 18, Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing.** One coordinated system of governance, marketing and access, with shared data between tourism bodies and airlines.

**Objective 19, Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits.** Chile's open skies; safety before product in the community cases.

**Objective 20, Develop workforce and service skills.** Singapore's hotel quality drive; the province's own labour analysis is still to be commissioned.

## 2.2 Demand-side factors

Interest in the Western Cape is broad and growing. Yet demand is concentrated in five markets and six months. The growth markets fly in through Gulf and African hubs and book on platforms where Western Cape product is hard to find.

A 2025 values-based survey reached more than 25,000 travellers in 34 outbound markets, 17 of them Wesgro priority markets, with 800 to 1,600 in each. More than 20 discussions with market-facing stakeholders added judgement to desk review of Wesgro reports, Statistics South Africa and Google search data.[99]

### Concentration in five markets

The UK, Germany, the USA, the Netherlands and France supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the first three alone 52%. The pattern is not new: the top five held 61% of Cape Town overseas air arrivals from January to August 2024. Within the five, the USA is gaining. On the Provincial Treasury's count of all international arrivals at Cape Town International, Africa included, its share rose 3.8 points on 2019, to

[99] Market Assessment, p40; Demand-Side Analysis, p7.

15.0% in 2024. The UK's and Germany's shares slipped by under a point and France's fell 1.6 points. That count is wider than the overseas shares above.[100]

The same markets pay among the most. Average spend per visitor in 2024 ran from R32,900 for the USA and R26,500 for the UK down to R8,600 for Namibia and R8,500 for Zimbabwe. Only Nigerians and Ghanaians spend as much, from a far smaller base (below). High-spend visitors come from Europe and North America, which ties future value growth to slower-growing source markets. The Provincial Treasury's 2024 regional averages are lower and rank the markets differently. Middle East visitors spend most, at R23,900, then Europeans at R19,900, while North Americans spend R16,100 against R17,000 for all international tourists. [Open item: SA Tourism to confirm the basis of the per-market spend figures, which sit well above the Provincial Treasury's regional averages.] On both counts Europe spends more than most, so the Western Cape must hold yield in its mature markets, Europe first, while volume growth comes from elsewhere.[101]

## Seasonal concentration

Demand peaks in the southern summer and thins in winter. December, January and November took 12.7%, 11.5% and 11.3% of overseas visitors in 2025, while June fell to 6.1%. October to March hold about 62% of the year. The 2024 Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey gives a similar split of 61% and 39%.[102]

Growth therefore depends on better conversion from April to September, not on pushing more demand into the busy peak months. Airlines cut seats in those same months, so filling the April to September green season needs seats as well as conversion (section 2.3).[103]

The quieter months have grown faster than the peak over the decade, but not lately. April to September carried 38.7% of the year's international and regional passenger movements in 2015, 41.4% in 2019 and 41.6% in 2023. The share then eased to 41.1% in 2024 and 40.8% in 2025. Since 2019 the green months have grown 24.4% and the other six months 27.8%. Volume is rising; the balance is not.

**Table 2.3.** April to September passenger movements at Cape Town International, 2015 to 2025

**Quieter-month traffic has doubled since 2015, and its share of the year rose to 41.6% in 2023 before easing.**

| Year | Annual movements | April to September | April to September share | May to August share |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **2015** | 1,713,047 | 662,771 | 38.7% | 24.2% |
| **2019** | 2,606,398 | 1,079,553 | 41.4% | 26.3% |
| **2023** | 2,807,431 | 1,167,206 | 41.6% | 26.7% |
| **2024** | 3,079,944 | 1,265,428 | 41.1% | 26.4% |
| **2025** | 3,293,615 | 1,342,770 | 40.8% | 25.8% |

Source: Study-team calculations from ACSA's Cape Town International passenger traffic release, September 2026. International and regional passengers, arrivals plus departures, by calendar year. Movements are not unique tourists, seats, nights or spend. The years 2020 to 2022 are omitted as restriction and recovery years.

Rooms tell a more cautious story than the terminal. Cape Town sample occupancy averaged 51.8% from May to August 2025, above 2024 at 50.5% and below 2023 at 58.1% and 2019 at 54.5%. June 2025 stood at 45.1%. A passenger movement is not a visitor night, and more room stock, shorter stays or residents travelling out could each explain the gap. An analyst estimate points the same way for the regions. May to September room-night demand grew 22% in the Cape Winelands and 31% on the Garden Route from 2015 to 2025, against 17% for the year in each. Its panel is not published.

[100] Demand-Side Analysis, p13; the slide prints 61% in its text, and 63% is the sum of its printed shares; Diagnostic, p29; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68 to p69.
[101] Demand-Side Analysis, p14; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p67.
[102] Demand-Side Analysis, p12, computed; the twelve printed monthly shares sum to 104.9% and are normalised here; Diagnostic, p32.
[103] Market Assessment, p25.

The green season is also not one season. May to August is the core winter, and April and September are shoulders with different products and buyers. Nor is it the low season everywhere: whale season on the Overberg coast peaks from September to November.

## Converting latent interest

Global demand is not the constraint. Over 2022 to 2024 the province received 3.6 million international arrivals in total, about 1.2 million a year. That is about 0.1% of global tourist arrivals over the period and 0.05% of global tourist spend.[104]

**Table 2.4.** Market capture, 2022 to 2024

**The province takes under 0.3% of air outbound trips in every core market, and fewer than three in ten Indian or Chinese visitors to South Africa reach it.**

| Market | Air outbound trips (three-year total) | Western Cape arrivals (three-year total) | Western Cape share of air trips | South Africa share of air trips | Western Cape share of South Africa's arrivals |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **United Kingdom** | 206m | 553,032 | 0.27% | 0.48% | 56% |
| **USA** | 219.5m | 414,863 | 0.19% | 0.45% | 42% |
| **Germany** | 219.7m | 393,319 | 0.18% | 0.31% | 58% |
| **France** | 101m | 177,979 | 0.18% | 0.32% | 55% |
| **India** | 64m | 57,975 | 0.09% | 0.33% | 27% |
| **China with Hong Kong** | 99m | 26,662 | 0.03% | 0.09% | 29% |

Source: Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p4 (air outbound trips, arrivals and shares). All counts are three-year totals for 1 January 2022 to 31 December 2024; the source attributes global trips to Euromonitor International and arrivals to SA Tourism. Last column computed: Western Cape arrivals as a share of South Africa's arrivals from the same market.

Most Indian and Chinese visitors to South Africa never reach the province. About 27% of South Africa's Indian arrivals and 29% of its Chinese arrivals came to the Western Cape over the three years, against 52% to 58% for the UK, Germany, France and the Netherlands. Those visitors are already in the country, so they are a market to win alongside new routes. Among US travellers' destinations South Africa placed second in Africa but 52nd to 57th worldwide over 2022 to 2024, so there it competes as an African choice more than a global one.[105]

## Regional recognition

Cape Town's reputation is established; the province's is not measured. Brand Finance's 2023 City Index ranks Cape Town first in Africa and 60th in the world, from about 15,000 respondents in 20 countries. That establishes a city reputation, not equivalent recognition of the province. No current, comparable measure of awareness exists for Cape Town, the Western Cape and its regions across the priority markets.

Itineraries follow what travellers recognise. DEDAT's 2026/27 Annual Performance Plan finds international flows concentrated on the Cape Peninsula, congestion at the Big Six attractions and regional destinations often left out of itineraries. A traveller who knows Cape Town but cannot place the Overberg, the West Coast or the Karoo is less likely to include them. Yet branding is one cause among several: awareness cannot secure regional nights where transport, rooms or bookable product are missing.

There is material to build on. The City's This Is Cape Town campaign runs in 55 cities on six continents. Wesgro's With Love from the Locals campaign, launched in March 2024, carries regional voices, and its domestic campaign reached 16.7 million people in 2024/25. In September 2026 Cape Town Tourism and Visit Stellenbosch agreed to share itineraries, content and trade activity, which sells two destinations in

[104] Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p2, computed.
[105] Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p3, p4, computed, p5 to p6.

one trip. Wesgro's April 2026 memorandum with Emirates names growth markets but sets no targets for regional nights. Recognition beyond Cape Town, and nights there, is the missing link between demand and dispersal.

## Growth scenarios to 2035

The scenarios differ by intervention, not by demand: what separates them is how far structural barriers are removed. The growth model builds each market's rate from four levers: outbound growth, the Western Cape's penetration, the airlift ceiling and structural conditions such as currency and visas. It anchors on OAG aviation data for access and traveller data for demand.[106]

From the 2025 base, the base case reaches 2,175,778 arrivals by 2035, implied growth of 3.8% a year. The conservative case reaches 1,822,634, at 2.0%, and the accelerated case 2,516,282, at 5.3%. The base case's 3.8% sits within the 3% to 5% norm, and only the accelerated case clears the 5% mark of structural acceleration (section 2.1).[107]

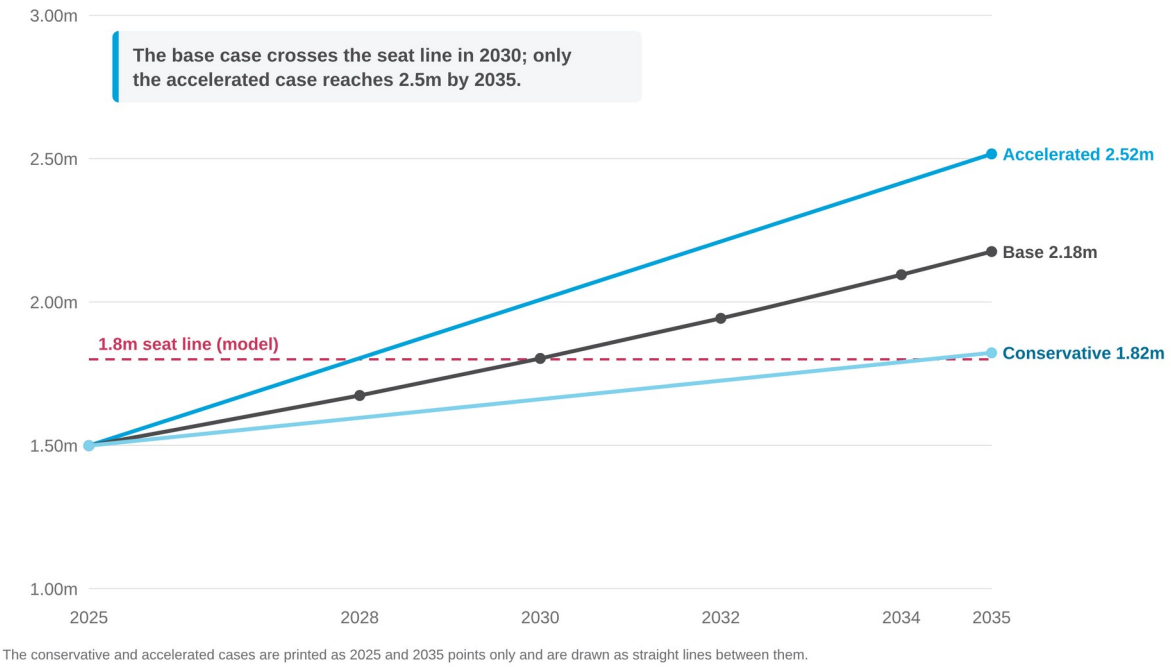



**Figure 2.2.** Growth scenarios to 2035

The step from 2,175,778 to 2,516,282 rests on confirmed direct routes to India and China, above-baseline activation and more hub capacity into Cape Town. The dependency is hard: without confirmed routes, volume reverts to base. Those routes are not close. A direct Indian service is unlikely before 2030, and China is a longer prize still. Until they come, the hub carriers carry the growth markets. Even the base case passes the model's seat line at the 2030 year point (section 2.3).[108]

[106] Demand-Side Analysis, p19, p18, p8; the traveller data are Skift's.
[107] Market Assessment, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, p20; the second source prints the same 2035 points from a 2024 base.
[108] Market Assessment, p18, p19; rounded, the two points are 2.18m and 2.52m; Demand-Side Analysis, p48; MIDAS, "The Chinese Market Opportunity".

## Growth by market group

In the base case the hub markets add the most arrivals and the acceleration markets grow fastest. The hub markets are the UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar and Turkey. The acceleration markets are the Gulf, China, India and Brazil ([Open item: Skift to confirm which Gulf markets the acceleration group holds, since the UAE and Qatar sit in the hub group.]). Between 2025 and 2035 hub markets add 206,584 arrivals, mature markets 178,780, acceleration markets 175,818, regional markets 110,298 and Japan and South Korea 5,469.[109]

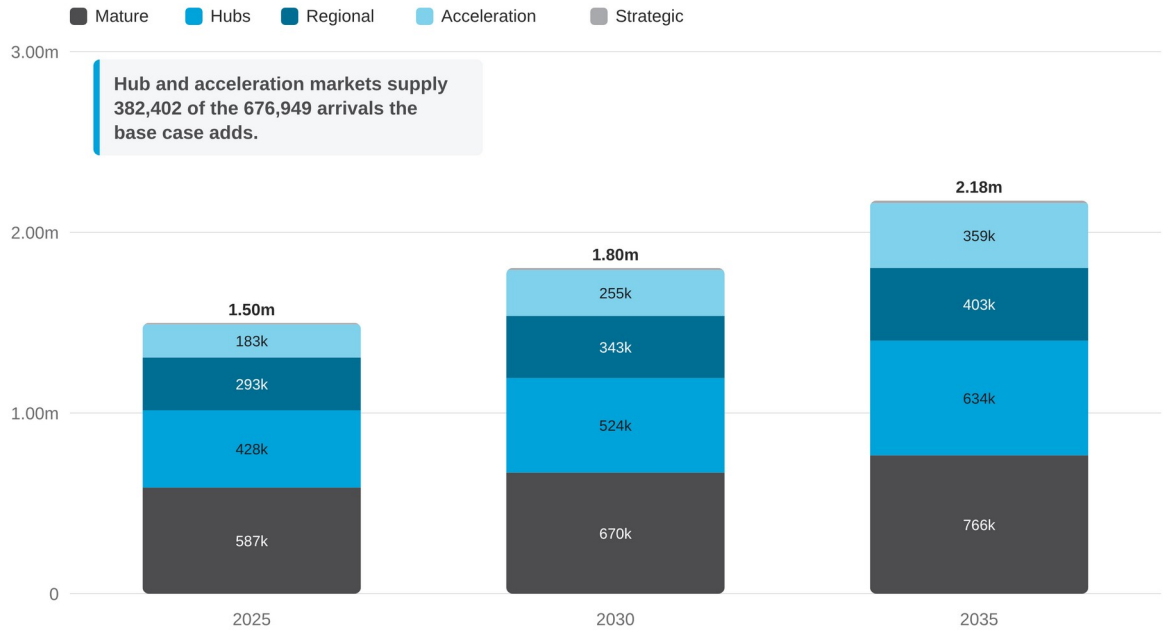



**Figure 2.3.** Base-case growth by market group

Note: Group membership: Mature (UK, Germany, USA, Netherlands, France, Switzerland); Hubs (UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar, Turkey); Regional (Namibia, Zimbabwe, Zambia, Botswana, Kenya and others); Acceleration (Gulf, China, India, Brazil); Strategic (Japan, South Korea).

India more than doubles from 76,547 to 165,260 arrivals and China with Hong Kong from 43,412 to 92,598, both at 8% a year. Spend follows the mix. The model fixes average spend for each group, from R24,500 a visitor in mature markets to R8,500 in regional ones. On that basis base-case foreign spend rises from a modelled R27.12bn in 2024 to R40.59bn in 2035. Volume and value come from different markets.[110]

Recent arrivals run the other way. Stats SA counted 75,541 Indian and 41,651 Chinese tourists to South Africa in 2024, then 69,680 and 37,902 in 2025. From January to September 2026 the totals were 37,875 from India, down 30.0%, and 22,848 from China, down 23.7%. These are national arrivals by residence, computed from the monthly releases, not provincial counts. Industry views attribute the fall to air access, price and trade confidence as well as entry rules. The model's 8% a year stands as the base path, and the decline is carried as context and risk. [Open item: Skift to test the 2027 starting point for India and China against the 2026 decline.]

[109] Market Assessment, p20, computed.
[110] Market Assessment, p22, p10, p24; the modelled 2024 figure sits 19% above the R22.7bn SA Tourism reported for FY2024, and section 5.3 records the open item to rebase on the FY2025 actual.

## Traveller segments

Four values-based segments fit the Western Cape, together about 97 million addressable travellers. Each has priority markets: Curious Explorers in the UK and the USA, and Creative Connectors in India. Discerning Connoisseurs are paired with China and the UAE, and Reflective Adventurers with Germany.[111]

**Table 2.5.** Four traveller segments

**Four segments hold about 97 million addressable travellers, and each is most concentrated in a named set of markets.**

| Segment | Addressable travellers | What drives them | Priority markets | Long-haul trip spend |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Curious Explorers** | 30m (31%) | Cultural immersion, learning and authentic connection | UK, USA | $4,800 to $6,200 |
| **Creative Connectors** | 25m (26%) | Design, food and urban creativity | India | $4,200 to $5,400 |
| **Discerning Connoisseurs** | 19m (20%) | Exclusivity, refinement and access | China, UAE | $8,500 to $14,000 |
| **Reflective Adventurers** | 23m (23%) | Renewal and connection with nature | Germany | $4,600 to $5,900 |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p42, p43, p45, p48, p51, p54. Priority pairs are the cells highlighted on p43. Trip spend is average long-haul trip spend as printed; the currency is not named on the slides.

Curious Explorers and Discerning Connoisseurs align best with the Western Cape's offering. The segments also matter for spread, not only for volume. Curious Explorers offer the strongest opportunity to spread visitors beyond Cape Town, and Reflective Adventurers can ease seasonality through year-round outdoor and wellness travel. These two are the segments to target for the regions and the green season.[112]

## India and China through hubs

The growth markets are already in the air, on other carriers. About 71,000 travellers from India and about 30,000 from China reach Cape Town each year through connecting hubs, together about 101,000 journeys. That count is of journeys by origin. SA Tourism counts about 28,000 Indian and Chinese tourist arrivals a year in the province, so the two series measure different things (Appendix A2). Addis Ababa and Dubai carry 81% of the Indian travellers, and half of them start in Mumbai. Direct Indian service is unlikely before 2030, because of aircraft constraints at Air India and IndiGo. For China, a China Southern service from Guangzhou is the likeliest first direct route.[113]

Demand from both markets weakened in 2026. National arrivals from India fell 30.0% and from China 23.7% in the first nine months, although both had pilot access to the Electronic Travel Authorisation before its launch in August 2026 (section 2.4). No direct Indian service is committed: carriers have stated interest only, and bilateral air rights sit with national government.

Australia (61,000 indirect travellers) and Saudi Arabia (137,000 passengers, with Riyadh Air's planned hub) come next. The Western Cape should grow this hub traffic now. Singapore shows the method: its tourism board, airport and airline work to one strategy (section 2.1). Here the partners are the hub carriers: Emirates, Ethiopian, Qatar Airways and Turkish Airlines. Wesgro should build early relationships with the Indian carriers and Indian government authorities. It should treat China as a long-term investment in awareness and indirect volume before any non-stop service.[114]

[111] Market Assessment, p41 to p43, p43.
[112] Market Assessment, p4, p56.
[113] Demand-Side Analysis, p46, p48, computed; Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p4, computed; MIDAS, "The Indian Market Opportunity", "Executive Summary", "The Chinese Market Opportunity"; the second source puts the two hubs at more than 80%; the aviation assessment counts about 29,600 travellers from China.
[114] MIDAS, "The Australian Market Opportunity", "The Saudi Arabian Market Opportunity", "The Indian Market Opportunity", "The Chinese Market Opportunity".

## Booking platforms by market

Conversion happens on platforms that differ by market. Chinese travellers discover on Douyin and Xiaohongshu and book on Trip.com, Qunar and Fliggy. Indian travellers book through MakeMyTrip, Booking.com and Expedia, and much Gulf travel still runs through private advisors and concierge agencies.[115]

Each market also has its own gap. Cape Town has no direct flight to Mumbai or Delhi and thin Indian-friendly adaptation, while Gulf travellers find no Arabic-language booking or local-currency pricing. Visas add a further barrier, and they sit with national government (section 2.4).[116]

The province's own channels also lag. The Department of Economic Development rates destination platforms behind international practice in online presence and AI adoption. The Overberg says its proximity to Cape Town is not packaged before travellers book flights. The money should therefore follow the platforms: activate inside them and shift investment toward trade-led conversion, away from broad awareness campaigns.[117]

## Regional Africa

Closer to home, Africa already supplies a large and steady base. The province recorded 323,971 tourist arrivals from 16 reported African markets in 2024, 62% of them from Zimbabwe and Namibia. African visitors spent R4.2bn in the province in 2025, and among them Nigerians and Ghanaians spent most per visit, at R31,000 and R27,700. Namibia and Zimbabwe add stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume.[118]

Nigeria, Kenya and Ghana are the priority growth markets, though the sources rank Ghana differently. Nigeria's addressable market is modelled at 310,000 to 510,000 adult trips a year and Kenya's at 240,000 to 400,000. Africa is therefore both a regional foundation to keep and a source of high-spending visitors to grow.[119]

## Business events and the trough

Business events run on a different calendar from leisure travel. International association meetings in Cape Town rose from 33 in 2022 to 58 in 2024. Of the 136 held over the three years, 109 fell between May and November, but 74 fell in September to November alone. Most meetings therefore land at the edge of the trough, not in it. Cape Town ranked 35th in the 2024 ICCA ranking and hosted 37 of South Africa's 64 UIA-recorded meetings in 2025. Hotel occupancy in Cape Town was 53% in June 2023, the gap such events could fill.[120]

Bids won are not winter nights delivered. Wesgro secured 36 bids in 2024/25 with an estimated value of R745.1 million. The CTICC hosted 330 events in the year to June 2025, 63 of them international, and its forward book lists congresses in May and June 2027. Cape Town Tourism reports that hotel occupancy averaged 61.7% in 2025 and reached 81.5% in February. From May to August it averaged 51.8%, and June stood at 45.1%.

Yet MICE is not one business. Corporate meetings, association congresses, incentives, exhibitions and leisure events have different buyers, rotation cycles and contracts. Only conferences are measured well, and meetings are absent from consolidated provincial statistics. Stellenbosch and George are credible secondary hubs that can take delegates' extra nights while major events stay in Cape Town. The lever

[115] Demand-Side Analysis, p45, p47, p49; Market Assessment, p34, p35.
[116] Demand-Side Analysis, p51.
[117] Stakeholder Insights, p24, p26; Demand-Side Analysis, p55.
[118] Demand-Side Analysis, p27, p29, p14.
[119] Demand-Side Analysis, p30, p28; African Markets memo, Mar 2026, section 2; the memo places Ghana among fourth-tier watch markets for brand seeding rather than conversion.
[120] Demand-Side Analysis, p37, computed, p36, p38, p34.

needs one events calendar, as Melbourne has (section 2.1), bids aimed at May to August and measures for each type of buyer.[121]

Public money for events is small and tied to other purposes. DEDAT's R7 million Tourism Growth Fund for 2026/27 supports attraction and business development, not event hosting. Cultural Affairs and Sport earmarks R4.2 million for hallmark and incubator sport events. No South African Formula 1 race appears on the rights-holder's 2027 calendar, published in September 2026, and the full rights fees and public guarantees a race would need were not verified.

Goal 1 must fill the green season, win growth markets on the routes and platforms they already use, hold yield in mature markets and build the African base. Seats, regional product and the enabling environment (sections 2.3 and 2.4) decide whether that demand lands.

**What this means for the objectives**

Objective 1, Respond to growth segment traveller preferences. Four segments, each with named priority markets. No comparable measure of awareness exists for the province and its regions.

**Objective 2, Create green-season demand with MICE and events.** Most international association meetings fall from May to November, but 74 of 136 fell in September to November. Bids must aim at the May to August trough. The seat side of the case sits in section 2.3.

**Objective 3, Make the whole province findable and bookable.** Conversion runs through market-specific platforms that Western Cape product must reach.

Objective 4, Convert India and China hub traffic. About 101,000 hub journeys a year and a direct Indian route unlikely before 2030. On SA Tourism's count, fewer than three in ten Indian or Chinese visitors to South Africa reach the province. National arrivals from both markets fell in the first nine months of 2026.

**Objective 5, Increase yield in mature markets.** On the per-country figures the highest-spending visitors come from the slowest-growing markets. The province takes under 0.3% of their air trips, and the USA gains share while the UK, Germany and France lose it.

**Objective 6, Build a regional foundation (Africa).** A large regional base and two high-yield growth markets.

## 2.3 Supply-side factors

Supply sets the ceiling on growth. The gateway's busiest direct routes run full, the new runway is years away and airlines are expected to raise fares before they add seats. Beyond the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

Stakeholders rate supply constraints the most severe: 44 of the 68 insights on supply are rated High, against 23 of 64 on demand. Two bodies of evidence test that view. Scheduled seats and estimated bookings cover every Cape Town route, with bookings from the airlines' global distribution systems to November 2025. On the ground, 50,332 tourism assets are mapped across six regions in three layers: attractions, services and enabling infrastructure. The map draws on Wesgro's supply database, SANParks and CapeNature data and open geographic sources. Its premise is that the weakest layer constrains how a destination performs. [Dataset limits, including the absence of geography below district level, to be confirmed against the supply dataset notes.] Each region is scored from 1 to 5 on attractiveness (40%), readiness and capacity (30%) and accessibility (30%).[122]

[121] Demand-Side Analysis, p35, p36, p41.
[122] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, counted; insights filed under Transform Supply and Reshape Demand; MIDAS, "The South African Market", "Seasonality"; bookings are weighted to the full market, so they "will not always reconcile exactly with airport published data"; Infrastructure Report, p2, p4, p9, p10, p17, p18; the scores "are evidence informed, not purely formula derived" and missing data is not

## The 2030 seat line

On the growth model, seats run out before demand does. The model draws current air access as a hard ceiling at 1.8 million inbound seats. The base case passes that line by 2030, at 1,802,929 arrivals, up from 1,673,855 in 2028. The line is the model's assumption, not a measured cap; what binds in practice is the runway at peak hours (section 1.2). On the model's own judgement, even 2.1 million arrivals by 2035, below the base case (section 2.2), needs deliberate intervention to add capacity. Growth to 2.5 million is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing one.[123]

## Full routes

Cape Town has won more routes than its peers (section 2.1), and they now run full. Twenty-nine international routes serve the airport in 2026, and Cape Town's share of South Africa's international capacity rose from 10% in 2010 to 25%. In the year to November 2025, 11 of the 27 routes with load data ran above 80%. Newark led at 88.6%, ahead of Atlanta at 84.3% and Frankfurt and London Heathrow at 83.0%. Sixteen ran at 75% or more.[124]

**Eleven of 27 routes ran above 80% load in the year to November 2025, and sixteen at 75% or more.**

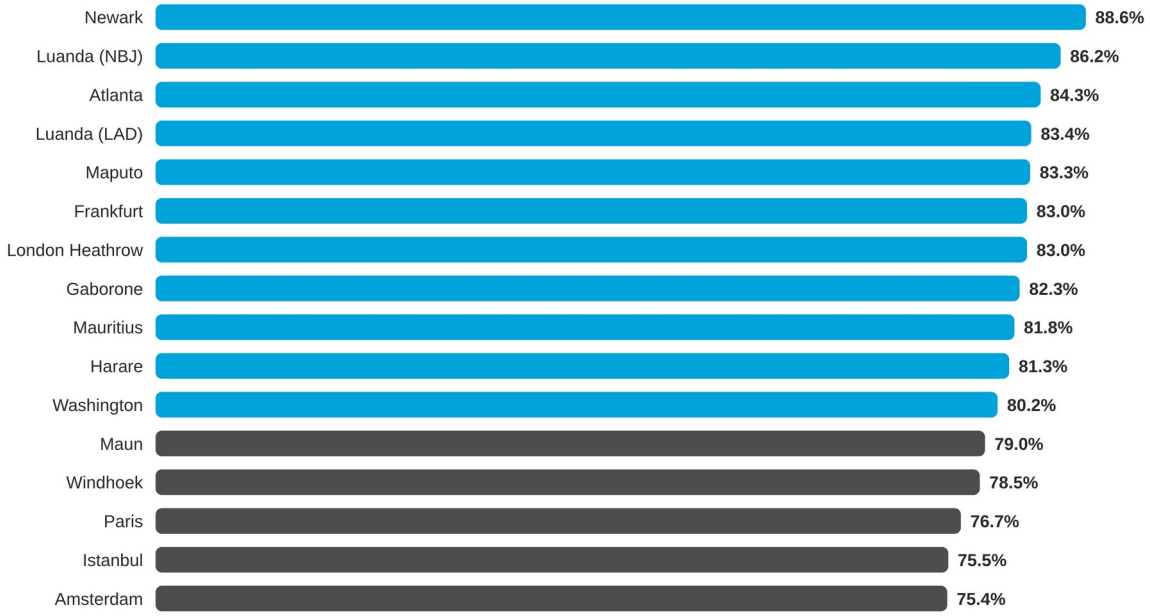



**Figure 2.4.** Route load factors to November 2025

Across all its routes, domestic included, Cape Town's 79% load factor is the joint highest of South Africa's five largest airports, with Lanseria. South Africa averages about 70% and Africa 75%, and Cape Town's international routes alone average 76%. Regional routes also run full, and all five markets are named for more capacity. Luanda ran at 86.2% and 83.4% on its two airports, Maputo 83.3%, Gaborone 82.3%, Mauritius 81.8% and Harare 81.3%. Domestically, Cape Town to Durban runs at 90.0% and warrants more seats, while other domestic routes sit between 70% and 80%.[125]

scored as poor performance.
[123] Market Assessment, p20; only six year points are printed, so the crossing falls between 2028 and 2030.
[124] MIDAS, "Executive Summary", "The Capetown Market", "Seasonality", computed; the printed network total is 76.0% on 3,816,797 seats, while the 27 listed rows sum to 75.0%.
[125] MIDAS, "The South African Market", "Seasonality"; the source puts the global average at 84%.

Cape Town has reached the point of asking what comes next. Near-term seats must come from more frequencies and larger aircraft on routes already full. Beyond that, the province needs a route strategy that looks for long-term gains over short-term wins.[126]

## A hub-based network

Cape Town's seven largest international markets are all hub airports, with 2.7 million seats in 2026 against 2.0 million in 2019. Western Europe holds 38% of international capacity, the Middle East 23%, Southern Africa 17%, Eastern Africa 14% and North America 6%. Most hub passengers connect: Emirates' connecting share is above 80% a year and Qatar Airways' is nine in ten.[127]

New carriers lean towards Africa and the hubs. Seven of the twelve that launched Cape Town services since 2014 fly to African points. By 2026 seats the largest are Airlink to regional points (441,602) and Ethiopian to Addis Ababa (437,430). Turkish to Istanbul (240,200), United to Newark and Washington (172,190) and Kenya Airways to Nairobi (127,138) follow.[128]

Yet no seat flies direct to Asia: the network has no direct capacity to any Asian market. Thirteen of the 27 routes in the load table serve African or Indian Ocean points, and none serves Asia. A direct Asian route is therefore a long-term prize, and the near-term seats sit with the hub carriers. The hub routes are not full. Dubai ran at 72.3%, Addis Ababa at 71.9% and Doha at 65.2% in the year to November 2025. On those routes marketing can still fill seats, which it cannot do on the eleven full ones.[129]

In 2026 the hub model showed its risk. About one third of passengers to or from Asia-Pacific used Middle East hubs in 2025, on IATA's May 2026 count. In September 2026 Middle East carriers' international demand fell 7.5%, while African carriers' rose 8.0%. Emirates had 91% of its previous network operating at 30 September, and its April to September passengers fell 22%. Qatar Airways had suspended four Saudi destinations, not its hub, and ACSA's warning of 1 March 2026 included Cape Town. Hubs in one conflict region share risk, so spreading work across Dubai and Doha alone gives false comfort.

Alternatives are growing. British Airways added Cape Town capacity in March 2026, and the IAG winter schedule raises Heathrow to Cape Town from seven to 19 weekly flights. Emirates launched a third daily service on 1 July 2026 and widened its codeshare with South African Airways in August, though a codeshare through Dubai is not an independent routing. Wesgro's 2024/25 record was one additional airline, four international routes and ten expansions.

## Winter seats and fares

On full routes, airlines are expected to raise fares before they add seats. The MIDAS forecast is that carriers will seek revenue through higher fares rather than new services, which frustrates the wish for more visitors. No fare data backs the forecast; it rests on judgement of airline behaviour. In winter carriers withdraw seats. June carried 6.4% of Cape Town's 2025 international seats and December 10.8%, with May, July, August and September at 6.9% each.[130]

[126] MIDAS, "In Conclusion".
[127] MIDAS, "The Capetown Market", "Seasonality".
[128] MIDAS, "The Capetown Market"; the other seven are Delta Air Lines to Atlanta with 110,612 seats, Norse Atlantic UK to London Gatwick with 103,428, LATAM Airlines Group to São Paulo with 47,084, Air Tanzania to Dar es Salaam and Victoria Falls with 37,716, Safair to Windhoek with 32,130, Proflight Zambia to Livingstone with 14,600 and Eswatini Air to Manzini with 3,700.
[129] MIDAS, "The Capetown Market", "Seasonality", computed.
[130] MIDAS, "In Conclusion", "Seasonality".

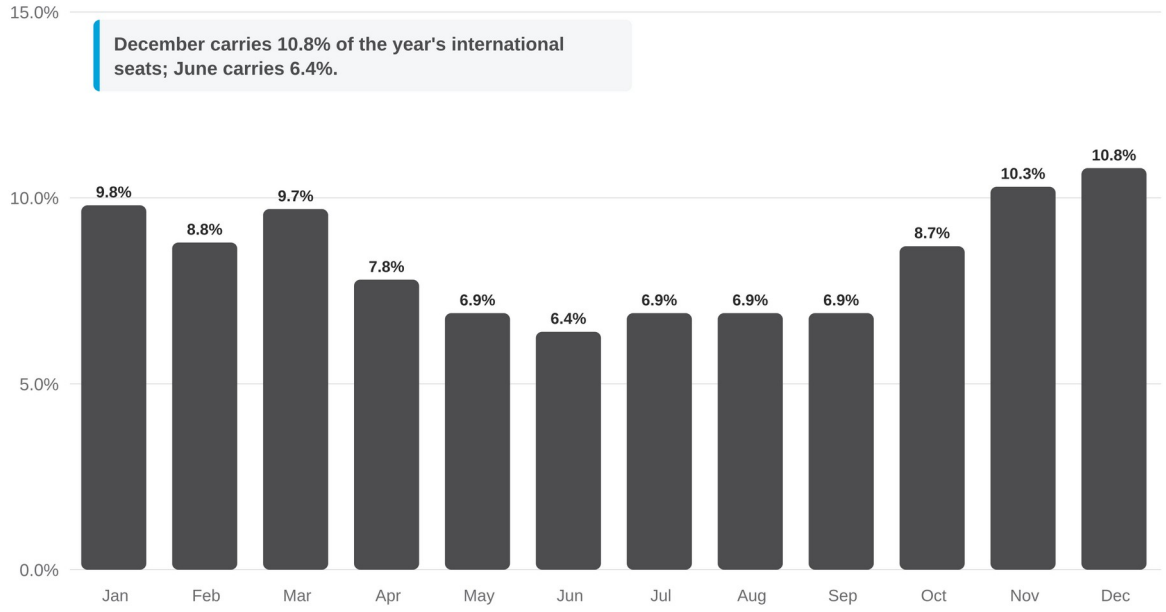



**Figure 2.5.** International seats by month, 2025

Connecting traffic is especially critical in the low season, which ties the winter schedule to the hub carriers' own priorities. New seats must therefore be won route by route and season by season, as New Zealand did with route-tied marketing (section 2.1).[131]

## Runway capacity

The airport, not the airlines, sets the outer limit. Cape Town International's one main runway has no parallel taxiway and caps movements at about 30 an hour. Two of the airport's seven parts are already full. The R6.39bn runway relocation lifts the cap to 45 movements an hour, a 50% rise. On the planning timeline it completes around 2033, with terminal relief from about 2032. ACSA's latest schedule is earlier, with the runway finished by December 2029, subject to contract award. This report assumes about 2033 and treats the earlier date as upside.[132]

ACSA's February 2026 programme prices the works. The realigned runway, at about R6.39 billion, is 3,500 m by 60 m, rotated 11.5 degrees and Code F capable, with contractor appointment planned for December 2026. Domestic arrivals works come to R2.39 billion, a domestic departures expansion from April 2027 to R500 million and international terminal development to R863 million. This is an investment programme, not a construction possession and slot timetable. [Open item: ACSA to reconcile the R11.3 billion overhaul in the Infrastructure Report with about R10.1 billion across its February 2026 items.]

The alternatives arrive sooner but carry less. George handled 911,000 passengers in 2025, above its design limit. A R310m terminal expansion doubles its capacity to about 2 million passengers by 2028 or 2029. Cape Winelands Airport targets first passengers in 2028 on an R8bn first phase. Environmental appeals against it were dismissed in May 2026, but financial close, aviation licensing and airline commitments are not evidenced, so it stays a scenario. Capacity and certainty pull apart: the certain fix comes last, and the earliest large option is the least certain.[133]

Yet no stakeholder named Cape Town International's capacity as a constraint, and it appears only as a transfer-time reference. No airline or airport sat among the 16 organisations, so the runway's absence

[131] MIDAS, "Executive Summary".
[132] Infrastructure Report, p101, p102, p103; Minister of Transport, parliamentary reply, Apr 2025; the 45 comes from the parliamentary reply, while the Infrastructure Report, p103, prints about 40% more flights an hour; ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, Aug 2026.
[133] Infrastructure Report, p104, p105, p106, p109.

from their concerns is a gap in the record, not a finding. The outer limit is a national lever, held by ACSA (section 2.4).[134]

## Cruise circuit and shore capacity

Cape Town's cruise berth has room. It can take 150 or more calls a season and handled 83 in 2024/25, a season Wesgro counts as 79 cruise liner visits and 83 vessel calls, with about 127,000 passengers. In 2025/26 visits fell to 64, with about 106,000 passengers, and the season added R1.35bn to provincial GDP-R against R1.79bn a season earlier (section 1.1). International passengers rose from 55,495 in 2022/23 to 100,255 in 2024/25, about 81% more; the 2025/26 split is not in hand. The base is volatile: reroutes made 20 of the 67 calls in 2023/24. The berth's limits are a 300m ship length, the South-Easter wind and no shore power [Cruise Cape Town to confirm the ship-length limit: the Infrastructure Report gives ships up to 300m (p110) and Wesgro's prospectus a berth length of 226 m (p9)].[135]

Ships come for the circuit, not for one port. A line deploys a ship for a season when a full itinerary works, and Wesgro's prospectus sells Cape Town as the homeport for two. The east coast itinerary calls at Mossel Bay and Hermanus, then at Gqeberha, East London, Durban and Richards Bay. It runs on to Mozambique, the East African coast and the Indian Ocean islands. The west coast itinerary runs through Saldanha Bay and Port Nolloth to Namibia, Angola and St Helena. The province holds one equipped port in that circuit. Mossel Bay handled 21 calls and about 13,000 passengers and opened a R22m passenger facility in November 2025, yet ships anchor and tender there and only small and mid-sized ships call. Saldanha Bay has had 3 trial calls into an ore terminal, with no cruise berth or passenger facility. Calls therefore rise when the circuit works, not when Cape Town markets harder. [Cruise Cape Town or the StratEcon study to supply deployment by line and call-day excursion uptake] Mossel Bay's own count differs: calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season, and StratEcon counts 21 passenger-day visits there in 2024/25, with 31,146 passengers and R46.3m of spending. For 2025/26 Wesgro counts 13 cruise liner visits across Mossel Bay, Hermanus and Saldanha Bay together, with just over 7,150 passengers and R11.2m of spending. [Open item: reconcile the Mossel Bay counts and the 2025/26 regional total against each source's definitions.][136]

Shore capacity binds on call days. A call lands its passengers in the same few hours, and the prospectus sells them the Cape Town Big 6, among them Table Mountain, Cape Point, Robben Island and the V&A Waterfront. Those are the sites this section finds full in season: Boulders is near carrying capacity, Cableway queues run up to three hours and weather cancels Robben Island trips. The terminal has queue space for about ten coaches. When two liners docked on one day in March 2025 with just over 5,000 passengers, the City warned the public to expect congestion around the Waterfront. The cruise season falls in the southern summer, so more peak calls compound peak pressure.[137]

Five moves follow from that reading. Circuit partnerships with partner ports and lines make a Southern African season worth a deployment. Homeport turnarounds bring pre- and post-cruise stays. Shore programmes move passengers beyond the flagships, to the Winelands, Hermanus and the Overberg, the West Coast and community walks. Call-day flow plans are agreed with the flagship sites, and marketing aims for more shoulder-season calls. The port stance holds: protect Cape Town, back Mossel Bay now and watch Saldanha Bay.[138]

[134] Stakeholder Insights, p16, p22, p43; those voices were scheduled for later engagement phases.
[135] Infrastructure Report, p110, p110 to p112; Diagnostic, p37; that source counts 79 vessels for the season, while passengers agree; the Infrastructure Report also prints about 40% use of the season, on a basis it does not state; Wesgro, 2024/25 Cruise Season Injects R1.79 Billion into Western Cape Economy, 13 Sep 2025, public source; StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p9 to p10, computed; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p9, p29.
[136] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p6, p7, p29; Infrastructure Report, p110 to p112; Stakeholder Insights, p20; the town was the only stakeholder to raise cruise; StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p29.
[137] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p6, p10, p16; City of Cape Town, All hands on deck to manage cruise liner congestion, media release, 11 Mar 2025, public source; Stakeholder Insights, p36, p33; Infrastructure Report, p24.
[138] Infrastructure Report, p110 to p112.

## Flagship sites in season

The province's best-known sites run at capacity in summer. At the Table Mountain Aerial Cableway, peak queues of up to three hours up and two down detract from the visitor experience. Chapman's Peak suffers disruptions, and the peak over December and January overwhelms transport and accommodation capacity. Boulders is already near carrying capacity, and summit expansion on Table Mountain is severely limited. Yet the township attractions are underused, and the overflow reserves are under-marketed. CapeNature's reserves are already drawing more visitors. Over the festive season, Robberg's day visitors rose 50% and Stony Point's visitors 28%. Stony Point, the Overberg's penguin colony, is this report's alternative to Boulders. On the peninsula the Southern Line through Muizenberg and Kalk Bay is a low-cost scenic corridor, though regular service on its Simon's Town section is unconfirmed (section 2.4). Eleven of the 16 organisations see the offer as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons. The peak must therefore spread to product with room, under the capacity discipline New Zealand applies (section 2.1). Beyond a few reserves, the regions cannot yet take the overflow.[139]

Cape Point is a flagship in its own right. Counted as the Cape of Good Hope, it drew 940,399 visitors in 2023, up 49.0%. More than half of international tourists, 55.4%, go there. No source yet measures the carrying capacity of any flagship.[140]

**Table 2.6.** Flagship visitors, 2023 and 2024

**Three flagships are each seen by more than half of international tourists, and visits to four of them rose by more than 40% in 2023.**

| Site | Visitors, 2023 | Rise on 2022 | International tourists who visit, 2024 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Table Mountain National Park** | 2,795,838 | 56.3% | Not listed as one site |
| **Table Mountain Aerial Cableway** | 984,641 | 44.3% | 50.5% |
| **Cape of Good Hope (Cape Point)** | 940,399 | 49.0% | 55.4% |
| **Boulders** | 762,494 | 60.2% | 56.2% |
| **Kirstenbosch** | 673,290 | 8.5% | 34.7% |
| **Robben Island** | 239,641 | Not stated | Not in the top ten |

Source: Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p69 (visitors and rise on 2022); Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68 (share of international tourists who visit each site, from its ten most visited places in 2024, where the sites appear as Cape Point, Boulders Beach National Park and Table Mountain Cableway). The first source does not say whether the park's count includes its Cape of Good Hope and Boulders sections.

Counts for 2025 show the same pressure. The City's fourth-quarter figures record 374,808 visits to the Cableway, 337,044 to Cape Point, 202,047 to Kirstenbosch and 108,225 to Robben Island, and Table Mountain National Park recorded 1,708,289 entries from April to October 2025. Visits are neither distinct tourists nor safe capacities. From 1 November 2026 SANParks charges South African adults R57 and international adults R282 at Boulders, and international adults R592 at Cape Point. Stony Point's R45 entry and opening hours establish neither spare ecological capacity nor readiness for coaches.

## Readiness beyond the Metro

Overall readiness halves between the Metro and the periphery. The Cape Metro rates 4.5 out of 5, the Winelands and the Garden Route 3.4, the Overberg 2.7, the West Coast 2.5 and the Central Karoo 1.9. Accessibility falls fastest. On attractions it scores 4.7 in the Metro, 3.3 in the Winelands and 3.0 on the Garden Route. It drops to 2.0 in the Overberg, 1.7 on the West Coast and 1.0 in the Central Karoo, while the Metro scores 5.0 on transport.[141]

[139] Stakeholder Insights, p36, p24, p11; Infrastructure Report, p28, p32, p24, p88, p100; the second puts peak queues at two to three hours; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p70; the count is reconstructed from the appendix tables.
[140] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p69; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68.
[141] Infrastructure Report, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85, p88 to p90.

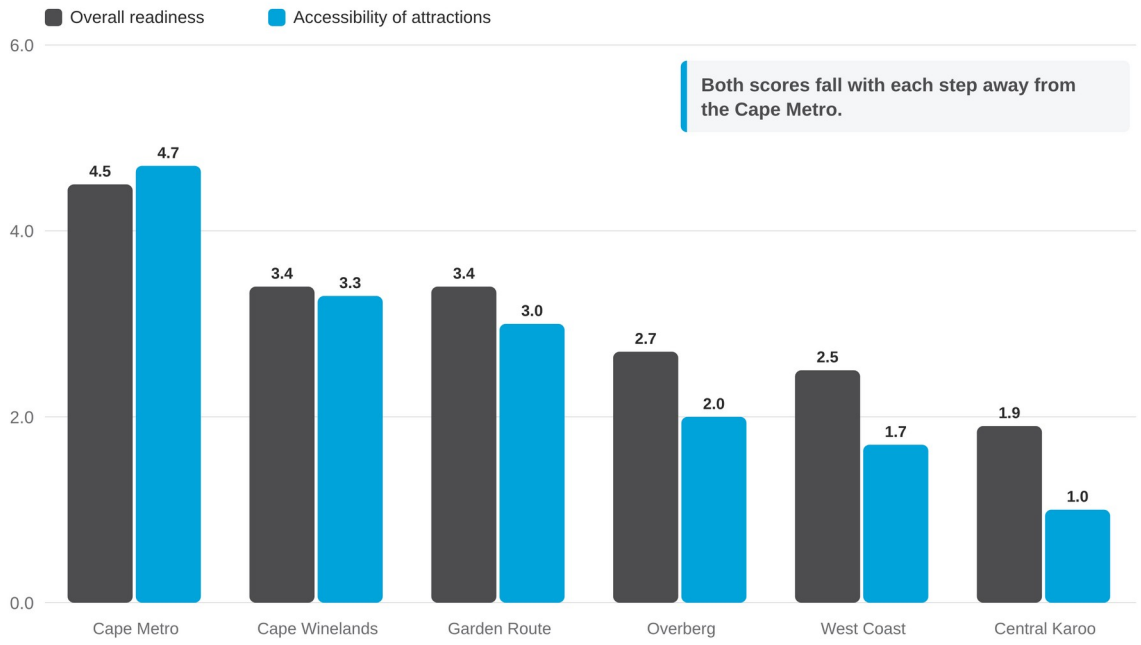



**Figure 2.6.** Readiness and accessibility by district

Note: Scale 1 (very weak) to 5 (leading); districts ordered from the Metro outward.

Cape Town is both the gateway and the dispersal point. The Metro holds 20,281 of the 50,332 assets (40.3%) and five of the province's six highest-volume attractions. It is the only region with an international airport and rapid transit. It also generates 72.5% of provincial output, measured as GDPR. Visitors are more concentrated than assets. Nine of the ten places international tourists visit most are in the Metro, led by the V&A Waterfront, which 78.3% of them visit. In 2023 the Metro's attractions also outgrew the province's, while Garden Route visitor numbers fell 20%.[142]

**Table 2.7.** District strengths and weaknesses

**Each district has a distinct strength, and the Metro holds two in every five of the province's tourism assets.**

| District | Assets | Share | Strength | Weakness |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Metro** | 20,281 | 40.3% | Five of the six highest-volume attractions; the only international airport and rapid transit | Peak congestion at flagship sites; rail unusable for tourism |
| **Garden Route** | 9,875 | 19.6% | Second-largest accommodation stock; a regional airport with direct flights | 300km of coastline fragments the route; no inter-town shuttle |
| **Cape Winelands** | 7,730 | 15.4% | Largest commercial and leisure base, anchored by 200-plus wine estates | Wine dominates; adventure and heritage under-promoted |
| **Overberg** | 6,176 | 12.3% | Whale coast; the only market where demand and pricing peak in winter | Public transport effectively absent; interpretation gaps |
| **West Coast** | 4,752 | 9.4% | Highest natural-asset attractiveness; accessible pricing | Short wildflower season; dining in a handful of nodes |
| **Central Karoo** | 1,518 | 3.0% | Niche assets of the highest uniqueness; dark-sky astro-tourism | A service desert outside Prince Albert and Beaufort West |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026: asset counts p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 (Winelands share computed: 7,730 of 50,332 is 15.4%); strengths and weaknesses p88 to p90.

[142] Infrastructure Report, p23, p88, p90; Diagnostic, p39, p42; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p69.

Beyond the Metro the visitor drives. Even the Garden Route, with its airport, has no shuttle between towns. Public transport is effectively absent on the West Coast and in the Overberg, and the Winelands have no transit between estates or valleys. Every accessibility measure in the Central Karoo sits at the floor, and even Metro rail is functionally unusable for tourism. Stakeholders call weak public transport, congestion and unreliable last-mile access structural barriers to visitor movement within and beyond Cape Town. Dispersal therefore needs deliberate corridor investment, not organic spillover from Cape Town.[143]

## Regional beds and booking

The assets that could draw visitors outward sit where few can stay or book. The West Coast has the province's highest natural-asset attractiveness and the Central Karoo its most unique niche assets, yet both score lowest on readiness. Inland areas north of the N2 on the Garden Route are tourism-inactive. Industrial belts in the Metro convert none of their nearby attractions into tourism.[144]

Beds are one gap. In the Winelands mid-market accommodation is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch, and a product mix skewed to luxury excludes mid-market and family segments. Accommodation is thin beyond Langebaan and Paternoster on the West Coast and thin at international grade along Route 62. On the West Coast, where beds are thin, overnight stays remain below the provincial average. No bed count yet sizes the gap.[145]

Sizing that gap takes more than a bed count. A usable supply comparison weighs rooms, bed types, trading periods, price points, meeting space, accessibility and committed developments against validated demand. A full hotel on peak weekends signals compression, not a year-round shortage. Branded stock also exists outside the Metro: George has the Protea Hotel by Marriott George King George, with 109 rooms and four event rooms, the largest seating 300. The question is which configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing, and where.

Booking is the second question, and the evidence on it is mixed. Six touring routes were rated Ready, Developing or Gap on access, accommodation, safety and bookability (the West Coast route carries an overall rating of Emerging). Route 62 has the lowest online bookability of the six, and the West Coast route rates Gap on digital distribution and payments. CapeNature takes about 70% of its reservations through its call centre rather than its online platform. Even in the Metro, about 40% or more of smaller operators are said to lack online booking, an estimate with no stated scope.[146]

Presence is not the constraint the evidence shows. A desk test on 10 November 2026 checked 21 eligible accommodation cases. All 13 outside the operational core and all eight core comparators had a property-specific platform listing. The cases were chosen, not sampled, and they favour established businesses, so the result gives counterexamples and not a provincial rate.

Prominence, inventory and sales are the open questions. No test has yet ranked regional product in a traveller's search, checked rooms on common dates or traced a sale. One major platform discloses that commission and programme participation can influence ranking, and the Competition Commission examined sponsored ranking in 2023. A listing can therefore exist and still earn little exposure, or earn it at a cost to the operator.

[143] Infrastructure Report, p49, p88 to p90, p5; Stakeholder Insights, p10.
[144] Infrastructure Report, p24, p35, p88.
[145] Infrastructure Report, p47, p53, p62, p84; Diagnostic, p46.
[146] Infrastructure Report, p19, p62, p84, p87, p32; the July final supersedes a June draft; Stakeholder Insights, p42.

**Table 2.8.** Touring route readiness

**Only the Cape Peninsula route is rated ready for international visitors; the Winelands and the Garden Route fall short on safety, and the outer routes on access, accommodation or bookability.**

| Route | From Cape Town | Access | Accommodation | Safety | Bookability | Overall |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Peninsula** | 0 km | Ready | Ready | Developing | Ready | Ready |
| **Cape Winelands** | 50 km | Ready | Ready | Developing | Ready | Developing |
| **Whale Coast and Overberg** | 120 km | Developing | Developing | Developing | Developing | Developing |
| **West Coast and Cederberg** | 120 km | Developing | Gap | Ready | Gap | Emerging |
| **Route 62 and Klein Karoo** | 160 km | Developing | Developing | Developing | Gap | Developing |
| **Garden Route** | 385 km | Ready | Ready | Developing | Ready | Developing |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p29, p30, p39, p40, p50, p51, p61, p62, p72, p73, p83, p84.

The regions need beds and a booking route before marketing, with quality visible on booking platforms, as in Valencia (section 2.1).

## Short-term rentals and residents

Short-term rentals are a large and largely uncounted layer of the province's accommodation supply. A March 2026 snapshot of one platform's listings counted 26,991 in Cape Town, 1,953 in Overstrand, 1,413 in Knysna, 1,404 in Stellenbosch and 1,226 in Bitou; no comparable count was found for George. A listing is not a bed available tonight, and a municipal count cannot stand for its towns.

Cape Town's stock is concentrated and commercial in structure. Of 27,760 listings in September 2026, 23,458 were entire homes or flats, and 62.5% sat with hosts listing more than one property, though a manager is not necessarily an owner. Three wards (115, 54 and 77) held 43.8% of listings. Some 18,199 listings carried a review in the past year, a proxy for activity rather than occupancy, and their advertised capacity of 103,550 guests is not a count of available peak beds.

**Table 2.9.** Cape Town listings in six wards, September 2026

**Three wards hold 43.8% of Cape Town's advertised listings, and most listings in every ward shown are entire homes.**

| Ward | All listings | Entire homes or flats | Private rooms | Listings with multi-listing hosts |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **115** | 6,192 | 5,695 | 455 | 4,349 |
| **54** | 4,328 | 3,859 | 460 | 3,256 |
| **77** | 1,648 | 1,348 | 293 | 929 |
| **23** | 1,474 | 1,229 | 242 | 913 |
| **64** | 1,232 | 1,064 | 150 | 650 |
| **74** | 1,217 | 1,055 | 154 | 702 |

Source: Study-team calculations from the advertised Cape Town listings of 23 September 2026. Multi-listing hosts are accounts with more than one Cape Town listing, which does not prove common ownership. Other room types make up the difference. Wards are not suburbs.

The rules are municipal and in motion. Cape Town's 2026/27 tariff rates commercial property at 2.41 times the residential rate, and its Rates Policy treats a home let short for more than half its annual room nights as commercial for rating. That threshold sets a rate, not a limit on letting. The City consulted from August to October 2026 on registration and platform data sharing, with category changes anticipated from July

2027. Nationally, a draft code was published in March 2026, and the Minister of Tourism has stated that the current Act does not empower her to regulate the sector.

The housing effect is not measured locally. International studies find rent and price effects from short-term listings, but no Cape Town study isolates them by precinct after controlling for migration, construction and income. Resident interests also reach beyond rents, to noise, waste, parking, public space and workers' commutes in the busiest precincts.

For the supply side the implication is twofold; first, short-term rentals supply much of the self-catering stock visitors already favour (section 1.1), so they belong in any count of regional beds. Second, letting concentrated in a few central wards adds to resident pressure, which the plan's spread in time and place is meant to ease.

## Capital for regional gaps

Committed capital closes the air gaps, not the regional ones. The Metro's pipeline exceeds R30bn, led by ACSA's R11.3bn airport overhaul, the R20bn V&A Granger Bay expansion and the R3.3bn MyCiTi Phase 2. Outside the Metro the money goes to roads, ports, airports and a few precincts: Cape Winelands Airport, the George terminal, the R693m Malmesbury bypass, the R62 reconstruction and the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct.[147]

None of it buys transit between towns, the beds each place lacks or a booking route. Section 2.4 shows that the bodies that manage and sell the regions are short of money themselves.

Goal 2 must therefore win seats into the gateway first, then build the corridors, beds and booking that decide where growth lands.

[147] Infrastructure Report, p32, p43, p54, p65, p76, p87; the pipeline also holds a wider Winelands airport precinct of R16bn to R20bn, a R9.4m landing-system upgrade at George, the R17m Malgas road, the Saldanha port upgrade and rural broadband to 2026.

**What this means for the objectives**

**Objective 7, Win direct routes and add seats on full routes.** Eleven routes run above 80% and fares are likely to rise before seats. The 2026 Gulf disruption showed that hubs in one region share risk. The runway is the binding constraint until about 2033, and the base case passes the model's seat line by 2030. Read as a rise in yearly arrivals by 2030, Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 arrivals target is about 2.6 to 3.3 times the base case's gain (Table 1.3).

**Objective 8, Grow cruise calls and ports.** The berth has room; the regional circuit and call-day shore capacity set growth. Value grows with the international mix rather than the number of calls.

**Objective 7 and objective 15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies.** Airport capital is committed, but regional gaps have no committed capital.

Objective 9, Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility. Accessibility falls from 4.7 to 1.0, and public transport is absent beyond the Metro. Stakeholders name last-mile access as a barrier, which supports it. The Department of Mobility's draft Tourism Transport Strategy already plans the airport link and tourist route signage (section 2.4). The MyCiTi airport service is suspended, and the grant behind MyCiTi ends in 2027/28.

**Objective 10, Support diversified route and product development, and objective 11, Align visitor experience in-destination.** Strong assets sit in areas with little tourism use, and the mid-market gap is a product question to test place by place. Stakeholders' account of a narrow product set supports objective 10, and nine of the ten places international tourists visit most are in the Metro.

Objective 12, Balance impact on nature-based attractions. Flagships are full at peak, as stakeholders also report. Table Mountain National Park alone drew 2.8 million visitors in 2023. The underused alternatives are the township attractions, the receiving reserves such as Stony Point and the Southern Line towns. Receiving sites need their own readiness test before visitors are steered to them.

Objective 3, Make the whole province findable and bookable. Regional rooms are listed on the platforms, but prominence, inventory and sales are unmeasured, and stakeholders report product that cannot be booked online.

**Objectives 2, 4, 5 and 6, from the air side.** Winter seats fall to 6.4% of the year in June. No seat flies direct to Asia today, and the hub routes still have seats, so conversion runs through the hubs. The mature long-haul routes are the fullest, and routes to five regional markets run above 80% and are named for more capacity.

## 2.4 The enabling environment

The enabling system is thinnest where the action plan needs it most. The decisive levers sit nationally, local tourism bodies' funding has been disrupted and the measures of tourism jobs and GDP are still to be built. In the communities, organisation rather than distance keeps visitor spend out.

### National levers

The levers that most limit growth are held nationally. In an insight rated High, the Department of Economic Development reports that restrictive bilateral air agreements are limiting airlift growth, leaving the province less competitive than peers. Chinese routes often extend government-to-government relations. The runway that caps Cape Town International sits with ACSA, a national body (sections 1.1 and 2.3).[148]

Visas and national marketing follow the same pattern. Chinese and Gulf travellers face slow, document-heavy visa processes. Four organisations raised visas, among them the Cableway for India and China

[148] Stakeholder Insights, p24; insights are the project team's statements, attributed to the organisation engaged; MIDAS, "The Chinese Market Opportunity".

and the CTICC for African events. The Department of Economic Development also finds that SA Tourism's institutional weakness constrains international marketing. The Western Cape holds none of these levers (section 1.1), so it must move them by escalation backed with evidence. Chile's case points the same way: lobby for air service liberalisation and simpler visas (section 2.1).[149]

Entry rules are changing as this report is written. The Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) launched officially on 12 August 2026, after pilot access for China, India, Indonesia and Mexico. By early November 2026 it was reported as open to 53 nationalities, with the eVisa platform to close on 1 December 2026; this comes from trade reporting, partly corroborated by an embassy notice. A R500 electronic processing fee has applied since 17 August 2026, and a separate R425 visa fee applies where payable. The Trusted Tour Operator Scheme (TTOS) had issued 49,725 visas by 22 January 2026, an approval rate of about 95%, with 45 operators added in August 2025 to the original 65. A visa issued is not an arrival, so the test is authorisations matched to arrivals.

African entry rules vary by passport, not by region. Ordinary passport holders from Ghana and Kenya have 90 days a year. Botswana and Zimbabwe are in the 90-day category, while Namibia, Zambia and Tanzania carry annual qualifications. Eswatini, Lesotho, Malawi, Mauritius and Mozambique are in the 30-day category, and Angola permits visits of up to 30 days within a 90-day annual allowance. Nigeria is not ordinarily exempt, and SADC membership confers no uniform waiver. No comparable processing-time series exists for visa-required African markets.

The province holds instruments for that escalation. Its own visa study, by BDO for the Department of Economic Development, ranks the reforms to press for: published processing times first, then visa exemption for China, India and Nigeria. Wesgro's Advocacy and Advisory unit exists to press such evidence on the levers the province does not control (section 1.1). The Tourism Blueprint 2030 names the same barriers: poor continental air access from restricted markets, a costly and inconvenient visa regime and persistent safety concerns.[150]

## Funding and mandates

The bodies that manage and sell the destination are weaker than a decade ago. The Department of Economic Development rates Western Cape and Cape Town tourism funding materially below peer destinations for destination management and marketing. It finds that tourism institutional capacity has eroded over the past decade at both provincial and municipal level, and both findings are rated High.[151]

National Treasury's MFMA Circular No. 131 of 31 March 2025 has since disrupted established municipal funding for local tourism organisations (LTOs), a finding also rated High. Most of them cannot sustain operations without municipal funding. Mandates also blur at district level. The West Coast District Municipality reports a mandate disconnect between the district, local municipalities and LTOs that leaves tourism development without a clear owner.[152]

The circular changes the route, not the permission. It does not prohibit funding tourism organisations. It separates an unrequited transfer under section 67 of the MFMA from a purchase of goods or services, which must follow constitutional procurement and municipal supply-chain rules. Cape Town processed its first Cape Town Tourism payment as contracted services, in compliance with the circular (City mid-year report, January 2026). An earlier Auditor-General finding at Mossel Bay recorded tourism spend as irregular where procurement was not followed.

The disruption is uneven. Garden Route officials reported in March 2026 that Calitzdorp and Ladismith could not operate fully, that Calitzdorp's office closed from November to February and that Oudtshoorn,

[149] Demand-Side Analysis, p51; Stakeholder Insights, p36, p45, p24, p25.
[150] BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p34; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4, p11.
[151] Stakeholder Insights, p25.
[152] Stakeholder Insights, p25, p39.

De Rust and Plettenberg Bay were affected. George's integrated municipal tourism unit was unaffected. These are attributed statements, not an audited inventory.

Provincial money is committed, not spare. DEDAT's 2026/27 main budget is R596.765 million, including a R127.355 million transfer to Wesgro, R6.8 million for the CTICC and earmarks of R3 million for tourism safety and R4 million for tourism growth initiatives. These are existing allocations, not spare money. Wesgro also runs an annual joint marketing agreement process for leisure events and quarterly regional and LTO forums.

Fiscal pressure is turning attention to a tourism levy and blended finance. The Department of Mobility's draft transport framework plans its own business case for a tourist levy, as alternative funding for tourism transport. The committed capital in section 2.3 builds airports, ports, roads, transit and precincts, but none of it funds the bodies that manage and sell the destination. The plan cannot rest on LTOs until their services are contracted on a lawful route and their mandates are settled.[153]

## Sustainability and climate risk

Sustainable growth starts with what the destination can carry. Water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes such as the Garden Route. Boulders is near carrying capacity, and no source yet measures the carrying capacity of any flagship (sections 1.1 and 2.3). Climate adds a dated cost. Robben Island Museum loses about R16 million a year to weather-cancelled trips, a High-rated insight, and CapeNature reports climate-related flooding, fire and heat closing sites. Sustainable destination management is therefore risk management for the province's flagship product today, and should be funded as such, not as a later add-on.[154]

The evidence separates three tasks. Adaptation and continuity keep the destination trading through floods, fire and drought. Ordinary resource and ecological capacity sets how many visitors a node's water, power and sites can carry in a normal season. Emissions mitigation is the third, with its own measures.

Structures for the first task exist. The province has a climate response forum, an implementation plan dated March 2023 and support for municipalities, and its Water Resilience Strategy runs from 2025 to 2035. DEDAT offers tourism disaster-risk guidance and one-day training. Wesgro's Water Communications Centre of 2017/18 is a local precedent for joint crisis messaging. The Green Tourism Incentive Programme is closed pending review.

Capacity is tighter than supply plans suggest. The City's August 2026 position is stable supply with rising restriction risk, and the first Faure water arrives only in 2031 (section 1.1). George's and Knysna's capacity figures depend on assets operating, and Blue Drop and Green Drop results do not certify spare capacity for a hotel. Floods in May 2026 damaged CapeNature roads, trails and buildings; by June, 85% of its reserves reported some damage.

## Collaboration and data sharing

Collaboration and data sharing are the barriers stakeholders raise most often. Fifteen of the 16 organisations raised industry and government collaboration, and fifteen raised policy and data sharing.[155]

[153] Stakeholder Insights, p23, p25; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12.
[154] Diagnostic, p38; Stakeholder Insights, p33, p43.
[155] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, counted.

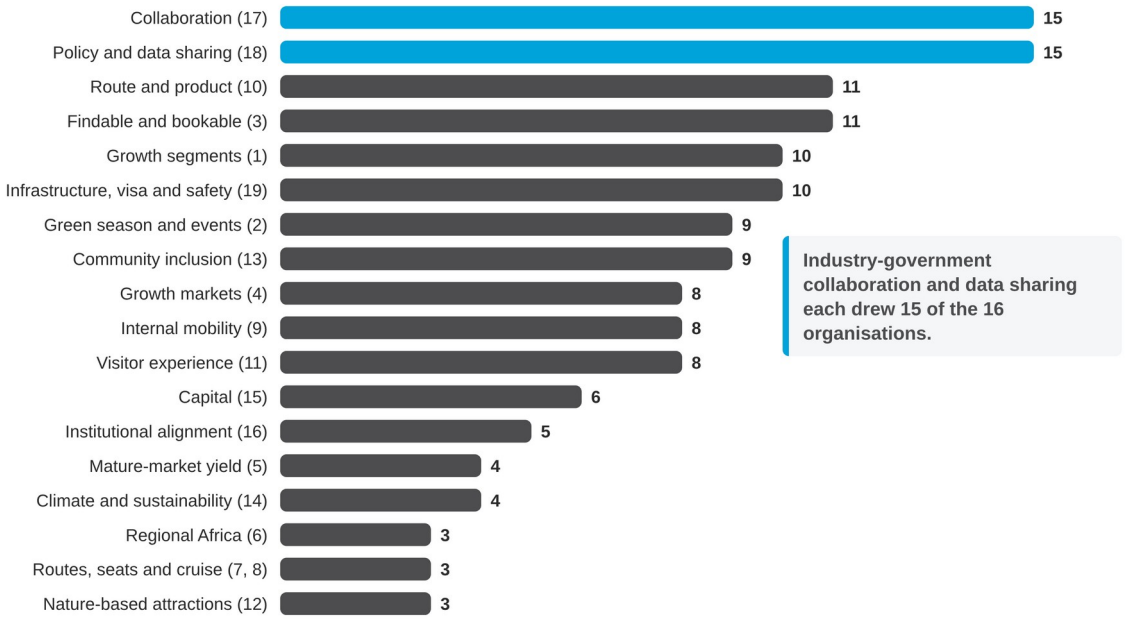



**Figure 2.7.** Objectives stakeholders raised

Data sharing also draws 30 insights and 16 High ratings, the most of any category. Stakeholders describe the data architecture as too fragmented, lagged and proxy-based to give a reliable provincial view of visitor volumes, spend, spread or economic impact.[156]

Coordination is hard everywhere, as the comparators show (section 2.1). Yet the platforms for collaboration already exist here. FEDHASA points to the Joint Association Members Meeting Sessions (JAMMS), through which Cape Town Tourism, FEDHASA Cape, SAACI Western Cape and SATSA Western Cape coordinate with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town. Cape Town Air Access joins them, with ACSA and industry, around routes (section 1.1). What is missing is an agreed way to share data across those bodies, not another forum.[157]

## Transport and safety plans

Two plans reach into the visitor's journey. The Department of Mobility's draft Provincial Land Transport Framework includes a Tourism Transport Strategy, which plans to revive the MyCiTi airport service with ACSA and to sign and maintain tourist routes. The City's framework for 2019 to 2024 set out a Tourist Safety Programme of secure zones in higher-risk tourism areas, a Tourist Police unit, victim support and safety forums, and parts of it now run. The action plan should build on both rather than start new ones. [Open item: the Department of Mobility to confirm which parts of its Tourism Transport Strategy are adopted, funded or running.][158]

Mobility evidence is thin and its funding is at risk. No verified visitor mode split exists: Wesgro's Cape Winelands survey for January to June 2025 records rental cars for 29.29% of international respondents, with 85.35% of domestic transport answers missing. The City says MyCiTi's Public Transport Network Grant ends in 2027/28, with R7.1 billion committed to the Cape Flats expansion and 23 million annual trips, and that fleet and services are at risk. Phase 2A is therefore a funded-delivery milestone, not a given. The MyCiTi airport service is suspended, and ACSA's own pages conflict on where e-hailing pickup sits.

[156] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, counted, p13.
[157] Stakeholder Insights, p31.
[158] Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5.

Rail and regional buses are closer to use than to a visitor product. The Southern Line runs from Cape Town to Fish Hoek, with a Simon's Town section whose regular service PRASA has yet to confirm. Trains do not normally run on Sundays or public holidays, and Boulders needs a transfer from Simon's Town station. The City's rail business plan favours transferred services with private operating participation, and the National Rail Master Plan went to consultation in April 2026; neither is an executed devolution. GO GEORGE requires its own R45 smart card, which can be loaded with cash, a debit or credit card or a SASSA card, and its single fare from July 2026 is R18.50. What is unresolved is tapping a bank card directly on the bus, which national integrated-fare regulations already contemplate. GO GEORGE trialled an airport service in September 2026.

Tourist safety services already run. DEDAT's 2026/27 Annual Performance Plan funds the City's dedicated Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit at high-volume central-city attractions, runs a Tourism Safety and Support service and convenes a Provincial Tourism Safety Forum twice a year. Cape Town Tourism's TravelWise network and the City's 24/7 visitor-support service operate. The open questions are coverage, eligibility and handoffs, not existence.

Activity figures are not crime rates. The City records 2,895 motorist assists by N2 patrols from September 2024 to January 2026, 1,061 of them camera-detected, and 80% of highway incidents since July 2025 were answered within five minutes. SANParks appointed a visitor-safety manager for Table Mountain in December 2025, yet a robbery on Lion's Head in October 2026 prompted a public dispute over patrol coverage. Tourism Monitors figures count people trained, not people placed. SAPS retains command, and the Province holds oversight under section 206 of the Constitution.

## Measuring jobs and GDP

Reliable measures of tourism's jobs and its contribution to GDP are work for execution. The national Department of Tourism reports no approved official methodology for provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates, an insight rated High, which is why the data-sharing protocol (I16) and the labour analysis (I18) build one. Stats SA cites 749 vacancies behind delays to the tourism satellite account and infers provincial flows partly from ports-of-entry data.[159]

The same work is needed at community scale. Community profiles do not count tourism employment inside their boundaries. The figures are node-side instead, such as about 4,700 formal Town Centre jobs for 82,393 employed Mitchells Plain residents, and need rests on fifteen-year-old Census data. CapeNature, the West Coast District and the Overberg raise skills gaps that the labour analysis can size.[160]

Skills evidence has the same limits. CATHSSETA's 2026/27 discretionary grants offer a funding route, not a vacancy count, and industry employment totals cannot identify unfilled posts. DEDAT's plan records pressure on guide registration, with application growth, overtime and burnout, and commits to workflow fixes. National Mandarin training of about 30 guides in early 2026 is not 30 additional Western Cape guides.

For the Western Cape, a jobs baseline comes before a jobs target. The labour analysis sets that baseline in 2027, and Gate 1 tests the ambition of 300,000 tourism-linked jobs against it (section 1.3). The yield-based regional metrics that New Zealand recommends (section 2.1) need the same reliable view of spend and spread, which the data-sharing protocol is to supply.

## Community share of spend

Foreign visitors spent R25.9bn in the province in FY2025, but little of it reaches its townships and rural settlements. The 20 shortlisted communities come from a long-list of every Census sub-place cluster of

[159] Stakeholder Insights, p37, p30.
[160] Inclusion Plan, p22, p15; Stakeholder Insights, p27, p39, p43.

1,500 people or more with official unemployment of 25% or more. Named mission, fishing and farm settlements are added. That gives 107 communities holding 2.81 million people in 2011, 48% of the province. Five weighted criteria (need, tourism potential, proximity, readiness and access) produce the shortlist of 20, five in the Cape Metro and three in each district.[161]

The 20 hold 18.4% of the province's residents and 15.4% of employed residents (Census 2011), yet receive 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend. This comes to about R4m to R10m a year on the documented floor, against R259m a year if they captured 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend.[162]

Inclusion here means activity inside the community. A tour, a meal, a bed or a market counts; a resident commuting to a hotel job in town does not. Inclusion therefore turns on where visitor spend lands, not on how many visitors come.[163]

## Organisation as the constraint

Distance is not the barrier. Of the 107 long-listed communities, 93 lie within 45 minutes of one of 35 tourism nodes or three corridors. Langa is 12 minutes from Cape Town International and Zwelihle seven from Hermanus. Distance is the binding constraint in none of the 20. Yet proximity and access carried 35% of the shortlist score, so the result is partly built into the selection (Appendix A5, Table A.20).[164]

Organisation is the binding constraint in 11 of the 20. Ten have no identified active tourism body, and nine show no benefit visible to residents.[165]

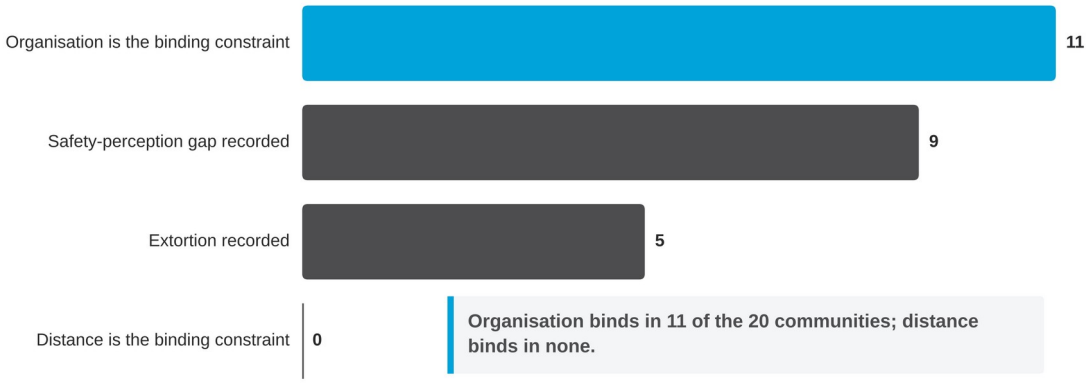



**Figure 2.8.** Binding constraints in 20 communities

Product often exists without a seller. Langa's walk sells on global platforms at ratings above 4.8, yet city firms sell most of the 23 Langa walks on Viator. Zwelihle's four resident guides sell by phone with no shared booking channel. The Mitchells Plain festival drew 27,800 visitors in November 2025 with no local operator or LTO behind it. The communities cannot yet be found or booked on the channels visitors use. What they lack is a local seller, not a shorter journey.[166]

## Safety perception

After a seller, safety is the next gate a visit must pass. Nine of the 20 communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion. Seven stakeholder organisations raised safety, a barrier that runs across transport, township tourism and international selling. Tourism activity alone cannot resolve

[161] Demand-Side Analysis, p11; Inclusion Plan, p14, p15, p16; the evidence joins Census 2011 sub-places to an OpenStreetMap asset layer of September 2026 with road travel times and municipal plans, and need rests on Census 2011 because Census 2022 is not published below ward level and asked no income question.
[162] Inclusion Plan, p5.
[163] Inclusion Plan, p4.
[164] Inclusion Plan, p16, p18, p30; the archetype counts give 92 near a node, while the source prints 93.
[165] Inclusion Plan, p28, p30.
[166] Inclusion Plan, p20, p28, p22, p34.

crime or extortion. Safety is therefore a launch requirement in its own right, not an outcome of the pilot. No community pilot should open until it is met.[167]

## Four community archetypes

The largest group of long-listed communities sits near a node and has something worth visiting, and each type needs its own first move. Near a node with assets underused, 49 long-listed and 11 shortlisted communities need sellers organised and a slot in the node's itineraries, procurement and events. Near a node with nothing inside, 43 long-listed and 6 shortlisted communities need a seller first, then one anchor asset under a covenant, then integration.[168]

Remote communities with underused assets, 7 long-listed and 2 shortlisted, need access opened and the asset placed on a route product the LTO already sells (Atlantis is classed remote by Wesgro's naming, though it lies 26 minutes from Darling). Remote communities with nothing inside, 8 long-listed and 1 shortlisted, need procurement and skills first and an asset only once a route product exists. The first move differs by type, but in each the seller or the route comes before the asset.[169]

**Table 2.10.** The 20 shortlisted communities

**The 20 shortlisted communities span every region and sit between 1 and 111 minutes from their nearest node.**

| Region | Community | Type | Score | Minutes to node | Binding constraint |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cape Metro | Langa | N-A | 3.00 | 12 to CTIA | Organisation |
| Cape Metro | Khayelitsha | N-A | 3.00 | 15 to CTIA | Organisation |
| Cape Metro | Gugulethu | N-A | 2.80 | 8 to CTIA | Attraction |
| Cape Metro | Mitchells Plain | N-A | 2.35 | 16 to CTIA | Organisation |
| Cape Metro | Atlantis | R-A | 2.20 | 26 to Darling | Organisation |
| Cape Winelands | Kayamandi | N-0 | 2.55 | 8 to Stellenbosch | Safety |
| Cape Winelands | Mbekweni | N-0 | 2.40 | 10 to Paarl | Attraction |
| Cape Winelands | Nkqubela | N-0 | 1.90 | 22 to the R62 | Attraction |
| Overberg | Genadendal | N-A | 2.45 | 11 to Greyton | Organisation |
| Overberg | Zwelihle | N-A | 2.05 | 7 to Hermanus | Organisation |
| Overberg | Kassiesbaai | N-A | 2.05 | 1 to Arniston | Organisation |
| Garden Route | Knysna northern townships | N-0 | 2.60 | 9 to Knysna | Market link |
| Garden Route | Thembalethu | N-0 | 2.30 | 11 to George | Attraction |
| Garden Route | De Rust | N-A | 2.30 | 42 to the R62 | Infrastructure |
| West Coast | Laingville | N-A | 2.10 | 4 to St Helena Bay | Organisation |
| West Coast | Doringbaai | R-0 | 2.00 | 111 to Clanwilliam | Organisation |
| West Coast | Elands Bay | R-A | 1.85 | 87 to Clanwilliam | Organisation |
| Central Karoo | Laingsburg (Bergsig) | N-A | 2.35 | 22 to Matjiesfontein | Attraction |
| Central Karoo | Kwa-Mandlenkosi | N-0 | 2.20 | 6 to Beaufort West | Organisation |
| Central Karoo | Prince Albert North | N-A | 1.80 | 4 to Prince Albert | Attraction |

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p18 (shortlist, composite score, free-flow minutes) and p53 to p58 (binding constraint). Archetypes abbreviated: N = near a node (45 minutes or less); R = remote; A = assets underused; 0 = no community-based product. [Open item: re-measure Metro travel times to a visitor node such as the V&A Waterfront or the CBD, not CTIA.]

[167] Inclusion Plan, p30, p35; Stakeholder Insights, p10.
[168] Inclusion Plan, p15, p17; p4 prints 48 and 8 for the two assets-underused rows.
[169] Inclusion Plan, p17.

## A seller with a stake

The evidence points to a model built around a seller. It joins a functioning selling capability to demand the node already has, behind launch gates for safety, access and a viable operating model. A pilot in two or three of the six communities profiled first would test it. The six are Langa, Kayamandi, Zwelihle, De Rust, Doringbaai and Laingsburg, one in each region. It would scale only once bookings, local spend, delivery and safety meet thresholds agreed before launch.[170]

Community supply is not one thing. It includes owner-run enterprises as well as collective projects, so a place called community tourism does not establish collective ownership. Each candidate therefore needs an operator and rights register before it is promoted.

The first output is deliberately small: one live booking route, published operating dates, a named customer contact and a simple record of bookings and local revenue. Most first moves carry no dedicated budget line. Chapter 4 sets out roles and funding. The order the cases support (section 2.1) therefore becomes the order of delivery: a seller first, then a safe visit, then product and exposure.[171]

Every gap in this part is a question of who benefits, who pays, who decides or who measures. Goal 3 must settle those four questions, because Goals 1 and 2 cannot deliver without the answers.

**What this means for the objectives**

Objective 13, Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion. The binding constraint is a seller with a stake, then a safe way in, then demand pulled from the adjacent node. Circular 131 leaves a lawful procurement route for funding local tourism bodies.

**Objective 14, Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk, and objective 15, Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies.** Water and site capacity under pressure, flood losses in the reserves and local tourism bodies whose funding route has changed. The Department of Mobility proposes its own tourist levy case.

**Objective 10, Support diversified route and product development, and objective 15.** Assets follow sellers and route products, not the reverse.

**Objective 16, Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers.** Air rights, visas and SA Tourism sit nationally, Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements and airport capacity sits with ACSA. Cape Town Air Access joins the three tiers, ACSA and industry around routes.

**Objective 19, Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits, a governance task because visas and air rights sit nationally.** Entry is moving to the Electronic Travel Authorisation, whose performance by nationality is not yet published, and safety and extortion gate activation in up to nine communities. The province's visa study ranks the reforms to press for, and the tourist safety services that already run are the base to build on.

**Objective 17, Strengthen industry and government collaboration, and objective 18, Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing.** Each raised by 15 of 16 organisations, with existing platforms such as JAMMS to build on.

**Objective 20, Develop workforce and service skills, waits on analysis still to be commissioned.** Skills gaps raised by CapeNature, the West Coast District and the Overberg District have no labour analysis behind them. No count of tourism jobs exists, which also supports objective 18.

**Objective 3, Make the whole province findable and bookable.** Community product sells by phone or through city operators.

[170] Inclusion Plan, p32, p14.
[171] Inclusion Plan, p33, p36.

Chapter 3

# Findings and recommendations

## 3.1 Goal 1: Reshape demand

Latent interest is not what holds Goal 1 back; turning it into bookings is. The province is known in its mature markets and under-sold in its growth markets, and outside its core its product is listed but of unmeasured reach.

Goal 1 sets out to break through three ceilings on demand, in markets, seasons and spread, by reshaping the brand toward new traveller segments. Five markets supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the UK, Germany and the USA supplied 52% between them. June held 6.4% of the year's international seats at Cape Town International in 2025, against 10.8% in December. Beyond the core routes, named experiences reach the visitor through day tours, walk-ins and local permits more often than through an online ticket.[172]

The gap between interest and arrival is wide. About 97 million high-value travellers in 34 markets have an interest in South Africa, and about 1.4 million convert into arrivals. In the growth markets the constraint is conversion and access, not only awareness. Each ceiling therefore needs a path from interest to booking: green-season seats and events, bookable product and hub traffic that stops in Cape Town.[173]

Two themes carry the goal. The first, traveller, brand and proposition, decides whom the province sells to, when and how. Its objectives target four segments in their home markets, build green-season demand from business events and make the whole province bookable (objectives 1 to 3). The second theme, source market growth and diversification, decides which markets grow the base. It converts Indian and Chinese travellers already flying in through hubs, raises yield in the mature markets and builds the regional African base (objectives 4 to 6).

The two themes work as one. The segments set the target inside each market, and the market groups set where volume and value come from. The green season and bookability decide whether the demand they win lands in the months and places with room to take it. Initiatives I1 to I5 carry the six objectives, and section 4.3 sets out each one.

Goal 1 carries most of the base case. Between 2025 and 2035 the base case adds 676,949 arrivals. The four hub markets, the UAE, Qatar, Ethiopia and Turkey, supply 206,584 of them and the mature markets 178,780. The acceleration markets, led by India and China, supply 175,818, regional Africa 110,298 and the strategic group 5,469. None of it lands without seats, so the air access objective in Goal 2 runs beside this goal from the first phase (objective 7). The goal is judged on arrivals by market group, direct foreign spend and green-season nights and share, not on arrivals alone (section 5.2).[174]

### 3.1.1 Traveller, brand and proposition

The first theme is about whom the Western Cape sells to, when and how. It holds three objectives: the segments, the green season and the bookability of the province. Together they decide whether interest becomes a trip: the right travellers, in months with room and on product they can book.

**THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · OBJECTIVE 1**

#### Respond to growth segment traveller preferences

Four traveller segments, each concentrated in named home markets, give Wesgro a sharper target than country alone, and the province scores 3.7 to 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win them.

[172] Demand-Side Analysis, p13; MIDAS, "Seasonality"; Inclusion Plan, p34, p47; Stakeholder Insights, p42.
[173] Market Assessment, p41; the slide gives no year or source for the 1.4 million; Diagnostic, p30.
[174] Market Assessment, p19, p20, computed.

### The opportunity

Country is too blunt a target for a long-haul destination. Within one market, travellers differ in what they want from a trip, what they spend and where they book. Four values-based segments fit the Western Cape. Together they hold about 97 million addressable travellers, and each is concentrated in named home markets. Marketing to a segment inside a market puts each rand where the province is most likely to win.[175]

The prize to 2035 is value as much as volume. Curious Explorers and Creative Connectors together hold over 40% of global outbound leisure demand, while Discerning Connoisseurs deliver the highest economic impact per arrival. The segments also help with season and spread. Curious Explorers offer the strongest opportunity for dispersal beyond Cape Town, and Reflective Adventurers support seasonality mitigation through year-round outdoor and wellness travel.[176]

The measure holds the province back as much as the message. Performance is judged on arrivals. The Department of Economic Development says current growth framing gives too much weight to visitor volumes and that a value and spend lens may suit better.[177]

Recognition is the second gap. Cape Town ranks first in Africa and 60th in the world on Brand Finance's 2023 City Index, yet a city reputation is not provincial recognition. No comparable measure of awareness exists for the province and its regions in the priority markets (section 2.2). Segments expected to travel beyond Cape Town will do so only if they can place its regions.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.1.** Evidence for objective 1

**Four segments are sized, scored and tied to home markets, the highest-yield segment is the smallest and recognition beyond Cape Town is unmeasured.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Four segments are sized** | Curious Explorers about 30m, Creative Connectors about 25m, Discerning Connoisseurs about 19m and Reflective Adventurers about 23m addressable long-haul travellers across 34 markets | Skift, Executive Summary; MA p43 |
| **The province can win them** | Ability-to-win 4.6, 4.1, 4.0 and 3.7 out of 5.0, scored on product fit, brand fit, competition and ease of air access | Skift, Ability-to-Win Assessment |
| **Each segment has home markets** | Curious Explorers are 30% of UK and US travellers; Reflective Adventurers 33% of German; Creative Connectors 32% of Indian; Discerning Connoisseurs 40% of UAE | Skift, Segment Incidence by Market; MA p43 |
| **The smallest segment yields most** | Discerning Connoisseurs spend $8,500 to $14,000 a long-haul trip, three to four times the other segments | Skift, segment 03; MA p51 |
| **Each segment books differently** | Creative Connectors book 42% through OTAs; Discerning Connoisseurs 42% through luxury travel advisors and 6% through OTAs | Skift, Travel Behaviour and Spend; MA p49, p52 |
| **Conversion is the gap** | About 97 million addressable travellers across 34 markets; about 1.4 million convert into arrivals | MA p41 |
| **Flows concentrate on the Peninsula** | International flows are concentrated on the Cape Peninsula, with congestion at the Big Six attractions and regional destinations often left out of itineraries | DEDAT APP 2026/27 |
| **City reputation is not provincial recognition** | Cape Town ranks first in Africa and 60th in the world, from about 15,000 respondents in 20 countries; no current, comparable measure of awareness exists for the city, the province and its regions | Brand Finance, 2023 |

Source: Skift Segmentation Analysis, Mar 2026 (working analysis, cited by section); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA). Trip spend in the currency printed, which the documents do not name. The 1.4 million carries no year or source line.

[175] Market Assessment, p41 to p43.
[176] Segmentation, "Strategic Implications"; Market Assessment, p56.
[177] Stakeholder Insights, p24.

The four segments rest on a May 2025 survey of more than 25,000 outbound travellers in 34 markets, applied to 17 priority markets. Each segment has its own home markets, spend and booking channels, so one campaign cannot reach all four. China holds the largest pool, about 21.49 million, but air access and visas constrain its conversion.[178]

Yet two limits apply. The survey leaves out the domestic market and seven African markets, among them Nigeria, Kenya and Ghana. Its findings are directional rather than definitive, and no Western Cape validation exists yet. Stakeholders also name interests outside the four: medical tourism, township culture, eco-adventure and international MICE. These are product interests that cut across the segments, not a fifth segment.[179]

### The course of action

Wesgro should market by segment within market and judge results by value as well as volume. The UK and Germany anchor the near term with a combined pool of about 12.5 million, and the USA is the largest single pool outside China. The same research that tests the segments here should extend them to the domestic and African markets, which the survey leaves out. The City's framework for 2019 to 2024 set out four segments of its own: Indulgers, Explorers, Specialists and business-events delegates.[180]

The brand aim widens with it. Alongside conversion for the city, Wesgro should aim for recognition of the province's regions and for nights spent there. It should test brand presentations in market before fixing a hierarchy: Cape Town as gateway endorsement, a Western Cape umbrella and regional brands leading specialist campaigns. Campaign and airline agreements should specify regional product, inventory links and completed regional bookings, which the April 2026 Emirates memorandum does not yet do.

The order matters. Segment targets and validation come first, in 2027, with the brand tests and a baseline of aided and unaided awareness for the city, the province and its regions (I16). The findings are directional, and the budget should not move on them at scale until they hold for the Western Cape (section 4.3). Spend moves to each segment's own channels from 2028. Spend per visitor joins Wesgro's targets from 2029, once the data exists to track it.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Set segment targets inside each priority market: Curious Explorers in the UK and USA, Reflective Adventurers in Germany, Creative Connectors in India, Discerning Connoisseurs in the UAE | Destination Marketing; Research |
| Wesgro | Move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion through each segment's own channels, from luxury advisors to mobile-first OTAs | Destination Marketing; trade and OTA partners |
| Wesgro | Test three brand presentations in priority markets (Cape Town as gateway endorsement, a Western Cape umbrella and regional brands leading specialist campaigns), and write regional product, inventory links and completed regional bookings into campaign and airline agreements | Destination Marketing; Air Access; Cape Town Tourism; regional tourism bodies |
| Wesgro | Commission destination-specific research to validate the segments, extend it to the domestic and African markets, build the segments into brand tracking and measure aided and unaided awareness of the city, the province and its regions in the priority markets | Research |
| Partners | Develop segment-matched product: heritage and township experiences, creative districts, private-access wine and food and a certified network of wellness retreats and trails | Product owners; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs |
| Partners | Map the City's four segments onto the four used here, so Wesgro, the City and Cape Town Tourism sell to the same travellers | City of Cape Town; Cape Town Tourism |
| National | Agree one segment frame with SA Tourism for long-haul campaigns, so provincial and national spend target the same travellers | SA Tourism |

[178] Segmentation, "Research Methodology", "Comparative Market Potential Overview".
[179] Segmentation, "Research Methodology", "Disclaimer"; Stakeholder Insights, p34, p35, p42, p45.
[180] Segmentation, "Strategic Implications"; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5.

### Why it can work

Segment targeting works because it moves money to where incidence, fit and channel meet. Curious Explorers are 30% of UK and US travellers, and the province scores 4.6 out of 5 on its ability to win them. Discerning Connoisseurs book 42% of trips through luxury travel advisors and 6% through OTAs. Broad awareness misses them, while advisor partnerships reach them at the point of sale.[181]

New Zealand gives each priority market a role, with the USA as its high-yield growth engine. It judges performance on revenue per visitor and length of stay over arrivals. Valencia matches product to purpose in a similar way, with sector-led programmes from gastronomy to business events that attract purpose-driven, higher-value travellers. Its tourist spend rose 21% in 2024 and spending per trip 6.3%, though no source isolates the programmes' share of that rise. The transfer depends on two changes: yield metrics beside the arrivals count, and partnerships with specialist distribution networks.[182]

A gateway brand can carry regional nights. VisitBritain reports that 60% of the additional spend it attributes to its activity fell outside London (Appendix A3). That is a reported result, not a causal estimate, but it shows the test to set: regional spend from campaigns that name regional product.

### Link forward

**Initiative I1**, segment-led activation and yield in mature markets, carries this entry with objective 5 (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-01 international arrivals, T1-02 arrivals by market group and T1-03 direct foreign spend at impact level, with T2-01 segment home-market arrivals at outcome level. T3-38, regional test offers with completed regional bookings, measures the output (section 5.2). A regional stop on a city day tour does not count; a completed regional booking does. The awareness research runs through I16.

THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · OBJECTIVE 2

## Create green-season demand with MICE and events

The green season is a seat problem and an events problem at once. June holds 6.4% of the year's international seats, and business events are the lever best placed to fill the trough, though international meetings now peak from September to November.

### The challenge

The green season is a proven market with room to grow. Capacity sits underused in the green season and across the regions. Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023 and 45.1% in June 2025. Growth to 2035 depends on better conversion from April to September, not on pushing more demand into the busy peak months.[183]

Yet the trough is a seat problem as well as a demand problem. Airlines cut seats in the same months that visitors fall away, and connecting traffic is especially critical in the low season. Leisure marketing alone cannot fill a month that carriers have already thinned (section 2.3). The province needs reasons to travel that are fixed in the calendar, booked months ahead and sold with the seats.[184]

Business events are the best of those reasons. They can be scheduled more flexibly than leisure trips, so they can strengthen demand in shoulder and green-season periods. Two gaps remain: aim and measurement. International meetings cluster just after the trough, and only conferences are counted well (section 2.2).[185]

A bid won is not a winter night delivered. Wesgro secured 36 bids in 2024/25 with an estimated value of R745.1 million, and the CTICC's forward book lists congresses in May and June 2027 (section 2.2).

[181] Segmentation, "Segment Incidence by Market", "Ability-to-Win Assessment", "Travel Behaviour and Spend".
[182] Benchmarking, p53, p55, p48, p46, p56.
[183] Demand-Side Analysis, p53, p34; Market Assessment, p25.
[184] MIDAS, "Executive Summary".
[185] Demand-Side Analysis, p34.

Forecast value does not show which months the delegates fill. Public event money is also small and tied to other purposes: DEDAT's R7 million Tourism Growth Fund supports attraction and business development, not hosting.

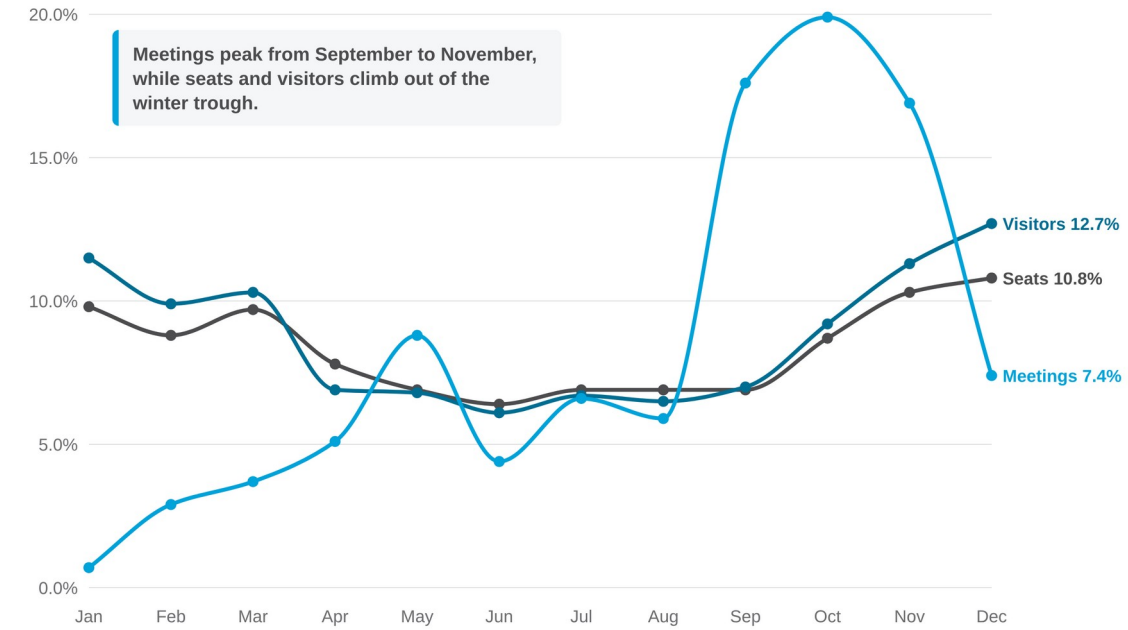
### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.2.** Evidence for objective 2

**Quieter-month traffic has doubled since 2015, yet seats and rooms still trough from May to September, while international meetings peak from September to November.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **June has the fewest seats** | June 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity at Cape Town International; May to September 6.4% to 6.9% a month; November 10.3% and December 10.8% | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **Visitors follow the seats** | About 62% of 2025 overseas visitor travel fell between October and March (normalised); the printed 2024 split is 61% to 39% | DSA p12; Diag p32 |
| **Meetings sit beside the trough** | 109 of 136 ICCA meetings in Cape Town from 2022 to 2024 fell between May and November; September to November alone held 74 | DSA p37 |
| **The meetings base is growing** | ICCA meetings 33 in 2022, 46 in 2023 and 58 in 2024 (41,571 participants); 37 UIA association meetings in 2025, 58% of South Africa's | DSA p37, p38 |
| **Business events lift yield** | International business-event delegates to South Africa spend R6,400 a day; Cape Town hotel occupancy was 53% in June 2023 | DSA p34 |
| **The venue confirms the gap** | June to August and December to January are structurally weak for MICE, and peak-date constraints lose events | SIR p45, p46 (CTICC) |
| **Public event money is small and tied** | DEDAT's R7 million Tourism Growth Fund supports attraction and business development, not event hosting; R4.2 million is earmarked for hallmark and incubator sport events; no South African Formula 1 race is on the 2027 calendar, and rights fees and guarantees were not verified | DEDAT APP 2026/27; Cultural Affairs and Sport, 2026/27; Formula 1, 2026 |
| **The forward book reaches winter** | The CTICC hosted 330 events in the year to June 2025, 63 of them international, and lists congresses for May and June 2027 | CTICC, 2025 |
| **Bids are not nights** | 36 bids secured in 2024/25 with an estimated value of R745.1 million; a forecast value, not delivered winter nights | Wesgro annual report, 2024/25 |
| **Quieter-month traffic has doubled** | April to September passenger movements rose from 662,771 in 2015 to 1,342,770 in 2025; their share of the year rose from 38.7% to 40.8%, after 41.6% in 2023 | ACSA, Sep 2026 (study team calculation) |
| **Rooms have not followed** | Cape Town sample occupancy averaged 51.8% from May to August 2025, against 50.5% in 2024, 58.1% in 2023 and 54.5% in 2019; June 2025 was 45.1% | Cape Town Tourism and Horwath HTL, 2024 and 2026 |
| **Regional winter demand has grown** | May to September room-night demand grew 22% in the Cape Winelands and 31% on the Garden Route from 2015 to 2025, against 17% for the year in each; an analyst estimate with no published panel | HVS, 2026 |

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (scheduled seats); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Wesgro Visitor Tracking Survey 2024); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The ICCA months are summed from the printed monthly counts. The 2025 ICCA row of 65 covers Stellenbosch and Cape Town and is not comparable. [Open item: Wesgro Convention Bureau to confirm the 2023 ICCA count (46 printed; Wesgro reported 42 in May 2025) and reconcile the yearly total of 137 with the 136 monthly records.]




Share of the year by month. Seats and visitors 2025; meetings 2022 to 2024. Printed visitor shares sum to 104.9%.

**Figure 3.1.** Meetings, seats and visitors by month

Seats and visitors both fall away from April to September. International meetings run thin from June to August and peak from September to November, at the edge of the trough rather than in it. Events therefore have one job: win new dates where seats and visitors are thinnest. May to August is the first portfolio, inside the April to September season.

The record makes further growth credible without sizing it. Quieter-month traffic doubled in a decade, so weather alone has not fixed the size of the green season. Yet winter rooms in Cape Town filled less in 2025 than in 2019 or 2023, so the task is recovery and conversion as much as promotion. No reading of the series credits a route, a campaign or an event for the gains.

Two limits qualify the numbers. The October to March share is about 62% for 2025, computed from a month-of-travel table whose shares sum to 104.9% and normalised. The only printed split is 61% to 39% for 2024, and this report carries both. And only conferences are measured: meetings are absent from provincial statistics, incentive volumes are unverified and exhibitions are unquantified.[186]

### The course of action

Wesgro should build an April to September events spine and sell it with the seats, with May to August as its first winter portfolio. Its plan sets 161 business event bids over FY26 to FY30, and the spine decides when they land. Sales are organised by buyer, because each buys differently: corporate midweek retreats, extensions to congresses already secured, new association bids, incentives with weather-resilient itineraries, exhibitions with non-local buyers and leisure events with non-local attendance. Dated green-season offers for named low-demand weeks are contracted with airline and trade partners, with rain alternatives and buyer commitments before any public support. Incentive packages test the cooler season with Indian and Gulf planners.[187]

The shared strategy and the count come first, in 2027. Wesgro agrees one event acquisition and calendar strategy with the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province. The calendar strategy builds on the year-round promotion and MICE marketing in the City's framework for 2019 to 2024. Wesgro also sets up a way to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions. It builds one monthly baseline of sold and available room nights, so that absolute winter nights and revenue are tracked beside the seasonal share. Without

[186] Demand-Side Analysis, p12, computed, p36; Diagnostic, p32.
[187] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; Diagnostic, p32; Demand-Side Analysis, p40.

that count, no one can tell whether the calendar fills the trough. It then publishes the calendar and aims bids at May to August first (section 4.3).[188]

Supported offers are judged against a comparison. Each season, Wesgro compares the supported dates and products with similar unsupported ones, or phases the offers in. It adjusts the comparison for fares, route changes, school holidays and weather. Offers that deliver additional nights at acceptable public cost are renewed. The longer congress pipeline is kept separate, because it runs on a different clock.

One appraisal applies to every publicly supported event. Before any commitment, each event is appraised on the same basis at its full public cost, a Formula 1 bid included. The appraisal counts non-local visitors, the months they come and the nights they add, so that forecast value is not mistaken for winter demand.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Publish a green-season events calendar and aim Convention Bureau bids at May to August first, within the April to September season, in the province's strongest sectors | Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing |
| Wesgro | Organise sales by buyer type: corporate midweek retreats, extensions to congresses already secured, new association bids, incentives, exhibitions with non-local buyers and leisure events with non-local attendance | Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing; CTICC |
| Wesgro | Contract dated green-season offers for named low-demand weeks with airlines and trade, with rain alternatives and buyer commitments before any public support, and test cooler-season incentive packages with Indian and Gulf planners | Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines |
| Wesgro | Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions, and build one monthly green-season baseline with accommodation partners: sold and available room nights by region and type, with the shoulder months split from May to August | Research; CTICC; Cape Town Tourism; LTOs |
| Partners | Programme lifestyle events in December and January and keep peak dates for international events; sell food and wine, whale and wildflower product on its own calendar, within conservation limits | CTICC; Overberg and West Coast LTOs |
| Partners | Agree one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province | City of Cape Town; DEDAT |
| Partners | Apply one common appraisal, at full public cost, to every publicly supported event before commitment, any Formula 1 bid included | DEDAT; City of Cape Town; Cultural Affairs and Sport; Provincial Treasury |
| National | Give regional African delegates, whose event demand the venue operator rates as visa-constrained, a delegate escalation channel for entry cases (objective 19) | Home Affairs; SA National Convention Bureau |

### Why it can work

Association conferences are won with long lead times, and they bring visitors who might not otherwise consider the province. A congress confirmed for July gives carriers a load to plan against, and that is the case Wesgro needs to hold winter seats (objective 7). Events used this way sustain year-round tourism demand and air connectivity. They also reach beyond the city. The main event can stay in Cape Town while delegates spend extra nights elsewhere, and Stellenbosch and George can host the next phase of regional conferences.[189]

Melbourne's monthly arrivals stay between 7% and 12% of the year, a balance that events and education travel help create. Yet summer still brings its largest international spike. Victoria builds the balance by curating a portfolio of global, cultural, regional and business events that generate repeat, predictable demand spikes across the year. The condition is the shared calendar and a proactive bidding pipeline

[188] City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5, p6.
[189] Demand-Side Analysis, p40, p41, p37.

behind it. Without them, the gap stays where it is: June to August remains structurally weak for business events.[190]

Two further cases test the approach (Appendix A3). Tasmania's Off Season recruits distinctive winter offers ahead of each season, and its government reported 339,800 May to August visitors in 2025, a result associated with the campaign and not isolated to it. Melbourne shows the fiscal side. Its 2024 Formula 1 race needed A$102.313 million of government investment after revenue, so a gross impact claim cannot stand in for an appraisal at full public cost.

### Link forward

**Initiative I2**, green-season events and business-events calendar (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-05 green-season nights and share at impact level, and T2-02 ICCA meetings and T2-03 April to September seat share at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 1.1 · TRAVELLER, BRAND AND PROPOSITION · OBJECTIVE 3

## Make the whole province findable and bookable

Regional rooms are listed on the booking platforms, but their prominence, inventory and sales are unmeasured and no profiled community rates Ready on bookability, so support follows an audit from discovery to sale.

### The challenge

Interest that cannot be booked is lost. Travellers discover and book on platforms, and each growth market uses its own (section 2.2). China books on Trip.com and Fliggy, India on MakeMyTrip and the Gulf on Almosafer. Product that is missing from those platforms does not exist for the traveller, however good it is. For the Western Cape the open question is how far regional product reaches those platforms, and how visibly.[191]

The gap decides how far growth to 2035 spreads. Cape Town is the gateway, and the case for growth beyond the Metro rests on visitors moving out and staying longer. The Overberg says it does not package its offer early enough to be front of mind when travellers book flights. Each room or tour outside the core that cannot be booked online depends on a traveller willing to pick up the phone.[192]

The barriers differ by product. A listed business may lack content, live inventory, workable distribution terms or demand. Community guides and some public attractions still lack a first online route. Rural broadband sits outside Wesgro's reach as a national programme.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.3.** Evidence for objective 3

**Route ratings and community profiles point to weaker bookability outside the core, while a desk test finds regional rooms listed; prominence and sales are unmeasured.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Three of six routes rate Ready** | Digital and bookability rated Ready on the Cape Peninsula, Garden Route and Cape Winelands routes; Developing on the Whale Coast; Gap on the West Coast and Route 62 | IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84 |
| **An unscoped estimate** | About 40% or more of smaller operators are said to lack online booking; the source gives no scope, and the audit tests it | IR p32 |

[190] Benchmarking, p17, p18, p20; Stakeholder Insights, p45.
[191] Demand-Side Analysis, p45, p47, p49.
[192] Stakeholder Insights, p26.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **No community is bookable** | None of 19 profiled communities rates Ready on digital and bookability; 8 rate Developing and 11 Gap | SCIP p20 to p26, p40 to p51 |
| **Community product sells by phone** | Four Zwelihle guides sell by phone with no shared booking channel; Visit Knysna lists nine township guides as phone contacts | SCIP p34, p47 |
| **Large attractions rely on phones** | CapeNature takes about 70% of its reservations through its call centre rather than its online platform | SIR p42 |
| **Regional rooms are listed** | 13 of 13 eligible accommodation cases outside the core and 8 of 8 core comparators had a property-specific platform listing; 11 of the 13 had a Booking.com trace and 11 an opened domestic listing | Study team desk test, 10 Nov 2026 |
| **Attractions sell differently** | 3 of 8 named attractions outside the core appeared on an experience marketplace, each as a tour stop; none showed a standalone online ticket; all 4 core comparators had an operator-directed online purchase route | Study team desk test, 10 Nov 2026 |
| **Presence is not prominence** | No ranking, travel-date, checkout or sales test has been run; the cases were chosen, not sampled, and exclude informal and community supply | Study team desk test, 10 Nov 2026 |
| **Ranking has a price** | Commission and programme participation can influence ranking on a major platform; sponsored ranking was examined in a 2023 inquiry | Booking.com, 2025; Competition Commission, 2023 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; the ~40% has no printed scope or source); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP; ratings compiled from the community profiles, LTO confirmation outstanding); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The 70% is CapeNature's own reservation mix, not a provincial share.

The evidence separates three kinds of product. Regional rooms are listed: every eligible case in the desk test had a platform listing, inside the core and outside it. Named attractions outside the core reach the marketplace as stops on Cape Town day tours, and none showed a standalone online ticket. Community product still sells by phone or through city operators (section 2.4). Elsewhere the product itself is missing: the Overberg and West Coast marine and wildflower assets have no guided tours and no bookable product. What no source measures is the step after listing: whether the product is found, has inventory on the dates travellers want and converts into a sale. The I3 audit measures each step by district, for accommodation and for experiences separately, and sets the baseline for T2-04 [eligible supply, platform presence, exposure and usable booking routes by district: Wesgro Research to build through the I3 audit; see section 5.4].[193]

Listing and recognition work as a pair. A March 2026 platform snapshot shows that short-term rental listings already exist in four regional municipalities (section 2.3), so the audit starts from some stock. A traveller who cannot place the Overberg or the Karoo is less likely to search for either (section 2.2). Yet awareness alone cannot land a regional night where rooms, transport or bookable product are missing. A named stop on a day tour is exposure, not a regional night, so the measure that counts is a completed regional booking. Objective 1 builds the recognition, and this objective builds the place for it to land.

### The course of action

Wesgro should measure the path from discovery to sale before it funds a fix, and then support the failure the audit finds. The audit runs in five steps: eligible supply, platform presence, unprompted discovery, a usable booking route and the commercial outcome. A failure at one step does not explain another, so each is reported separately. Each pilot community's first deliverable is one live booking route, published operating dates, a named customer contact and a simple record of bookings and local revenue.[194]

The audit comes first, in 2027. Research builds the inventory with the LTOs, field checks included for informal and community product, and publishes the first presence and exposure baseline for T2-04. A bounded support trial follows in 2028, with a comparison group where feasible. It tracks fulfilled regional

[193] Infrastructure Report, p93, p32; both pages describe the gap without counting it.
[194] Inclusion Plan, p33.

nights, paid visits and operators' net receipts after commission. Support scales from 2029 only where the trial paid, and packaged itineraries go onto the chosen platforms in the same period (section 4.3). No provincial marketplace or platform is built before the audit reports. Regional products with confirmed terms keep selling throughout.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Run a discovery-to-sale audit by district, for accommodation and for experiences separately: a verified inventory of eligible supply, a stratified sample of platform presence, repeatable discovery searches, booking-route checks on common dates and consented sales returns | Research; LTOs |
| Wesgro | Run a bounded support trial where the audit verifies a failure: a first booking route for unlisted product, and content, inventory, distribution terms or packaging for listed product, with a comparison group | Tourism; Research; district municipalities; LTOs |
| Wesgro | Choose platform and trade partners from priority-market journey evidence, starting with the audit's findings on Trip.com, Almosafer and Booking.com, and list packaged regional itineraries on them | Destination Marketing; OTAs |
| Partners | Give each pilot community one live booking route before any promotion (objective 13) | LTOs; community sellers |
| Partners | Move CapeNature reservations online and complete cashless payments at reserve level | CapeNature |
| National | Extend rural broadband under SA Connect, so operators outside the core can take online bookings and card payments | National government |

**Why it can work**

Bookability turns interest the province has already earned into payment. It does not replace awareness: the Overberg says potential visitors do not grasp how close the district is to Cape Town. Listing and packaging therefore go together. A listing puts outer-district product on the platform where a traveller already plans, but only a visible listing reaches that traveller at the moment of decision. The audit then shows, district by district, which step fails and whether support moved it.[195]

New Zealand packages regional clusters into bookable long-haul itineraries and pairs regional operators with specialist global travel designers. Its regions gain higher revenue per visitor and better seasonal resilience. The lesson is to use Cape Town as a gateway that spreads value across the province through bookable regional experiences. In communities, a booking route also needs a seller behind it. In Santa Marta in Rio de Janeiro, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and kept selling after the launch programme ended. The condition is connectivity, payment and a seller with a stake.[196]

**Link forward**

**Initiative I3**, bookable province programme (section 4.3); the community booking routes run through **I12** (objective 13). **Indicators** T2-04 regional product with a verified listing and a usable booking route and T2-05 CapeNature online booking share (section 5.2).

### 3.1.2 Source market growth and diversification

The second theme is about which markets grow the base. It holds three objectives: India and China, the fastest-growing markets, which reach the province through hubs; the mature long-haul markets; and regional Africa. Volume and value come from different groups, so each needs its own lever (section 2.2).

[195] Stakeholder Insights, p26.
[196] Benchmarking, p55, p51; Inclusion Plan, p7, p30.

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · OBJECTIVE 4

## Convert India and China hub traffic

About 101,000 air journeys a year from India and China already reach Cape Town, mainly through Gulf and African hubs. No direct Indian route is likely before 2030 and national arrivals from both markets fell in 2026, so converting that flow is the lever available now, once its brakes are diagnosed.

### The opportunity

India and China grow fastest in the base case, at 8% a year to 2035, against 5% for the Middle East and Brazil in their acceleration group. India and China start from a low base, at about 2.6% and 1.4% of South Africa's overseas tourists in September 2025. The upside is large, and much of it is already in the air.[197]

Yet both markets fell in 2026. Stats SA counted 37,875 tourists from India and 22,848 from China to South Africa from January to September, down 30.0% and 23.7%, after 69,680 and 37,902 in 2025 (section 2.2). Industry views attribute the fall to air access, price and trade confidence as well as entry rules. Both markets had pilot access to the ETA before its August 2026 launch, so easier entry alone has not turned the trend.

About 71,000 travellers from India and about 30,000 from China reach Cape Town each year through Gulf and African hubs. They fly with carriers whose Cape Town business is built on onward traffic. Nine in ten of Qatar Airways' Cape Town passengers connect through its hub, as do more than 80% of Emirates'. Hub routes through Dubai, Addis Ababa and Doha run at 65.2% to 72.3% load, so they have room for more.[198]

The province is absent where these travellers decide. Both markets plan and book on their own platforms, where Western Cape product is hard to find (section 2.2). Access and product add friction. Cape Town has no direct flight to Mumbai or Delhi and thin Indian-friendly adaptation, while Chinese travellers face complex visas and few Mandarin-language services.[199]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.4.** Evidence for objective 4

**India and China reach Cape Town only through hubs, the direct route that would change that is at least five years away and national arrivals from both fell in 2026.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **India flies in through hubs** | About 71,000 Indian travellers a year reach Cape Town via hubs; Addis Ababa and Dubai carry more than 80% of them | DSA p48; MIDAS, Indian Market |
| **China flies in through hubs** | About 30,000 Chinese travellers a year via Dubai, Addis Ababa, Doha and Singapore (MIDAS: 29,600 in 2025) | DSA p46; MIDAS, Chinese Market |
| **No Indian route before 2030** | Air India and IndiGo have no aircraft to spare before the end of the decade, and no South African airline can fly the sector | MIDAS, Indian Market; DSA p48 |
| **A Chinese route is a state decision** | Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements; Guangzhou is the likely start, with China Southern or China Eastern | MIDAS, Chinese Market |
| **Hub routes have room** | Load factor Dubai 72.3%, Addis Ababa 71.9% and Doha 65.2%, year to November 2025 | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **Growth is fast from a low base** | India 76,547 to 165,260 (88,713 more) and China with Hong Kong 43,412 to 92,598 (49,186 more), base case, 2025 to 2035 | MA p22; DSA p23 |

[197] Market Assessment, p22; Diagnostic, p30.
[198] Demand-Side Analysis, p46, p48; MIDAS, "Seasonality".
[199] Demand-Side Analysis, p51.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Both markets fell in 2026** | India 37,875 (down 30.0%) and China 22,848 (down 23.7%) from January to September 2026, after 69,680 and 37,902 in 2025; national tourist arrivals by residence | Stats SA, 2026 |
| **Entry has moved to the ETA** | Both markets had pilot access before the ETA launched on 12 August 2026; a R500 electronic processing fee has applied since 17 August 2026 | Presidency, Aug 2026; Government Gazette 55209, Aug 2026 |

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (weighted GDS bookings, twelve months to November 2025); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA, 2025 base). The 101,000 is the sum of the two printed estimates; the hub tables beneath them sum to 97,579 and carry no year.

The upside comes in two parts. The hub flow is available now, on routes with spare seats and carriers that gain from every connecting passenger. The direct route is not: the accelerated case depends on confirmed direct routes, and without them volume reverts to base. This objective therefore works the hub flow now and builds the route case for later.[200]

A further pool is already in the country. Most of South Africa's visitors from India and from China with Hong Kong never reach the province, though they hold a visa and a seat (section 2.2). Itineraries sold through Johannesburg, with a flight to Cape Town on the same ticket, can reach them.[201]

### The course of action

Wesgro should run India and China as conversion markets through the hubs and as relationship markets for the direct route. The money shifts toward trade-led conversion rather than broad awareness. India needs early relationships with its carriers and authorities. China is a long-term investment in which awareness and indirect volume come before any non-stop service. By November 2025 Cape Town Air Access had held talks with Cathay Pacific, China Southern, Air India and IndiGo.[202]

The 2026 decline changes the first step. Before activation spend rises, Wesgro and Cape Town Air Access run one diagnosis of both markets that sets routes, fares, entry and product side by side, with the hub carriers and the trade. It shows which brake binds in each market. Direct services are then tested commercially with carriers before any route case enters Phase 2, because stated interest is not a commitment.

The hub work comes first because it needs no new seats, and the diagnosis runs beside it in 2027. Wesgro agrees joint market support with the three hub carriers in 2027, and activation on the Chinese and Indian platforms runs in market from 2028 (section 4.3). The direct route cases wait for runway capacity and go to carriers from 2032. Wesgro's plan targets three international tourism marketing campaigns over FY26 to FY30. Any that run in India or China should convert inside the platforms and with the hub carriers.[203]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Secure added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with joint market support tied to Indian and Chinese sales | Air Access; hub carriers |
| Wesgro | Run a joint route, fare, visa and product diagnosis of the India and China markets with the hub carriers and the trade, and test direct services commercially before any route case goes forward | Air Access; Research; hub carriers; trade |
| Wesgro | Activate inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip with market-specific itineraries and Trip.com packages | Destination Marketing; OTAs; trade |
| Wesgro | Build long-term route cases for the India and China corridors and keep a standing relationship with Indian carriers, Cathay Pacific, China Southern and China Eastern | Air Access |

[200] Demand-Side Analysis, p20.
[201] Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p3, p4, computed.
[202] Demand-Side Analysis, p55; MIDAS, "The Indian Market Opportunity", "The Chinese Market Opportunity"; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 13.
[203] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Sell Johannesburg-gateway itineraries, with a flight to Cape Town added to the ticket, to Indian and Chinese visitors already bound for South Africa | Destination Marketing; inbound operators; airlines |
| Partners | Ready the product for both markets: Mandarin and Indian-language guiding, Alipay and WeChat Pay, visible vegetarian options | Product owners; attractions; hospitality bodies |
| National | Escalate ETA performance for China and India, and the route designation for China that is decided government to government | Home Affairs; Department of Transport |

### Why it can work

Conversion works here because the travellers are already moving. Each Indian or Chinese visitor routed to Cape Town fills a seat the hub carrier already flies. The carrier gains from joint marketing without adding capacity. Activation inside the platforms where these travellers plan and pay reaches them at the point of decision, which broad awareness does not.

Singapore converts transit into visits through its Stopover Programme and Free Singapore Tour, run by the tourism board, Changi Airport Group and Singapore Airlines under one strategy. It received 16.5 million international visitors in 2024 and record receipts of about S$29 billion, though no source isolates the programme's share. The condition is entry and the hubs themselves. The Gulf hubs were disrupted in 2026 and hubs in one region share risk, so the work spreads beyond Dubai and Doha to Addis Ababa, Istanbul and the growing European capacity (section 4.8).[204]

### Link forward

**Initiative I4**, India and China hub conversion (section 4.3), with the direct-route cases run under **I6** (objective 7). **Indicators** T1-02 arrivals by market group at impact level and T2-06 India and China hub arrivals at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · OBJECTIVE 5

## Increase yield in mature markets

The mature markets already pay the most and fill the fullest routes, so growth there comes from more value per visitor and more seats on existing routes, not from broad awareness campaigns.

### The opportunity

The mature markets are where the province earns its premium. High-spend visitors come from Europe and North America, which ties future value growth to slower-growing source markets. The mature group grows steadily to 2035, but more slowly than the hub and acceleration markets (section 2.2). Growth here comes from value per visitor more than from volume.[205]

Value matters to the growth case because seats are scarce. Five mature long-haul routes already run above 80% load: Newark, Atlanta, Frankfurt, Heathrow and Washington. The runway binds at the peak until relief arrives in about 2033 (section 2.3). Each extra rand per visitor on a full route is growth that needs no extra seat. Longer stays and travel beyond the Metro add value in the same way.[206]

Two things stand in the way: carrier pricing and the province's own measures. On full routes, carriers are expected to raise fares rather than add new services, which frustrates the wish for more visitors. The

[204] Benchmarking, p40; Singapore Tourism Board, Feb 2025.
[205] Demand-Side Analysis, p14.
[206] MIDAS, "Seasonality".

province must therefore earn more per visitor without losing share. Yet its targets count arrivals, and spend per visitor by market is printed for a single year.[207]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.5.** Evidence for objective 5

**The highest-spending visitors come from the slowest-growing markets on the fullest routes.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Five mature routes are full** | Load factor Newark 88.6%, Atlanta 84.3%, Frankfurt 83.0%, Heathrow 83.0% and Washington 80.2%; eleven of the 27 tabled routes run above 80% | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **Carriers are expected to price first** | Carriers on full routes are expected to seek higher fares rather than add services | MIDAS, In Conclusion |
| **Mature visitors spend most** | Average spend in the province USA R32,900, UK R26,500 and Germany R25,600, against Zimbabwe R8,500 (2024) | DSA p14 |
| **The province earns a premium** | 13% to 16% of national arrivals by quarter in 2025, but 20% to 27% of national foreign direct spend | DSA p11 |
| **Five markets dominate** | The top five supplied 63% of overseas arrivals in 2025, and the UK, Germany and USA 52% | DSA p13 |
| **Growth is steady** | Mature group 587,287 to 766,067 arrivals in the base case, 2025 to 2035 | MA p21; DSA p22 |

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (year to November 2025); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA, 2025 base). No deliverable carries fare, revenue-per-seat or yield data.

The constraint is well documented; the lever is not. The five routes are full and their visitors pay most. Yet none of the work behind this report holds fare, revenue-per-seat or yield data. None models a yield uplift either. The yield lever rests on how carriers are expected to behave on full routes. This objective therefore sets yield as an indicator to establish, not a target to hit, until spend per visitor by market is tracked every year [yield baseline: SAT spend per visitor by market as an annual series; only 2024 is printed].

Market share can be measured now. Over 2022 to 2024 the province took under 0.3% of air outbound trips from each of the UK, the USA, Germany and France (section 2.2). Of the three largest markets, only the USA gained share of Cape Town arrivals from 2019 to 2024, rising 3.8 points to 15.0%.[208]

### The course of action

Wesgro should protect share and raise value per visitor in the mature markets, and work the full routes for frequency and gauge before it chases new ones. Drawing these visitors beyond the Metro serves the same end while the growth markets develop. There is tactical room for added frequency on some routes and larger aircraft from some airlines.[209]

The full routes come first. From 2027 Wesgro makes the frequency and gauge case to their carriers, because seats held now protect share until the runway relief arrives (section 4.3). Luxury-advisor distribution follows in 2028. Spend per visitor and length of stay join Wesgro's own targets from 2029, once the data-sharing protocol supplies them (objective 18).

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Make the case to carriers on the five full routes for added frequency or larger aircraft, backed by green-season marketing | Air Access; airlines |
| Wesgro | Sell Discerning Connoisseur product through luxury advisors and high-end operators in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland | Destination Marketing; trade |

[207] MIDAS, "In Conclusion"; a judgement of airline behaviour, not backed by fare data.
[208] Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p4; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68, p69.
[209] Demand-Side Analysis, p17; MIDAS, "In Conclusion".

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Add two measures beside arrivals in Wesgro's own targets: spend per visitor by market with length of stay, and each market's share of air outbound trips | Research |
| Partners | Invest in premium product outside the Metro and in the mid-market accommodation each place is shown to lack (objectives 11 and 15) | Accommodation investors; hospitality bodies |
| National | Escalate the cap on US carriers, the absence of an Open Skies agreement and the bilateral agreements that limit airlift | Department of Transport |

### Why it can work

Yield work suits full routes. When seats are scarce, a visitor who stays longer, travels further and spends more adds value without adding a seat. Selling to the highest-spending segment through luxury advisors lifts the average spend of the travellers the seats already carry. Full routes also give Wesgro a frequency case to put, though not a promise of seats, because carriers are expected to raise fares first.[210]

Kenya shows that value per visitor can outrun volume. With about 2.4 million arrivals in 2024, against Morocco's 17.4 million, Kenya earned about US$1,460 per international arrival. Morocco earned about US$630 and the Western Cape about US$890. The condition is a measure. Without spend per visitor by market as an annual series, yield can be neither managed nor judged, so the data-sharing protocol comes first (objective 18).[211]

### Link forward

**Initiative I1**, segment-led activation and yield in mature markets (section 4.3), with the frequency case run under **I6** (objective 7). **Indicators** T1-03 direct foreign spend at impact level and T2-07 mature-market spend per visitor at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 1.2 · SOURCE MARKET GROWTH AND DIVERSIFICATION · OBJECTIVE 6

## Build a regional foundation (Africa)

Regional Africa is the province's steadiest volume and its least developed premium market: Zimbabwe and Namibia supply 62% of African arrivals, while West African visitors spend the most per visit.

### The opportunity

Africa is the province's nearest market and its steadiest. Namibia and Zimbabwe add stability, repeat demand and counter-seasonal volume. Regional trips are shorter in lead time and easier to convert, which helps the green season. Africa is therefore both a base to keep and a market to grow (section 2.2).[212]

The opportunity to 2035 is premium growth on top of that base. Nigerian and Ghanaian visitors spend as much per visit as visitors from the mature markets, from a far smaller base (section 2.2). Kenya's case rests on scale rather than spend. Its visitors spend R16,900 a visit, but its pool of 240,000 to 400,000 trips a year is second only to Nigeria's outside South Africa. The growth model also gives it the strongest regional upside. Cape Town is not a cold start in Nigeria or Kenya, where awareness of South Africa exists and needs converting rather than building from scratch.[213]

Access is the constraint. Routes to Luanda, Maputo, Gaborone, Harare and Mauritius run above 80% load, so added demand there meets full aircraft. Visas add friction. South Africa ranked 33rd of 54 African

[210] MIDAS, "In Conclusion".
[211] Demand-Side Analysis, p15.
[212] Demand-Side Analysis, p14; Diagnostic, p31.
[213] Demand-Side Analysis, p29, p30; African Markets, s3; Market Assessment, p23; African Markets, s4.2, s5.

countries on the Africa Visa Openness Index, as BDO reported in 2024. The CTICC also reports that regional African event demand is constrained by visa requirements.[214]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.6.** Evidence for objective 6

**African demand is a Southern African volume base with two high-spending West African markets and regional routes above 80% load.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **A Southern African base** | 323,971 African arrivals across 16 markets in 2024; Zimbabwe and Namibia supplied 62% | DSA p27 |
| **Two high-spend markets** | Spend per visitor Nigeria R31,000, Ghana R27,700 and Kenya R16,900 (printed averages; they do not reconcile with the printed totals); African visitors spent R4.2bn in 2025 | DSA p29, p30 |
| **Regional routes are full** | Luanda 86.2% and 83.4%, Maputo 83.3%, Gaborone 82.3%, Mauritius 81.8% and Harare 81.3%; MIDAS names all five markets for added capacity | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **The pool is large** | Nigeria 310,000 to 510,000 and Kenya 240,000 to 400,000 addressable adult trips a year; Ghana 55,000 to 100,000 | Skift African, s3 |
| **South Africa is considered** | 10.9% consideration share among Nigerian and 13.4% among Kenyan outbound travellers, second only to Dubai in Kenya | Skift African, s4.2, s4.3 |
| **Regional growth is steady** | Regional group 292,514 to 402,812 arrivals in the base case, 2025 to 2035, with Kenya the strongest upside (nine modelled markets; the 16-market figure above is a survey total) | MA p20, p23; DSA p24 |

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA; SA Tourism 2024 Departure Survey and 2025 performance report); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (year to November 2025); Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026 (working analysis, by section); Market Assessment Report, May 2026 (MA). The printed spend averages do not reproduce from the totals and visitor counts on the same slide; the report quotes the printed averages.

Africa holds two different markets. A Southern African base delivers volume, while Nigeria and Kenya offer premium demand from a large addressable pool. Three cautions apply. Nigeria and Ghana have no row in the growth model, so no 2035 arrivals figure exists for the two highest-spending African markets [Nigeria and Ghana arrivals targets: not modelled; Wesgro Research to add both]. Ghana sits in the watch tier for brand seeding rather than conversion. And regional travellers tend to stop in Johannesburg rather than continue to Cape Town.[215]

### The course of action

Wesgro should run Africa as two markets: a regional volume base held through capacity and value, and a premium growth market in Nigeria and Kenya won through conversion. Nigeria is the priority for luxury, status-driven and conference travel. Kenya is the priority for business mobility and premium urban breaks, and both are reached through premium activation and the trade.[216]

The groundwork comes first. In 2027 Nigeria and Ghana enter the growth model, because the two highest-spending African markets have no targets yet (section 4.3). Premium activation in Nigeria and Kenya starts in 2028. The capacity case on the five full regional routes follows from 2029, made by Air Access once the route fund is running (objective 7).

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Make the capacity case on the five full regional routes with Airlink, Ethiopian Airlines, Kenya Airways and the other regional carriers | Air Access (objective 7); airlines |

[214] MIDAS, "Seasonality"; BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p5; Stakeholder Insights, p45.
[215] African Markets, s5; Stakeholder Insights, p35.
[216] African Markets, s5.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Run premium, trade-led activation in Nigeria and Kenya for leisure, weddings and conferences with leisure extensions | Destination Marketing; Convention Bureau; trade |
| Wesgro | Add Nigeria and Ghana to the growth model and commission consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda | Research |
| Partners | Convert rest-of-Africa travellers who stop in Johannesburg with onward packages, and give regional delegates leisure extensions | Cape Town Tourism; CTICC; tour operators; Cross-Border Road Transport Agency |
| National | Escalate visas for African markets, building on the Ghana visa waiver of November 2023, and liberalisation of regional air routes | Home Affairs; Department of Transport |

### Why it can work

The two-market approach matches the lever to the demand. On the five full regional routes, volume is capped by seats, so the capacity case is where it grows. Premium demand in Nigeria and Kenya already knows South Africa, which ranks second only to Dubai in Kenyan outbound consideration. Activation converts that awareness rather than having to create it. Conferences with leisure extensions serve both, because business travel can help smooth demand across the calendar and event attendance can become longer stays.[217]

Kenya splits its demand in a similar way. Regional African markets drive its volume and business travel, while long-haul markets bring leisure demand and higher spend per visitor. It draws 41% of its arrivals from Africa, mainly from Uganda and Tanzania. Nairobi serves as East Africa's aviation, diplomatic and business hub through Kenya Airways' regional network. Its arrivals grew 14.6% in 2024 to about 2.4 million, against world growth of 11%. The transferable changes are to treat MICE as a system lever and to align city, provincial and national actors around one gateway strategy. The condition is seats and visas. Activation in Nigeria and Kenya converts only travellers who can get a visa and a seat.[218]

### Link forward

**Initiative I5**, regional Africa programme (section 4.3), with the regional capacity case run under **I6** (objective 7). **Indicators** T1-02 arrivals by market group at impact level and T2-08 African arrivals and spend at outcome level (section 5.2).

[217] African Markets, s4.3; Demand-Side Analysis, p17, p41.
[218] Benchmarking, p32, p34, p35; World Tourism Barometer, Jan 2025.

## 3.2 Goal 2: Transform supply

Supply sets the ceiling on the growth case. The airport caps arrivals before its relief arrives, and outside the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

Goal 2 removes the mobility, infrastructure and product constraints that limit how many visitors the province can carry and where they can go. Demand work in Goal 1 fills seats only if the seats exist. It pays outside the Metro only if visitors can reach, book and stay in the product there (section 2.3).

The first constraint is the gateway. The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point. The runway binds at peak hours before that. The international terminal upgrade at Cape Town International is due about 2032 and the relocated runway about 2033.[219]

Transport is a connectivity and dispersal challenge, not a province-wide capacity crisis. Cape Town International is the key gateway risk. Beyond the gateway, the constraint is reach and readiness. Accessibility to attractions and services falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo. Only one touring route of six is rated Ready.[220]

The goal holds two themes. The first is how visitors reach the province and move through it (objectives 7 to 9). The second is what they find on arrival (objectives 10 to 12).

Only the air entry needs more transport capacity. Cruise has room at the berth: it can take 150 or more calls a season, and the province received 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26. The flagship nature sites face a limit of a different kind, which calls for managing flows rather than adding volume (objective 12). The other three entries concern reach, product and experience. The entries also have an order. Seats into the gateway come first; corridors, beds and booking then decide where growth lands (section 2.3). Visas, air service agreements and the runway are national levers, which the province leads by escalation in Goal 3 (section 3.3.2).[221]

By 2035 the goal must do two things. It must hold and add seats on the full routes until runway relief arrives. It must also lift the share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro, by giving visitors product they can reach, book and stay in. Initiatives I6 to I11 deliver the six entries (section 4.3).

### 3.2.1 Accessibility, connectivity and infrastructure

The first supply theme covers how visitors reach the province and move through it. Air access and cruise bring visitors in, and internal mobility carries them beyond Cape Town.

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · OBJECTIVE 7

#### Win direct routes and add seats on full routes

Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load and carriers are expected to price before adding seats, so the province must win frequency and larger aircraft before runway relief in about 2033.

**The challenge**

Cape Town International is the province's only international airport, so the growth case runs through one gateway. On the growth model, seats run out before demand does, at the 2030 year point. Growth to 2035 is therefore a supply programme before it is a marketing one (section 2.3).[222]

[219] Demand-Side Analysis, p21; Infrastructure Report, p101, p102, p103.
[220] Infrastructure Report, p114, p88 to p90, p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84.
[221] Infrastructure Report, p110; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[222] Infrastructure Report, p90; Demand-Side Analysis, p21.

Two limits bind before that line. The first is commercial. Cape Town's best routes already run full, and on the mature long-haul routes carriers are expected to raise fares rather than add services. The second is physical. A single main runway caps movements at about 30 an hour, and the relocated runway that lifts the cap is due about 2033. ACSA's latest schedule is earlier, with the runway finished by December 2029, subject to contract award. The phasing in Chapter 4 assumes about 2033 and treats the earlier date as upside.[223]

A third limit showed itself in 2026: reliance on hubs in one region. Emirates had 91% of its previous network operating at 30 September and carried 22% fewer passengers from April to September, and ACSA's warning of 1 March included Cape Town (section 2.3). Alternatives are growing. The IAG winter schedule raises Heathrow to Cape Town from seven to 19 weekly flights.

Yet the province starts from strength. It added 17 mainline international routes between 2015 and 2025, more than any of eight peer airports. The task is to hold and enlarge those routes until the runway arrives, and to have the next ones ready when it does.[224]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.7.** Evidence for objective 7

**The best routes and the peak runway are full, planned relief lands after the base case crosses the model's seat line and hubs in one region share risk.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Routes are full** | 11 of 27 tabled routes above 80% load and 16 at 75% or more; network load 76.0% | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **Fares expected before seats** | Carriers on full routes will seek higher fares rather than add services, though there is tactical room for added frequency and larger aircraft | MIDAS, In Conclusion |
| **A record to build on** | 17 mainline international routes added from 2015 to 2025, ahead of Santiago (14), Valencia (12) and Calgary (8) | MIDAS, International Comparisons |
| **A seat line in 2030** | The model draws current air access at 1.8 million inbound seats; the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point (1,802,929) | DSA p21 |
| **Relief lands late** | The single main runway caps movements at about 30 an hour; ACSA's ~R11.3bn programme brings the international terminal about 2032 and the runway about 2033; ACSA's latest schedule shows the runway by December 2029 | IR p101 to p103; ACSA, Aug 2026 |
| **Second gateways** | George doubles by 2028 or 2029 (R310m, to about 2m passengers); Cape Winelands is a scenario: environmental appeals were dismissed in May 2026, but finance, licensing and carriers are not evidenced | IR p104 to p109 |
| **Hubs in one region share risk** | About one third of passengers to or from Asia-Pacific used Middle East hubs in 2025; Emirates had 91% of its network operating at 30 September 2026 and its April to September passengers fell 22% | IATA, 2026; Emirates, 2026 |
| **Alternatives are growing** | British Airways added Cape Town capacity in March 2026; the IAG winter schedule raises Heathrow to Cape Town from seven to 19 weekly flights; Emirates launched a third daily service on 1 July 2026 | IAG, 2026; Emirates, 2026 |
| **The programme is priced, not timetabled** | Realigned runway about R6.39bn, with contractor appointment planned for December 2026; domestic arrivals R2.39bn; domestic departures R500m from April 2027; international terminal R863m | ACSA, Feb 2026 |
| **Route support has a record** | In 2024/25 Wesgro recorded one additional airline, four international routes and ten expansions | Wesgro annual report, 2024/25 |

[223] MIDAS, "In Conclusion"; Infrastructure Report, p101 to p103; ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, Aug 2026.
[224] MIDAS, "International Comparisons".

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (twelve months to November 2025; 76.0% is the printed network total and the 27 rows sum to 75.0%); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

The evidence describes a timing problem more than a demand problem. The fares forecast covers the mature long-haul routes only, and no fare data yet tests it. The five regional markets that also run above 80% are named for more capacity. The hub routes still have room, with Dubai at 72.3%, Addis Ababa at 71.9% and Doha at 65.2%. On those routes marketing can still fill seats.[225]

Relief also comes in the wrong order: the certain fix comes last, and the earliest large option is the least certain. George doubles its capacity but flies domestic routes only, and Cape Winelands stays a scenario until finance, licensing and carriers are shown. The province's aviation strategy identifies a possible upgrade that would let George handle international traffic. No airline is among the 16 organisations whose views this report draws on, so carriers' views on frequency and gauge are untested.[226]

**The course of action**

The approach splits the air agenda by horizon. Until runway relief arrives in about 2033, the first job is to fill and enlarge what already flies. The near-term moves are added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with airline incentives coordinated through Cape Town Air Access. Route cases for India and China are the long-term move. Wesgro also presses for more seats to Luanda, Maputo, Gaborone, Harare and Mauritius, the five regional markets above 80%.[227]

Wesgro's plan also expects 10 new routes, first-time scheduled international services, by FY30. That is two a year. Cape Town Air Access counts 33 route launches since 2015, about three a year; the 17 mainline routes added over the same decade make about 1.7 a year. On the plan's own definition the target sits below the partnership's recent pace. Filling existing seats first still leaves room for them, because the runway binds at peak hours and new routes can land outside them. As reported in November 2025, Cape Town Air Access's short to medium term targets spanned Africa, Saudi Arabia, China, Hong Kong, India and Australia. The African and Saudi links fit before runway relief.[228]

Resilience joins capacity as a test. In 2027 Cape Town Air Access models correlated hub-closure scenarios, using flown-seat and itinerary data by hub. The plan then knows what a second disruption would cost and which routings would carry the load. The air access fund carries conditions that protect public money: tapering support, matched airline marketing, minimum flown capacity, clawbacks, a documented funding gap and grants set after bids. Cape Winelands Airport is treated as a scenario until finance, licensing and carriers are shown.

Cape Town Air Access's route fund becomes a ring-fenced public-private fund, designed in 2027 and 2028. It is then running when the regional frequency cases are made from 2029. The India and China cases go to carriers from 2032, as runway capacity arrives (section 4.3). ACSA delivers the runway and terminals, and Wesgro tracks them quarterly as the first risk. Air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing sit with national government, so the province escalates them (section 3.3.2).

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Run a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes, with joint marketing tied to route performance | Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines |
| Wesgro | Win Wesgro's 10 new routes by FY30 outside the peak hours, starting with regional and hub links; put belly cargo into each route case | Air Access; airlines; ACSA; exporters |

[225] MIDAS, "In Conclusion", "Seasonality".
[226] Infrastructure Report, p109, p104 to p107; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch13; Stakeholder Insights, p16.
[227] Demand-Side Analysis, p54.
[228] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20, p59; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 5; MIDAS, "International Comparisons"; Infrastructure Report, p101, p102; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 12.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Scale and ring-fence Cape Town Air Access's route fund as a public-private fund for route support, with a set size, governance and resilience conditions: tapering support, matched airline marketing, minimum flown capacity, clawbacks, a documented funding gap and grants set after bids | Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; SA Tourism; private sector |
| Wesgro | Treat runway delivery as the first risk: track approvals and milestones quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035 | Air Access; Research |
| Wesgro | Model correlated hub-closure scenarios with flown-seat and itinerary data by hub, and weight route work toward routings outside any one region | Air Access; Research; airlines; ACSA |
| Partners | Deliver the runway, terminals and George upgrade on the published dates; show financial close, aviation licensing and airline commitments at Cape Winelands before it enters the capacity plan | ACSA; Cape Winelands Airport |
| National | Escalate bilateral air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing at Cape Town International | Department of Transport; Home Affairs |

### Why it can work

The programme works on the airline's decision, not the visitor's. A carrier on a mature long-haul route seeks revenue through fares, yet there is tactical room for added frequency and larger aircraft. Joint marketing and a ring-fenced fund lower the carrier's risk on extra capacity. The province then buys seats, not higher fares. Belly cargo strengthens the case. Cape Town International is the province's only airport for international air freight, all of it carried in passenger aircraft. Exports made up 67% of its air freight in 2023. New Zealand tied marketing budgets to long-haul corridors and designed campaigns around airline breakeven. It reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24.[229]

Chile shows the infrastructure half. A private concession funded about US$900 million of expansion at Santiago, and international seats grew about 40% to 50% between 2013 and 2019 under open-skies agreements. The route fund is the province's to scale; open skies and private airport finance are national levers, carried in the escalation agenda (objective 19). The condition is the runway. If relief slips past about 2033, existing routes must carry growth for longer.[230]

Conditions on route money have precedent (Appendix A3). Queensland's Attracting Aviation Investment Fund matched A$100 million of government funding with A$100 million from airports and regional bodies, and paid against delivered capacity. Scotland's independent evaluation of its route fund used passenger surveys, an explicit counterfactual and carbon costs. Both are reported or evaluated results, not causal audits.

### Link forward

**Initiative I6**, route development and seat retention with a public-private air access fund (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-01 international arrivals at impact level, and T2-09 seats and routes, against Wesgro's 10 new routes by FY30, and T2-10 seats added on full routes at outcome level. T3-39, hub-closure scenarios completed, measures the output (section 5.2).

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · OBJECTIVE 8

## Grow cruise calls and ports

The Western Cape received 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26, down from 79 a season earlier, and Cape Town's berth has room for 150 or more calls, so the berth is not the limit. Growth

[229] MIDAS, "In Conclusion"; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p3-55, p3-56; Benchmarking, p54.
[230] Benchmarking, p23, p25, p26.

is set by the regional circuit that makes a Southern African season worth a ship's deployment, and by shore capacity on call days, when passengers converge on flagship sites already full in season.

### The opportunity

Cruise has room to grow at the berth Cape Town already has. The equipped berth can take 150 or more calls a season; it handled 83 in 2024/25, and the province received 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26. The 2025/26 season brought R1.47bn of spending and added R1.35bn to provincial GDP-R, against about R1.79bn after displacement a season earlier. The berth is therefore not what limits growth.[231]

International passengers drive the value (section 2.3). In 2024/25, the last season with a full study in hand, world cruises made up 42 of the 79 vessel visits, and their passengers added R802m to provincial GDP-R, 73% of what all passengers added. That season also earned R1.326bn of net foreign exchange and R259m in taxes. In 2025/26 cruise generated about R1bn of foreign exchange.[232]

The regional circuit decides whether ships come. A line commits a ship to Southern Africa for a season only when the whole itinerary works. Cape Town is the homeport, with calls east toward the Indian Ocean islands and west toward Angola and St Helena (section 2.3). The province holds one equipped port in that circuit, and Mossel Bay and Saldanha Bay can extend it east and west. Stakeholders name home porting and expedition vessels as the segments that bring longer stays and higher local spend.[233]

Shore capacity decides what a call is worth (section 2.3). On call days passengers converge on flagship sites that are already full in season, and the terminal queues about ten coaches at a time. The berth itself takes ships of up to 300m, the South-Easter delays berthing and there is no shore power. Port capital goes to freight: Saldanha's R4bn iron-ore expansion and Cape Town's container expansion add no cruise capacity.[234]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.8.** Evidence for objective 8

**Cape Town's berth has room and value grows with international passengers; the regional circuit and call-day shore capacity set growth, and port capital is going to freight.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Calls and passengers** | 64 cruise liner visits and about 106,000 passengers in 2025/26; 79 vessels and 127,178 passengers in 2024/25; 67 vessels in 2023/24 | Prospectus p29; Diag p37 |
| **Value comes from the mix** | International passengers 55,495 in 2022/23, 71,878 in 2023/24 and 100,255 in 2024/25, up 39% in the last season against 16% for all passengers; world cruises 73% of passengers' GDP-R; R1.79bn GDP-R in 2024/25 and R1.35bn in 2025/26 | StratEcon p9, p10, p22, p23; Diag p37; Prospectus p29 |
| **A berth with room** | Cape Town's equipped berth took 83 calls in 2024/25 against a season capacity of 150 or more; it takes ships up to 300m, the South-Easter delays berthing and there is no shore power | IR p110 |
| **The circuit sets deployment** | Cape Town is sold as homeport for two itineraries. East coast: Mossel Bay, Hermanus, Gqeberha, East London, Durban and Richards Bay, then Mozambique, East Africa and the Indian Ocean islands. West coast: Saldanha Bay and Port Nolloth, then Namibia, Angola and St Helena. The Western Cape has four ports and one equipped berth | Prospectus p6, p7; IR p111 |

[231] Infrastructure Report, p110, p112; StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p4, p19, p20, p22; the study counts 79 vessel visits for the season; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[232] StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p4, p23, p28, p34; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[233] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p7; Infrastructure Report, p111; Inception Report, p9.
[234] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p10; Infrastructure Report, p110, p112.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Shore capacity binds on call days** | Queue space for up to 10 coaches at the terminal; two liners on 12 March 2025 carried just over 5,000 passengers and the City warned of congestion; Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues run up to three hours in season (section 2.3) | Prospectus p10; City; IR p24; SIR p36 |
| **Regional ports extend the route** | Mossel Bay 21 calls and about 13,000 passengers, with a R22m reception facility opened in November 2025; Saldanha Bay 3 trial calls into an ore terminal; 13 cruise liner visits and just over 7,150 passengers across Mossel Bay, Hermanus and Saldanha Bay in 2025/26 | IR p111; Prospectus p29 |
| **Port capital is for freight** | Cape Town's container expansion and Saldanha's R4bn iron-ore expansion add no cruise capacity; the R22m Mossel Bay facility is the only cruise capital | IR p112 |
| **Packaging works** | Mossel Bay calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season through closer coordination and better excursion packaging, with Wesgro credited | SIR p20, p21 |

Source: StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025 (StratEcon; GDP-R after displacement); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026 (Prospectus); City of Cape Town media release, 11 Mar 2025 (City). For the same season StratEcon counts 79 vessel visits and 127,128 passengers, the Diagnostic 79 and 127,178, and the Infrastructure Report 83 calls. The 2025/26 figures are the prospectus's headline results from Cruise Cape Town's 2025/26 economic study, which is not in hand. Mossel Bay's 27 a season is its own figure; section 2.3 sets out the Mossel Bay counts.

The evidence sets a clear stance: protect Cape Town, back Mossel Bay now and watch Saldanha Bay. Mossel Bay handled 21 calls in 2024/25, opened a new passenger facility in November 2025 and expected about 23 calls in 2025/26. Wesgro counts 13 cruise liner visits across Mossel Bay, Hermanus and Saldanha Bay for that season (section 2.3). Ships anchor and tender at Mossel Bay, and only small and mid-sized ships call. Saldanha Bay has no passenger facility. The regional ports work as day stops rather than home ports, so they spread spend rather than multiply the passenger total.[235]

Wesgro's plan sets the target: 250 ship calls over FY26 to FY30, about 50 a year. The plan rounds up an annual average of 47 calls and notes that 20 of the 67 calls in 2023/24 were ships rerouted by the Middle East conflict. At about 50 a year the target sits below the 64 cruise liner visits of 2025/26 and the 79 of 2024/25. It is a floor the berth already clears, not a case for a second berth.[236]

### The course of action

The approach works on the circuit and the shore, with the berth Cape Town already has. Cruise Cape Town leads. In 2027 it designs a circuit compact with partner ports and lines and a call-day flow plan with the flagship operators. The Mossel Bay excursion packages and one definition of a call for reporting against the 250 are designed in the same year. Shore programmes beyond the flagship sites follow in 2028, with marketing to homeport, expedition and shoulder-season operators and community product on cruise-operator channels (section 4.3). Saldanha Bay waits until demand is proven, because its port capital serves iron ore.

The port itself stays with its owners. Transnet National Ports Authority and the V&A Waterfront hold berth scheduling, wind delays, shore power and the 300m limit. The national asks are that Transnet puts cruise into port planning and that port and immigration processing runs consistently across South African ports, so that a circuit works for the line.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Agree a circuit compact with partner ports and lines, so that itineraries east and west of Cape Town hold for a season | Cruise Cape Town; partner ports; cruise lines |

[235] Infrastructure Report, p112, p111; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[236] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; Infrastructure Report, p110; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Agree a call-day flow plan with the flagship operators and build shore programmes beyond the flagship sites | Cruise Cape Town; flagship site operators; V&A Waterfront; City of Cape Town |
| Wesgro | Market Cape Town as homeport to world-cruise, expedition and shoulder-season operators whose ships fit the berth, with pre- and post-cruise stays | Cruise Cape Town; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town |
| Wesgro | Back Mossel Bay now with packaged excursions and line marketing; keep Saldanha Bay on watch until demand is proven | Cruise Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality |
| Wesgro | Put community and regional product on cruise-operator channels, starting with a bookable walk in the Knysna townships | Cruise Cape Town; LTOs |
| Partners | Manage berth scheduling and wind delays at Cape Town, plan for shore power and review the 300m limit | Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront |
| National | Put cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries no cruise capacity | Transnet |
| National | Run port and immigration processing consistently across South African ports, so that a circuit works for the line | Transnet National Ports Authority; national government |

### Why it can work

The actions match the constraint. The berth has headroom; what limits growth is the circuit that brings a ship for a season and the shore capacity that receives its passengers. A circuit compact gives lines a full itinerary, and shore programmes give passengers more to buy beyond the flagships. Regional day stops spread that spend along the coast.[237]

The best precedent is local. On its own count, Mossel Bay's calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season, supported by closer coordination and better excursion packaging. The town credits its partnership with Wesgro. No benchmark destination offers a cruise precedent, so the case rests on Mossel Bay. The condition is that ship deployments hold. Growth to 2024/25 leaned on Red Sea reroutes, and their reversal is the main risk. Visits fell from 79 to 64 in 2025/26.[238]

### Link forward

**Initiative I7**, cruise circuit and shore capacity (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-11 cruise calls, passengers and GDP-R at outcome level, against Wesgro's target of 250 calls over FY26 to FY30 (section 5.2).

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · OBJECTIVE 9

## Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility

Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only.

### The challenge

Growth to 2035 has to spread beyond Cape Town, yet large parts of the province outside the Metro and the Garden Route are effectively car-only. The N2 is the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor, a single point of failure. Limited public transport restricts access for visitors who do not drive and shrinks the addressable market. Section 2.3 shows readiness and access falling with each step away from the Metro.[239]

[237] Infrastructure Report, p112.
[238] Stakeholder Insights, p20, p21; the Infrastructure Report, p111, prints 21 calls for 2024/25; Infrastructure Report, p110, p112; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29.
[239] Infrastructure Report, p99, p98.

The problem is reach, not capacity. Even in the Metro no rail line reaches the airport, and safety perceptions and limited visitor wayfinding hold back Metrorail's tourism potential. In April 2025 the Department of Mobility reported that no mass public transport served the airport and that the MyCiTi airport service had been suspended since 2022. Stakeholders call weak public transport, congestion and unreliable last-mile access structural barriers to visitor movement.[240]

No single body owns the visitor's journey. The Department of Mobility notes that mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers of government, and argues the case for a dedicated transport authority.[241]

Funding and information add to the gap. The City says MyCiTi's Public Transport Network Grant ends in 2027/28 and that fleet and services are at risk, so Phase 2A is a funded-delivery milestone, not a given. ACSA's own pages conflict on where e-hailing pickup sits at the airport. No verified visitor mode split exists to size any of this (section 2.4).

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.9.** Evidence for objective 9

> **Access falls away with distance from Cape Town, the rail and road assets that exist are not run for visitors and the bus network's grant ends in 2027/28.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Access decays with distance** | Accessibility Cape Metro 4.7 (5.0 on transport), Cape Winelands 3.3, Garden Route 3.0, Overberg 2.0, West Coast 1.7, Central Karoo 1.0 | IR p88 to p90 |
| **One corridor, mostly car-only** | The N2 is the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor; beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only | IR p98, p99 |
| **Rail exists but not for visitors** | Metrorail runs 104 of 121 stations and 22.7m trips (FY2025), but no rail reaches the airport and the Southern Line's visitor branding dates to 2007 | IR p100 |
| **The Metro's last mile is unfunded** | MyCiTi Phase 2 (R3.3bn) does not reach Chapman's Peak, Constantia or Cape Point south | IR p32 |
| **No shuttles between towns** | No inter-town shuttle on the Garden Route despite obvious demand; no public tourism transport between Hermanus, Stanford, Elim and Agulhas | IR p90, p67 |
| **Stakeholders rank it high** | 18 insight rows from 8 of 16 organisations, 10 rated High, including public transport and airport transfer times | SIR p22, p20 to p46 |
| **The MyCiTi grant ends in 2027/28** | The Public Transport Network Grant ends in 2027/28, with R7.1 billion committed to the Cape Flats expansion and 23 million annual trips; fleet and services are at risk | City of Cape Town, 2026 |
| **The Southern Line is not yet a visitor product** | Trains run from Cape Town to Fish Hoek; regular service on the Simon's Town section is unconfirmed; no normal Sunday or public-holiday service; Boulders needs a transfer from Simon's Town station | PRASA timetable, relayed Feb 2026; Cape Argus, Apr 2026 |
| **Airport pickup information conflicts** | The MyCiTi airport service is suspended, and ACSA's own pages conflict on where e-hailing pickup sits | ACSA, 2026 |
| **The George bus takes a card, not a bank tap** | GO GEORGE requires its own R45 smart card, loadable with cash, a debit or credit card or a SASSA card; the July 2026 single fare is R18.50; an airport service was trialled in September 2026 | GO GEORGE, 2026 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; comparative regional analysis on a 1 to 5 scale); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; the theme count is reconstructed from the appendix tables, which print no tally).

The evidence shows transport assets that exist but are not run for visitors. The Southern Line runs from Cape Town through Muizenberg and Kalk Bay to Fish Hoek as a low-cost scenic corridor, with a Simon's

[240] Infrastructure Report, p114, p98 to p100; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p3-59; Stakeholder Insights, p10.
[241] Stakeholder Insights, p23.

Town section whose regular service PRASA has yet to confirm. Trains do not normally run on Sundays or public holidays, Boulders needs a transfer from Simon's Town station and the line's visitor branding dates to 2007. The gaps between towns are services rather than roads. The Garden Route has no inter-town shuttle despite obvious demand, and Hermanus, Stanford, Elim and Agulhas have no public tourism transport between them.[242]

The shuttle gap has a commercial fix. A shared shuttle needs demand aggregation and booking integration to work, as !Khwa ttu says of the West Coast. Part of the answer is therefore within reach of a marketing and packaging body, while the rail and road assets stay with their owners.[243]

### The course of action

Wesgro does not build transport. It makes existing transport usable for visitors and gathers the demand that makes shuttles pay. The Department of Mobility leads the work, with Wesgro's Tourism unit. Shuttle aggregation and transfers sold inside itineraries are piloted in 2027 and 2028, and shuttle products run from 2029. The April 2025 draft land transport framework targets MyCiTi Phase 2A to Khayelitsha and Mitchells Plain for 2027, which would bring township product within reach sooner. The Department of Mobility's draft Tourism Transport Strategy adds the airport leg and touring-route signage, so Wesgro also sells airport transfers inside itineraries.[244]

Funded service specifications come first. They cover the airport link and regional services, and they are written for visitors without cars. The MyCiTi grant and the suspended airport service take priority over rail branding, and Phase 2A is counted only once its funding is confirmed. Airport pickup information is harmonised across ACSA, the City and operators. The Southern Line product proceeds only on a PRASA-signed timetable with security and disruption obligations. Rapid rail to George waits for an appraisal of cheaper options, and the last mile to Cape Point comes later in the period (section 4.3). On the George bus the national ask narrows to the written technical or regulatory reason for refusing direct bank-card tapping, from the Department of Transport and the payment provider. Airport-corridor safety costs sit once, in I17.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Package the Southern Line as a visitor product, with refreshed branding and day passes, once PRASA signs a timetable with security and disruption obligations | Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; PRASA |
| Wesgro | Aggregate demand and bookings for corridor shuttles, starting on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast | Tourism; district municipalities; private operators |
| Wesgro | Sell the airport transfer and the corridor transfers on the N2 and R62 routes inside the itinerary, so visitors without a car can buy the trip | Destination Marketing; operators |
| Partners | Write funded service specifications for the airport link and regional services, including for visitors without cars, and secure MyCiTi funding beyond the grant that ends in 2027/28 | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town; ACSA |
| Partners | Complete the Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and the unfunded last mile to Cape Point, with integrated ticketing | City of Cape Town; PRASA; Department of Mobility |
| Partners | Appraise cheaper options before any Cape Town to George rapid rail decision, and extend the George public transport model | Department of Mobility |
| Partners | Revive the MyCiTi airport service, plan facilities for e-hailing and metered taxis at Cape Town International and publish one consistent set of airport pickup information | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town; ACSA |
| National | Obtain from the Department of Transport and the payment provider the written technical or regulatory reason for refusing direct bank-card tapping on the George bus, and fund passenger rail beyond the Metro | Department of Transport; PRASA |

[242] Infrastructure Report, p100, p90, p67.
[243] Stakeholder Insights, p41.
[244] Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p3-24; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12.

**Why it can work**

The mechanism is aggregation. A shuttle pays only at volume, and pooled bookings across operators, sold inside a multi-day itinerary, turn scattered requests into a load that can run. The Southern Line needs no new track to become a product, but it does need a timetable PRASA will sign and security a visitor can rely on. Each step widens the market to visitors without a car, the market that limited public transport now narrows.[245]

None of the six benchmark destinations carries an internal mobility lever with figures. Medellín shows the principle at city scale. A cable-car line carrying about 35,000 passengers a day and six outdoor escalators, built for Comuna 13's residents, became part of the visit. The area drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025, 52% of them international. The Cape Winelands shows it at home: its heritage tram, built to connect wine estates, solves the drink-and-drive barrier. The condition is shared ownership and an early capacity limit. The three tiers must run the visitor's journey as one, and trains must be safe enough to sell. Visitor caps must also come before the crowds, which in Comuna 13 they did not.[246]

An airport bus can come before an airport rail link. Edinburgh's Airlink 100 runs a 24-hour airport express, as often as every 10 minutes by day (Appendix A3). Its subsidy is not published, so the case supports the service standard and not a return.

**Link forward**

**Initiative I8**, corridor mobility (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level, and T2-12 accessibility score by district and T2-13 corridor transfer products at outcome level (section 5.2).

### 3.2.2 Product and destination capacity

The second supply theme covers what visitors find once they arrive: product beyond the icons, the quality of the stay and the limits of the flagship sites. The three objectives work as a set. New product gives visitors a reason to travel outward, quality standards make that product safe to sell and flow management at the flagships sends the overflow to it.

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · OBJECTIVE 10

### Support diversified route and product development

The province does not lack attractions; it lacks finished experiences around them, with assets outside the Metro left without guides, interpretation or bookable product and one touring route of six rated Ready.

**The challenge**

The growth case needs visitors to travel beyond the Cape Peninsula, stay longer and spend in more places. The province has the assets to support that. Of 50,332 mapped tourism assets, the Cape Metro holds 40.3% and the five other districts the rest. The West Coast has the highest natural-asset attractiveness in the province and the Central Karoo its most unique niche assets.[247]

Yet both score lowest on readiness, and the product around the assets is unfinished (section 2.3). Eleven of 16 organisations engaged see the offer as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons. The Department of Economic Development adds that destination development has focused more on managing barriers than on building product outside the Cape Peninsula.[248]

[245] Infrastructure Report, p99.
[246] Benchmarking, p25, p27; the nearest is Chile's domestic air network, run as a designed portfolio linking Santiago to its regions; Inclusion Plan, p8; Infrastructure Report, p90.
[247] Infrastructure Report, p2, p23, p88.
[248] Stakeholder Insights, p11, p24; the count is reconstructed from the appendix tables.

Nine of the ten places international tourists visit most are in the Metro. That concentration costs the province twice. The flagships run full in season while the township attractions are underused. Further out, strong product sits where visitors cannot easily reach or afford it.[249]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.10.** Evidence for objective 10

**Assets are spread across the province, but product, packaging and investment stop at the core routes.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Assets are spread** | 50,332 mapped tourism assets; the Cape Metro holds 40.3% and the five other districts the rest | IR p2, p23 |
| **Assets are not activated** | Overberg and West Coast marine and wildflower assets have no guided tours, interpretation centres or bookable product; the Central Karoo and northern inland are attraction deserts | IR p93 |
| **Cold zones in every district** | Industrial belts with zero tourism conversion in the Metro; the inland Garden Route north of the N2; the Rûens interior; large parts of the Central Karoo off the N1 transit core | IR p24, p35, p68, p79 |
| **One route is Ready** | Cape Peninsula Ready; Garden Route, Cape Winelands, Whale Coast and Route 62 Developing; West Coast and Cederberg Emerging | IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84 |
| **No capital for product** | Non-wine diversification in the Winelands is strategy, not committed capital; De Hoop lacks accommodation investment; Overberg year-round product is unfunded | IR p54, p76 |
| **Stakeholders see concentration** | 11 of 16 organisations raised the theme; the offer is seen as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons | SIR p11 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; route ratings are approximate and the asset count carries no year); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables).

The evidence locates the constraint. It is less about creating new attractions and more about turning existing assets into complete, accessible visitor experiences. Each route falls short on something different: accommodation and bookability on the West Coast, bookability on Route 62 and depth beyond Hermanus on the Whale Coast. The Winelands and the Garden Route fall short only on safety (section 2.3).[250]

An attraction without an online ticket is not always unsold. Walk-in entry and local permits can be workable access models. The test is whether the visitor can plan and complete the trip, and whether the operator loses profitable sales.

No committed capital yet follows the gap. No source counts the assets that have no product around them [assets with no bookable product or guided access, by district: needs the Wesgro supply database behind the 50,332 count]. The first design task is therefore to size the gap district by district.[251]

### The course of action

Wesgro works outward from strength. The Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg already have strong underlying product and need connectivity, packaging and service depth. Route 62 and the West Coast are packaged as slow-travel products. In 2027 and 2028 the Tourism unit designs bookable itineraries for all six touring routes. Delivery starts from 2029 on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, which are closest to ready. It moves to Route 62 and the West Coast once their product is online (objective 3; section 4.3).[252]

The City is a natural partner. Its framework for 2019 to 2024 proposed a Cape Town+ offer linking the city with the surrounding regions. Stellenbosch and George can anchor regional business events, which gives the Convention Bureau a part to play. The capital sits with others. Accommodation investors and

[249] Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68; Infrastructure Report, p24, p89.
[250] Infrastructure Report, p114, p62, p73, p84.
[251] Infrastructure Report, p54, p76.
[252] Infrastructure Report, p114.

municipalities add beds and service depth in secondary towns later in the period (objective 15). SANParks carries the precinct projects, and rural broadband sits with national government (objective 3).[253]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Package bookable multi-day itineraries on each of the six touring routes, delivering first on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, then Route 62 and the West Coast | Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; LTOs |
| Wesgro | Activate cold-zone assets with guided tours, interpretation and bookable product, beginning with the marine and wildflower assets | Tourism; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs |
| Wesgro | Build regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George, with stays before and after Cape Town events | Convention Bureau |
| Partners | Invest in accommodation and service depth beyond Hermanus, in Route 62's secondary towns and beyond Langebaan and Paternoster (objective 15) | Accommodation investors; municipalities |
| Partners | Refresh flagship product: Robben Island beyond the prison tour; the Cableway's lower station | Robben Island Museum; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway |
| National | Complete SANParks precinct projects such as the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct | SANParks |

### Why it can work

The actions supply what the assets lack: a guide, a bed and a booking route. Packaging turns scattered assets into a trip a visitor can buy, and a multi-day itinerary gives a reason to stay outside the Metro. The Overberg shows both the pull and the limit. Its whale-watching anchor sustains operator confidence despite flat accessibility, yet De Hoop still lacks accommodation investment and year-round product is unfunded.[254]

Chile ran Santiago, Valparaíso, the wine valleys and Patagonia as one portfolio. It reports longer stays and shoulder-season revenue from the approach, though no figure is printed for either. The change for the Western Cape is to sell experiences as curated journeys and move from asset marketing to experience-led packaging. The condition is that the other entries keep pace. Itineraries sell only if the product can be booked (objective 3), reached without a car (objective 9) and stayed in. Without beds, a packaged route stays a day trip from Cape Town.[255]

### Link forward

**Initiative I9**, corridor product development (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level and T2-14 readiness by district at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · OBJECTIVE 11

## Align visitor experience in-destination

Accommodation outside the Metro has gaps in the middle of the market that differ by place, and service, interpretation, language and access readiness thin out with distance from Cape Town.

### The challenge

The growth case needs visitors the current offer serves poorly. The gap in the middle of the accommodation market is a product question, not a province-wide absence. In the Winelands, mid-market stock is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch and a luxury-skewed product mix excludes mid-market and family segments. The Garden Route is described as short of quality-graded hotels that anchor

[253] City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5; Demand-Side Analysis, p41.
[254] Infrastructure Report, p75, p76.
[255] Benchmarking, p27, p28.

midweek, conference or business travel, yet George already has a branded, conference-capable hotel of 109 rooms. What is missing is a configuration, price point, location or capacity, and it differs by place.[256]

The experience is weakest at the arrival gate and at the periphery. The international airport is the most negative node in Cape Town's online mentions. Further out, readiness falls with distance from the Metro (section 2.3). Accommodation readiness drops from 4.7 in the Metro to 2.0 in the Central Karoo.[257]

The growth markets add their own needs. Chinese visitors find few Mandarin-language services. Indian visitors see little sign of vegetarian options or Indian-language guides. Gulf visitors find no Arabic-language booking or local-currency options. These are the markets Goal 1 courts, so the gaps sit on the growth path (section 3.1). Halal readiness belongs on the same list, since the province's Tourism Blueprint names halal tourism among the latent forms whose potential return has not yet been reached.[258]

Access and information are part of the experience. A graded building is not an accessible trip: the transfer, the room, the attraction and the information must work end to end, and TGCSA guidance on universal access already exists. Halal and vegetarian claims must match what is delivered. Guide registration is under strain, with application growth, overtime and burnout recorded in DEDAT's 2026/27 plan. Short-term rentals supply much of the self-catering stock visitors already favour, yet no count sets them beside hotels and guesthouses (section 2.3).

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.11.** Evidence for objective 11

**The experience breaks at place-specific gaps in the accommodation market, at the service counter, at the arrival gate and wherever an accessible trip cannot be completed.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **The mid-market gap differs by place** | Mid-market stock is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch; George has a branded, conference-capable hotel with 109 rooms and four event rooms, the largest seating 300; Mossel Bay reports limited upper-upscale capacity under a conference-capable brand | IR p47; SIR p20; Marriott, 2026 |
| **Accommodation range thins** | Accommodation range Ready on three routes, Developing on the Whale Coast and Route 62 and Gap on the West Coast | IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84 |
| **A two-tier system** | Strong product sits where visitors cannot easily reach or afford it; accommodation readiness 4.7 in the Metro against 2.0 in the Central Karoo | IR p89 |
| **Service is uneven** | Mossel Bay calls restaurant quality and service a major weakness; CapeNature is wary of scaling international demand because service readiness is uneven | SIR p20, p43 |
| **Growth markets need adapting** | Limited Mandarin-language services; little visibility of vegetarian options or Indian-language guides; no Arabic-language booking or local-currency options | DSA p51 |
| **The arrival is the weak point** | The international airport is the most negative node in Cape Town's online mentions; immigration processing and peak-hour throughput need work | Diag p22; DSA p54 |
| **Guide registration is under strain** | Application growth, overtime and burnout in guide registration, with workflow fixes committed | DEDAT APP 2026/27 |
| **A graded building is not an accessible trip** | Guidance on universal access exists, but no verified end-to-end accessible itineraries are published | TGCSA guidance |
| **Short-term rentals are uncounted supply** | 26,991 listings in Cape Town and 1,953 in Overstrand on one platform in March 2026; a listing is not a bed available tonight | Inside Airbnb, Mar 2026 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Mentionlytics sentiment data).

[256] Infrastructure Report, p95, p53.
[257] Diagnostic, p22; Infrastructure Report, p89.
[258] Demand-Side Analysis, p51; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p7.

The evidence shows a gap in the middle of the market and at the service counter, not a shortage of premium product. Service quality worries the operators themselves: CapeNature is cautious about scaling international demand while service readiness is uneven across its sites.[259]

Two measures are missing. No source counts rooms or beds by district and type, short-term rentals included [room and bed count by district for hotels, guesthouses and short-term rentals: needs the Wesgro supply database or an accommodation audit], and none prints a visitor satisfaction score.

### The course of action

The quality charter comes first, because it sets the standard the other actions aim at. DEDAT leads it with Wesgro's Tourism unit. It is a province-wide framework that aligns all tourism stakeholders under consistent benchmarks, phased by district, with support for SMMEs to comply. It works as a supported condition for discretionary public promotion, not as a new badge: operators who meet it, with help where they need it, are the ones public campaigns carry. Design runs through 2027 and 2028, and the district phases start in 2029 (section 4.3).[260]

The accommodation question becomes a destination-and-product test, run with I14 (objective 15). It asks which configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing in each place, and whether better use of existing stock answers it. An accommodation audit counts hotel, guesthouse and short-term rental stock separately by district. The arrival gate sits outside the province's reach: Home Affairs and ACSA hold immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, so the province presses them.

Two strands join the charter. Accessible journeys are built as saleable itineraries and tested end to end with lived-experience partners. Their verified access information is published. Guide registration is run as a service, with its performance published.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Prepare for growth markets: multilingual guiding, digital payments, halal food and prayer facilities and culturally relevant product for Chinese, Indian and Gulf visitors, with halal and vegetarian claims verified against delivery | Tourism; Destination Marketing |
| Wesgro | Run a destination-and-product test with I14 of which accommodation configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing in George and Mossel Bay, east of Hermanus and on Route 62 (objective 15) | Tourism; private investors |
| Wesgro | Audit accommodation by district, counting hotel, guesthouse and short-term rental stock separately | Research; Tourism; municipalities |
| Wesgro | Build accessible journeys as saleable itineraries, test them end to end with lived-experience partners and publish verified access information | Tourism; Destination Marketing; lived-experience partners; operators |
| Partners | Set up a provincial quality charter, phased by district, as a supported condition for discretionary public promotion, with its status visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply | DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism; industry bodies |
| Partners | Close service and interpretation gaps at named sites: Robben Island interpretation, CapeNature service readiness, restaurant quality in Mossel Bay | Attraction operators; municipalities; CATHSSETA |
| Partners | Publish guide-registration service performance and complete the committed workflow fixes | DEDAT |
| National | Improve immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, and deliver the terminal relief due about 2032 | Home Affairs; ACSA |

[259] Stakeholder Insights, p43.
[260] Benchmarking, p42, p49; that source proposes Wesgro as lead.

### Why it can work

A visible standard solves a problem of trust. A visitor booking a guesthouse on Route 62 cannot judge its service from abroad; certification shown on the booking platform can. The same standard gives small operators a clear target and a route to support, and it lets the province sell product outside the core with confidence.

Quality governance was Valencia's primary lever. Its Qualitur programme and SICTED quality system raised service consistency, reputation and repeat visitation. The city received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 13.9% more than in 2023 and 24.4% above 2019. Singapore's tourism board used a hotel industry transformation map, a hotel rejuvenation fund and the Hotels Act. The aim was to move from short stopovers towards longer stays and higher spend. The condition is that small businesses can comply. The compliance burden and skills shortages are the main risks, so the charter needs SMME support from the start and the skills work in objective 20.[261]

### Link forward

**Initiative I10**, visitor experience and quality standards (section 4.3). **Indicators** T2-15 routes rated Ready at outcome level and T3-41 accessible journeys verified and published at output level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · OBJECTIVE 12

## Balance impact on nature-based attractions

Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours, so growth at the flagship nature sites must come from maintaining what exists, managing flows and steering visitors only to reserves ready for them.

### The challenge

The flagship nature sites carry the province's brand. Table Mountain, Robben Island and Kirstenbosch form the only globally branded landmark cluster, and the Metro holds five of the province's six highest-volume attractions. In season they run full (section 2.3). Peak queues at the Cableway of up to three hours detract from the visitor experience.[262]

More volume at these sites is the wrong aim. The Department of Economic Development wants further growth directed to under-visited parts of the province rather than constrained flagships. Yet the flagships congest at the peak while the overflow reserves remain under-marketed. Stony Point, a penguin colony in the Overberg, is the candidate alternative to Boulders at the peak, and its visitors rose 28% over the festive season (section 2.3). Yet its R45 entry and opening hours establish neither spare ecological capacity nor readiness for coaches, so it must pass its own readiness assessment first.[263]

Nature tourism also funds conservation. CapeNature cannot rely on public funding alone and treats tourism as a revenue business to support its conservation mandate. Flooding, fire and heat are already closing CapeNature sites, so the reserves that should take the overflow are themselves under strain.[264]

Maintenance is the first call on that revenue. CapeNature's audited 2025/26 accounts show ecotourism revenue of R82.038 million, against a restated R77.171 million the year before, repairs of R16.058 million and government grants of R331.562 million. Its 2026/27 Ecotourism and Access budget is R132.542 million, including R35.599 million for buildings. Floods in May 2026 damaged roads, trails and buildings, and by June 85% of reserves reported some damage. The reserves expected to take the overflow therefore need repair before they need marketing.

[261] Benchmarking, p47, p46, p41; growth across all levers, not attributed to quality alone.
[262] Infrastructure Report, p88; Stakeholder Insights, p36.
[263] Stakeholder Insights, p24; Infrastructure Report, p88; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p70.
[264] Stakeholder Insights, p44, p43.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.12.** Evidence for objective 12

> **The flagship sites are at or near their limits and climate is already closing sites, while the receiving reserves are flood-damaged and unassessed.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Boulders is near capacity** | Some nature-based attractions, Boulders among them, are already near carrying capacity, so more volume there is undesirable (Department of Economic Development) | SIR p24 |
| **The summit cannot grow** | Environmental restrictions limit permanent expansion on Table Mountain's summit; peak queues run up to three hours up and two hours down | SIR p36; IR p28 |
| **Overflow is under-marketed** | Peak-season congestion at flagship sites while overflow reserves remain under-marketed | IR p88 |
| **Tourism funds conservation** | CapeNature's ecotourism income pays for alien clearing, fire response and species protection, and public funding alone will not suffice | SIR p43, p44 |
| **Climate already bites** | Flooding, fire and heat are closing CapeNature sites; weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year | SIR p43, p33 |
| **Seasonal windows are narrow** | Whale season peaks from September to November; climate change threatens the predictability of the wildflower season | IR p67, p64 |
| **Visits stayed high in 2025** | Fourth quarter 2025: Cableway 374,808, Cape Point 337,044, Kirstenbosch 202,047 and Robben Island 108,225; Table Mountain National Park 1,708,289 entries from April to October 2025; visits are neither distinct tourists nor safe capacities | City of Cape Town, 2025; SANParks, 2025 |
| **Ecotourism revenue is small beside grants** | Ecotourism revenue R82.038m in 2025/26 (R77.171m restated the year before), repairs R16.058m and government grants R331.562m; the 2026/27 Ecotourism and Access budget is R132.542m, including R35.599m for buildings | CapeNature AFS 2025/26; CapeNature budget 2026/27 |
| **Floods damaged the receiving reserves** | Floods in May 2026 damaged roads, trails and buildings; by June, 85% of reserves reported some damage | CapeNature, 2026 |
| **Prices already differ by visitor** | From 1 November 2026 Boulders costs R57 for South African adults and R282 for international adults, and Cape Point R592 for international adults; Stony Point charges R45 | SANParks tariffs, 2026; CapeNature, 2026 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; insight statements by organisation, not quotations); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

The evidence holds counts but not limits. In 2023 Boulders drew 762,494 visitors, up 60.2% on 2022. Cape Point, counted as the Cape of Good Hope, drew 940,399, up 49.0%. Section 2.3 gives the other flagships' counts. With 55.4% of international tourists going there, Cape Point is a flagship in its own right. No source yet prints permitted capacity for these sites [flagship carrying capacity: request from SANParks, the Cableway, Robben Island Museum and SANBI]. Without limits, the province cannot set caps, price the peak or show that steering visitors works.[265]

### The course of action

Wesgro stops marketing volume to the flagship sites and uses them as the hook that sends visitors elsewhere. The Peninsula route's own opportunities are to disperse visitors beyond the highest-volume attractions and to expand shoulder-season experiences. The baseline comes first. In 2027 and 2028 Wesgro's Research unit asks the flagship sites for their capacity, to set beside the Treasury's counts (section 4.3). Dispersal marketing follows readiness: receiving reserves, Stony Point included, pass their own readiness assessment before visitors are steered to them.[266]

Maintenance comes before new product. CapeNature and the site operators compile a costed condition register, and repairs of verified assets come first. Two flow pilots move into the first phase: Boulders and

[265] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p69; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68.
[266] Infrastructure Report, p30.

one other constrained site, in the summer of 2027/28 at the earliest. Each protects walk-up access and resident access and carries a stop rule.

The site operators hold the flow tools, from digital flow management to tiered pricing. The pilots test them first, and from 2029 the operators extend what works at the Cableway and Boulders, where mandates allow. Later in the period CapeNature makes reserve product climate-resilient. SANParks carries the national step: a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders, agreed with the City and the operators.[267]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Market receiving reserves, Stony Point included, and the Southern Line towns only once each passes its own readiness assessment, as alternatives to peak-hour visits at Boulders and the Cableway | Destination Marketing; CapeNature; SANParks; PRASA |
| Wesgro | Request carrying capacity for the flagship sites and publish it beside the Treasury's visitor counts as the baseline | Research; site operators; Provincial Treasury |
| Wesgro | Report spend per visitor and length of stay for nature product alongside visitor numbers | Research |
| Partners | Assess each receiving reserve, Stony Point included, for ecological capacity and coach readiness before any dispersal marketing | CapeNature; Overberg LTOs |
| Partners | Compile a costed condition register for reserve and attraction assets, and repair verified assets before adding new product | CapeNature; SANParks; site operators |
| Partners | Run two flow pilots, at Boulders and one other constrained site, from summer 2027/28 at the earliest, protecting walk-up and resident access and carrying a stop rule; then extend digital flow management and tiered pricing where mandates allow | SANParks; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; CapeNature |
| Partners | Make reserve product climate-resilient by reassessing asset formats and siting | CapeNature |
| National | Agree a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders with the City and the operators | SANParks |

### Why it can work

Flow management protects the visit and the revenue together. Digital flow tools and tiered pricing spread arrivals across the day and the season. A site then serves its visitors without a three-hour queue and earns more at the peak. Marketing the alternatives at the point of booking sends the overflow to reserves that are ready for it, and their income pays for conservation there.

New Zealand uses land-use controls and premium curation on the principle that capacity discipline protects long-term pricing power. Kenya treats conservation as national economic infrastructure, with tourism-funded conservation financing and community conservancies that sustain demand and environmental integrity. The City already runs the model at small scale. Since August 2025 Witzands permits have been capped by day, and 80% are pre-booked online. The condition is the operators. They must share their counts, and their mandates must allow pricing: CapeNature's statutory affordability mandate has kept its prices conservative, and CapeNature is now moving towards tiered pricing.[268]

Timed entry has a mixed record, which is why each pilot carries a stop rule. Rocky Mountain made day-use access permanent after pilots, while Arches and Yosemite dropped reservations in 2026 (Appendix A3). The pilots therefore watch queues, conservation outcomes, excluded visits and neighbouring businesses together.

[267] Demand-Side Analysis, p3; Stakeholder Insights, p44.
[268] Benchmarking, p55, p33; Inclusion Plan, p41; Stakeholder Insights, p44.

### Link forward

**Initiative I11**, flagship site demand management (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-16 peak queue at the Cableway at outcome level, with the Treasury's flagship visitor counts beside it. T3-22 flow pilots run and T3-40 condition register published and repairs completed measure the outputs (section 5.2).

## 3.3 Goal 3: Build enabling capability

Goal 3 decides whether the other two can be delivered and shared: who benefits, who pays, who decides and who measures.

Goal 3 sets out to build an inclusive, well-governed tourism system that supports sustainable growth, returns and development. The other two goals depend on it. Demand work fills seats and supply work opens the regions, but neither lasts unless someone owns the decisions, pays for the assets and counts the results. Section 2.4 found that system thin at each point the action plan relies on.

Each question starts from a gap. On who benefits, 20 township and rural communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive a traced 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend. On who pays, the capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets. On who decides, visas and air service agreements sit with national government, and mobility mandates are split across three tiers. On who measures, provincial measures of tourism GDP and jobs are still to be built.[269]

Two themes and eight objectives carry the goal. The first theme, investment, inclusion and sustainability, settles who benefits from growth, how it is paid for and how it lasts. It gives community product a local seller, keeps local tourism bodies in service, holds growth within what each destination can carry and builds an investment pipeline that follows demand (objectives 13 to 15). The second theme, governance and leadership, settles who decides and who measures. It aligns the three tiers of government, turns industry forums into one joint plan and agrees how data is shared (objectives 16 to 18). The same theme holds two further objectives. Objective 19 takes the national deficits in infrastructure, visas and safety to the tier that holds them. Objective 20 commissions the labour analysis a skills plan will rest on.

The eight entries work as a sequence, not a menu. Governance starts alongside the first seat and bookability moves (section 3.4). Steerco, the data-sharing protocol and the escalation agenda start in the first quarter of 2027, because every other initiative reports through them (section 4.2). The community pilots start in the same phase, with booking routes shared with objective 3 and safety plans drawn from objective 19. Climate risk, local tourism funding, the investment pipeline and the labour analysis spend 2027 and 2028 on design. Each first needs a baseline or a case that does not yet exist. Capital for product and community assets comes last. It follows demand that the pilots and the regional product have shown, not the reverse (section 2.1).

The evidence behind the goal is mostly qualitative. It rests on statements attributed to the 16 organisations with recorded insights, a one-page table of what each tier holds, the community profiles and the district gap tables. The goal therefore carries more open items than the other two. Several entries start by building the baseline they will be judged against. Provincial and City documents narrow some of these gaps and offer programmes to build on; each entry cites the ones it uses.[270]

By 2035 the goal must leave the province able to deliver its growth and share it. Visitor spend should reach the communities, measured against a reference point of 1% of foreign direct spend, R259m a year at FY2025 levels (section 5.3). Local tourism bodies should hold stable funding, and tourism projects should reach financial close. The national tier should answer the province's asks, and the province should count its own tourism jobs and spend. Initiatives I12 to I18 carry the eight objectives, with objectives 16 and 17 sharing one forum in I15 (section 4.1).

[269] Inclusion Plan, p5; Infrastructure Report, p32 to p87, p100, p112; Diagnostic, p58; Stakeholder Insights, p23, p37.
[270] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46; Diagnostic, p58; Inclusion Plan, p20 to p28; Infrastructure Report, p32 to p87.

### 3.3.1 Investment, inclusion and sustainability

The first enabling theme covers who benefits from growth, how it is paid for and how it lasts. It holds three objectives: community inclusion, sustainable tourism and investment. The inclusion model is set out at concept level, and Chapter 4 assigns its roles and funding.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · OBJECTIVE 13

## Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion

Twenty communities hold 18.4% of the province's residents but receive only a small documented share of foreign direct spend, and in eleven the binding constraint is organisation, not distance or product.

#### The opportunity

Community inclusion decides whether growth to 2035 is shared. Inclusion here means visitor activity inside the community: a tour, a meal, a bed or a market. A resident commuting to a hotel job in town counts for little or nothing. On that measure the province starts near zero. Foreign visitors spent R25.9bn in FY2025, and the 20 shortlisted communities received a documented floor of R4m to R10m of it.[271]

The prize is large. At 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend, the 20 communities would receive R259m a year; at 1% of the 2035 spend ambition, R547m. Both are reference points, not adopted targets (section 5.3). The visitors are already close, and organisation rather than distance keeps their spend out (section 2.4).[272]

Inclusion also widens what the province sells. SATVITO finds that more township and village product could widen market reach and lift visitor spend, yet negative safety perceptions of the townships hold demand back. The opportunity opens only to a community that can sell and a visit that is safe.[273]

The local bodies that would carry a seller can still be funded. MFMA Circular No. 131 separates an unrequited transfer from a purchase of goods or services, and Cape Town has paid Cape Town Tourism as contracted services in compliance with it (section 2.4). Where services lapsed the effect was direct: Garden Route officials reported in March 2026 that Calitzdorp and Ladismith could not operate fully and that Oudtshoorn, De Rust and Plettenberg Bay were affected. De Rust is one of the six communities profiled first.

#### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.13.** Evidence for objective 13

**The shortlisted communities sit close to visitors but earn almost nothing from them, most lack a body that can sell and the bodies that exist need a lawful funding route.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Close to demand** | 93 of 107 long-listed communities lie within 45 minutes of a tourism node or corridor; distance is the binding constraint in none of the 20 | SCIP p16, p30 |
| **Almost no spend** | 18.4% of residents (Census 2011) against a traced floor of 0.02% to 0.04% of foreign direct spend, about R4m to R10m a year | SCIP p5 |
| **Organisation binds** | Organisation is the binding constraint in 11 of 20 communities, and 10 have no identified active tourism body | SCIP p28, p30 |

[271] Inclusion Plan, p4, p5; Demand-Side Analysis, p11.
[272] Inclusion Plan, p5.
[273] Stakeholder Insights, p34.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Product sells by phone** | No profiled community rates Ready on digital and bookability; Zwelihle's four resident guides sell by phone with no shared channel | SCIP p20 to p26, p34 |
| **Safety is a gate** | 9 of 20 communities record a safety-perception gap and 5 record extortion (SAPS 2025/26 station data) | SCIP p27, p30 |
| **The prize** | 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend is R259m a year, about 26 to 65 times today's documented floor | SCIP p5 |
| **LTOs depend on municipalities** | Most local tourism bodies are not operationally sustainable without municipal funding, and MFMA Circular No. 131 has disrupted that route (Department of Economic Development) | SIR p25 |
| **LTO budgets go to marketing** | LTO contracts and budgets are weighted toward destination marketing, leaving little for tourism development (West Coast District Municipality) | SIR p39 |
| **Circular 131 leaves a procurement route** | The circular separates an unrequited transfer (MFMA section 67) from a purchase of services under supply-chain rules; Cape Town paid Cape Town Tourism as contracted services | National Treasury, 2025; City of Cape Town, Jan 2026 |
| **Disruption is uneven** | Calitzdorp and Ladismith could not operate fully and Oudtshoorn, De Rust and Plettenberg Bay were affected; George's municipal tourism unit was unaffected (officials' statements, not an audited inventory) | Garden Route officials, Mar 2026 |
| **Community supply is mixed** | Owner-run enterprises sit beside collective projects, so a place called community tourism does not establish collective ownership | Cape Town Tourism directory, 2026 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP; desk research 17 to 23 September 2026, ratings from the community side with LTO confirmation outstanding). The R259m is 1% of the R25.9bn FY2025 foreign direct spend in the Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11. The plan does not describe how the spend floor was traced. The multiple of today's floor is computed.

The evidence places the main gap in selling, not proximity. Organisation binds in 11 of the 20 communities, attraction in six and distance in none. No profiled community yet rates Ready on digital and bookability. The spend floor is uncertain, because the method behind it is not yet shown. [Open item: the Inclusion Plan to set out how the R4m to R10m floor was traced.][274]

The funding evidence is thinner than the selling evidence. The finding that LTOs cannot sustain operations without municipal funding rests on two organisations, the Department of Economic Development and the West Coast District Municipality, and no source counts the LTOs or their grants [number of Western Cape LTOs and their municipal funding before and after Circular 131: DEDAT to supply].[275]

The cases set the order of action: a seller with a stake, then a safe and workable visit, then product that keeps spend in the community and only then exposure. Kliptown in Soweto shows the cost of the reverse order. Walter Sisulu Square cost R160 million to R180 million, out of the R436 million first allocated to Kliptown, before an operator was in place (section 2.1). By 2017 it drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year, against a business case of almost 200,000 international visitors. Safety is the second gate. In Rio, security collapsed in 2017 and public support was withdrawn early. Nine communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion, so every pilot needs a site-specific safety plan before launch.[276]

### The course of action

Wesgro should connect community product to the demand it already moves, and leave the building of selling bodies to municipalities, LTOs and the communities themselves. The model has three parts: a selling capability that works, a link to demand that already exists and gates that must be passed before activation and investment. The four gates are a site-specific safety and access plan, a viable operating model, an operating budget and a maintenance and marketing covenant.[277]

[274] Inclusion Plan, p30, p53 to p58, p20 to p26, p40 to p51.
[275] Stakeholder Insights, p25, p39.
[276] Inclusion Plan, p12, p11, p7, p27, p35.
[277] Inclusion Plan, p32.

In 2027 Wesgro and its partners choose two or three pilots on readiness and agree who funds a seller with a stake in each. Safety plans follow in the same year (section 4.3). In 2028 each pilot opens one live booking route and runs a fixed-date test, and Wesgro places the product in its itineraries and calendars. Investment follows demand, and pilots scale from 2029 only once bookings, local spend, delivery and safety meet thresholds agreed before launch. In Metro pilots, the Cultures of Cape Town programme and local tourism forums can host the seller, if they run. The City's framework proposed both, with a special focus on the Cape Flats and townships.[278]

Three conditions are added before promotion. Each pilot keeps an operator and rights register, because owner-run and collective supply need different agreements. Paid departures carry buyer commitments on net rate, schedule, commission, cancellation and settlement. Extortion controls, with confidential reporting and a named SAPS referral, are in place before launch.

Local tourism bodies are kept in service by contract. Municipalities buy LTO services through lawful procurement, on a provincial practice note that sets out the route Circular 131 leaves open, and the national ask narrows to the points still in dispute. The arrangement also tests the Blueprint's district model (objective 16). From 2029 the service agreements carry a development mandate and enter IDPs with reporting, through the Provincial Treasury's district reviews.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Put pilot community product into the itineraries, calendars and channels Wesgro already runs, such as the Langa and Kayamandi routes and the Mal'va festival listing | Tourism; Destination Marketing |
| Wesgro | Choose the two or three pilots with partners on the plan's readiness criteria, and keep the record of bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue | Research; Tourism |
| Partners | Form or fund a local selling body in each pilot community, with one live booking route, published dates, a named customer contact and an operator and rights register | Municipalities, with the City of Cape Town in Metro pilots; LTOs; community sellers |
| Partners | Secure paid departures with buyer commitments on net rate, schedule, commission, cancellation and settlement before any promotion | LTOs; community sellers; inbound operators |
| Partners | Attach maintenance and marketing covenants to public assets before any re-letting or upgrade | Municipalities |
| Partners | Keep LTO services running through lawful procurement with a development mandate, written into IDPs from 2029 with reporting, using the Provincial Treasury's district reviews | Municipalities; district municipalities; DEDAT; Provincial Treasury |
| Partners | Issue a provincial practice note on the procurement route that Circular 131 leaves open for tourism services | DEDAT; Provincial Treasury |
| National | Commit SAPS to the launch safety plans the pilots need, with a named referral for extortion reports, and open ACSA and other national procurement to businesses trading inside the communities | SAPS; ACSA |
| National | Clarify the points of MFMA Circular No. 131 that remain in dispute for tourism services | National Treasury |

### Why it can work

The model supplies the missing piece and little else. Demand already passes within minutes of most communities. A local seller with a booking route turns that passing demand into bookings, and the gates stop capital from arriving before visitors do. The seller records bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue, so each pilot can be judged on its results.[279]

Resident sellers have outlasted the programmes that launched them. In Rio de Janeiro's Santa Marta, about 20 resident guides ran the tours by 2015 and outside jeep firms had left. Medellín's Comuna 13 drew 1.98 million visitors in 2025 around resident-run product. On Vilakazi Street in Soweto, residents

[278] Inclusion Plan, p31, p32; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5 to p6.
[279] Inclusion Plan, p33.

opened Sakhumzi in 2001 with four employees; it employed about 110 by 2019. The condition is a seller that survives without a sponsor. Costa Rica's community network turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 and did not survive donor exit, dissolving at the end of 2018, though the record names no single cause. The lesson drawn there is an entity with its own selling channel and a succession plan that does not rest on a donor. Most first moves carry no budget line, and the LTOs that would carry a seller depend on municipal funding whose route Circular 131 has changed. No pilot launches until a named municipality or partner has contracted its seller.[280]

**Link forward**

**Initiative I12**, community inclusion pilots (section 4.3), with booking routes shared with **I3** (objective 3). **Indicators** T1-07 community share of foreign direct spend at impact level and T2-17 communities with a live booking route and T2-18 LTOs with a service agreement at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · OBJECTIVE 14

## Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk

Growth has to last. Water already caps visitor load in nodes such as the Garden Route and the flagship nature sites run near capacity in season, while floods, fire and wind close sites and routes. The work divides into three strands: emissions, continuity through shocks and ordinary resource and ecological capacity.

**The challenge**

Growth to 2035 has to stay within what the destination can carry. Water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes such as the Garden Route, and the flagship nature sites run near capacity in season (section 2.3). The pressure weighs most where tourism weighs most. In 2023 tourist spend equalled 15.6% of GDPR in the Overberg and 16.8% on the West Coast, against 6.7% in the Metro. The Garden Route and Central Karoo reviews print identical series, which the Treasury is to confirm (section 5.4).[281]

That growth also rests on sites and routes that weather can close, and the losses already fall on the flagship sites (section 2.4). Each district carries its own climate risk, from water security on the Garden Route to extreme summer heat in the Central Karoo. A risk spread across every district needs an owner in each.[282]

The response divides into three tasks that are often run as one (section 2.4). Adaptation and continuity keep a destination trading through a flood or a fire season. Ordinary resource and ecological capacity sets how many visitors a node can carry in a normal year. Emissions mitigation is a third task with its own measures. The local tourism bodies that would help manage the response are fragile, and their funding route sits under objective 13.[283]

[280] Inclusion Plan, p7, p30, p8, p9, p10, p36.
[281] Diagnostic, p38; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Overberg, p119; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, West Coast, p131; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p72.
[282] Diagnostic, p43; Infrastructure Report, p86.
[283] Stakeholder Insights, p25.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.14.** Evidence for objective 14

> **Climate losses are dated and site-specific, water headroom is planned rather than commissioned and continuity structures exist to build on.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **A flood cut a route** | Meiringspoort closed since the flood of 6 May 2026; rebuild R421m over about 26 months; De Rust's pass-through trade cut; a temporary one-lane reopening is targeted for December 2026 | SCIP p24; Western Cape Government, Jul 2026 |
| **Weather costs a flagship** | Weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year, on management's estimate | SIR p33 |
| **Sites are closing** | Flooding, fire and extreme heat are closing CapeNature sites and restricting trails; high winds close the Cableway for a significant part of the year | SIR p43, p36 |
| **Every district has a climate risk** | Water security in the Metro and the Garden Route; drought, heat and fire in the Cape Winelands; wildflower predictability on the West Coast; whale migration and sea levels in the Overberg; summer heat in the Central Karoo | IR p31, p64, p75, p86; Diag p43, p45 |
| **Supply is stable, headroom is not commissioned** | Cape Town's immediate supply is stable but restriction risk has risen; the first Faure water arrives in 2031, with further augmentation to 2036 | City of Cape Town, Aug 2026 |
| **Floods damaged the reserves** | Floods in May 2026 damaged CapeNature roads, trails and buildings; by June, 85% of reserves reported some damage | CapeNature, 2026 |
| **Continuity structures exist** | A provincial climate response forum, a March 2023 implementation plan, the Water Resilience Strategy 2025 to 2035 and DEDAT's tourism disaster-risk guidance and one-day training | Western Cape Government, 2023 to 2026 |
| **Power has steadied, connections have not** | Eskom reported 539 days without load shedding in November 2026; grid-connection constraints remain | Eskom, 2026; GreenCape, 2026 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag). No deliverable quantifies climate risk province-wide.

The evidence is dated and site-specific, but it does not add up to a provincial picture. No source puts a provincial figure on tourism revenue at risk from weather or water [provincial estimate of tourism revenue at risk: none in hand]. George's and Knysna's capacity figures depend on assets operating, and Blue Drop and Green Drop results do not certify spare capacity for a hotel.

The response exists in pieces. Mossel Bay's membership inspections check water-wise and green practices, the only working sustainability standard on record. CapeNature is reassessing asset formats and siting to cut losses from flooding, fire and extreme weather. What is missing is a provincial record of losses and a stable owner for local destination management.[284]

### The course of action

The work runs in three strands. The first is adaptation and continuity. In 2027 and 2028 DEDAT and Wesgro's Research unit build a climate and weather risk register for sites and routes, starting with the dated losses (section 4.3), and Wesgro routes itineraries around Meiringspoort while it is closed. The second is ordinary resource and ecological capacity. Readiness is assessed by node or supply zone, and continuity arrangements are tested, before public money promotes more demand there. The quality charter carries sustainability checks on the Mossel Bay model (objective 11). The third is emissions mitigation: absolute resource use and emissions are reported beside per-night intensity. From 2029

[284] Stakeholder Insights, p21, p43.

climate risk enters municipal IDPs, with reporting. The route exists: the Provincial Treasury writes its district reviews to inform IDPs and budgets, and they already carry environmental risk data.[285]

The register comes first, because routing, funding and capital choices all depend on knowing which sites close and how often. Three districts then have positions to build on: the Cape Winelands as a climate-smart wine region, the Overberg as a nature-positive test bed and the Garden Route as a case for resilience investment.[286]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Keep a climate and weather risk register for tourism sites and routes, starting with the Robben Island, Cableway and CapeNature losses and the Meiringspoort closure | Research; DEDAT; site operators |
| Wesgro | Build sustainability checks into the provincial quality charter (objective 11) on the Mossel Bay model | Tourism; LTOs |
| Wesgro | Route itineraries and marketing around closures, starting with alternatives to Meiringspoort until the pass reopens | Destination Marketing; Garden Route and Klein Karoo LTOs |
| Wesgro | Report absolute resource use and emissions for tourism beside per-night intensity | Research; DEDAT; operators |
| Partners | Make reserve and attraction assets climate-resilient, with off-grid power at remote sites | CapeNature; site operators |
| Partners | Assess readiness by node or supply zone and test continuity arrangements before publicly supported demand expansion | DEDAT; municipalities; site operators |
| National | Complete the Meiringspoort rebuild | The road authority |

### Why it can work

The register turns scattered losses into decisions. Some losses already carry a figure: weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year, and the Meiringspoort rebuild costs R421m. Once losses are dated and costed by site, Wesgro can route itineraries around a closure and operators can weigh resilience spending against the loss it avoids. Readiness assessments work on the other half. They stop public promotion from sending visitors to a node whose water, power or sites cannot carry them.[287]

The evidence diagnoses this risk more than it prescribes for it. No comparator carries a climate-adaptation or local funding lever, so the precedents are partial. Kenya finances conservation from tourism, a self-financing system that supports conservation and sustains tourism demand. Valencia runs its SICTED quality system with environmental compliance frameworks, and counts a stronger reputation for quality and sustainability among the results. Mossel Bay's inspections show the same checks can work at town scale. The condition is data. Operators and municipalities must share losses, resource use and capacity for the register and the assessments to hold.[288]

### Link forward

**Initiative I13**, destination readiness and climate resilience (section 4.3). **Indicators** T2-19 weather losses at flagship sites at outcome level and T3-25 risk register published at output level (section 5.2).

[285] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p4 to p5.
[286] Diagnostic, p45, p49, p43.
[287] Stakeholder Insights, p33; Inclusion Plan, p24.
[288] Benchmarking, p33, p47.

THEME 3.1 · INVESTMENT, INCLUSION AND SUSTAINABILITY · OBJECTIVE 15

## Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies

The province's capital pipeline funds airports, ports, roads, rail and the Metro waterfront, but almost none of it reaches regional product, bookability or community assets, where the growth case needs investment.

### The challenge

The growth case needs capital where the current pipeline does not reach. Visitors who travel beyond the Metro need beds, a booking route and finished product. The communities need assets a local seller can run. Yet committed capital closes the air gaps, not the regional ones (section 2.3). The province does not lack capital works. It lacks capital aimed at tourism outside the Metro.

Tourism funding is also tight, and below peer destinations (section 2.4). Fiscal pressure is prompting consideration of a tourism levy. The Department of Mobility sees a need for climate, development, blended-finance and private-sector models to fund tourism-enabling mobility. Its draft land transport framework goes further and plans its own business case for a tourist levy, to fund tourism transport. Much of the product gap will therefore fall to private capital, which moves only where a case is ready.[289]

The accommodation gap shows what is at stake, and it is a product question rather than a missing tier. George already has a branded, conference-capable hotel, the Protea Hotel by Marriott George King George, with 109 rooms and four event rooms. The question is which configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing, and where. The Garden Route is short of quality-graded hotels for midweek, conference and business travel. Mossel Bay reports that limited upper-upscale hotel capacity, particularly a recognised brand able to host conferences, holds back its higher-value and business demand.[290]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.15.** Evidence for objective 15

**Capital is committed to gateways and transport, and each district's tourism gaps carry no committed capital.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **The Metro pipeline** | About R30bn or more planned: ~R11.3bn at Cape Town International, R20bn for the V&A Granger Bay expansion and R3.3bn for MyCiTi Phase 2; SME bookability and township product sit outside every capital programme | IR p32 |
| **Airports are funded** | R310m George terminal by 2028; Cape Winelands Airport ~R8bn private phase 1, with funding not yet locked in | IR p43, p106 |
| **Tourism gaps are not** | No committed capital for West Coast accommodation and payments, De Hoop accommodation, Whale Coast bookability, Overberg year-round product or Route 62 accommodation | IR p65, p76, p87 |
| **Port capital is for freight** | Of the port capital listed, only the R22m Mossel Bay reception facility is for cruise | IR p112 |
| **Funding is below peers** | Western Cape tourism funding is materially below peer destinations, and a tourism levy and blended finance are under consideration | SIR p25, p23 |
| **Capital first fails** | Kliptown's Walter Sisulu Square cost R160m to R180m before an operator and drew about 4,000 museum visitors a year by 2017 | SCIP p11 |

[289] Stakeholder Insights, p25, p23; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12.
[290] Infrastructure Report, p94, p95; Stakeholder Insights, p21.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **The gap is a product question** | George has a branded, conference-capable hotel with 109 rooms and four event rooms, the largest seating 300; the missing product differs by place | Marriott, 2026 |
| **A levy has two legal routes** | A municipal tax under sections 4 to 6 of the Municipal Fiscal Powers and Functions Act, or a provincial tax under section 228 of the Constitution and the Provincial Tax Regulation Process Act; either can take more than a year; TOMSA collects a voluntary 1% | Municipal Fiscal Powers and Functions Act, 2007; Provincial Tax Regulation Process Act, 2001; TOMSA, 2026 |
| **An approvals route exists** | DEDAT runs a Red Tape Reduction service and helpline, a route for investment cases held up in approvals | DEDAT, 2026 |
| **Funding routes exist** | The Tourism Transformation Fund has approved 43 transactions worth more than R510.51m nationally (approvals, not disbursements); the IDC takes tourism business cases; the Green Tourism Incentive Programme is closed pending review | National Empowerment Fund, May 2026; IDC, 2026; Department of Tourism, 2026 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; the ~R11.3bn CTIA headline itemises to R9.94bn on p103); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP). No deliverable gives a Western Cape tourism funding-gap figure.

The evidence shows a gap in direction as much as in volume. The district tables list a large capital pipeline, and their gap columns show that none of it reaches regional product, SME bookability or township product. That finding is an inference from the tables rather than a printed statement, and no source gives a Western Cape tourism funding-gap figure [Western Cape tourism funding against the peer set: DEDAT and Wesgro budget data needed]. Kliptown is the warning case: capital built before an operator earned no operating income (section 2.1).

No scored list of tourism investment opportunities exists yet. The district gap-closure tables are its ready input: each names a gap, where it sits and whether any capital is committed to it. Scoring them for return, jobs and inclusion turns a list of needs into a ranked pipeline.

Routes to capital and approval exist, though none is a tourism pipeline. The Tourism Transformation Fund has approved 43 transactions worth more than R510.51 million nationally, which are approvals and not disbursements. The IDC takes tourism business cases, and DEDAT runs a Red Tape Reduction service and helpline. The Green Tourism Incentive Programme is closed pending review. A scored pipeline gives each of these routes cases to work on.

The levy has a legal route and a timetable. A municipal levy is a municipal tax under sections 4 to 6 of the Municipal Fiscal Powers and Functions Act. A provincial levy is a provincial tax under section 228 of the Constitution and the Provincial Tax Regulation Process Act. Either route can take more than a year. The industry already collects a voluntary 1% through TOMSA, so any new charge lands beside an existing one.

### The course of action

Wesgro should build the tourism investment pipeline the gap tables imply, and commit public capital only where demand has been shown. In 2027 and 2028 Wesgro's investment promotion team scores the gaps for return, jobs and inclusion and prepares the first investment cases (section 4.3). Each accommodation case starts from the destination-and-product test run with I10: which configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing, and where. The test compares refurbishment and better use of existing stock with new build on lifecycle cost. The first cases cover the conference-capable and mid-market product the test confirms in secondary nodes, and accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62. From 2029 Wesgro takes the cases to investors. DEDAT, the Department of Mobility and the City of Cape Town then test blended-finance vehicles and one levy case for the visitor economy. The pipeline is refreshed each year.

Approvals need a route as much as capital does. Tourism investment cases held up in approvals go through DEDAT's Red Tape Reduction service as a named tourism case route. The service records the

time each stage takes and the reason for each delay. That record shows investors and municipalities where approvals stall, which no source does today.

One rule runs across the portfolio: invest after demand, and attach a maintenance and marketing covenant to any public asset before it is let or upgraded. The order matters. A levy or a blended-finance vehicle needs projects to fund, so both are tested only once the first cases exist. The levy also needs one case, not two. Separate tourism and transport levies would charge the same visitors twice. DEDAT should therefore agree with the Department of Mobility in 2027 that the Department's levy case covers destination management as well as tourist transport. That is this report's recommendation, not a position either department has taken.[291]

The levy case is set against its legal route and timing. A municipal tax and a provincial tax each follow a statutory process that can take more than a year. No levy proceeds should therefore be assumed for essential near-term operations, which stay on existing budgets. The case also weighs a new charge against the voluntary 1% the industry already collects through TOMSA.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Build a tourism investment pipeline from the gap-closure tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion, and take it to investors | Wesgro investment promotion; Tourism; DEDAT |
| Wesgro | Run the destination-and-product test with I10, then prepare investment cases for the conference-capable and mid-market product it confirms in secondary nodes and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62, comparing refurbishment with new build on lifecycle cost | Wesgro investment promotion; private investors |
| Wesgro | Scale Cape Town Air Access's route fund into the public-private air access fund, with ring-fenced corridor budgets (objective 7) | Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; SA Tourism; private sector |
| Partners | Make one levy case for the visitor economy that covers destination management and tourist transport, set against its legal route and timing, with no levy proceeds assumed for essential near-term operations; test blended-finance vehicles | DEDAT; Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town |
| Partners | Route tourism investment cases through the Red Tape Reduction service, recording stage times and reasons for delay | DEDAT; municipalities |
| Partners | Attach covenants to public assets before re-letting or upgrading them, and invest in community assets only after demand is proven | Municipalities |
| National | Hold ACSA, PRASA and Transnet to their published capital dates, and add tourism use to the port plans | ACSA; PRASA; Transnet |

### Why it can work

A scored pipeline lowers the cost of finding a deal. Investors see ranked cases with demand evidence attached, rather than a list of district needs. Investing after demand reverses the Kliptown sequence, and covenants keep a public asset maintained and marketed after it opens. Wesgro has brokered community-linked capital before, though outside tourism. It brokered IDC funding for the Doringbaai abalone farm in 2015; the village trust holds 37% and the farm employs about 50.[292]

The comparators pair public direction with private capital. Chile funded about US$900 million of expansion at its gateway airport through a private concession awarded by its Ministry of Public Works. Melbourne paired its event strategy with 21% growth in hotel rooms, 5,000 new rooms and the entry of global hotel brands. The condition is demand first. Beds in secondary nodes pay only if the routes, events and booking work in Goals 1 and 2 bring visitors to them.[293]

[291] Inclusion Plan, p31, p15.
[292] Inclusion Plan, p25.
[293] Benchmarking, p26, p18.

### Link forward

**Initiative I14**, tourism investment pipeline (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-20 pipeline projects at financial close at outcome level (section 5.2).

## 3.3.2 Governance and leadership

The second enabling theme covers who decides, who measures and how the plan is run. It holds five objectives. Three build the means of joint decision: three-tier alignment, collaboration with industry and shared policy and data (objectives 16 to 18). Two apply them to specific gaps. Objective 19 escalates the national deficits in infrastructure, visas and safety. Objective 20 builds workforce skills on a labour analysis still to be commissioned.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · OBJECTIVE 16

## Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers

Air service agreements and visas sit with national government, mandates are split across three tiers and the national marketing body is under strain, so the province needs one shared agenda with clear decision rights.

### The challenge

The levers the growth case needs are spread across three tiers of government, and none of them answers to one plan. The national tier holds visa rules, air service agreements and route rights. The province holds jobs, safety programmes and infrastructure planning. Local government holds basic services and precinct management. The levers that bind growth most sit nationally (section 2.4). The province must therefore move decisions it does not make.[294]

The bodies that should carry this work have thinned. The Department of Economic Development finds that tourism institutional capacity has eroded over a decade at provincial and municipal level. Even working partnerships lapse. FEDHASA reports that the Discover Garden Route MOU has expired, and that Knysna municipality's non-participation limited its reach. Without one provincial voice, each ask reaches the national tier from several directions or not at all.[295]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.16.** Evidence for objective 16

**The levers the growth case needs are spread across three tiers, and the bodies that hold them are thin or out of step.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **National holds air rights and visas** | The national tier holds visa rules and border compliance, and air service agreements and route rights; the province holds jobs, safety programmes and infrastructure planning | Diag p58 |
| **Bilateral agreements bind** | Restrictive bilateral air agreements limit airlift and leave the province less competitive than peers (Department of Economic Development) | SIR p24 |
| **Chinese routes are state decisions** | Chinese routes follow government-to-government agreements, and the designated airline may learn of its designation late | MIDAS, Chinese Market Opportunity |
| **Capacity has eroded** | Tourism institutional capacity has eroded at provincial and municipal level over a decade; SA Tourism's weakness constrains otherwise sound international strategies | SIR p25 |

[294] Diagnostic, p58.
[295] Stakeholder Insights, p25, p31.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Mandates are split** | Mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers; a district, local and LTO mandate disconnect leaves tourism development without a clear owner | SIR p23, p39 |
| **The capital is national** | ACSA's runway (R6.39bn, about 2033), Transnet's port plans and PRASA's R21.1bn rail programme all sit with national SOEs | IR p100, p103, p112 |

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; statements attributed to organisations, not quotations); MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026; Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR). The only national government bodies with an appendix table in the first phase of engagement, Stats SA and the Department of Tourism, speak to data alone; SA Tourism has none.

The evidence agrees on the problem and is thin on the fix. What is needed is a shared growth agenda with clear decision rights and joint delivery plans. No source maps decision rights by tier beyond one summary table. The national tier is barely heard: the Department of Tourism and Stats SA spoke only to data, and SA Tourism has no recorded view. The first task is therefore to hear the national tier directly and write down who decides what. For the districts, one design is already on record. The Tourism Blueprint 2030 recommends tourism coordination at district level, with regional tourism organisations run as non-profits, funded by district municipalities and seating the LTOs. It also asks for the LTO model to be set in law. The Blueprint's targets were set before COVID, so this action plan treats its model as a position to test, not a settled design. The mandate settlement below and the LTO service agreements in objective 13 test it against Circular 131.[296]

### The course of action

Wesgro should convene the shared agenda and hold the evidence the national tier needs, rather than try to own levers it cannot. In the first quarter of 2027 the Wesgro CEO's office and DEDAT constitute a Tourism Growth Steerco (section 4.2). Wesgro's CEO and DEDAT's Head of Department co-chair it, with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member (section 4.7). Steerco agrees a decision-rights map by tier and tables the first national escalation agenda (objective 19). It gives the province one voice and one route to national decisions. Steerco should also connect to the tourism coordinating cluster the City's Tourism Development Framework proposed, if the City set it up.[297]

Route work runs alongside, inside existing agreements, through standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities and with China's state-owned carriers (section 4.4).[298]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco, co-chaired with DEDAT and with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member, and agree a decision-rights map by tier, building on the tier split in section 1.1 | Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism |
| Wesgro | Hold standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities, with China Southern and China Eastern and with Riyadh Air | Air Access |
| Wesgro | Track the national capital programmes that bind the plan (runway, ports and rail) and report on them each quarter | Air Access; Research |
| Partners | Settle district, local and LTO mandates, testing the Blueprint's district model for regional tourism organisations, restore a tourism development function where it has lapsed and revisit the Discover Garden Route partnership | District municipalities; municipalities; LTOs |
| Partners | Test a dedicated transport authority model for tourism-enabling mobility | Department of Mobility |
| National | Agree with the province how marketing and data roles divide between national and provincial bodies | SA Tourism; Department of Tourism |

[296] Diagnostic, p58; Stakeholder Insights, p16, p30, p37; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p8, p4.
[297] City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5 to p6.
[298] MIDAS, "The Indian Market Opportunity", "The Chinese Market Opportunity".

### Why it can work

Alignment works by settling ownership before it is contested. A decision-rights map shows each tier what it owns, so provincial and local bodies stop waiting on decisions that are theirs to make. One forum then speaks for the province, so national bodies receive one position rather than several. Where the comparators name the body that negotiates air service agreements, it is national: Chile's civil aviation board and Singapore's aviation authority. The province's lever is evidence and alignment, not authority.[299]

Coordination across tiers works where it is permanent. A public-private structure led by Visit València embeds municipal, provincial and regional authorities in one decision-making system. The change asked of the Western Cape is to embed tourism governance in permanent public-private structures. Yet coordination strains even among the leaders: in Victoria, roles and branding remain a source of tension between national and state bodies. The condition is national engagement. The plan works only if the national tier takes part in Steerco's agenda and answers its asks, which section 5.2 tracks.[300]

### Link forward

**Initiative I15**, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment, carries this entry with objective 17 (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-21 escalation items answered by the national tier at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · OBJECTIVE 17

## Strengthen industry and government collaboration

Fifteen of the sixteen organisations heard raised collaboration, and the channels already exist in the industry associations' joint forum (JAMMS), the bid teams and the tour-operator forums, so the task is to turn existing forums into one joint plan.

### The opportunity

Collaboration is one of the two concerns stakeholders share most widely, and the channels for it already work. Fifteen of the 16 organisations heard raised it, as many as raised data sharing (section 2.4). FEDHASA reports that Western Cape tourism associations already coordinate through JAMMS with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town. C-BRTA cites biannual tour-operator forums, and the Department of Tourism cites statistics committees that already convene public and private stakeholders. The province does not need another forum. It needs the forums it has to plan together.[301]

Joint work already pays where the task is concrete. Mossel Bay's cruise calls rose from four before Covid to 27 a season, supported by closer coordination and better excursion packaging. The town credits its public-private tourism model with faster decisions. The CTICC finds the same on bids: destination stakeholders collaborate effectively on bid development and international event attraction.[302]

Growth to 2035 needs that discipline applied to development, and here the system falls short. The West Coast District Municipality finds provincial and regional forums dominated by destination marketing rather than development. Operators are represented only through LTOs and business chambers, so private participants are sometimes unaware of tourism plans and projects. The Department of Economic Development reports that misalignment between public tourism institutions and key industry bodies is weakening collaboration.[303]

[299] Benchmarking, p23, p38.
[300] Benchmarking, p47, p49, p16.
[301] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, p31, p28, p37; a rough count of organisations with at least one collaboration insight, taken from the appendix tables by organisation and not weighted by insight row.
[302] Stakeholder Insights, p20, p21, p46.
[303] Stakeholder Insights, p39, p25.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.17.** Evidence for objective 17

**Collaboration is wanted almost everywhere and already works in places, but the forums are marketing-led and the trade's voice is missing.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Almost everyone raised it** | 15 of the 16 organisations raised at least one collaboration insight, 23 rows in all | SIR p20 to p46 |
| **A channel exists** | Tourism associations already coordinate through JAMMS with Wesgro, the Western Cape Government and the City of Cape Town (FEDHASA) | SIR p31 |
| **Out of step** | Misalignment between public tourism institutions and key industry bodies is weakening collaboration (Department of Economic Development) | SIR p25 |
| **Forums are marketing-led** | Provincial and regional forums are dominated by destination marketing rather than development, and support is not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality) | SIR p39 |
| **Joint selling works** | Stakeholders collaborate well on bids; 36 conference bids secured in 2024/25 are expected to bring 27,000+ delegates and R745 million by 2028 | SIR p46; DSA p36 |
| **The trade is missing** | No airline, OTA or tour operator gave a recorded view | SIR p16 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA).

The record describes a system that collaborates to sell and stalls when it must plan. Joint work succeeds on a bid, a cruise call or a route, where the task is bounded and the payoff shared. It weakens on development, where no forum owns the agenda and operators sit one step removed. The airlines and distributors that fill the seats are also absent. No airline, online travel agency or tour operator gave a recorded view.[304]

### The course of action

Wesgro uses the forums that exist and gives them a development agenda and one joint plan. In 2027 it adopts JAMMS as the single channel to the associations, because FEDHASA expects consultation through it to cascade more efficiently than approaching each body separately. It adds the Tour Guides Association, so frontline operators have a voice. Sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture are designed inside Steerco's structure (section 4.7) and run from 2029 (section 4.3).[305]

Partners carry the regional and bidding work. District municipalities, DEDAT and the LTOs give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs. The CTICC and the universities supply the academic and sector champions on whom international bids depend. Nationally, the province asks SA Tourism to include provincial assets in its campaigns for emerging source markets, which Robben Island Museum also seeks. From 2029 the joint industry plan is agreed and reviewed each year.[306]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Use JAMMS as the single consultation channel to the associations, and add the Tour Guides Association | Wesgro CEO's office; FEDHASA |
| Wesgro | Set up sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture inside Steerco's structure | Tourism; Convention Bureau; industry bodies |
| Wesgro | Bring airlines, online travel agencies and tour operators into the joint plan, starting with Trip.com Group, Thomas Cook India, dnata Travel, China International Travel Service and Emirates | Destination Marketing; Air Access |

[304] Stakeholder Insights, p16.
[305] Stakeholder Insights, p31.
[306] Stakeholder Insights, p46, p33.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Partners | Supply academic and sector champions for international bids | CTICC; universities |
| Partners | Give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs | District municipalities; DEDAT; LTOs |
| National | Include provincial assets in SA Tourism's campaigns for emerging source markets | SA Tourism |

### Why it can work

A joint plan gives each forum a decision to make, not just information to exchange. Sector councils give wine, business events, adventure and culture a standing seat, so the market, not officials, sets development priorities. Shared targets already pay here. Cape Town secured 36 conference bids in 2024/25, expected to bring more than 27,000 delegates and R745 million in economic impact through 2028. Cape Town also added 17 mainline international routes from 2015 to 2025, more than any of eight secondary airports in the comparison. That record is credited to Wesgro's commercial and relationship-driven route development.[307]

Valencia shows the model at destination scale. Sector-led executive committees, with the regional business confederation on the governing board, keep tourism development market-driven rather than bureaucratically led. Valencia received 3.5 million international visitors in 2024, 24.4% above 2019. That performance is credited to governance that is decentralised, sector-led and embedded across the destination. Singapore's tourism board, airport group and national airline work under one coordinated strategy with shared KPIs. The condition is commitment from industry. The plan holds only if the associations and the trade sign up, so the number of partners signed up is its measure of success (section 5.2).[308]

### Link forward

**Initiative I15**, Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-22 industry partners signed up to the joint plan at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · OBJECTIVE 18

## Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing

Provincial measures of tourism GDP and jobs are still to be built, operators cannot see their own customers and the arrivals series run unreconciled, so a data-sharing protocol is the precondition for every target.

### The challenge

Measuring what the plan sets out to grow is the first data task. Provincial tourism GDP and jobs need a method (section 2.4), and the Department of Tourism adds that official tourism GDP and employment data have lagged since Covid-era method changes. Data sharing draws more stakeholder insights than any other theme, as section 2.4 shows. Bodies from Stats SA and SA Tourism to ACSA, the airlines and the card schemes produce tourism data. Yet they collect different metrics at different frequencies with different definitions.[309]

Every target to 2035 depends on fixing this. The plan tracks spend, season and spread beside arrivals. No source yet prints visitor spend by district (section 5.3). The nearest measure is tourist spend as a share of each district's GDPR. The Provincial Treasury's district reviews print it, from Wesgro and S&P Global Market Intelligence data. Even arrivals are counted in ways that are not reconciled. Appendix A2 sets out

[307] Demand-Side Analysis, p36; MIDAS, "Executive Summary", "International Comparisons".
[308] Benchmarking, p45, p48, p49, p46, p60, p40, p42.
[309] Stakeholder Insights, p37; Diagnostic, p56, p57.

three measures: ACSA passenger arrivals, SA Tourism tourist arrivals and the growth model's international arrivals. OAG's air series adds a fourth count. Without a shared data layer, no intervention can be targeted or measured.[310]

Policy and the operators' own data are as thin. The Department of Economic Development reports a provincial tourism policy gap, with limited legislation and out-of-date master-planning frameworks. At the sites, third-party ticketing channels do not share visitor-level data with the Table Mountain Aerial Cableway. Robben Island Museum cannot link its marketing spend to visitor acquisition.[311]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.18.** Evidence for objective 18

**Data is the largest theme in the stakeholder record, and the gaps run from national methodology to operators' own customer records.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **The largest theme** | 15 of 16 organisations and 30 insight rows, the most of any theme, 16 of them rated High | SIR p20 to p46 |
| **No provincial method** | Provincial tourism GDP and jobs await an approved method (section 2.4); official data lag after Covid-era method changes, and the tourism satellite account is slowed by 749 Stats SA vacancies (Department of Tourism) | SIR p37, p30 |
| **No single view** | No single view of visitor behaviour; stakeholders collect different metrics at different frequencies with different definitions | Diag p56, p57 |
| **Operators cannot see customers** | Third-party ticketing channels do not share visitor-level data; Robben Island cannot link marketing spend to visitor acquisition | SIR p36, p33 |
| **Platforms exist** | JAMMS, the provincial tourism statistics committees and a cross-agency task team exist; the Cape Town Tourism and Google collaboration is still exploratory | SIR p29, p30, p31, p37 |
| **Provincial holders exist** | The Provincial Treasury's reviews print spend per visitor by region of origin and, by district, attraction counts, bed-nights and tourist spend as a share of GDPR; the Department of Mobility's Integrated Transport Hub is the province's most comprehensive transport data repository | PERO p67; MERO p68 to p73; PLTF p3-60 |
| **Short-term rentals are largely uncounted** | A March 2026 snapshot of one platform counted 26,991 listings in Cape Town; the City consulted from August to October 2026 on registration and platform data sharing | Inside Airbnb, Mar 2026; City of Cape Town, 2026 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025 (PERO); Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro (MERO); Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025 (PLTF).

The evidence locates the gap in sharing, not in supply. Provincial macro-research is strong; what is missing is granular data on movement within regions and conversion along the path to purchase. The platforms to share it exist in JAMMS, the statistics committees and a cross-agency task team. None of them holds an agreement on what each body shares, in what form and how often. No source describes a data-sharing protocol or a policy revision in progress at provincial level [data-sharing protocol or policy revision in progress, with owner and start date: Wesgro Research and DEDAT to confirm].[312]

Part of the gap is national and beyond the province's reach. Stats SA cites 749 vacancies as one factor that appears to slow the tourism satellite account. The province can agree terms with data holders now. A recognised provincial jobs and GDP method needs the Department of Tourism.[313]

[310] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p8 to p9, p72; Demand-Side Analysis, p11, p13, p20, p27; Infrastructure Report, p5.
[311] Stakeholder Insights, p25, p36, p33.
[312] Diagnostic, p56, p57.
[313] Stakeholder Insights, p30.

### The course of action

Wesgro's Research unit agrees data-sharing terms with each data holder and runs one indicator register and dashboard, as section 5.5 sets out. In 2027 it builds the register and agrees terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the site operators and the booking platforms. It also agrees terms with the Provincial Treasury for the data behind the Treasury's reviews and with the Department of Mobility for its Integrated Transport Hub. In 2028 the dashboard goes live with automated arrivals, seat and cruise feeds and quarterly digital tracking (section 4.3). The dashboard sets campaign results against airline capacity and hotel trends, and annual or twice-yearly brand research sits beside it. Wesgro also starts to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions. Meetings are absent from consolidated provincial statistics, and the scale of the other two is unverified.[314]

Short-term rentals need their own agreement. Wesgro Research and the municipalities agree a lawful, property-level evidence agreement with the platforms and municipal valuers. It lets listings, active letting and nights be counted by ward and district, within data-protection law. The agreement builds on the City's consultation on registration and platform data sharing (section 2.3). It supplies the accommodation audit in objective 11, and it gives the resident debate measured facts.

Partners and the national tier hold the rest. Attraction operators and CapeNature share visitor-level data from their ticketing and reservation systems. DEDAT and the municipalities close the provincial policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting, as the West Coast District Municipality asks. Nationally, the province asks the Department of Tourism to approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and Stats SA to resource the tourism satellite account.[315]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Agree data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the Provincial Treasury, the Department of Mobility, the site operators and the booking platforms | Research |
| Wesgro | Run one indicator register and dashboard, with quarterly digital tracking and annual brand research | Research; programme office |
| Wesgro | Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions | Research; Convention Bureau |
| Partners | Close the provincial tourism policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting | DEDAT; municipalities |
| Partners | Share visitor-level data from ticketing and reservation systems | Attraction operators; CapeNature |
| Partners | Agree a lawful property-level short-term rental evidence agreement with platforms and municipal valuers | Municipalities; City of Cape Town; booking platforms; Research |
| National | Approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account | Department of Tourism; Stats SA |

### Why it can work

A protocol fixes definitions once, so the data the province already has begins to add up. The arrivals measures can be bridged, so each is read against the others and the growth model is checked against counted arrivals. Spend and spread gain a district baseline. Operators who see their own customers can price, target and report, which gives them a reason to share. The dashboard also gives Steerco one set of facts, so collaboration (objective 17) argues over decisions rather than numbers.

New Zealand shows what shared data can support. Data shared between tourism bodies and airlines is one of four enablers of its route-accountable marketing, with airport readiness, route incentives and co-investment tied to route KPIs. That marketing reports more than 16,000 incremental bookings and a return

[314] Digital Insights memo, 10 Dec 2025, section 6; Demand-Side Analysis, p36.
[315] Stakeholder Insights, p39.

of about NZ$55 million in 2023/24. Valencia is the realism check: integrating data systems across institutions there can create technical and organisational challenges. The condition is consent. Each data holder must sign, so the number of agreements signed is the first measure of progress (section 4.3).[316]

### Link forward

**Initiative I16**, data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-23 automated data feeds in the dashboard at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · OBJECTIVE 19

## Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits

Visas, air rights, the runway and policing sit with national government, so the province leads by escalation backed with evidence, and delivers the safety programmes and basic services that are its own.

### The challenge

Visas, air rights, airport capacity and policing shape how many visitors reach the province and how safe they feel. The province holds few of these levers. National government holds visa rules, border compliance and air service agreements. The province holds safety programmes and local government holds basic services. ACSA, a national body, holds the runway (section 2.4). Escalation is therefore the province's main tool for the national share.[317]

The deficits bear hardest on the markets the growth case needs. Chinese and Middle Eastern travellers face slow, document-heavy visa processes. The Table Mountain Aerial Cableway cites visas as a constraint on growth from India and recovery from China, and the CTICC on regional African events.[318]

Inside the province, safety and basic services gate both visits and community growth. Nine of the 20 shortlisted communities record a safety-perception gap and five record extortion. A formal safety assessment remains a separate requirement before any community product launches. Two provincial documents and the City's framework name safety as a constraint, and the City's stakeholders rank it the first priority for growth. The road from the airport is one concern. The Department of Mobility's draft framework flags the N2 from Cape Town International as a congestion and safety problem for tourists. Congestion costs the Metro an estimated R2.8 billion a year, and water scarcity acts as a hard ceiling on visitor load in high-growth nodes. Here the province and the municipalities hold part of the answer.[319]

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.19.** Evidence for objective 19

**Ten of the 16 organisations raise the deficits, and most of the levers sit with national government or SOEs.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Raised widely** | 10 of 16 organisations raised the theme; across all themes, safety perception came from seven organisations, visas from four and utilities from four | SIR p20 to p46 |
| **Visas hold back growth markets** | Visa issues constrain growth from India and recovery from China; regional African event demand is visa-constrained | SIR p36, p45 |
| **Safety is cross-cutting** | Perceptions of crime feature in overseas sales conversations; township product and shared mobility are held back by safety perception | SIR p46, p34, p22 |

[316] Benchmarking, p54, p45.
[317] Diagnostic, p58.
[318] Demand-Side Analysis, p51; Stakeholder Insights, p36, p45.
[319] Inclusion Plan, p30, p35; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p4; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4; Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p4; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12; Diagnostic, p38.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **Safety and visas top the barriers** | Skift's barrier research ranks crime and personal safety first and visa and entry requirements second; the Diagnostic judged e-visa reforms promising but unproven for the province | Diag p55, p34 |
| **The gateway binds** | The single main runway caps movements at about 30 an hour; terminal relief lands about 2032 and runway relief about 2033; immigration processing at peak needs work | IR p101 to p103; DSA p54 |
| **Visa reform is credited with arrivals** | Ghanaian arrivals to South Africa reached 36,656 in 2024, up 149%; the waiver began on 1 November 2023, and the rise is credited to the waiver, marketing and airlift together | Skift African, s4.6 |
| **The ETA replaces the eVisa** | Launched on 12 August 2026 after pilot access for China, India, Indonesia and Mexico; reported open to 53 nationalities by early November 2026, with the eVisa platform to close on 1 December 2026; a R500 processing fee since 17 August 2026 | Presidency, Aug 2026; trade reporting, Nov 2026 |
| **Group visas have a record** | The Trusted Tour Operator Scheme had issued 49,725 visas by 22 January 2026, an approval rate of about 95%; 45 operators joined the original 65 in August 2025 | Home Affairs APP 2026/27 |
| **African entry differs by passport** | Ghana and Kenya ordinary passports have 90 days a year; Nigeria is not ordinarily exempt; SADC membership confers no uniform waiver; no comparable processing-time series exists for visa-required African markets | South African High Commission, London, Nov 2026 |
| **Safety services run** | DEDAT's 2026/27 plan funds the City's Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit at high-volume central-city attractions, a Tourism Safety and Support service and a twice-yearly Provincial Tourism Safety Forum; N2 patrols logged 2,895 motorist assists from September 2024 to January 2026 | DEDAT APP 2026/27; City of Cape Town, Jan 2026 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation counts reconstructed from the appendix tables); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Skift, Barriers to visiting Cape Town, 2024, as cited); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Skift African Market Analysis, 16 Mar 2026 (working analysis; arrivals to South Africa, not Cape Town).

Stakeholders raise the deficits widely. Ten of the 16 organisations raised them, and safety perception alone came from seven. Yet even this evidence, broad as it is, is statement rather than measure. No visa processing time is in hand for any priority market (section 5.2). The nearest national measure is now history: in its first year the eVisa processed fewer than half its applications and rejected 93% of those it decided.[320]

The entry system has since changed. The Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA) launched on 12 August 2026, after pilot access for China, India, Indonesia and Mexico (section 2.4). By early November 2026 it was reported as open to 53 nationalities, with the eVisa platform due to close on 1 December 2026. Both priority growth markets therefore apply through the ETA. Yet a visa issued is not an arrival, and no series shows ETA decision times, refusals or arrivals by nationality. The Trusted Tour Operator Scheme gives the nearest operating record: 49,725 visas issued by 22 January 2026, at an approval rate of about 95%.

National reform can move arrivals, though rarely alone. Ghana's visa waiver began on 1 November 2023, and Ghanaian arrivals to South Africa reached 36,656 in 2024, up 149%. The rise is credited to the waiver, marketing and airlift together. The ETA and the Trusted Tour Operator Scheme are promising, but their effect on Western Cape arrivals is not yet proven. The province's task is to make the case for reform in its own markets, with its own numbers.[321]

African entry rules differ passport by passport. Ghana and Kenya ordinary passports carry 90 days a year, and Botswana and Zimbabwe sit in the 90-day category. Nigeria is not ordinarily exempt, and SADC membership confers no uniform waiver (section 2.4). The reported ETA list covers 17 African markets, Ghana, Kenya and Nigeria among them, yet access to the platform does not change a traveller's visa

[320] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46, counted; BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p12.
[321] African Markets, s4.6; arrivals to South Africa, not Cape Town; Diagnostic, p34.

status. No comparable processing-time series exists for the visa-required African markets. Regional event demand therefore cannot yet be set against entry performance.

The province's own safety services already run. DEDAT's 2026/27 Annual Performance Plan funds the City's Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit at high-volume central-city attractions. It also runs a Tourism Safety and Support service and convenes a Provincial Tourism Safety Forum twice a year. Cape Town Tourism's TravelWise network and the City's 24/7 visitor-support service operate. The City records 2,895 motorist assists by N2 patrols from September 2024 to January 2026. An assist is not a crime rate, and the open questions are coverage, eligibility and handoffs between services, not existence.

**The course of action**

The initiative runs two workstreams, and the first is access escalation. Wesgro runs a standing escalation agenda at Steerco. Each item names the decision, the national body that owns it and the date the province asks for. The first agenda is tabled in 2027 (section 4.3). It covers entry for China, India, the Middle East and Africa, air service agreements and immigration throughput at Cape Town International. The visa asks start from DEDAT's visa regime study, which ranks published processing times first and visa exemption for China, India and Nigeria second. The agenda takes the reforms that bear on visitors and first checks what has moved since 2024. Wesgro's Advocacy and Advisory unit was set up to build evidence-based policy feedback on levers the province does not control. Once Wesgro confirms its remit, the unit runs the agenda day to day. Research and Destination Marketing build the evidence for each ask, market by market. Stakeholder insights already point to the evidence needed: the safety issues most damaging to demand and the access barriers across air, visas and onward travel.[322]

The visa ask is rebuilt around how the ETA performs. The province asks Home Affairs for monthly figures by priority nationality: applications, completions, median and 90th-percentile decision times, refusals by reason and appeals. It also asks for authorisations matched to arrivals, because a visa issued is not an arrival. The agenda adds an African passport matrix, which sets each priority African market's entry terms beside its leisure and event demand. A delegate escalation channel completes the workstream: the Convention Bureau raises stalled applications from delegates to confirmed congresses.

The second workstream is tourism safety, and it builds on services that already run. The Metro needs dedicated tourism safety units and programmes. The City's framework for 2019 to 2024 set out secure zones, a Tourist Police unit, victim support and safety forums, and DEDAT now funds the City's Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit (section 2.4). From 2027 the City, the Western Cape Government, SAPS and SANParks agree one referral pathway, so a visitor or an operator meets a single route to help. The pathway names aftercare for serious cases and safeguards for the workers who respond. Handoffs between services are tested on real scenarios, such as an airport-road breakdown or a missing person. SAPS keeps command throughout. The workstream is reviewed at the end of 2028, before any expansion beyond the pilot hotspots.[323]

The rest of the local share runs in parallel. Safety compacts follow in pilot communities. Municipalities and CapeNature fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns. Wesgro carries a visitor-safety narrative in its marketing. It applies the four launch gates set in objective 13 to any community product it sells. From 2029 responses to the national asks are logged and followed up each quarter.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Table an escalation agenda at Steerco: entry through the ETA for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements; immigration throughput at Cape Town International | Wesgro CEO's office; Advocacy and Advisory unit; DEDAT |

[322] BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p34; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p27; Stakeholder Insights, p14.
[323] Diagnostic, p41; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5.

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Build the market-by-market evidence for each ask, including an African passport matrix, from the reforms DEDAT's visa study ranks to safety perception in source markets | Research; Destination Marketing |
| Wesgro | Run a delegate escalation channel for stalled applications from delegates to confirmed congresses | Convention Bureau; Advocacy and Advisory unit; Home Affairs |
| Wesgro | Carry a visitor-safety narrative in marketing, and apply the four launch gates set in objective 13 to any community product Wesgro sells | Destination Marketing; Tourism |
| Partners | Build on the running safety services with one referral pathway, named aftercare for serious cases, worker safeguards and tested handoffs; review at the end of 2028 before expansion; safety compacts in pilot communities | City of Cape Town; Western Cape Government; DEDAT; municipalities; SAPS; SANParks; Cape Town Tourism |
| Partners | Fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns | Municipalities; CapeNature |
| Partners | Study congestion on the N2 from Cape Town International and sustain the highway patrols on the airport corridor, with their cost carried once, in this initiative | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town |
| National | Publish monthly ETA performance by priority nationality: applications, completions, decision times, refusals, appeals and authorisations matched to arrivals; decide on air service agreements and immigration counters; make station security a rail line item | Home Affairs; Department of Transport; PRASA |

### Why it can work

Escalation works when the ask is specific and the evidence is local. The method has already moved decisions taken elsewhere. Cape Town added 17 mainline international routes from 2015 to 2025, more than any of eight secondary-airport peers, a record credited to Wesgro's commercial and relationship-driven route development (objective 17). A standing agenda keeps each ask alive across budget cycles, so a refusal becomes a follow-up rather than an end. It also gives coordination one anchor. Chile's coordination is most powerful when anchored around a single strategic constraint, long-haul access. Action on its own share, from safety units to basic services, strengthens the province's hand when it asks others to act.[324]

Chile shows what national access policy can achieve. It runs one of the world's most liberal aviation systems, using open-skies agreements, strong aviation institutions and private sector participation. Passenger traffic at Santiago's airport rose from about 16 million in 2010 to more than 26 million in 2019. For the Western Cape, the lesson is to lobby actively for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes. Kenya reduces entry friction to position Nairobi as a regional hub. No comparator shows a region escalating to its national government, so the province's own record is the first real test. The condition is a national answer. The province cannot compel one, so it measures what it can: ETA decision times in priority markets and the share of its asks answered (section 5.2).[325]

Publishing entry outcomes is the practice to ask for. Kenya replaced visas with an ETA in 2024 and reports 2,186,816 authorisations at an average three-day turnaround in 2024/25 (Appendix A3). The province can ask for the same openness, though only national government can change the rules.

### Link forward

**Initiative I17**, access and safety escalation agenda, with its two workstreams (section 4.3). **Indicators** T2-24 ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals for priority markets, T2-29 tourism safety response and completed handoffs in pilot hotspots and T2-21 escalation items answered at outcome level (section 5.2).

[324] Benchmarking, p59.
[325] Benchmarking, p23, p25, p26, p28, p59.

THEME 3.2 · GOVERNANCE AND LEADERSHIP · OBJECTIVE 20

## Develop workforce and service skills

The 300,000 tourism-linked jobs ambition needs a measure before it becomes a target, so the first step is an employer-linked labour analysis in 2027 that sets the baseline, and the skills plan follows from it.

### The challenge

Counting the jobs that growth creates is execution work, and this objective starts it. The ambition of 300,000 tourism-linked jobs is one of four headline ambitions, and it still needs a base year, a baseline and a target year. A labour analysis supplies them, on a provincial method the plan builds (section 2.4). That section also sets out why a jobs baseline comes before a jobs target.[326]

Jobs matter to the action plan as much as arrivals. Wesgro's mission is to drive inclusive and sustainable growth and create jobs in Cape Town and the Western Cape. Service quality also rests on people. Mossel Bay names inconsistent restaurant quality and service delivery as a major weakness. CapeNature is cautious about scaling international demand because service readiness is uneven across its sites.[327]

Yet skills gaps surface only in passing. CapeNature finds low baseline skills in communities near reserves, which need substantial upskilling before they can meet service standards. The West Coast District Municipality reports stretched municipal officials, and the Overberg calls for substantial mentoring and business support. Each is a statement, not a measure.[328]

A vacancy does not prove a skills shortage. Industry employment totals cannot identify unfilled posts. A post can also stay open because of pay, seasonal contracts or the cost of commuting, none of which training fixes. The analysis therefore has to separate skills scarcity from the conditions of the job.

### What the evidence shows

**Table 3.20.** Evidence for objective 20

**The provincial tourism employment figure is still to be built, and the skills evidence so far is a handful of statements and two training programmes.**

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **The ambition needs a base** | 300,000 tourism-linked jobs, one of four headline ambitions, still to be given a base year, baseline and target year | Inc p4 |
| **A provincial method to build** | Provincial tourism GDP and jobs estimates await an approved methodology (Department of Tourism; section 2.4) | SIR p37 |
| **Skills gaps near reserves and in municipalities** | Low baseline skills near reserves need upskilling before service standards can be met (CapeNature); local municipalities face skills and staffing constraints, with support not tailored to districts (West Coast District Municipality) | SIR p43, p39 |
| **Training exists in places** | 20 CATHSSETA site guides certified in Mbekweni in August 2026; a hospitality academy in Prince Albert from early 2026 | SCIP p42, p51 |
| **Guide registration is under pressure** | DEDAT records application growth, overtime and burnout in guide registration and commits to workflow fixes; national Mandarin training of about 30 guides in early 2026 is not 30 more Western Cape guides | DEDAT APP 2026/27; Department of Tourism, 2026 |
| **Grants are a route, not a count** | CATHSSETA's 2026/27 discretionary grants offer a funding route; industry employment totals cannot identify unfilled posts | CATHSSETA, 2026 |

[326] Inception Report, p4; Stakeholder Insights, p37.
[327] Inception Report, p5; Stakeholder Insights, p20, p43.
[328] Stakeholder Insights, p43, p39, p27.

| Finding | Figure | Source |
|---|---|---|
| **One provincial series** | 1,701 full-time equivalent cruise jobs in the Western Cape in 2025/26, and 1,234 direct and 2,345 total in 2024/25, the only provincial tourism jobs figures in hand | Prospectus p29; StratEcon p24, p27; Diag p37 |
| **Cape Town's counts differ** | About 45,000 direct and 150,000 total tourism jobs in the City's framework, about 3.3 total for each direct job; 106,707 direct jobs in the City's 2024 count | TDF p3; City of Cape Town, 2025 |

Source: Inception Report, Nov 2025 (Inc); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag). StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025 (StratEcon), the study the Diagnostic cites. Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026 (Prospectus). City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024 (TDF); City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025. The ratio of total to direct jobs is computed.

The evidence holds parts but no whole. The only provincial tourism jobs figures in hand are for cruise. Wesgro's prospectus reports 1,701 full-time equivalent jobs in the province for the 2025/26 season. StratEcon's study of 2024/25 reports 1,234 direct jobs in the Western Cape and 2,345 in total, and the two seasons may not share a definition. Public sources give the scale the analysis must work from. Direct tourism employment was 106,707 in Cape Town in 2024 and 953,981 nationally. Some municipal counts exist too, such as 12,015 tourism jobs in Knysna in 2024.[329]

The City's own counts differ, probably by definition and date. Its Tourism Development Framework gives about 45,000 direct jobs and about 150,000 in total. That direct count is under half the City's 2024 figure. The framework's figures imply about 3.3 total jobs for each direct job. On that ratio the 300,000 ambition means about 90,000 direct jobs on the framework's definition. The ambition can be judged only once its definition and base are fixed.[330]

A provincial figure exists in a source Wesgro holds. The Pero 2025 carries a tourism employment table that this report could not retrieve [provincial tourism employment from the Pero 2025: Wesgro Research to extract]. Training also exists in places, from the CATHSSETA site guides certified in Mbekweni to the hospitality academy in Prince Albert. What is missing is the sizing step that links these pieces to the growth case.[331]

The funding and the pressure points are visible, but the vacancies are not. CATHSSETA's 2026/27 discretionary grants offer a funding route, not a vacancy count. DEDAT's plan records pressure on guide registration, from application growth to overtime and burnout, and commits to workflow fixes (objective 11). National Mandarin training of about 30 guides in early 2026 does not add 30 guides in the Western Cape. Only employers' own records, by occupation, place and season, can show where posts stay open and why.

### The course of action

Wesgro and DEDAT commission a tourism labour analysis in 2027, and it is employer-linked. It draws on employers' own records by occupation, place and season. It fixes a provincial employment baseline and definition, tests the 300,000 ambition and identifies the occupations and skills the growth case needs. It separates skills scarcity from pay, seasonal contracts and commuting, because each needs a different response. The test starts with whether the ambition counts direct or total jobs. Before the analysis starts, Wesgro Research extracts the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025. Chapter 5 takes the jobs baseline from the analysis and sets the targets at the first gate, at the end of 2028, so the baseline must be in place by then (sections 4.7 and 5.3).

The skills plan follows the analysis and runs through the provincial quality charter (objective 11). The Singapore lesson behind it pairs a province-wide quality framework with investment in workforce

[329] Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29; StratEcon, Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025, p24, p27; City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025; Stats SA Tourism Satellite Account, provisional, 2026, public sources; Inclusion Plan, p47.
[330] City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p3.
[331] Inception Report, p34; Inclusion Plan, p42, p51.

capability. From 2029 CapeNature, CATHSSETA, training providers and municipalities run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, using CATHSSETA's discretionary grants where they fit. Each partnership traces paid placements and retention, not only people trained. LTOs and tour operators help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries. Nationally, the province asks the Department of Tourism to approve a provincial jobs methodology and Stats SA to resource the tourism satellite account.[332]

| Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|
| Wesgro | Commission an employer-linked labour analysis with DEDAT, by occupation, place and season: baseline, definition, the training pipeline and skills gaps separated from pay, seasonal contracts and commuting | Research; DEDAT; employers |
| Wesgro | Extract the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025 | Research |
| Wesgro | Build a workforce strand into the provincial quality charter (objective 11) | Tourism |
| Partners | Run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, building on the CATHSSETA guide certification and the Prince Albert academy, and trace paid placements and retention | CapeNature; CATHSSETA; training providers; municipalities |
| Partners | Help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries | LTOs; tour operators |
| National | Approve a provincial tourism jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account | Department of Tourism; Stats SA |

**Why it can work**

Measurement comes first because a skills plan without a baseline can be neither targeted nor judged. The analysis shows which occupations bind growth, where and by when, so training money follows the gap rather than the loudest request. Linking skills to the quality charter ties training to the standards visitors judge. Linking training to bookings answers the Overberg's finding that low early earnings make it hard for newly trained guides to stay in the sector.[333]

Singapore's Hotel Industry Transformation Map, run by the tourism board with the hotel association and backed by dedicated funds, lifted service quality and spend per visitor. Across the cases, assets and training without a durable route to market did not produce comparable continuity. None of the six comparators carries a labour analysis or a tourism employment target, so the sizing step has no precedent in the benchmark set. The condition is a recognised method. Without the Department of Tourism's approval, the analysis can set a provincial baseline but not one the national accounts share.[334]

**Link forward**

**Initiative I18**, tourism labour analysis and skills plan (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-04 tourism jobs at impact level, with its baseline set by the analysis, and T2-25 labour analysis published at outcome level (section 5.2).

## 3.4 The integrated case

The three goals make one case. Demand work fills seats only if the seats exist, supply work pays only if the product can be booked, and both need the enabling base to last.

The growth model sets out three paths from the 2025 base of 1,498,829 arrivals: 1,822,634 in 2035 on the conservative path, 2,175,778 on the base path and 2,516,282 on the accelerated path. The paths differ by intervention, not by demand potential. Each step of the growth case therefore rests on a named set of

[332] Benchmarking, p42.
[333] Stakeholder Insights, p27.
[334] Benchmarking, p41; Inclusion Plan, p30.

interventions. The first two steps draw on Goals 1 and 2 alone. Goal 3 adds arrivals only on the third step, through the three-tier agenda and national escalation (objectives 16 and 19). Its other six objectives decide whether growth is shared, funded, sustained and measured.[335]

The conservative path, 1,822,634 arrivals in 2035, holds existing air access with no added frequencies or routes and continues trade and marketing, with growth in the mature markets and current corridors. Objectives 5 and 7 hold that base. The base path adds 353,144 arrivals to reach 2,175,778. It assumes Wesgro's trade and marketing continue at 2025 intensity while Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines add frequency and capacity, and India, China and regional Africa grow through hub connections. Objectives 1 to 7, 9 and 10 hold it. The accelerated path adds a further 340,504 to reach 2,516,282. It needs direct India and China routes secured and dedicated activation in India, China, the USA and the GCC, with India, China and the Middle East growing ahead of their source markets. Objectives 4, 7, 16 and 19 deliver it on top of the base.[336]

**The gateway binds first, at peak.** The growth model draws current air access as a line at 1.8 million inbound seats, and the base case crosses it at the 2030 year point. Relief at Cape Town International arrives about 2032 for the international terminal and about 2033 for the runway. ACSA now schedules the realigned runway for December 2029, subject to contract award. This plan keeps about 2033 as its planning date and treats the earlier date as upside. Between those dates, growth has to come from larger aircraft and added frequency on the full routes and from hub-carrier capacity (objectives 5, 6 and 7). Domestic connections can also grow through George, whose terminal doubles by 2028 or 2029.[337]

**If the supply moves slip, growth flattens near the seat line.** The conservative path, with no new seats, ends at 1.82 million in 2035, just above the 1.8 million line. Projected growth cannot be realised without added capacity or frequency, and without confirmed routes the accelerated case reverts to base. On the full routes, demand work cannot make up the gap, because marketing raises fares rather than seats; on the hub routes, which have seats to spare, it can. Wesgro's own target of 800,000 to 1 million new arrivals over FY26 to FY30 sits above every modelled path (Table 1.3).[338]

**Below the gateway, the goals depend on each other.** Green-season demand needs seats in the months carriers now cut (objectives 2 and 7). Dispersal needs product that can be booked and reached (objectives 3, 9 and 10). Inclusion needs a seller and a safe visit before exposure (objectives 13 and 19). Every target needs data that today sits with SA Tourism, ACSA, the Provincial Treasury and the booking platforms (objective 18).

**Air access and bookability move first, because every other lever runs through them.** Three phases follow from that logic. Activate, 2027 to 2028, works on seats, bookability, green-season events, the inclusion pilots and the governance base before the seat line. Expand, 2029 to 2031, scales hub conversion, corridor product and quality and closes the first investments. Sustain, 2032 to 2035, takes the direct routes to carriers as runway relief arrives. Chapter 4 turns the sequence into eighteen initiatives with owners, phases and decision gates (section 4.2).

[335] Market Assessment, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, p20, p19.
[336] Market Assessment, p18, p19, the 2025 base; the Demand-Side Analysis, p20 describes the same case as existing Wesgro programmes expanded; Demand-Side Analysis, p19, p20; increments computed from the printed end points; the mapping to objectives is this report's.
[337] Demand-Side Analysis, p21; arrivals and seats share one axis and no seat table sits behind the 1.8 million line; the crossing is read from the chart, after the 2028 point of 1,673,855 and by the 2030 point of 1,802,929; Infrastructure Report, p103; ACSA, Q1 2026/27 presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News, Aug 2026.
[338] Demand-Side Analysis, p20, p21; MIDAS, In Conclusion; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20.

Chapter 4

# Execution plan

## 4.1 From objectives to initiatives

Twenty objectives become eighteen initiatives, one per objective except where one owner delivers two.

The plan follows one chain from vision to measure. Each level answers a different question. The goal says what must change and the objective says where; the initiative says what Wesgro and its partners do, and the indicator says how Steerco will know it has happened (section 5.1).

Seven levels run from the vision to the measures, and each has a fixed count in this plan. One vision says where the province is going: grow international arrivals from 1.5m in 2025 toward 2.5m by 2035. Three goals say what must change, such as Reshape demand. Six themes say in which part of the system, such as source market growth and diversification. Twenty objectives say where the evidence says to act, such as Convert India and China hub traffic. Eighteen initiatives say what Wesgro and its partners do, such as I4 India and China hub conversion. The 139 actions say who does what, by tier, such as activation inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip. The indicators, 7 at impact, 29 at outcome and 41 at output level, say how Steerco knows, such as T2-06 India and China hub arrivals. The counts come from Chapter 3, the action tables and the traceability table in Appendix A1.

Two merges take twenty objectives to eighteen initiatives. Segment-led marketing and mature-market yield share one owner and one set of channels, so objectives 1 and 5 form initiative I1. Institutional alignment and industry collaboration share one forum, so objectives 16 and 17 form I15. Every other objective has its own initiative, numbered I1 to I18 in one sequence so that the M&E toolkit can track them on one list.

Leads are proposed, not agreed. They follow the Wesgro units named in the Inception Report's stakeholder map and the actions in Chapter 3, and Steerco confirms them at its first meeting [Steerco to confirm initiative leads and partners]. Six initiatives have a partner as the accountable lead, because the main lever sits outside Wesgro's mandate: corridor mobility, quality standards, flagship sites, community pilots, destination readiness and skills.

**Table 4.1.** The eighteen initiatives

**Eighteen initiatives cover the twenty objectives, and eleven of them are in implementation by 2028. Thirteen draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget, and four need private capital as a main source.**

| Code | Initiative | Objectives | Proposed lead | Phase 1 role | Main funding | Supporting funding |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I1** | Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets | 1, 5 | Destination Marketing | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating | Private capital |
| **I2** | Green-season events and business-events calendar | 2 | Convention Bureau | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal | Private capital |
| **I3** | Bookable province programme | 3 | Tourism | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal | National and SOE; Private capital |
| **I4** | India and China hub conversion | 4 | Destination Marketing | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating | Private capital |
| **I5** | Regional Africa programme | 6 | Destination Marketing | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating | Private capital |

| Code | Initiative | Objectives | Proposed lead | Phase 1 role | Main funding | Supporting funding |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I6** | Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund | 7 | Air Access | Implement | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital | National and SOE |
| **I7** | Cruise circuit and shore capacity | 8 | Cruise Cape Town | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating; National and SOE | Private capital |
| **I8** | Corridor mobility | 9 | Department of Mobility, with Wesgro Tourism | Design | Provincial and municipal; National and SOE | Wesgro operating; Private capital |
| **I9** | Corridor product development | 10 | Tourism | Design | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital | National and SOE |
| **I10** | Visitor experience and quality standards | 11 | DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism | Design | Provincial and municipal | Wesgro operating; Private capital |
| **I11** | Flagship site demand management | 12 | Site operators, with Wesgro Research | Design | National and SOE; Private capital | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal |
| **I12** | Community inclusion pilots | 13 | Municipalities and LTOs, with Wesgro Tourism | Design, then implement | Provincial and municipal | Wesgro operating; National and SOE; Private capital |
| **I13** | Destination readiness and climate resilience | 14 | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research | Design | Provincial and municipal | Wesgro operating; National and SOE; Private capital |
| **I14** | Tourism investment pipeline | 15 | Wesgro investment promotion | Design | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal; Private capital | None |
| **I15** | Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment | 16, 17 | Wesgro CEO's office | Implement | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal | None |
| **I16** | Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence | 18 | Research | Design, then implement | Wesgro operating | Provincial and municipal; National and SOE; Private capital |
| **I17** | Access and safety escalation agenda | 19 | Wesgro CEO's office, with DEDAT | Implement | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal | None |
| **I18** | Tourism labour analysis and skills plan | 20 | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research | Design | Wesgro operating; Provincial and municipal | National and SOE; Private capital |

Source: Chapter 3 entries; proposed leads for Steerco to confirm. Phase 1 role from the Gantt in section 4.2. Funding routes from the initiative charters (section 4.3); rand values are not estimated.

## 4.2 Sequencing and phases

Three phases run to 2035, and the first is weighted to the moves that change the 2030 constraint: seats, bookability, green-season events and the inclusion pilots.

The phases follow calendar years: Activate from 2027 to 2028, Expand from 2029 to 2031 and Sustain from 2032 to 2035. Each phase ends at a decision gate tied to the Chapter 5 indicators (section 4.7). The first gate, at the end of 2028, falls in Wesgro's FY2028/29, two years before the base case crosses the model's seat line around 2030.[339]

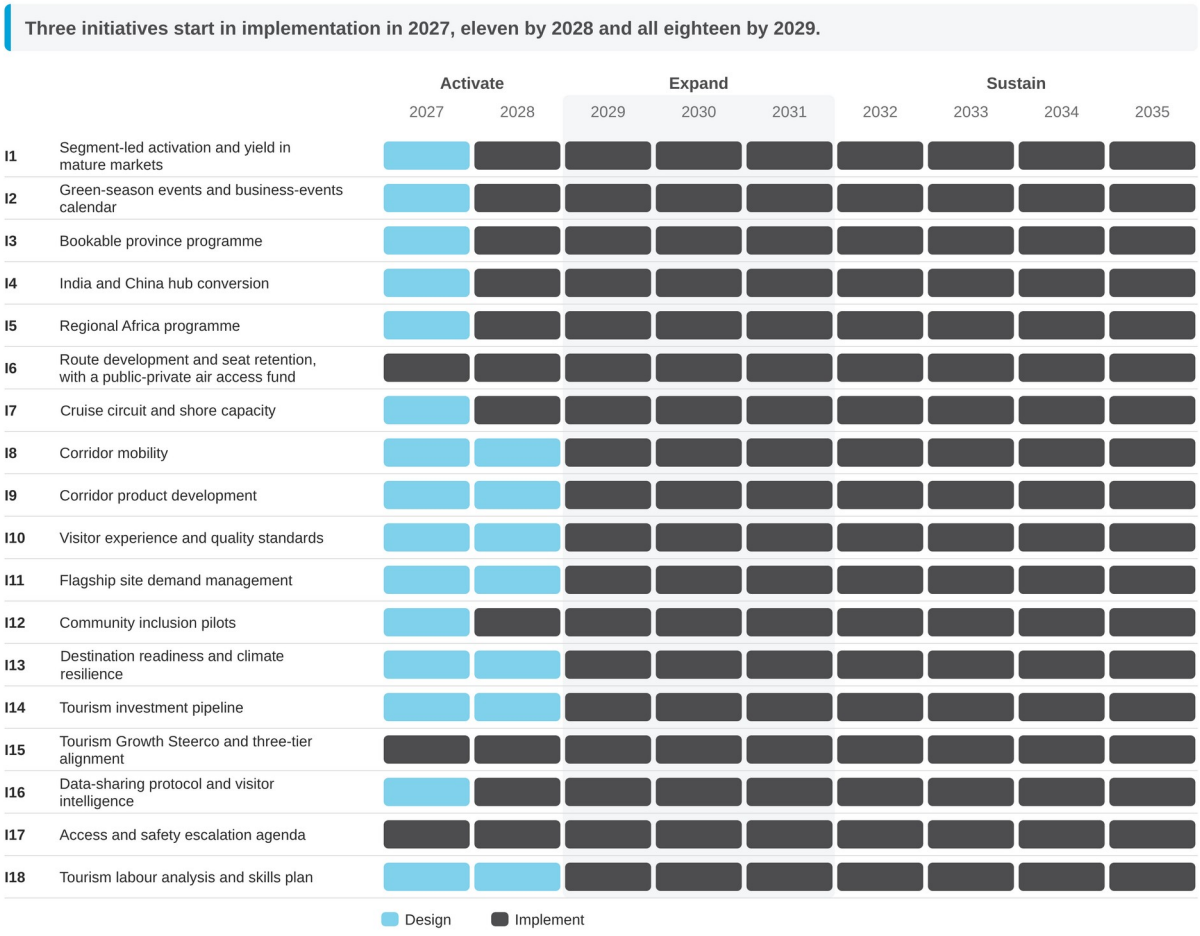



**Figure 4.1.** Initiative timeline, 2027 to 2035

Note: Design means scoping, data, agreements and pilots; implement means delivery at scale.

### Phase 1: Activate, 2027 to 2028

Phase 1 works inside Wesgro's mandate and budget and on the levers that move before the airport can. It holds and adds seats on the full routes, opens new routes outside the peak hours and builds the air access fund (I6). It publishes the green-season calendar (I2), audits regional distribution from discovery to sale and prepares a bounded support trial (I3) and starts two or three inclusion pilots (I12). Steerco, the data-sharing protocol and the escalation agenda start in the first quarter (I15, I16, I17), because every other initiative reports through them.

The marketing initiatives (I1, I4, I5) and cruise (I7) spend 2027 on design: segment targets, hub-carrier agreements, the Nigeria and Kenya plans and the cruise circuit compact. Seven initiatives use both years for design (I8 to I11, I13, I14, I18). Their first task is a baseline or a case that no deliverable holds: funded

[339] Demand-Side Analysis, p21.

mobility services, product, quality, flagship capacity and condition, destination readiness, the investment pipeline and the labour analysis. The gate at the end of 2028 asks four questions. Have seats on the full routes held? Does the bookability baseline exist and is it moving? Has any pilot met its thresholds? Which of Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 targets will the outputs meet (section 4.7)?

Phase 1 also carries the tests the 2026 evidence calls for. Air Access completes correlated hub-closure scenarios (I6). Site operators run two flow pilots, at Boulders and one other constrained site, in summer 2027/28 at the earliest (I11). The safety workstream agrees one referral pathway and tests its handoffs, and the visa ask is rebuilt on ETA performance (I17). Accessible journeys are tested end to end before they are sold (I10). LTO services move onto lawful procurement, on a provincial practice note (I12).

### Phase 2: Expand, 2029 to 2031

Phase 2 scales what Phase 1 proved and meets the model's seat line. Hub conversion, regional Africa and segment marketing run at scale. Corridor mobility and product move from design to delivery, on the Garden Route, the Winelands and the Overberg first. The quality charter is adopted and phased by district, and the investment pipeline reaches financial close on its first projects. Flow management extends beyond the two pilot sites where the pilots held, and the safety pathway widens if the 2028 review supports it. The mid-term review in 2030 tests arrivals against the base path when the base case crosses the model's seat line, and checks that the runway is on its published dates (section 5.6).

### Phase 3: Sustain, 2032 to 2035

Phase 3 runs as relief arrives at Cape Town International: the international terminal about 2032 and the runway about 2033. The direct India and China route cases built since 2027 go to carriers as capacity frees up, which is the step the accelerated case depends on. Inclusion pilots that met their thresholds scale through channels. Destination readiness and the LTO service agreements, written into IDPs from 2029, are reviewed each year. The terminal evaluation in 2035 closes the plan (section 5.6).[340]

## 4.3 Initiative charters

Each initiative has a one-page charter that a lead can run from and Steerco can hold to account.

Every charter uses the same fields. It states the aim, the objectives served, the proposed lead and partners and the tier of government. It then sets the actions in each phase, marked Design or Implement, and closes with the dependencies, the funding route, the risks and the indicators it moves. Actions come from the Chapter 3 action tables. Leads are proposals for Steerco to confirm, and rand bands are set in section 4.6.

### I1 Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Raise value per visitor from the mature markets and target every priority market by segment, not by country alone. Build recognition of the regions, and nights spent there, beside city conversion. |
| Objectives | 1, 5 |
| Proposed lead | Destination Marketing |
| Partners | Research; trade and OTA partners; SA Tourism; City of Cape Town; Cape Town Tourism |
| Tier of government | Provincial (Wesgro); national alignment with SA Tourism |

[340] Infrastructure Report, p103.

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): segment targets inside each priority market; a shared segment frame with SA Tourism, the City and Cape Town Tourism; destination-specific segment research; tests of three brand presentations; regional product, inventory links and completed regional bookings written into campaign and airline agreements. Implement (2028): move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion; luxury-advisor and high-end operator distribution in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Segment campaigns at scale; spend per visitor and length of stay added to Wesgro's own targets; segments built into brand tracking. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Segment research refreshed; budget shifted toward the segments and markets with the highest yield. |
| Dependencies | I6 for seats on the full routes; I16 for spend-per-visitor data; I10 for product quality. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Carriers on full routes raise fares rather than seats; SA Tourism's institutional weakness limits joint campaigns (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25). |
| Indicators | T1-01, T1-02, T1-03; T2-01, T2-07; T3-01 segment targets in Wesgro's annual plan; T3-02 share of market budget in trade-led conversion; T3-37 international tourism trade engagements by market; T3-38 regional test offers with completed regional bookings. |

## I2 Green-season events and business-events calendar

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Build an April to September demand spine from business events and flagship weeks, with May to August as the first winter portfolio, and sell it with the seats. |
| Objectives | 2 |
| Proposed lead | Convention Bureau |
| Partners | Destination Marketing; CTICC; City of Cape Town; DEDAT; Cultural Affairs and Sport; Provincial Treasury; LTOs |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; national for delegate visas |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province, building on the MICE and events marketing the City's framework proposed, if it still runs; a way to measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions; one monthly green-season baseline of sold and available room nights by region and type; sales organised by buyer type; one common appraisal, at full public cost, for every publicly supported event. Implement (2028): publish the calendar; aim bids at May to August first; dated offers for named low-demand weeks with airlines and trade, with buyer commitments before public support; cooler-season incentive packages for Indian and Gulf planners. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Regional conferences in Stellenbosch and George; lifestyle events at CTICC in December and January; food and wine, whale and wildflower product sold on its own calendar; supported offers renewed against a comparison group; absolute winter nights and revenue tracked beside the seasonal share. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Calendar refreshed each year; a standing bid pipeline for green-season dates. |
| Dependencies | I6 for seats in the trough months; I9 for regional venues; I17 for visas for African delegates; I16 for the room-night baseline; I13 for destination readiness; I3 for the distribution of contracted offers. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Weather limits summit and outdoor events (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p35); peak hotel prices deter December and January events (p46). A rising share read as growth when summer weakens; occupancy lifted by closed stock. |
| Indicators | T1-05; T2-02 ICCA meetings and bids secured, against Wesgro's 161 over FY26 to FY30, T2-03 April to September seat share; T3-03 calendar published; T3-04 all bids submitted, and those for May to September events. |

## I3 Bookable province programme

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Make regional product found and sold where travellers book, fixing the failure an audit verifies in each district. |
| Objectives | 3 |
| Proposed lead | Tourism |
| Partners | Research; LTOs; district municipalities; OTAs; CapeNature |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; national for broadband |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): a discovery-to-sale audit by district, for accommodation and for experiences separately, from a verified inventory to booking-route checks; channel choice tested against priority-market journeys. Implement (2028): a bounded support trial with a comparison group; community booking routes with I12; first platform and trade partnerships. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Support scaled where the trial paid; packaged regional itineraries listed on the chosen platforms; CapeNature reservations moved online. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Audit repeated every two years; support extended to every route. |
| Dependencies | I12 for community routes; I16 for the audit data; I1 for the awareness research and regional test offers; I9 for itineraries; SA Connect rural broadband. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Rural connectivity and payments; compliance cost for small operators; commission and ranking costs erode operators' returns; a convenience sample is read as coverage. |
| Indicators | T2-04 verified listing and usable booking route by district, T2-05 CapeNature online share; T3-05 presence and exposure baseline published; T3-06 operators supported, with fulfilled bookings traced. |

## I4 India and China hub conversion

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Convert the Indian and Chinese travellers already flying in through hubs, and prepare the direct route case for when runway capacity arrives. |
| Objectives | 4 |
| Proposed lead | Destination Marketing |
| Partners | Air Access; hub carriers; OTAs; trade; inbound operators |
| Tier of government | Provincial; national for visas and route designation |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): a joint route, fare, visa and product diagnosis of both markets; joint market support with Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines; activation plans for Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip. Implement (2028): in-market activation with Trip.com packages and market-specific itineraries, run as conversion campaigns; Johannesburg-gateway itineraries with a flight to Cape Town for Indian and Chinese visitors already bound for South Africa; product readiness with Mandarin and Indian-language guiding and Alipay and WeChat Pay. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Activation at scale; commercial tests of direct services before any route case; standing relationships with Indian carriers, Cathay Pacific, China Southern and China Eastern. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Direct route cases taken to carriers as runway capacity arrives, with I6. |
| Dependencies | I6 for route cases; I10 for product readiness; I17 for visas and route designation. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | ETA performance; the 2026 fall in national arrivals from both markets; no Indian aircraft for a direct route before 2030 (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026, Indian Market Opportunity). |
| Indicators | T1-02; T2-06 India and China hub arrivals; T3-07 hub-carrier agreements; T3-08 route cases prepared. |

## I5 Regional Africa programme

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Hold the regional volume base and grow Nigeria and Kenya as premium markets. |
| Objectives | 6 |
| Proposed lead | Destination Marketing |
| Partners | Air Access; Convention Bureau; regional carriers; trade |
| Tier of government | Provincial; national for visas and route liberalisation |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): Nigeria and Kenya activation plans; Nigeria and Ghana added to the growth model; consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda. Implement (2028): premium, trade-led activation. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Conferences with leisure extensions; onward packages for regional travellers who stop in Johannesburg. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Effort shifted with results; brand seeding in the watch markets. |
| Dependencies | I6 for regional capacity; I2 for conference demand; I17 for visas. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Visa friction and budget sensitivity of regional demand (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p45). |
| Indicators | T1-02; T2-08 African arrivals and spend; T3-09 activation programmes run; T3-10 regional capacity cases made. |

## I6 Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Hold and add seats on the full routes until runway relief, win Wesgro's 10 new routes by FY30 and have direct route cases ready when relief arrives. |
| Objectives | 7 |
| Proposed lead | Air Access |
| Partners | DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; SA Tourism; airlines; private sector |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; national for air service agreements; ACSA for airport capacity |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Implement (2027): a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes with joint marketing; new routes outside the peak hours, regional and hub links first, with belly cargo counted in each route case; quarterly runway milestone tracking; a capacity-against-demand model to 2035; correlated hub-closure scenarios with flown-seat and itinerary data by hub. Design (2027 to 2028): a public-private air access fund with ring-fenced corridor budgets and resilience conditions (tapering support, matched airline marketing, minimum flown capacity, clawbacks, a documented funding gap, grants set after bids). |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Fund in operation; frequency and gauge cases on the five full regional routes; growth at George; Cape Winelands Airport treated as a scenario until finance, licensing and carriers are shown. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Direct India and China route cases taken to carriers as runway capacity arrives. |
| Dependencies | ACSA's programme at Cape Town International; I17 for air service agreements; I4 and I5 for demand. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). [Open item: Air Access to give the current size and funders of its route fund.] |
| Risks | Runway relief slips; bilateral agreements stay restrictive; hub disruption recurs (section 4.8). |
| Indicators | T1-01; T2-09 seats and new routes, with load factor and route survival, T2-10 seats added on full routes; T3-11 fund constituted; T3-12 runway milestone reports issued; T3-39 hub-closure scenarios completed. |

## I7 Cruise circuit and shore capacity

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Hold calls above Wesgro's 250 over FY26 to FY30 by making the regional circuit work for lines, and grow shore spend through call-day capacity beyond the flagship sites and regional day stops. |
| Objectives | 8 |
| Proposed lead | Cruise Cape Town |
| Partners | Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront; City of Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality; partner ports; flagship site operators; cruise lines |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; Transnet for ports |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): a circuit compact with partner ports and lines; a call-day flow plan with the flagship operators; Mossel Bay excursion packages; one definition of a call for reporting against the 250. Implement (2028): shore programmes beyond the flagship sites; marketing to homeport, expedition and shoulder-season operators; community product on cruise-operator channels. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Circuit itineraries marketed with partner ports; Saldanha Bay only if demand is proven; shore power and wind planning with the ports authority. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Longer itineraries, homeport turnarounds and pre- and post-cruise stays. |
| Dependencies | Berth scheduling by Transnet National Ports Authority; partner ports and consistent port and immigration processing; I11 for call-day flows at the flagship sites; I3 and I12 for bookable shore product. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs. Supporting: private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Red Sea reroutes, which made 20 of 67 calls in 2023/24, end (Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20); visits fell from 79 in 2024/25 to 64 in 2025/26 (Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29); the 300m ship-length limit (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110, p112). |
| Indicators | T2-11 cruise calls, passengers and GDP-R; T3-13 call-day excursion capacity beyond the flagship sites; T3-14 lines engaged. |

## I8 Corridor mobility

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Make the transport that exists usable for visitors from the airport onward and aggregate the demand that makes corridor shuttles viable. |
| Objectives | 9 |
| Proposed lead | Department of Mobility, with Wesgro Tourism |
| Partners | City of Cape Town; ACSA; PRASA; district municipalities; private operators |
| Tier of government | Provincial, local and national (PRASA) |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design and pilot (2027 to 2028): funded service specifications for the airport link and regional services, including for visitors without cars; one consistent set of airport pickup information; shuttle demand aggregation on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast; airport and corridor transfers sold inside N2 and R62 itineraries; a Southern Line visitor product once PRASA signs a timetable with security and disruption obligations. The airport leg is designed with the City and ACSA. The draft land transport framework proposes to revive the MyCiTi airport service and to plan facilities for e-hailing and metered taxis at Cape Town International (Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12). |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Shuttle products in operation; Central Line recovery and integrated ticketing; visitor routes on MyCiTi Phase 2A to Khayelitsha and Mitchells Plain, subject to funding beyond the grant that ends in 2027/28, which the draft framework targets for 2027 (Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p3-24). |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | A decision on Cape Town to George rapid rail, after an appraisal of cheaper options; the last mile to Cape Point. |
| Dependencies | PRASA, ACSA and the City of Cape Town; MyCiTi funding beyond 2027/28; the written reason for refusing direct bank-card tapping on the George bus; I17 for airport-corridor safety; I9 for itineraries. |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Funding route | Main: provincial and municipal budgets, including the provincial transport budget; national programmes and SOEs. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Rail safety and reliability; the MyCiTi grant ends in 2027/28; shuttle viability at low volumes. |
| Indicators | T1-06; T2-12 accessibility score, T2-13 corridor transfer products; T3-15 funded service specifications agreed; T3-16 shuttle products bookable. |

## I9 Corridor product development

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Turn assets outside the Metro into bookable multi-day itineraries, starting with the corridors closest to ready. |
| Objectives | 10 |
| Proposed lead | Tourism |
| Partners | City of Cape Town; LTOs; district municipalities; CapeNature; SANParks; private investors |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; national for SANParks precincts |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): itineraries for the six touring routes, linked to the Cape Town+ offer the City's framework proposed, if it runs; a plan to activate cold-zone assets; regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Delivery on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg first, then Route 62 and the West Coast. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Accommodation and service depth in secondary towns; refreshed flagship product. |
| Dependencies | I3 for bookability; I8 for transfers; I14 for capital. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | No committed capital for product (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p54, p76); operator capacity. |
| Indicators | T1-06; T2-14 readiness by district, T2-26 overnight share by district, T2-27 tourist spend share of district GDPR; T3-17 multi-day itineraries listed; T3-18 cold-zone assets activated. |

## I10 Visitor experience and quality standards

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Adopt a provincial quality charter, phased by district, as a supported condition for public promotion, make journeys accessible end to end and prepare the province for growth-market visitors. |
| Objectives | 11 |
| Proposed lead | DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism |
| Partners | Industry bodies; CATHSSETA; attraction operators; DEDAT (guide registration); lived-experience partners; municipalities |
| Tier of government | Provincial; industry |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): a charter that works as a supported condition for discretionary public promotion, with its status visible on booking platforms; support for SMMEs to comply; readiness standards for language, payments and food, with claims verified against delivery; accessible journeys tested end to end with lived-experience partners; an accommodation audit by district that counts hotel, guesthouse and short-term rental stock separately; guide-registration service performance published. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Charter adopted and phased by district; verified access information published for the tested itineraries; a destination-and-product test for accommodation with I14. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Charter embedded in grading; measurement repeated. |
| Dependencies | I14 for the accommodation test; I18 for skills; I3 for visibility on platforms; I16 for short-term rental evidence. |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Funding route | Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Compliance burden on small businesses; skills shortages. |
| Indicators | T2-15 routes rated Ready; T3-19 charter adopted; T3-20 businesses certified; T3-41 accessible journeys verified and published. |

## I11 Flagship site demand management

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Maintain what exists, manage visitor flows at the flagship nature sites and steer visitors to receiving reserves that are ready. |
| Objectives | 12 |
| Proposed lead | Site operators, with Wesgro Research |
| Partners | SANParks; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; CapeNature; Robben Island Museum; City of Cape Town; Provincial Treasury |
| Tier of government | National (SANParks), provincial (CapeNature) and site operators |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): a capacity baseline for the flagship sites, beside the Treasury's 2023 visitor counts; a costed condition register, with repairs of verified assets first; readiness assessments for receiving reserves, Stony Point included, before dispersal marketing. Pilot (summer 2027/28 at the earliest): two flow pilots, at Boulders and one other constrained site, protecting walk-up and resident access, with a stop rule. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Digital flow management and tiered pricing extended at the Cableway and Boulders on the pilots' results; marketing of receiving reserves that have passed readiness and of the Southern Line towns; a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Yield measures for nature product; climate-resilient asset formats. |
| Dependencies | I8 for the Southern Line; I16 for data; I13 for climate risk and continuity. |
| Funding route | Main: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Operators do not share data; mandates limit pricing (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44); the repair backlog after the 2026 floods. |
| Indicators | T2-16 peak Cableway queue and flagship visitors; T3-21 flagship baseline published; T3-22 flow pilots run; T3-40 condition register published and repairs completed. |

## I12 Community inclusion pilots

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Test the Inclusion Plan's model in two or three communities (a seller with a stake, a link to existing demand and gates before any investment) and keep local tourism bodies in service through lawful procurement. |
| Objectives | 13 |
| Proposed lead | Municipalities and LTOs, with Wesgro Tourism |
| Partners | Municipalities, with the City of Cape Town in Metro pilots; district municipalities; LTOs; community sellers; DEDAT; Provincial Treasury; SAPS |
| Tier of government | Local and provincial; national for safety (SAPS) |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): pilots chosen on readiness; an operator and rights register for each; agreement on who funds a seller with a stake in each, hosted in Metro pilots by the City's community programmes where they run; safety plans with extortion controls (confidential reporting and a named SAPS referral); a provincial practice note on LTO procurement under Circular 131. Implement (2028): one live booking route per pilot; paid departures with buyer commitments before promotion; a fixed-date test; product placed in Wesgro's itineraries and calendars. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Pilots that meet their thresholds scale; LTO service agreements with a development mandate written into IDPs from 2029, through the Treasury's district reviews; covenants on public assets; links to tourism procurement. |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Extension to more shortlisted communities through channels; LTO service agreements reviewed each year with reporting. |
| Dependencies | I3 for booking routes; I17 for safety; municipal assets; National Treasury on the disputed points of Circular 131. |
| Funding route | Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Safety; the selling body is not sustained; LTO services lapse where procurement is not followed; capital ahead of demand (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p11). |
| Indicators | T1-07; T2-17 communities with a live booking route, T2-18 LTOs with a service agreement; T3-23 pilots selected; T3-24 fixed-date tests held; T3-26 LTO procurement practice note issued. |

## I13 Destination readiness and climate resilience

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Keep destinations trading through shocks, hold growth within each node's resource and ecological capacity and report emissions beside it. |
| Objectives | 14 |
| Proposed lead | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research |
| Partners | Municipalities; district municipalities; CapeNature; site operators; Provincial Treasury |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; national for MFMA Circular No. 131 |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): a climate and weather risk register for sites and routes; readiness assessments by node or supply zone; tested continuity arrangements; a reporting frame for absolute resource use and emissions beside per-night intensity. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Climate risk written into IDPs from 2029, through the Treasury's district reviews; readiness assessments required before publicly supported demand expansion; sustainability checks in the quality charter; itineraries routed around closures. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | IDP entries for climate risk reviewed each year with reporting; resource use and emissions reported each year. |
| Dependencies | I10 for the charter; I11 for site condition and capacity; I16 for data. |
| Funding route | Main: provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: Wesgro operating budget, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Further climate events; water restrictions before new supply arrives in 2031 (section 4.8). |
| Indicators | T2-19 weather losses at flagship sites; T3-25 risk register published. |

## I14 Tourism investment pipeline

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Build a scored pipeline of tourism investments from the gap-closure tables and take it to investors. |
| Objectives | 15 |
| Proposed lead | Wesgro investment promotion |
| Partners | DEDAT; Department of Mobility; Tourism; private investors; municipalities |
| Tier of government | Provincial and local; private |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): a pipeline from the gap tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion; return projections for the SLA; the destination-and-product test with I10, comparing refurbishment and better use of existing stock with new build on lifecycle cost; investment cases for the conference-capable and mid-market product the test confirms and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62; a tourism case route through DEDAT's Red Tape Reduction service, recording stage times and reasons for delay; agreement with the Department of Mobility that its tourist levy case also covers destination management. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Investor engagement; first projects at financial close; one levy case for the visitor economy, set against its legal route and timing, and blended finance tested with DEDAT, the Department of Mobility and the City. |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Pipeline refreshed each year; covenants on public assets. |
| Dependencies | I9 and I10 for product and quality, including the destination-and-product test; I6 for the air access fund. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Capital ahead of demand; tight fiscal space (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25); a levy route that can take more than a year. |
| Indicators | T2-20 projects at financial close; T3-27 investment cases prepared; T3-28 investor engagements. |

## I15 Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Give the province one forum, one shared agenda with clear decision rights and one joint plan with industry. |
| Objectives | 16, 17 |
| Proposed lead | Wesgro CEO's office |
| Partners | DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism; City of Cape Town; district municipalities; industry bodies |
| Tier of government | All three tiers and industry |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Implement (2027): Steerco constituted with terms of reference; a decision-rights map by tier from the Diagnostic's tier table; JAMMS adopted as the consultation channel; a link to the City's tourism coordinating cluster, if the City set one up; sector councils designed; airlines, OTAs and tour operators brought into the joint plan. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | A joint industry plan agreed and reviewed each year; sector councils running; regional forums carrying a development agenda. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Steerco embedded as the standing governance of the plan; the programme office hands over to the line units by the end of 2031. |
| Dependencies | DEDAT and Cape Town Tourism as standing members; I17 for the national asks; I16 for the scorecard. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Misalignment between public institutions and industry bodies persists (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p25); SA Tourism's institutional weakness. |
| Indicators | T2-21 escalation items answered, T2-22 partners in the joint plan; T3-29 Steerco meetings held each quarter; T3-30 joint industry plan agreed. |

## I16 Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Agree data-sharing terms with every data holder and run one indicator register and dashboard. |
| Objectives | 18 |
| Proposed lead | Research |
| Partners | Stats SA; SA Tourism; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; Provincial Treasury; Department of Mobility (Integrated Transport Hub); booking platforms; municipalities and their valuers |
| Tier of government | Provincial; national for the jobs methodology and the tourism satellite account |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027): data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the Provincial Treasury, the Department of Mobility, site operators and booking platforms; the indicator register; a baseline of aided and unaided awareness for the city, the province and its regions in the priority markets. Implement (2028): a lawful property-level short-term rental evidence agreement with platforms and municipal valuers; dashboard live with automated arrivals, seats and cruise feeds; quarterly digital tracking; measurement of meetings, incentives and exhibitions. |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | District arrivals and spend baseline, built on the Treasury's district reviews; annual brand research on comparable aided and unaided awareness of the city, the province and its regions. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Arrivals series bridged and read against each other; the register refreshed each year. |
| Dependencies | Agreement from each data holder; the Department of Tourism's methodology; I15 for the forum. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget. Supporting: provincial and municipal budgets, national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | Data holders do not share; national data lag (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p30, p37). |
| Indicators | T2-23 automated data feeds; T3-31 data-sharing agreements signed; T3-32 dashboard live. |

## I17 Access and safety escalation agenda

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Run two workstreams. Access escalation turns the national deficits into a standing agenda of asks, each with an owner, a decision and a date, backed by evidence. Tourism safety joins the services that already run through one referral pathway. |
| Objectives | 19 |
| Proposed lead | Wesgro CEO's office, with DEDAT; the Advocacy and Advisory unit proposed to run the agenda day to day |
| Partners | Home Affairs; Department of Transport; SAPS; ACSA; SA Tourism; City of Cape Town; Department of Mobility; SANParks; Cape Town Tourism |
| Tier of government | National (Home Affairs, Transport, SAPS, ACSA, PRASA); provincial for safety programmes; local for basic services |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Access escalation, implement (2027): the first agenda tabled at Steerco: entry through the ETA for China, India, the Middle East and Africa, starting from the reforms DEDAT's visa study ranks (BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p34); monthly ETA performance requested by priority nationality; an African passport matrix; a delegate escalation channel; air service agreements and the US carrier cap; immigration throughput at Cape Town International; station security; the N2 airport corridor. Evidence built market by market. Tourism safety, design and pilot (2027 to 2028): one referral pathway across the running services, with named aftercare for serious cases, worker safeguards and tested handoffs in pilot hotspots; review at the end of 2028 before expansion. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Responses logged and followed up each quarter; ETA performance reported by priority nationality; the safety pathway extended beyond the pilot hotspots if the 2028 review supports it; safety compacts in pilot communities. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Asks updated as airport relief arrives; direct route designations pursued with the national tier. |
| Dependencies | I15 for the forum; I16 for evidence; I4 to I6 for the market case. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | National asks go unanswered; ETA performance data are not released; safety incidents (section 4.8). |
| Indicators | T2-24 ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals, T2-28 visitors who report feeling safe, T2-29 tourism safety response and completed handoffs, T2-21 items answered; T3-33 agenda tabled; T3-34 responses logged. |

## I18 Tourism labour analysis and skills plan

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Aim | Fix a provincial tourism employment baseline through an employer-linked labour analysis, test the 300,000 ambition and set a skills plan from the result. |
| Objectives | 20 |
| Proposed lead | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research |
| Partners | CATHSSETA; employers; industry bodies; training providers |

| Field | Charter |
|---|---|
| Tier of government | Provincial; national for the jobs methodology and sector training |
| Activate, 2027 to 2028 | Design (2027 to 2028): an employer-linked labour analysis commissioned, by occupation, place and season, separating skills scarcity from pay, seasonal contracts and commuting; the Pero 2025 tourism employment table extracted; the 300,000 first tested against about 3.3 total jobs per direct job (City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p3; computed); a workforce strand built into the quality charter. |
| Expand, 2029 to 2031 | Skills plan adopted; training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, with paid placements and retention traced; the jobs indicator moved from the ratio to a provincial measure. |
| Sustain, 2032 to 2035 | Labour analysis refreshed for the terminal evaluation. |
| Dependencies | I10 for the quality charter; I16 for data; the Department of Tourism's methodology. |
| Funding route | Main: Wesgro operating budget, provincial and municipal budgets. Supporting: national programmes and SOEs, private capital. Rand band to be set (section 4.6). |
| Risks | No provincial methodology is approved; employers do not share records; skills shortages cap service quality. |
| Indicators | T1-04; T2-25 labour analysis published; T3-35 analysis published; T3-36 skills plan adopted. |

## 4.4 Roles and accountabilities

Wesgro is accountable for twelve initiatives and does part of the work in all eighteen; for the other six, the accountable lead sits with another tier, and the plan names it.

The matrix below assigns each initiative to the four roles: responsible (R) for doing the work, accountable (A) for the result, consulted (C) before decisions and informed (I) of progress. Where Wesgro is accountable and does the work itself, the cell reads A/R. Assignments are proposals for Steerco to confirm, built from the actions in Chapter 3.

**Table 4.2.** Accountability by initiative and tier

**Wesgro is accountable for twelve initiatives; provincial departments, municipalities or site operators are accountable for six, and SOEs or national departments do part of the work in four.**

| Code | Initiative | Wesgro | Province | City, CTT | Districts, LTOs | SOEs | SAT | National | Industry, sites |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I1** | Segment-led activation and yield in mature markets | A/R | C | C | I | - | C | - | C |
| **I2** | Green-season events and business-events calendar | A/R | C | R | R | - | I | - | C |
| **I3** | Bookable province programme | A/R | C | C | R | - | - | I | C |
| **I4** | India and China hub conversion | A/R | I | I | - | C | C | C | C |
| **I5** | Regional Africa programme | A/R | I | I | - | C | C | C | C |
| **I6** | Route development and seat retention, with a public-private air access fund | A/R | R | R | - | C | I | C | C |
| **I7** | Cruise circuit and shore capacity | A/R | I | C | C | R | - | - | C |
| **I8** | Corridor mobility | R | A | R | R | R | - | C | C |
| **I9** | Corridor product development | A/R | C | C | R | - | - | C | C |
| **I10** | Visitor experience and quality standards | R | A | C | C | - | - | - | R |
| **I11** | Flagship site demand management | R | C | C | C | - | - | C | A |

| Code | Initiative | Wesgro | Province | City, CTT | Districts, LTOs | SOEs | SAT | National | Industry, sites |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I12** | Community inclusion pilots | R | R | R | A | - | - | C | C |
| **I13** | Destination readiness and climate resilience | R | A | C | R | - | - | C | R |
| **I14** | Tourism investment pipeline | A/R | R | C | C | C | - | - | C |
| **I15** | Tourism Growth Steerco and three-tier alignment | A/R | R | R | R | C | C | C | R |
| **I16** | Data-sharing protocol and visitor intelligence | A/R | C | R | C | R | R | R | C |
| **I17** | Access and safety escalation agenda | A/R | R | R | C | C | C | R | C |
| **I18** | Tourism labour analysis and skills plan | R | A | C | C | - | - | C | R |

Source: Letsema, from the Chapter 3 action tables; proposed for Steerco to confirm. Province: DEDAT, the Department of Mobility and the Provincial Treasury. SOEs: ACSA, Transnet and PRASA. National: Home Affairs, Transport, National Treasury and SAPS. Industry: industry bodies, airlines, CapeNature, SANParks and attraction operators.

## National government and the state-owned entities

Four levers sit outside the province and cannot be bought or marketed into place. Route rights and visas sit with the national tier, the airport and port capital programmes with national SOEs and policing with SAPS. The plan treats them as an escalation agenda (I17), carried by Steerco through DEDAT to the national departments and SOEs. Wesgro's Advocacy and Advisory unit, set up to build evidence-based policy feedback on levers the province does not control, is proposed to run it day to day. DEDAT's visa study supplies its visa asks, already ranked, and the asks now start from ETA performance data that only Home Affairs holds. Each item is stated as a decision, an owner and a date the province is asking for. Wesgro's own route work (I6) runs inside the existing agreements meanwhile.[341]

## Provincial government

DEDAT is a standing member of Steerco and the accountable lead where the lever is policy or funding rather than promotion: quality standards (I10), destination readiness and climate risk (I13) and the labour analysis (I18). The Department of Mobility leads the transport half of corridor mobility (I8), including the airport leg with the City and ACSA. It also joins the levy case (I14) and brings its Integrated Transport Hub into the data protocol (I16). The Provincial Treasury's district reviews feed the data protocol and the IDP step (I13, I16). Wesgro's units lead the demand, access, product and data initiatives and report through the programme office.

The Province also holds three roles the plan now relies on. On safety, DEDAT funds the City's Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit, runs the Tourism Safety and Support service and convenes the Provincial Tourism Safety Forum (I17). The Province holds oversight of policing, and SAPS keeps command. On red tape, DEDAT's Red Tape Reduction service carries the tourism case route and records where approvals stall (I14). On procurement, DEDAT and the Provincial Treasury issue the practice note that lets municipalities buy LTO services lawfully (I12).

## District and local government

Municipalities and LTOs hold the assets, the selling bodies and the visitor services that the regional and inclusion initiatives depend on. They lead the community selling bodies in the pilots (I12), attach covenants to public assets (I12, I14) and carry the route and product work in their districts (I3, I9). The City of Cape Town is a partner on segments, events, routes, cruise, mobility, product, flagship sites,

[341] Diagnostic, p58; Infrastructure Report, p103, p112; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p27; BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024, p34.

community pilots and safety (I1, I2, I6 to I9, I11, I12, I17). Cape Town Tourism is a partner on segments, routes and data (I1, I6, I16), and both sit on Steerco. The City's framework for 2019 to 2024 set out three plans the initiatives can build on: an air, rail and cruise access programme, a Cape Town+ offer and a Tourist Safety Programme. The safety services run today, through the City's Tourist and Visitor Safety Unit and its 24/7 visitor-support service. Municipalities also buy LTO services through procurement, the route MFMA Circular No. 131 leaves open (I12).[342]

### The private sector and site operators

Airlines decide frequency and gauge, hotel investors decide the accommodation mix and attraction operators manage their own capacity. The plan gives them the evidence and the demand case. It asks for the decisions it cannot make for them: seats on full routes (I6), investment in secondary nodes (I14) and visitor-flow management at flagship sites, where the operators are accountable (I11).

## 4.5 Tactical wins for the first 24 months

Twelve actions can start by mid-2028, nine of them inside Wesgro's current mandate and budget, and each one opens a baseline, a seat or a booking path that a later initiative needs.

The list is weighted the way Phase 1 is: seats, bookability, the green season, inclusion pilots and the data the rest of the plan reports on. Start dates are proposals in half-years. No action needs new capital; the funding route column says where the money comes from.

**Table 4.3.** First-24-month actions and funding

**Twelve actions for the first 24 months use existing mandates and budgets and open the baselines and booking paths the later initiatives need.**

| Action | Initiative | Proposed owner | Start | Funding route | What it opens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hold winter seats with demand: joint green-season marketing with carriers on the full routes | I6, I2 | Air Access | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | Seats kept in May to September, when carriers cut first |
| Publish a green-season events calendar and aim bids at May to August first, within the April to September season | I2 | Convention Bureau | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | A demand spine for the trough months |
| Track the runway programme quarterly, commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035 and complete correlated hub-closure scenarios | I6 | Air Access | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | Early warning on the binding constraint and on shared hub risk |
| Constitute Steerco with terms of reference and table the first escalation agenda, starting from DEDAT's ranked visa reforms and a request for ETA performance data | I15, I17 | Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | One forum and one route to national decisions |
| Agree the data-sharing protocol with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the Provincial Treasury and the Department of Mobility | I16 | Research | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | The feeds the scorecard needs |

[342] City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5, p6.

| Action | Initiative | Proposed owner | Start | Funding route | What it opens |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Build the regional inventory and run the first presence and discovery tests | I3 | Research | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | The baseline for T2-04 and the case for any onboarding |
| Request carrying capacity from the flagship sites, to publish beside the Treasury's 2023 visitor counts, and start a costed condition register | I11 | Research | 2027 H1 | Wesgro operating | The flagship capacity baseline and the repair list that precedes new product |
| Commission the employer-linked labour analysis behind the jobs ambition | I18 | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research | 2027 H1 | Wesgro and DEDAT operating | A tested jobs target |
| Package the Garden Route and Route 62 with a shuttle transfer sold inside the itinerary | I8, I9 | Tourism | 2027 H2 | Wesgro operating; operators | Car-free multi-day trips beyond the Metro |
| Seek a PRASA-signed Southern Line timetable, with security and disruption obligations, before any visitor rail product is packaged | I8 | Tourism | 2027 H2 | Wesgro operating; City | A rail product to Muizenberg, Kalk Bay and Fish Hoek that is sold only on a confirmed service |
| Choose two or three pilot communities, open an operator and rights register for each and agree with municipalities and LTOs who funds a seller with a stake | I12 | Tourism | 2027 H2 | Municipal and LTO budgets | The first test of the inclusion model |
| Give each pilot community one live booking route, and paid departures with buyer commitments, before any promotion | I12, I3 | LTOs, with Tourism | 2028 H1 | Municipal and LTO budgets | Community product that can be bought |

Source: Letsema, from the Chapter 3 action tables and the initiative charters (section 4.3). Owners and start dates are proposals for Steerco to confirm.

## 4.6 Funding and investment

Most of the plan runs on budgets that already exist; the capital it needs sits with ACSA, PRASA, Transnet and private investors, and none of it has been costed yet.

No deliverable costs any initiative. The Inception Report scoped an investment opportunity framework with return scoring, but no separate output was delivered, and stakeholders describe Western Cape tourism funding as materially below peer destinations without giving a figure. Thirteen initiatives draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget, and four need private capital as a main source; the initiatives table in section 4.1 gives each one's main and supporting funding routes. This section leaves the rand bands to be set with Wesgro Finance and DEDAT [cost band per initiative and phase: Wesgro Finance and DEDAT to set before Steerco signs off the plan]. Wesgro Finance and DEDAT also agree a stop list before Gate 1, naming the Wesgro work deprioritised to fund the initiatives (section 4.8). [Open item: Wesgro Finance to give an indicative rand band for the first 24 months.][343]

Current allocations show where the plan's money sits today. DEDAT's 2026/27 main budget is R596.765 million, including a R127.355 million transfer to Wesgro and R6.8 million for the CTICC. It earmarks R3 million for tourism safety and R4 million for tourism growth initiatives, and the department's performance plan carries a R7 million Tourism Growth Fund. These are existing allocations, not spare money. The MyCiTi operating grant ends in 2027/28, so the airport link needs a funded service specification before any product is sold on it (I8).

[343] Inception Report, p18, p20; Stakeholder Insights, p25.

Four findings shape the funding routes. First, municipalities buy LTO services through procurement under MFMA Circular No. 131; they do not grant them (I12). Second, maintenance precedes new product at the reserves, where CapeNature's ecotourism revenue of R82.038 million sits beside R16.058 million of repairs (I11). Third, national routes exist for cases that qualify, among them the Tourism Transformation Fund and the IDC, while the Green Tourism Incentive Programme is closed pending review. Fourth, a levy follows a statutory route that can take more than a year, so no levy proceeds fund essential near-term operations (I14).

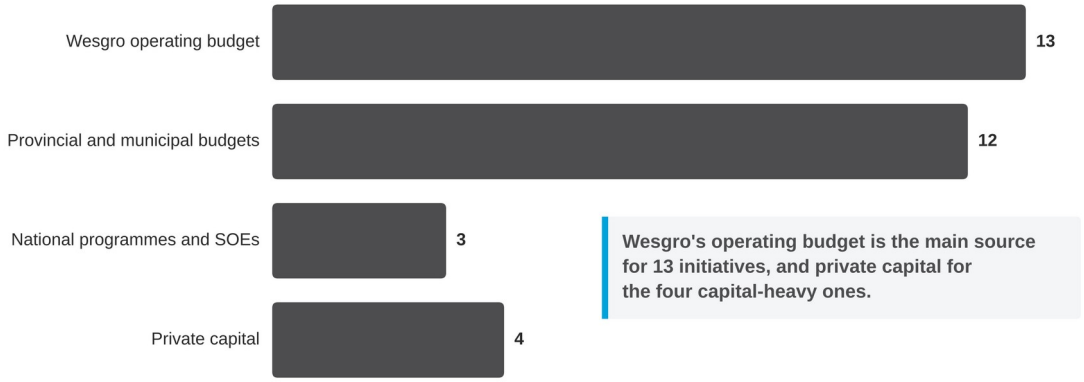



**Figure 4.2.** Initiatives by main funding source

**Crowding in capital.** The rule for capital is the Inclusion Plan's: invest after demand is shown, and attach a maintenance and marketing covenant to any public asset. Wesgro's investment promotion work builds the tourism pipeline from the Infrastructure Report's gap-closure tables, where every district lists tourism gaps with no committed capital (I14). The air access fund scales Cape Town Air Access's existing route fund with public and private money (I6). Its likely funders already sit in that partnership: the City, the province, ACSA, Cape Town Tourism, SA Tourism, Wesgro and private partners. Its support carries resilience conditions, from tapering and matched airline marketing to clawbacks (objective 7). Corridor mobility (I8) bids into the provincial transport budget; the draft land transport framework allocates R22.8bn to transport initiatives in the 2024 MTEF. The same framework plans a tourist levy case, which I14 would widen to cover destination management.[344]

**What the SLA asks and what is still to do.** The SLA asks for return projections on infrastructure priorities (clause 1.1.8.3) [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. Those need costed projects, and the only costed items in hand are the airport, rail and port programmes the province does not fund. The return case is therefore an output of I14 in Phase 1, built project by project as the pipeline forms.

## 4.7 Delivery governance

One Steerco, one programme office and four fixed decision points keep eighteen initiatives and three tiers of government on one plan.

[344] Inclusion Plan, p15, p31, p32; Infrastructure Report, p32 to p87; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 1; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p xix; Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, ch12.




**Figure 4.3.** Delivery governance structure

**Steerco.** A Tourism Growth Steerco co-chaired by Wesgro's CEO and DEDAT's Head of Department, with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member and the City of Cape Town, the district municipalities and the industry bodies at the table. It is distinct from the Unlocking Tourism Steerco that oversees this study. It receives the quarterly scorecard, clears cross-initiative issues, holds the escalation agenda and recommends gate decisions to the Board. Stakeholders asked for this kind of alignment directly: mobility responsibilities alone are split across three tiers of government. Steerco should also connect to the tourism coordinating cluster the City's framework proposed, if the City set one up.[345]

**Programme office.** A small office inside Wesgro runs the plan on a build, operate and transfer basis. It builds the charters, the dashboard and the reporting calendar in Phase 1, runs them through Phase 2 and hands them to the line units by the end of 2031. It owns the scorecard and the dashboard, and Wesgro Research owns the indicator definitions and the data protocol (I16).

**Cadence.** Initiative leads report monthly to the programme office, Steerco meets quarterly and the Board receives an annual outlook, which also anchors the Unlocking Tourism business outlook event. The plan is refreshed each year against the indicators and the gate decisions.

**Table 4.4.** Decision gates and reviews

**Four decision points test the plan against its indicators, and each one decides what the next phase funds.**

| Gate | When | What it tests | What it decides |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Gate 1** | End 2028 | Seats on full routes held or added (T2-09, T2-10); discovery-to-sale baseline published and the support trial evaluated (T2-04); pilots against thresholds (T2-17); flow pilots against their stop rule (T3-22); the safety pathway against its 2028 review (T2-29); data protocol live (T2-23); outputs of I1, I2, I4, I6 and I7 against Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 targets | Move to Expand; scale or stop each pilot; renew, change or stop the bookability support trial; extend or stop flow management at the pilot sites; widen or hold the safety pathway; confirm route cases for India and China, and bring them into Phase 2 if ACSA awards the runway contract on its December 2029 schedule; state which of Wesgro's targets the action plan would raise |
| **Mid-term review** | 2030 | Arrivals against the base path at the model's seat line (T1-01); peak-hour runway headroom; runway on its published dates; green-season nights and share (T1-05) | Re-sequence Phase 2 if peak capacity binds early or relief slips |

[345] Stakeholder Insights, p23; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p5 to p6.

| Gate | When | What it tests | What it decides |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Gate 2** | End 2031 | Spend and spread (T1-03, T1-06); corridor readiness (T2-14); investment at financial close (T2-20) | Commit Phase 3 funding; take direct route cases to carriers |
| **Terminal evaluation** | 2035 | All Tier 1 indicators against the base and accelerated paths | Close the plan and set the next one |

Source: Letsema, proposed gates; indicator codes from section 5.2.

**Alignment with Wesgro's plan.** Gate 1 falls in the fourth year of Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan, in time to shape the next one. Its paper maps the outputs to the plan's six targets. The activity targets sit at or below today's pace, while the arrivals target sits above every modelled path to 2030 (Table 1.3).[346]

## 4.8 Risks and dependencies

Twelve of the sixteen material risks sit outside Wesgro's control, so the mitigation for most of them is early warning and a route to the tier that can act.

Likelihood and impact are Letsema's assessment on a three-point scale, from the evidence cited in each row. Steerco reviews the register each quarter and the owner reports on any risk rated high on both.

**Table 4.5.** Risks and their mitigation

**Sixteen risks could move the plan off its path, and the two rated high on both measures concern the national air regime and the Gulf hubs.**

| Risk | Evidence | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Runway relief at Cape Town International slips past about 2033** | IR p103, p109 | Medium | High | Quarterly milestone tracking; frequency and gauge on full routes; George for domestic connections (I6) | Air Access; ACSA |
| **Bilateral air agreements and the US carrier cap stay restrictive** | SIR p24; Inc p8 | High | High | Escalation agenda with stated asks (I17); route work inside existing rights (I6) | Steerco; DEDAT |
| **ETA processing for China, India and African markets is slow or unmeasured** | SIR p36, p45; Diag p34; no ETA performance series is published; Indian and Chinese arrivals fell in 2026 (section 2.2) | Medium | High | Escalation agenda; ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals tracked as T2-24; a delegate escalation channel (I17); joint route, fare, visa and product diagnosis (I4) | Steerco |
| **Safety incidents or perception deter visitors** | Diag p55; SCIP p27, p30 | Medium | High | Safety gates before any pilot launch (I12); one referral pathway across the running safety services, with tested handoffs; perception tracked as T2-28 and response as T2-29 (I17) | Tourism; Steerco |
| **Climate events close sites and routes** | SCIP p24; SIR p33, p43; flood damage at 85% of CapeNature reserves by June 2026 | High | Medium | Climate risk register; node readiness assessments and tested continuity arrangements; itineraries routed around closures (I13); condition register and repairs (I11) | Research; DEDAT |

[346] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20.

| Risk | Evidence | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Water restrictions or grid constraints bind in peak season** | Diag p38, p43; IR p31; load shedding has eased, but restriction risk has risen in Cape Town (section 1.1) | Medium | Medium | Node readiness assessments before publicly supported demand expansion; escalation of utility risks; off-grid power at remote sites (I13, I17) | DEDAT; site operators |
| **MyCiTi's operating grant ends before services are funded** | The grant ends in 2027/28 and the airport service is suspended (section 2.4) | Medium | Medium | Funded service specifications for the airport link and regional services before product is sold on them (I8); escalation through Steerco (I17) | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town |
| **LTO services lapse where municipalities do not use the procurement route under MFMA Circular No. 131** | SIR p25, p39; Garden Route offices closed or cut back (section 2.4) | High | Medium | Provincial practice note; service agreements bought through lawful procurement, with a development mandate; a narrowed national clarification (I12) | DEDAT; municipalities |
| **Data holders do not share data** | SIR p37; Diag p57 | Medium | Medium | Data-sharing protocol with each holder (I16) | Research |
| **Cruise growth reverses as Red Sea reroutes end** | IR p112; reroutes made 20 of 67 calls in 2023/24 (WSP p20); visits fell from 79 in 2024/25 to 64 in 2025/26 (Wesgro prospectus, Oct 2026, p29) | Medium | Medium | Diversify lines with world cruises first, agree the circuit compact and add Mossel Bay day stops (I7) | Cruise Cape Town |
| **Skills shortages cap service quality** | SIR p43; Inc p8 | Medium | Medium | Labour analysis and skills plan (I18); quality charter (I10) | Research; DEDAT |
| **Gulf hub disruption cuts connecting capacity** | Hub routes carry 53% of arrivals on the ten largest routes (DSA p13); the 2026 disruption left Emirates at 91% of its network on 30 September | High | High | Correlated hub-closure scenarios; hub-carrier work spread beyond the Gulf to Addis Ababa, Istanbul and the European routes; resilience conditions in the air access fund; direct-route cases kept ready (I4, I6) | Air Access |
| **A downturn in the core markets** | The UK, Germany and the USA supply 52% of overseas arrivals (DSA p13) | Medium | High | Rebalance activation towards Africa and the hub markets (I1, I4, I5) | Destination Marketing |
| **Wesgro's operating budget is cut** | Thirteen initiatives draw mainly on Wesgro's operating budget (section 4.1) | Medium | High | Rand bands and a stop list agreed with DEDAT before Gate 1 (section 4.6) | Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT |

| Risk | Evidence | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Resident pushback in the Metro** | Public debate on locals' costs and access (Hypertext, Apr 2026); short-term letting concentrated in three central wards (section 2.3) | Medium | Medium | Spread visitors in time and space (I2, I8, I9); count short-term rentals by ward under a lawful evidence agreement (I16); protect resident and walk-up access in the flow pilots (I11); track resident sentiment | City of Cape Town; Cape Town Tourism |
| **Partners do not deliver the plans this one builds on** | The City's framework reports uneven past progress on its tourism plans and links it to restructuring, thin resources, little support across departments and weak monitoring (TDF p3) | Medium | High | Steerco confirms before Gate 1 which partner plans are adopted, funded and running; each charter keeps Wesgro's own route to the result (I15) | Steerco; programme office |

Source: Letsema assessment. Evidence: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026 (SCIP); Inception Report, Nov 2025 (Inc); Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30 (WSP); City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024 (TDF).

Chapter 5

# Monitoring and evaluation framework

## 5.1 Results chain

Every initiative is measured at three levels: what it produces, what changes because of it and what that adds to the 2035 case.

The framework is the written form of the M&E toolkit the SLA requires (clauses 1.1.4 and 1.1.10). It sets indicators, baselines and targets for arrivals, spend, jobs, airlift, cruise and SMME inclusion, with the tools to track them [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. The Inception Report adds geographic spread and asks for definitions, sources, frequency, owners and governance for each indicator.[347]

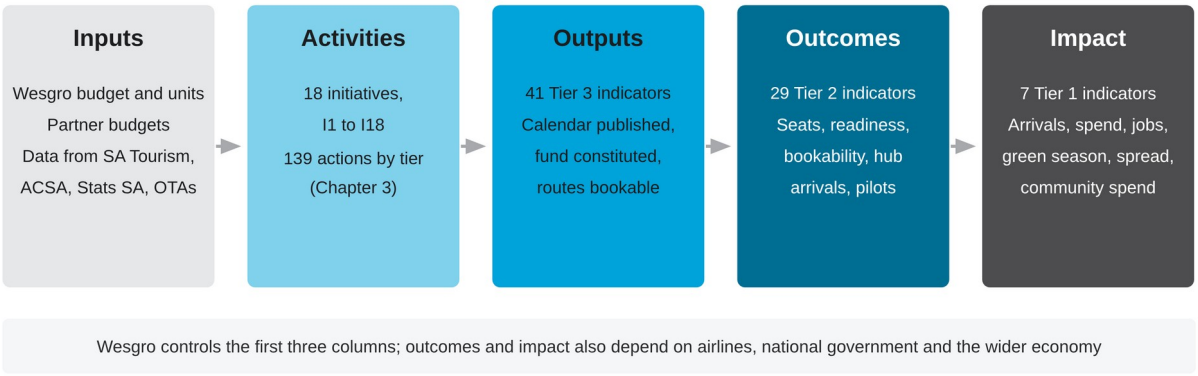



**Figure 5.1.** Results chain for the plan

The chain follows the theory of change in Figure 1.6: outputs lead to outcomes, and outcomes to impact, only where its assumptions hold.

The table below gives the chain for each initiative, goal by goal. Tier 3 output indicators come from the initiative charters, Tier 2 outcome indicators from the objectives and Tier 1 impact indicators from the growth case.

**Table 5.1.** Results chain by initiative

**Goal 1 initiatives (I1 to I5) move arrivals, market mix, spend and green-season nights. Goal 2 initiatives (I6 to I11) move seats, cruise volumes and the share of visitors and spend outside the Metro. Goal 3 initiatives (I12 to I18) move community spend and jobs, and supply the governance and data every other indicator relies on.**

| Initiative (activity) | Outputs (Tier 3) | Outcomes (Tier 2) | Impact (Tier 1) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **I1 Segment-led activation and yield** | T3-01, T3-02, T3-37, T3-38 segment targets set; spend moved to conversion; trade engagements; regional test offers booked | T2-01 segment home-market arrivals; T2-07 mature-market spend per visitor | T1-01, T1-02, T1-03 |
| **I2 Green-season events calendar** | T3-03, T3-04 calendar published; bids submitted | T2-02 ICCA meetings and bids secured; T2-03 April to September seat share | T1-05 |
| **I3 Bookable province** | T3-05, T3-06 presence and exposure baseline published; operators supported | T2-04 verified listing and usable booking route by district; T2-05 CapeNature online share | T1-06 |
| **I4 India and China hub conversion** | T3-07, T3-08 carrier agreements; route cases | T2-06 India and China hub arrivals | T1-01, T1-02 |

[347] Inception Report, p23.

| Initiative (activity) | Outputs (Tier 3) | Outcomes (Tier 2) | Impact (Tier 1) |
|---|---|---|---|
| **I5 Regional Africa** | T3-09, T3-10 activation run; capacity cases | T2-08 African arrivals and spend | T1-02, T1-03 |
| **I6 Route development and seat retention** | T3-11, T3-12, T3-39 fund constituted; runway reports; hub-closure scenarios completed | T2-09 seats and new routes; T2-10 seats added on full routes | T1-01 |
| **I7 Cruise circuit and shore capacity** | T3-13, T3-14 call-day excursion capacity; lines engaged | T2-11 cruise calls, passengers and GDP-R | T1-03 |
| **I8 Corridor mobility** | T3-15, T3-16 funded service specifications agreed; shuttles bookable | T2-12 accessibility; T2-13 corridor transfer products | T1-06 |
| **I9 Corridor product development** | T3-17, T3-18 itineraries listed; assets activated | T2-14 readiness by district; T2-26 overnight share by district; T2-27 tourist spend share of district GDPR | T1-06 |
| **I10 Visitor experience and quality** | T3-19, T3-20, T3-41 charter adopted; businesses certified; accessible journeys verified | T2-15 routes rated Ready | T1-03 |
| **I11 Flagship site demand management** | T3-21, T3-22, T3-40 baseline published; flow pilots run; condition register and repairs | T2-16 peak Cableway queue and flagship visitors | T1-06 |
| **I12 Community inclusion pilots** | T3-23, T3-24, T3-26 pilots selected; tests held; LTO procurement practice note issued | T2-17 communities with a live booking route; T2-18 LTOs with a service agreement | T1-07 |
| **I13 Destination readiness and climate resilience** | T3-25 risk register published | T2-19 weather losses | T1-06 |
| **I14 Tourism investment pipeline** | T3-27, T3-28 cases prepared; investor engagements | T2-20 projects at financial close | T1-03, T1-04 |
| **I15 Steerco and three-tier alignment** | T3-29, T3-30 quarterly Steerco; joint industry plan | T2-21 escalations resolved; T2-22 partners in the joint plan | All |
| **I16 Data protocol and intelligence** | T3-31, T3-32 agreements signed; dashboard live | T2-23 data feeds in the dashboard | All |
| **I17 Access and safety escalation** | T3-33, T3-34 agenda tabled; responses logged | T2-24 ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals; T2-28 visitors who report feeling safe; T2-29 safety response and completed handoffs | T1-01, T1-02 |
| **I18 Labour analysis and skills plan** | T3-35, T3-36 analysis published; skills plan adopted | T2-25 labour analysis published | T1-04 |

Source: Initiative charters (section 4.3); indicator register (section 5.2).

## 5.2 Indicator set

Seven impact indicators, twenty-nine outcome indicators and forty-one output indicators measure the plan, each with a definition, a source, an owner and a frequency.

Tier 1 measures the 2035 case and is reported to the Board. Tier 2 measures the objectives, one to three each, and is reported to Steerco each quarter where the source allows. Tier 3 measures the initiatives' own outputs and is reported by the leads to the programme office each month. The full register, with targets, sits in the toolkit (section 5.7).

**Table 5.2.** Tier 1 impact indicators

| Code | Indicator | Definition | Source | Frequency | Owner |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T1-01** | International arrivals | Arrivals, growth-model basis; quarterly proxy: international passenger arrivals at CTIA | SA Tourism; ACSA | Annual; quarterly proxy | Research |
| **T1-02** | Arrivals by market group | Arrivals in the mature, hub, regional, acceleration and strategic groups | SA Tourism [Open item: SA Tourism cannot report the Hubs group; Skift to define it.] | Annual | Research |
| **T1-03** | Direct foreign spend | Foreign direct spend in the Western Cape, rand | SA Tourism | Annual; quarterly shares | Research |
| **T1-04** | Tourism jobs | Tourism jobs in the Western Cape, on the measure the labour analysis sets (I18) | Labour analysis (I18); Stats SA TSA | Annual | Research |
| **T1-05** | Green-season nights and share | Overseas visitor nights in April to September, and their share of the year, reported beside peak-season volume | SA Tourism; Wesgro visitor tracking | Annual | Research |
| **T1-06** | Share outside the Metro | Share of arrivals and of spend recorded outside the Cape Metro | SA Tourism provincial data; Provincial Treasury district reviews; Wesgro visitor tracking; data protocol | Annual | Research |
| **T1-07** | Community share of foreign direct spend | Spend traced to businesses trading inside the pilot communities, as a share of foreign direct spend; widened to the 20 shortlisted communities once a source covers them | Pilot records; SA Tourism | Annual | Tourism; Research |

Source: Letsema, indicator register; SLA clauses 1.1.4 and 1.1.10; Inception Report, Nov 2025, p22, p23. Baselines and targets in section 5.3.

**Table 5.3.** Tier 2 outcome indicators

**Twenty-nine Tier 2 indicators give each objective one to three outcome measures, and ten of them take their baseline in 2027.**

| Code | Indicator | Objective | Baseline | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-01** | Arrivals from the four largest segment home markets (UK, Germany, USA, India) | 1 | 503,277 (2025, computed) | MA p21, p22 |
| **T2-02** | ICCA association meetings and business event bids secured in Cape Town | 2 | 58 meetings (2024); 36 conference bids secured (2024/25) | DSA p36, p37 |
| **T2-03** | April to September share of international seats at CTIA | 2 | 41.8% of seats (2025, computed); 40.8% of passenger movements (2025), after 38.7% in 2015 and 41.6% in 2023 | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **T2-04** | Eligible regional product with a verified listing and a usable booking route, by district and channel, for accommodation and for experiences; exposure in the first 20 eligible results reported beside it | 3 | Set by the discovery-to-sale audit in 2027 (I3); the 36-case desk test is not a baseline | I3 audit |
| **T2-05** | CapeNature reservations made online | 3 | About 70% through the call centre | SIR p42 |
| **T2-06** | India and China arrivals via hubs | 4 | India 76,547; China with Hong Kong 43,412 (2025, model value) | MA p20, p22 |

| Code | Indicator | Objective | Baseline | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-07** | Spend per visitor, mature markets | 5 | USA R32,900; UK R26,500; Germany R25,600 (2024) | DSA p14 |
| **T2-08** | African arrivals and spend | 6 | 292,514 arrivals (2025, model value, regional group); R4.2bn spend (2025) | MA p20; DSA p29 |
| **T2-09** | International seats and routes at CTIA; new routes tested on load factor and survival | 7 | 3,816,797 seats, printed network total (27 routes tabled; year to Nov 2025); 29 routes (2026) | MIDAS, The Capetown Market; Seasonality |
| **T2-10** | Seats added on routes above 80% load | 7 | 11 routes above 80% (year to Nov 2025); seats added from the capacity-against-demand model (I6) | MIDAS, Seasonality |
| **T2-11** | Cruise calls, unique passengers and GDP-R | 8 | 64 cruise liner visits; about 106,000 passengers; R1.35bn GDP-R (2025/26). For 2024/25: 79 vessel visits; 106,315 unique passengers (127,128 passenger counts); R1.79bn GDP-R after displacement; the Infrastructure Report counts 83 calls (p110) | Prospectus p29; StratEcon p8 to p10, p22; Diag p37 |
| **T2-12** | Accessibility score by district | 9 | Metro 4.7 to Central Karoo 1.0 (2026) | IR p88 |
| **T2-13** | Corridor transfer products on sale | 9 | No inter-town tourism shuttle on the Garden Route | IR p90 |
| **T2-14** | Overall readiness by district | 10 | Metro 4.5; Garden Route and Winelands 3.4; Overberg 2.7; West Coast 2.5; Central Karoo 1.9 | IR p28 to p85 |
| **T2-15** | Touring routes rated Ready | 11 | 1 of 6 (2026) | IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84 |
| **T2-16** | Peak queue at the Cableway; visitors at six flagships | 12 | Up to three hours up and two down; 2023 visitors from 239,641 at Robben Island to 2,795,838 in Table Mountain National Park | SIR p36; MERO Cape Metro p69 |
| **T2-17** | Communities with a live booking route | 13 | 0 of 19 profiled rate Ready on bookability | SCIP p20 to p26, p40 to p51 |
| **T2-18** | LTOs with a service agreement bought through lawful procurement | 13 | Not in hand | SIR p25 |
| **T2-19** | Weather losses at flagship sites | 14 | Robben Island roughly R16m a year | SIR p33 |
| **T2-20** | Tourism projects at financial close | 15 | None; tourism gaps carry no committed capital | IR p32 to p87 |
| **T2-21** | Escalation items answered by the national tier | 16 | No agenda tabled yet | This plan |
| **T2-22** | Industry partners signed up to the joint plan | 17 | No joint plan; 15 of 16 organisations raised collaboration | SIR p20 to p46 |
| **T2-23** | Automated data feeds in the dashboard | 18 | None; no dashboard | This plan |
| **T2-24** | ETA decision times (median and 90th percentile) and authorisations matched to arrivals, priority markets | 19 | Not in hand; the ETA launched on 12 August 2026 and no performance series is published. As history, the eVisa rejected 3,687 first-year applications because the travel date had passed | SIR p36, p45; BDO p12 |
| **T2-25** | Tourism labour analysis published | 20 | No labour analysis in any deliverable | Inc p4 |
| **T2-26** | Share of visitors staying overnight, by district | 10 | Not in hand for international visitors; the Treasury's district samples are mostly domestic (2023) | MERO Garden Route p150 to p151; MERO West Coast p128 to p130; Diag p48 |

| Code | Indicator | Objective | Baseline | Source |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-27** | Tourist spend as a share of GDPR, by district | 10 | Overberg 15.6%; West Coast 16.8%; Cape Winelands 7.0%; Metro 6.7% (2023); Garden Route and Central Karoo to confirm | MERO Cape Metro p72; Cape Winelands p113; Overberg p119; West Coast p131 |
| **T2-28** | Visitors who report feeling safe, priority markets | 19 | Not in hand; from Wesgro visitor tracking, if the survey asks the question | This plan |
| **T2-29** | Tourism safety response and completed handoffs in pilot hotspots | 19 | Not in hand; set from the referral pathway's records in 2027 (I17) | This plan |

Source: Chapter 3 evidence tables. MA: Market Assessment Report, May 2026. DSA: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026. IR: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026. SIR: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026. SCIP: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026. Diag: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025. Inc: Inception Report, Nov 2025. MIDAS: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026. StratEcon: Cruise Liner Economic Contribution Study 2024/25, Oct 2025. Prospectus: Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026. MERO: Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, by district. BDO: BDO for DEDAT, Western Cape Visa Regime Study, Jul 2024. Computed values are sums or shares of printed figures.

The ten that take their baseline later are T2-04, T2-18, T2-20, T2-21, T2-23, T2-24, T2-25, T2-26, T2-28 and T2-29. Each takes its target once its baseline exists, on the dates in the data gaps table (section 5.4).

**Table 5.4.** Tier 3 output indicators

| Codes | Initiative | Outputs |
|---|---|---|
| **T3-01, T3-02, T3-37, T3-38** | I1 | Segment targets in Wesgro's annual plan; share of market budget in trade-led conversion; international tourism trade engagements by market; regional test offers with completed regional bookings |
| **T3-03, T3-04** | I2 | Green-season calendar published; all bids submitted, and those for May to September events |
| **T3-05, T3-06** | I3 | Inventory and first presence and exposure baseline published; operators supported after the audit, with fulfilled bookings traced |
| **T3-07, T3-08** | I4 | Joint marketing agreements with hub carriers; India and China route cases prepared |
| **T3-09, T3-10** | I5 | Activation programmes run in Nigeria and Kenya; regional capacity cases made |
| **T3-11, T3-12, T3-39** | I6 | Air access fund constituted; quarterly runway milestone reports issued; correlated hub-closure scenarios completed |
| **T3-13, T3-14** | I7 | Call-day excursion capacity beyond the flagship sites; lines engaged on expedition and home-porting |
| **T3-15, T3-16** | I8 | Funded service specifications agreed for the airport link and regional services; corridor shuttle products bookable |
| **T3-17, T3-18** | I9 | Multi-day itineraries listed per route; cold-zone assets activated |
| **T3-19, T3-20, T3-41** | I10 | Quality charter adopted; businesses certified; accessible journeys verified and published |
| **T3-21, T3-22, T3-40** | I11 | Flagship baseline published; flow pilots run against a stop rule; condition register published and repairs completed |
| **T3-23, T3-24, T3-26** | I12 | Pilot communities selected; fixed-date tests held; LTO procurement practice note issued |
| **T3-25** | I13 | Climate risk register published |
| **T3-27, T3-28** | I14 | Investment cases prepared; investor engagements held |
| **T3-29, T3-30** | I15 | Steerco meetings held each quarter; joint industry plan agreed |
| **T3-31, T3-32** | I16 | Data-sharing agreements signed; dashboard live |
| **T3-33, T3-34** | I17 | Escalation agenda tabled; responses logged |
| **T3-35, T3-36** | I18 | Labour analysis published; skills plan adopted |

Source: Initiative charters, section 4.3. Each output has a baseline of zero at the start of 2027, except T3-37: Wesgro counted 2,500 international tourism trade engagements in FY24 and targets 12,500 over FY26 to FY30 (Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20).

## 5.3 Baselines and targets

The arrivals targets come straight from the growth model, while the jobs and other Tier 1 targets wait for baselines that do not yet exist.

Baselines are fixed at 2025, the growth model's base year, for the growth-model indicators and at FY2024/25 for the airport series, the recovery baseline used in Chapter 1. Targets follow two paths: the base case, which assumes Wesgro's current activity continues with hub carriers adding capacity, and the accelerated case, which adds direct India and China routes and dedicated activation. The model prints the base case for 2028, 2030, 2032, 2034 and 2035, and the other paths for 2035 only. The 2031 base value and the accelerated milestones are computed and marked as such.[348]

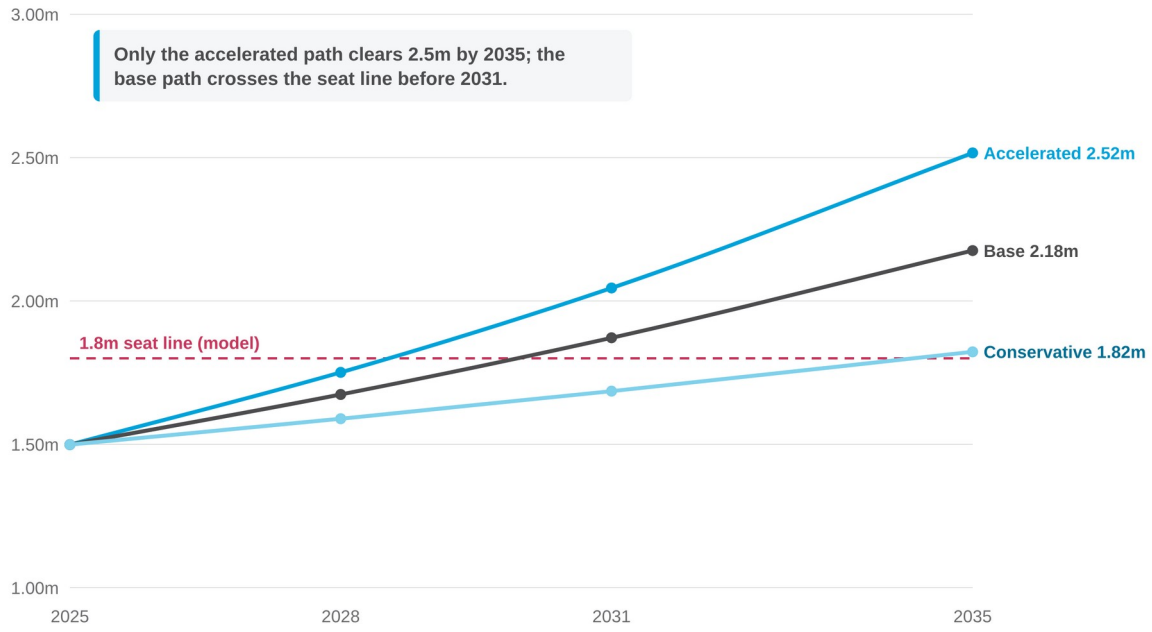



**Figure 5.2.** Arrivals paths and milestones to 2035

**Table 5.5.** Tier 1 baselines and targets

**Arrivals carry targets on both paths; spend carries the working analysis's base path; jobs and the other Tier 1 indicators set baselines first.**

| Indicator | Baseline | 2028 base / accelerated | 2031 base / accelerated | 2035 base / accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T1-01 International arrivals** | 1,498,829 (2025, model value); CTIA 1.44m (FY24/25) | 1,673,855 / 1,750,871* | 1,871,637 / *2,045,297* | 2,175,778 / 2,516,282 |
| **T1-02 Arrivals by market group** | Mature 587,287; hubs 427,803; regional 292,514; acceleration 182,815 (2025) | Base path by group, section 2.2 | 2030: 670,350; 523,523; 343,096; 255,159 | 766,067; 634,387; 402,812; 358,633 (base); accelerated not split |
| **T1-03 Direct foreign spend** | R25.9bn (FY2025, nominal) | Not printed | R33.7bn in 2030 (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand) | R40.6bn (base, modelled, constant 2024 rand); accelerated not modelled |

[348] Demand-Side Analysis, p19.

| Indicator | Baseline | 2028 base / accelerated | 2031 base / accelerated | 2035 base / accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T1-04 Tourism jobs** | Set by the labour analysis (I18) | Set at Gate 1 | Set at Gate 1 | Set at Gate 1 |
| **T1-05 Green-season nights and share** | 38.1% (2025, normalised); 39% (2024) | Level set at Gate 1 | Nights rising | Nights rising; share reported beside green and peak volumes |
| **T1-06 Share outside the Metro** | Not in hand; baseline due in 2027 from the data protocol, drawing on the Treasury's district reviews and Wesgro visitor tracking | Baseline set | Rising | Rising |
| **T1-07 Community share of spend** | 0.02% to 0.04%; R4m to R10m a year (floor) | Pilots measured | Level set after the pilots | 1% (R259m at FY2025 spend) as the reference point |

Source: T1-01: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11, p20, p21 (computed values marked *). T1-02: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20. T1-03: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p11 (baseline); Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p24 (modelled base path, working analysis). T1-04: baseline and targets to be set by the labour analysis (I18). T1-05: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p12; Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p32. T1-07: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p5.

**Arrivals.** The model's 2025 base and the airport series measure different things: arrivals on the growth model's basis, which Skift is to confirm (Appendix A2), and international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International. The airport series is the quarterly proxy because ACSA publishes it, and it stood at 1.44m in FY24/25 and 1.57m in FY25/26. Both are reported, each against its own history.[349]

**Wesgro's targets.** Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan sets five-year levels for four indicators. Three of them sit below the recent pace and the fourth holds it. T2-11 counts calls toward 250, about 50 a year, against 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26 and 79 in 2024/25, because its base appears to leave out the 2023/24 reroutes. T2-02 counts bids secured toward 161, about 32 a year at about R28m each, against 36 at about R20.7m each in 2024/25. T2-09 counts first-time scheduled international routes toward 10, two a year, against about three a year since 2015 on Cape Town Air Access's count. It tests each route on load factor and survival. T3-37 counts trade engagements toward 12,500, about 2,500 a year and flat on FY24. Each indicator therefore reports against Wesgro's level and its own baseline, and the action plan's target is the higher of the two. Wesgro's 800,000 to 1 million new arrivals runs above every modelled path to 2030 (Table 1.3), so T1-01 keeps the model's targets and reports Wesgro's beside them.[350]

**Spend.** T1-03's path holds spend per arrival fixed, so its targets are in constant 2024 rand, while SA Tourism reports nominal rand; progress is read after deflating by CPI. The model's 2024 spend of R27.12bn sits 19% above the R22.7bn SA Tourism reported for FY2024. [Open item: Skift to rebase the spend path on the FY2025 actual of R25.9bn.][351]

**Jobs.** T1-04's baseline is set by the labour analysis at Gate 1 (I18). Wesgro Research first extracts the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025 [provincial tourism employment baseline: Wesgro Research to supply from the Pero 2025 or the Stats SA provincial TSA]. The modelled path follows once the provincial measure is fixed.

The report restates the 300,000 as a total-sector figure for the labour analysis to test (I18). For context, public sources put direct tourism employment at 106,707 in Cape Town in 2024 and 953,981 nationally in 2024. The City's framework counts about 45,000 direct and 150,000 total tourism jobs in Cape Town. Its direct count probably rests on a narrower definition than the 106,707; the labour analysis reconciles the two.[352]

[349] Demand-Side Analysis, p11.
[350] Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20, p59; Diagnostic, p37; Wesgro, Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape, Oct 2026, p29; Demand-Side Analysis, p36, computed; Cape Town Air Access, Letsema Update, Nov 2025, slide 5, computed.
[351] Market Assessment, p10, p24.
[352] City of Cape Town, Economic Value of Tourism, 2025; Stats SA Tourism Satellite Account, provisional, as reported in 2026; City of Cape Town, Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024, p3.

**Green season.** The 2025 month table sums to 104.9%. Normalised, it gives 61.9% for October to March and 38.1% for the green season, in line with the printed 61% and 39% for 2024. T1-05 uses 38.1% as its baseline. Absolute April to September nights and revenue are reported beside the share, because a share alone cannot show whether winter demand grew. The share has in fact slipped while volume grew: the airport series puts April to September at 41.6% of movements in 2023 and 40.8% in 2025. A share that rises because summer falls is not the intended gain.[353]

**Spread and community spend.** No deliverable prints district visitor spend. The Provincial Treasury's district reviews print tourist spend as a share of GDPR, from 6.7% in the Metro to 16.8% on the West Coast in 2023. That measures tourism's weight in each district economy, not where provincial visitor spend lands. The share outside the Metro therefore takes its baseline from the data protocol in 2027 (I16), and T1-06 carries no interim level before then. The community share starts from the Inclusion Plan's traced floor; its 1% is a reference point the plan prints, not a target any party has adopted.[354]

**Domestic context.** Domestic trips and spend are tracked as context and carry no target, because the plan's mandate is international (section 1.3). The 2025 position is about 4.0 million overnight trips and R12.7 billion of nominal overnight spend. Read beside T1-05 and T1-06, the measure shows whether green-season and regional demand is shared with South African travellers or crowded out by rising peak prices.

## 5.4 Data sources and gaps

Arrivals, seats and cruise volumes can be tracked from existing feeds; spread, bookability, jobs and community spend cannot until new data is built or shared.

Stakeholders put data among the top barriers: provincial tourism GDP and jobs need an approved method (section 2.4), and no one holds a single view of visitor behaviour. The data-sharing protocol under objective 18 (I16) is the route to closing the gaps below.[355]

**Table 5.6.** Data sources and holders

| Source | Holder | Indicators | Frequency | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Departure survey and performance reports** | SA Tourism | T1-01 to T1-03, T1-05, T2-07, T2-08 | Quarterly and annual | Published; provincial cuts on request |
| **Passenger statistics and schedules** | ACSA; OAG | T1-01 proxy, T2-03, T2-09 | Monthly | Available; automated feed possible |
| **Accommodation performance review** | Cape Town Tourism; Horwath HTL | T1-05 context | Monthly | Published sample; Cape Town only |
| **GDS bookings by route** | MIDAS or a data vendor | T2-06, T2-10 | Annual | Repeat commission needed |
| **Cruise season economic contribution** | StratEcon for Wesgro (economic contribution study) | T2-11 | Each season | The 2024/25 study is in hand and cited, with GDP-R after displacement; the 2025/26 headline results come from Wesgro's prospectus [Cruise Cape Town to supply the StratEcon 2025/26 study] |

[353] Demand-Side Analysis, p12; Diagnostic, p32.
[354] Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p72; Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, West Coast, p131; Inclusion Plan, p5.
[355] Stakeholder Insights, p37; Diagnostic, p56, p57.

| Source | Holder | Indicators | Frequency | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Infrastructure readiness scores** | Wesgro; Letsema method | T2-12, T2-14, T2-15 | Every three years | Re-score in 2029 and 2032 [Open item: publish the scoring formula before the 2029 re-score; the Infrastructure Report's overall ratings are judgement-based (Appendix A4).] |
| **Provincial and district economic reviews** | Provincial Treasury | T1-06, T2-16, T2-26, T2-27 | Annual | Published; tourism sections draw on Wesgro and S&P Global data |
| **Integrated Transport Hub** | Department of Mobility | T2-12, T2-13 | To be agreed | Not yet shared; to join the protocol (I16) |
| **Operator, site and pilot records** | LTOs; CapeNature; site operators; pilots | T2-04, T2-05, T2-16, T2-17, T2-19 | Annual | New collection under the protocol |
| **Safety service and referral records** | City of Cape Town; DEDAT; SAPS; SANParks | T2-29 | Quarterly | New collection under the referral pathway (I17) |
| **ETA applications, decisions and matched arrivals** | Home Affairs | T2-24 | Monthly, on request | Not published; requested through the escalation agenda (I17) |

Source: Letsema, from the indicator register; data holders in part as listed in Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p56, p57. Provincial Treasury: Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25, Cape Metro, p8 to p9, p68 to p73. Integrated Transport Hub: Western Cape Department of Mobility, draft Provincial Land Transport Framework, Apr 2025, p3-60.

**Table 5.7.** Data gaps and owners

**Twenty-five data gaps stand between the plan and a full baseline, and each has a proposed owner and route.**

| Gap | Indicator | Proposed owner | Proposed date | Route |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **District-level visitor arrivals and spend** | T1-06 | Research | End 2027 | SA Tourism cut; Treasury district reviews; Wesgro visitor tracking; protocol |
| **Provincial tourism employment baseline** | T1-04 | Research | Mid 2027 | Pero; Stats SA provincial TSA |
| **Eligible supply, platform presence, exposure, usable booking routes and fulfilled sales, by district** | T2-04 | Research | End 2027 | Discovery-to-sale audit (I3, I16) |
| **Carrying capacity at the flagship sites; 2023 visitor counts are in hand** | T2-16 | Research | End 2027 | Request to operators (I11) |
| **Meetings, incentives and exhibitions volumes** | T2-02 | Convention Bureau | End 2028 | Venue and DMC returns |
| **LTOs and their municipal service agreements** | T2-18 | DEDAT | End 2027 | LTO survey |
| **ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals, by market** | T2-24 | Wesgro CEO's office | End 2027 | Request to Home Affairs for monthly ETA performance data (I17) |
| **Nigeria and Ghana in the growth model** | T1-02 | Research | Mid 2027 | Model update |
| **Definition of a call behind the plan's 250: cruise liner visits (64 in 2025/26, 79 in 2024/25) or vessel calls (83 in 2024/25)** | T2-11 | Cruise Cape Town | Mid 2027 | Cruise Cape Town; StratEcon |

| Gap | Indicator | Proposed owner | Proposed date | Route |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Accommodation stock by district and type: hotel, guesthouse and short-term rental** | T2-15 | Research | End 2028 | Accommodation audit (I10); short-term rental evidence agreement (I16) |
| **Overnight share of international visitors, by district** | T2-26 | Research | End 2027 | Treasury district reviews; Wesgro visitor tracking |
| **Garden Route and Central Karoo tourist spend shares, identical series to confirm** | T2-27 | Research | Mid 2027 | Provincial Treasury |
| **Visitors who feel safe, priority markets** | T2-28 | Research | End 2027 | Safety question in Wesgro visitor tracking |
| **Aided and unaided awareness of the city, the province and its regions, priority markets** | T2-01 | Research | End 2027 | Brand research baseline (I16) |
| **Visitor mode split, international and domestic** | T2-12 | Department of Mobility; Research | End 2028 | Wesgro visitor tracking; Integrated Transport Hub (I8, I16) |
| **Tourism safety responses and handoffs in pilot hotspots** | T2-29 | DEDAT; City of Cape Town | End 2027 | Referral pathway records (I17) |
| **Condition of reserve and flagship assets** | T2-16 | CapeNature; site operators | End 2027 | Costed condition register (I11) |
| **Open posts by occupation, place and season** | T1-04 | DEDAT; Research | End 2028 | Employer-linked labour analysis (I18) |
| **Effect of short-term rentals on rents and prices, by precinct** | Context | City of Cape Town; Research | To be agreed | Property-level evidence agreement (I16) |
| **Domestic trips by month, purpose and origin** | Context | Research | End 2027 | Wesgro and SA Tourism survey extract |
| **Public event awards and full service costs, by funder** | T2-02 | Convention Bureau; DEDAT | End 2027 | Common return from public funders (I2) |
| **Flown seats and itineraries by hub** | T2-09, T2-10 | Air Access | End 2027 | ACSA, airline and itinerary data (I6) |
| **Commissioned water, wastewater and power headroom by node** | Context | DEDAT; municipalities | End 2028 | Node readiness assessments (I13) |
| **Guide register: active and pending records and processing times** | T2-15 | DEDAT | End 2027 | Registrar service returns (I10) |
| **Sold and available room nights by month, region and accommodation type, on a constant panel** | T1-05 | Research; Cape Town Tourism | End 2027 | Accommodation partners' returns (I2, I16) |

Source: Letsema, from the placeholders in Chapters 3 and 5; owners and dates proposed for Steerco to confirm.

## 5.5 Tracking mechanism

A quarterly scorecard to Steerco, an annual outlook to the Board and a live dashboard where the sources allow it.

Four principles run the tracking. Automate before collecting by hand: arrivals, seats and cruise volumes come from feeds that already exist. Name one owner for the dashboard (the programme office) and one

for the definitions (Wesgro Research). Report every indicator against its own baseline and both paths. Refresh the register each year at the plan review.

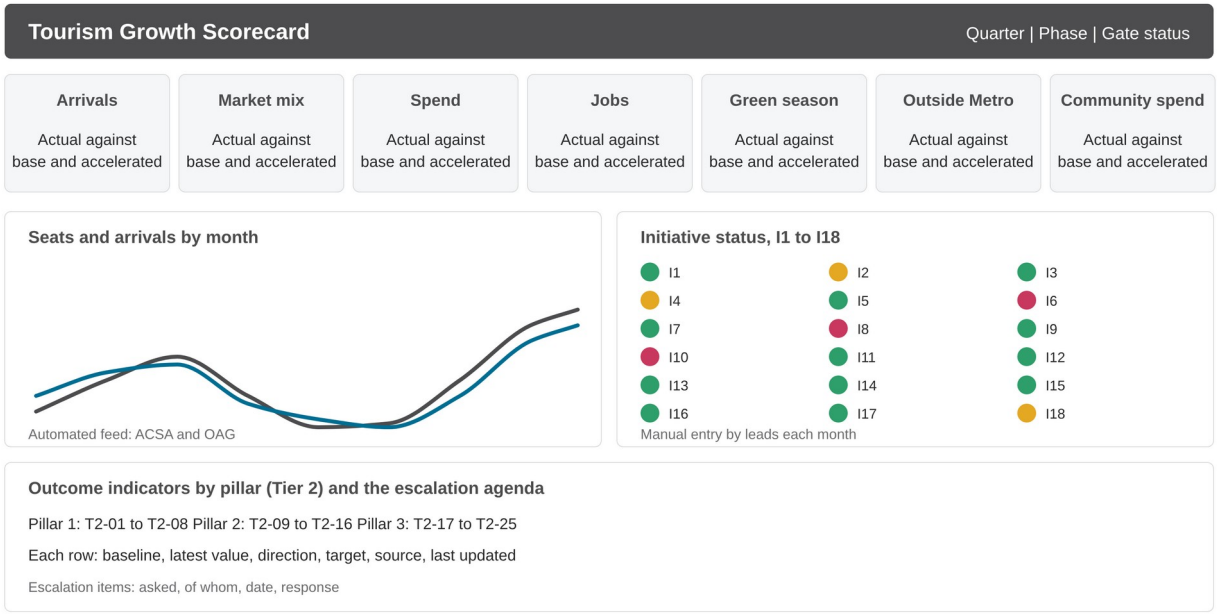



**Figure 5.3.** Quarterly scorecard layout

Reporting runs on a fixed calendar tied to Steerco and the Board. Each month, the leads send Tier 3 outputs, initiative status and the seats and arrivals feeds to the programme office as a dashboard update. Each quarter, the programme office takes Tier 2 outcomes where available, the risks rated high and the escalation responses to Steerco in the scorecard. Each year, Steerco takes Tier 1 impact against both paths, the plan refresh and gate status to the Board in an outlook report, made public at the business outlook event. At each gate, Steerco sends the Board a gate paper on the tests in section 4.7.

## 5.6 Evaluation and learning

Two evaluations bracket the plan: a mid-term review in 2030, when the base case crosses the model's seat line, and a terminal evaluation in 2035.

The mid-term review tests whether the plan is on its path and whether the path still holds. It falls in 2030 because that is when the base case crosses the model's 1.8 million seat line, before runway relief on the planning date. The review also falls at the end of Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan period, so it reads the plan's six targets against the result. The terminal evaluation in 2035 measures the result against both paths and sets up the next plan. Both should be run by a party independent of the programme office.[356]

Evaluation examines whether the expected mechanisms operate, for whom, at what cost and under which conditions. It considers actual implementation, visitor and operator responses, additional benefit and alternative explanations. Sector growth alone cannot establish programme attribution. Pilots, proportionate comparisons, commercial evidence and independent review can strengthen an assessment of contribution.[357]

Each goal carries two evaluation questions, one on results and one on the assumptions behind them. For Reshape demand: did arrivals, spend per visitor and green-season nights and share move with the activation, and in which markets and segments? Is conversion still the constraint, or has access overtaken it in the growth markets? For Transform supply: did seats, readiness and bookability rise outside the

[356] Demand-Side Analysis, p21; Infrastructure Report, p103; Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20.
[357] HM Treasury (2020), Magenta Book Supplementary Guide: Handling Complexity in Policy Evaluation (CECAN).

Metro, and did visitors follow? Did the airport relief arrive on time, and did the second gateways carry the load meanwhile? For Build enabling capability: did the pilots meet their thresholds, and did community spend rise? Did the national asks get answers, and did the data protocol deliver the baselines?

**Pilots before capital.** The inclusion pilots are evaluated before any capital is committed, on the Inclusion Plan's own measures: bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue. A pilot scales only when it meets the thresholds agreed before launch. The same rule applies to any product or asset investment under I9 and I14: test demand, then invest.[358]

**Learning into the plan.** Findings from each review, gate and pilot go into the annual plan refresh under section 4.7, so the charters, targets and sequence change with the evidence rather than at the end of the plan.

## 5.7 Toolkit handover

The M&E toolkit turns this chapter into four working files that Wesgro Research owns from handover.

The four files are the indicator register, the baseline workbook, the scorecard template and the dashboard data model (SLA clauses 1.1.10.2 and 1.1.15.3) [clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B]. The indicator register holds all 77 indicators with their definition, unit, source, frequency, owner, baseline and target by year and path. The baseline workbook holds the baseline values with page references to the deliverables, and the computed values with their method. Wesgro Research owns both. The programme office owns the scorecard template, which carries the quarterly Steerco scorecard and the annual Board outlook. It also owns the dashboard data model: the feeds, refresh frequency and manual-entry forms for the dashboard in section 5.5.

Handover runs through knowledge-transfer sessions with Wesgro Research and the programme office, as the SLA requires (clause 1.1.15). The Excel toolkit itself is outside this report and is listed as an open item [M&E toolkit workbook: Letsema to deliver with the final report].

[358] Inclusion Plan, p33, p32.

# Appendices

# A1 Evidence behind the objectives

Every objective traces back to the evidence behind it and forward to its initiative and indicators, with a rating for the strength of that evidence.

The first table sets out what the evidence supports for each objective and rates its strength on a three-point scale: strong, adequate or thin. The second table traces each objective back to its workstream and the sections that discuss it, and forward to its initiative and indicators.

**Table A.1.** Strength of evidence by objective

**Nine objectives rest on strong evidence and ten on adequate evidence; only objective 20 is thin, and several figures hold only with a qualifier.**

| Objective | What the evidence supports | Strength |
|---|---|---|
| **1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences** | Four segments confirmed against markets of high incidence; the segmentation is directional and leaves out the domestic and seven African markets; no comparable awareness measure exists for the province and its regions | Strong |
| **2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events** | June holds 6.4% of 2025 international seat capacity; ICCA meetings 33 to 58 from 2022 to 2024; 36 bids secured in 2024/25 at an estimated R745.1m, which are not delivered winter nights; quieter-month passenger traffic doubled from 2015 to 2025, while Cape Town sample occupancy in May to August 2025 stayed below 2019 | Strong |
| **3 Make the whole province findable and bookable** | Regional rooms are listed in every eligible case of a 21-case desk test, with prominence and sales unmeasured; none of 19 profiled communities rates Ready on digital and bookability; CapeNature takes about 70% of reservations through its call centre, and community product sells by phone; the I3 audit sets the baseline | Adequate |
| **4 Convert India and China hub traffic** | About 101,000 journeys a year via hubs, the sum of two printed estimates, 71,000 and 30,000; the hub tables sum to 97,579; Indian and Chinese arrivals to South Africa fell 30.0% and 23.7% in January to September 2026 | Strong |
| **5 Increase yield in mature markets** | Five mature long-haul routes above 80% load; no fare or yield data | Adequate |
| **6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)** | Nigeria R31,000 and Ghana R27,700 a visit, read as spend per visitor; the printed averages do not reproduce from the totals | Strong |
| **7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes** | Eleven of 27 routes run above 80% load and sixteen at 75% or more, and carriers are expected to raise fares before adding seats. No frequency, aircraft-size or peak-slot data shows where seats can be added; Wesgro's plan targets 10 new routes by FY30; the 2026 Gulf disruption showed that hubs in one region share risk | Adequate |
| **8 Grow cruise calls and ports** | 64 cruise liner visits in 2025/26, after 79 visits and 83 vessel calls in 2024/25, against berth capacity of 150 or more; Wesgro's plan sets 250 calls over FY26 to FY30; the regional circuit and call-day shore capacity set growth, and value grows with international passengers, not volume | Adequate |
| **9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility** | Accessibility falls from 4.7 to 1.0 on the attractions and services basis; the transport basis gives 5.0 to 1.0; no verified visitor mode split exists, and MyCiTi's operating grant ends in 2027/28 | Strong |
| **10 Support diversified route and product development** | Cold zones, the Infrastructure Report's term for areas with tourism assets but little or no tourism use; no count of idle assets | Strong |
| **11 Align visitor experience in-destination** | A mid-market gap that differs by place, stated in words; George already has a branded conference hotel; no room or bed count by district and type | Adequate |
| **12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions** | Stakeholder statements and queue times; the Treasury counts 2023 visitors at six flagships, but no source sets capacity or caps; CapeNature's 2025/26 accounts show ecotourism revenue of R82.038m beside repairs of R16.058m | Adequate |

| Objective | What the evidence supports | Strength |
|---|---|---|
| **13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion** | Seller with a stake, 20 communities and R259m a year at 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend; one page prints 18 shortlisted, and the spend-tracing method is not described; LTO services can be bought through procurement under Circular 131, and Garden Route offices lapsed in 2025/26 | Strong |
| **14 Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk** | Meiringspoort closed, and 85% of CapeNature reserves reported flood damage by June 2026; Cape Town's first Faure water arrives in 2031; tourist spend equals 15.6% to 16.8% of GDPR in the Overberg and on the West Coast, with the Garden Route and Central Karoo to confirm | Adequate |
| **15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies** | An inference: a large capital pipeline exists and almost none of it reaches regional product, SME bookability or township product; a levy follows a statutory route that can take more than a year | Adequate |
| **16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers** | Air rights and visas sit nationally, as the Diagnostic's tier table shows; no decision-rights map exists | Adequate |
| **17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration** | Raised by 15 of 16 organisations, a reconstructed count of organisations, not insight rows | Strong |
| **18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing** | Platforms exist; no data-sharing protocol in progress is described; the Treasury's reviews and the Integrated Transport Hub already hold district and transport data; short-term rentals are largely uncounted | Adequate |
| **19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits** | Levers sit nationally for visas and air rights; safety programmes are provincial and basic services local; DEDAT's visa study ranks the reforms; the ETA replaced the eVisa in 2026 and no performance series is published; the City's and DEDAT's tourist safety services run | Strong |
| **20 Develop workforce and service skills** | Provincial tourism employment baseline to be set by the labour analysis (I18), commissioned in 2027; industry employment totals cannot identify unfilled posts | Thin |

Source: Reading and strength from the evidence notes behind Chapter 3. Strong: the figure and finding are printed in two deliverables or in one with a full table. Adequate: supported, with a figure missing, different or from one source. Thin: side mentions only. Wesgro, provincial and City documents add to the reading where Chapter 3 cites them; the ratings rest on the deliverables.

**Table A.2.** Traceability by objective

| Objective | Workstream | Sections | Initiative | Indicators |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences** | Skift segmentation (March 2026), carried into the Market Assessment and Demand-Side Analysis; the City's four segments (Tourism Development Framework) | 2.2 | I1 | T1-01; T1-02; T2-01 |
| **2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events** | MIDAS seasonality (June 6.4% of international seats) and the Demand-Side MICE section (ICCA, UIA); Wesgro's plan (161 bids); study-team airport time series, 2015 to 2025 | 2.2; 2.1; 2.3 | I2 | T1-05; T2-02; T2-03 |
| **3 Make the whole province findable and bookable** | Inclusion plan (community product sold by phone), Stakeholder Insights (Cape Nature 70% through the call centre), Infrastructure Report (route bookability gaps); study-team desk test of listing presence (November 2026) | 2.2; 2.1; 2.3; 2.4 | I3 | T2-04; T2-05 |
| **4 Convert India and China hub traffic** | Demand-Side route-to-market (71,000 India and 30,000 China via hubs) and MIDAS (same figures; no direct route before 2030) | 2.2; 2.1; 2.3; 1.1 | I4 | T1-02; T2-06 |

| Objective | Workstream | Sections | Initiative | Indicators |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **5 Increase yield in mature markets** | MIDAS (mature long-haul routes above 80% load; carriers raise fares before adding seats) with the Demand-Side mature-market projection | 2.2; 2.1; 2.3 | I1 | T1-03; T2-07 |
| **6 Build a regional foundation (Africa)** | Demand-Side African opportunity section and Skift African memo; MIDAS regional route loads | 2.2; 2.3; 1.1 | I5 | T1-02; T2-08 |
| **7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes** | MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment; Infrastructure Report air-access section; Wesgro's plan (10 new routes); Cape Town Air Access update | 2.3; 2.1 | I6 | T1-01; T2-09; T2-10 |
| **8 Grow cruise calls and ports** | Diagnostic cruise table and Infrastructure Report cruise and ports section; StratEcon cruise study 2024/25, received at inception; Wesgro's plan (250 calls); Wesgro's cruise prospectus (circuit, terminal and 2025/26 season results); City of Cape Town media release (call-day congestion) | 2.3; 1.1 | I7 | T2-11 |
| **9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility** | Infrastructure Report comparative regional analysis; Stakeholder Insights (Department of Mobility); draft Provincial Land Transport Framework (airport leg, corridors) | 2.3; 1.1 | I8 | T1-06; T2-12; T2-13 |
| **10 Support diversified route and product development** | Infrastructure Report spatial maps and route scorecards; Stakeholder Insights (11 of 16 organisations); the Treasury's district reviews (overnight share, tourism share of GDPR) | 2.3; 2.4 | I9 | T1-06; T2-14; T2-26; T2-27 |
| **11 Align visitor experience in-destination** | Infrastructure Report accommodation mapping; Stakeholder Insights (service quality); Benchmarking (Valencia, Singapore) | 2.3; 2.1 | I10 | T2-15 |
| **12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions** | Stakeholder Insights (Boulders near capacity, Table Mountain queues); Infrastructure Report flagship congestion; the Treasury's flagship counts | 2.3; 2.1; 1.1 | I11 | T2-16 |
| **13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion** | SME and Community Inclusion Plan (September 2026); the City's community programmes; Stakeholder Insights (MFMA Circular No. 131, LTO sustainability) | 2.4; 2.1 | I12 | T1-07; T2-17; T2-18 |
| **14 Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk** | Stakeholder Insights (climate losses); Inclusion plan De Rust profile (Meiringspoort closed 6 May 2026); the Treasury's district reviews | 2.4; 2.1; 1.1 | I13 | T2-19 |
| **15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies** | Infrastructure Report pipeline and gap-closure tables (gaps with no committed capital); Stakeholder Insights (funding below peers); Benchmarking (Chile concession, New Zealand route fund); draft Provincial Land Transport Framework (levy case) | 2.4; 2.1; 2.3 | I14 | T2-20 |

| Objective | Workstream | Sections | Initiative | Indicators |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers** | Stakeholder Insights (bilateral air agreements, fragmented mandates); Diagnostic governance tiers; MIDAS (government-to-government route designation) | 2.4; 2.1; 1.1; 1.3 | I15 | T2-21 |
| **17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration** | Stakeholder Insights appendix tables, counted for this report (Appendix A6) | 2.4; 2.1 | I15 | T2-22 |
| **18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing** | Stakeholder Insights (JAMMS, statistics committees, Stats SA task team); Skift digital memo (tracking framework); the Treasury's reviews; Integrated Transport Hub | 2.4; 2.1; 1.1 | I16 | T2-23 |
| **19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits** | Stakeholder Insights, Demand-Side barriers and MIDAS all place visas and air rights with national government; DEDAT's visa study (BDO); the City's Tourist Safety Programme and the safety services DEDAT funds | 2.4; 1.1 | I17 | T2-24; T2-28; T2-29 |
| **20 Develop workforce and service skills** | No workstream; prompted by the 300,000-jobs ambition (Inception p4) and skills mentions in the Stakeholder Insights and Inclusion plan | 2.4; 1.3 | I18 | T1-04; T2-25 |

Source: Workstream attribution is this report's, from the deliverables that carry the figures; the sections named give the pages. Wesgro, provincial and City documents follow the deliverables where Chapter 3 cites them.

# A2 Demand model

The demand model takes international arrivals from 1,498,829 in 2025 to 1,822,634, 2,175,778 or 2,516,282 in 2035, and its base case crosses the 1.8 million seat line the model draws, at the 2030 year point.

## Method

The model sets a growth rate for each source market from four levers and projects arrivals from the base year to 2035. The levers are source market growth, Western Cape penetration of source-market outbound, an airlift capacity ceiling and structural market conditions. Source-market growth sets the ceiling: the Western Cape cannot sustainably grow faster than its source markets generate travellers. Projections are anchored on OAG aviation data and Skift global traveller data.[359]

The growth model exists in two editions. The May Market Assessment runs from a 2025 base of 1,498,829 arrivals and the June Demand-Side Analysis from a 2024 base of 1,445,031. Both reach 2,175,778 in the base case and 2,516,282 in the accelerated case by 2035. The report runs the growth case from the 2025 base, keeps FY24/25's 1.44m as the recovery baseline and states which is which wherever both appear.[360]

## Scenario definitions

The three scenarios vary intervention, not demand: what separates them is how far structural barriers are removed and growth opportunities pursued.[361]

[359] Demand-Side Analysis, p18, p20, p8.
[360] Market Assessment, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, p20.
[361] Demand-Side Analysis, p19.

**Table A.3.** Growth model scenario definitions

**The scenarios step up from no new airlift or growth-market spend to direct India and China routes with dedicated activation in four markets.**

| Dimension | Conservative | Base | Accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Descriptor** | The floor. What happens if Wesgro does nothing new | The most likely outcome. Wesgro maintains current activity | The upside. What confirmed intervention adds |
| **Air access** | Existing air access maintained with no additional frequencies or routes | Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines continue adding frequency and capacity into Cape Town | Direct India and China routes secured, alongside additional frequency growth from Emirates, Qatar, Ethiopian and Turkish Airlines |
| **Market activation** | Continued trade and marketing activity, with no dedicated growth market investment | Existing Wesgro programmes expanded across mature, regional and hub markets | Dedicated in market activation in India, China, USA and the GCC to increase destination awareness and conversion |
| **Market development** | Growth concentrated in existing mature markets and current connectivity corridors | UK, USA and Germany continue to grow, while India, China and Regional Africa expand through existing hub connections | India, China and the Middle East grow ahead of source market averages through improved access and activation |
| **May additions** | WC holds share; India and China as hub flows; all CAGRs below outbound averages | Trade and marketing at 2025 intensity; selective frequency increases; share gains in mature markets | Japan and South Korea introduced; mature European markets above base, constrained by seat capacity |
| **Step up from previous case** | Not applicable | Protecting existing airlift, growing hub frequencies, retaining source-market share and continued trade presence | Confirmed direct airlift, above-baseline marketing and added hub capacity; without confirmed routes, volume reverts to base |

Source: Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p19 (descriptor, air access, market activation and market development rows) and p20 (step-up row). Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p18 (working analysis; May additions row) and p19 (the same step-up wording). Wording as printed, shortened in the last two rows.

The May working analysis lists Japan and South Korea as introduced under the Accelerated case, yet its base case already carries both as the strategic group at 8,410 arrivals in 2025. Its Accelerated activation names India, China and the USA; the June matrix adds the GCC.[362]

## Scenario end points

**Table A.4.** Model end points by base year

**The two decks print the same 2035 end points from different bases, with the base case 676,949 arrivals above 2025.**

| Measure | Conservative | Base | Accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|
| **2025 base (May)** | 1,498,829 | 1,498,829 | 1,498,829 |
| **2035 projection** | 1,822,634 | 2,175,778 | 2,516,282 |
| **Absolute growth from 2025** | +323,805 | +676,949 | +1,017,453 |
| **Growth vs 2025** | +22% | +45% | +68% |
| **Implied 10-year CAGR** | 2.0% | 3.8% | 5.3% |
| **Uplift vs Conservative** | Not applicable | +353,144 | +693,648 |
| **2024 base (June)** | 1,445,031 | 1,445,031 | 1,445,031 |
| **Absolute growth from 2024** | +377,603 | +730,747 | +1,071,251 |
| **Growth vs 2024** | +26% | +51% | +74% |
| **Implied 11-year CAGR, printed** | 2.0% | 3.7% | 5.0% |

[362] Market Assessment, p18, p20, p22; Demand-Side Analysis, p19.

| Measure | Conservative | Base | Accelerated |
|---|---|---|---|
| **11-year CAGR, computed** | 2.1% | 3.8% | 5.2% |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 (working analysis; 2025 basis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p20 (2024 basis). The last row is computed from the printed 2024 base and 2035 end points.

The June deck prints 11-year CAGRs of 2.0%, 3.7% and 5.0%, while its own end points give 2.1%, 3.8% and 5.2% (computed). Both subtitles round the Conservative and Accelerated end points to 1.82M and 2.52M.[363]

## Base case by market group

**Table A.5.** Base case by market group

**Every market group grows at each printed year point, and the base-case total first sits above the 1.8M seat line at 2030.**

| Group | 2025 | 2028 | 2030 | 2032 | 2034 | 2035 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mature markets** | 587,287 | 635,712 | 670,350 | 707,009 | 745,816 | 766,067 |
| **Regional markets** | 292,514 | 321,854 | 343,096 | 365,796 | 390,059 | 402,812 |
| **Hubs** | 427,803 | 483,407 | 523,523 | 566,081 | 611,038 | 634,387 |
| **Acceleration** | 182,815 | 223,110 | 255,159 | 292,138 | 334,846 | 358,633 |
| **Strategic growth** | 8,410 | 9,772 | 10,801 | 11,940 | 13,200 | 13,879 |
| **Total** | 1,498,829 | 1,673,855 | 1,802,929 | 1,942,964 | 2,094,959 | 2,175,778 |
| **Current seat capacity line (seats, as drawn)** | 1.8M | 1.8M | 1.8M | 1.8M | 1.8M | 1.8M |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21 prints the same 2028 to 2035 values. Only these six year points are printed. Groups as printed: Mature (US, UK, Netherlands, Germany, France, Switzerland); Regional (Namibia, Zim, Zambia, Bots, Kenya, etc.); Hubs (UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar, Turkey); Acceleration (Gulf, China, India, Brazil); Strategic growth (Japan and South Korea). The five groups sum to the printed total in every year (computed).

Hubs add the most arrivals of any group, 206,584 from 2025 to 2035, while acceleration markets grow fastest at 7.0% a year (computed). The June deck reads the chart the same way: hub markets deliver the largest absolute rise in volume in the model.[364]

On the June 2024 basis the groups start at Mature 572,032, Regional 283,362, Hubs 410,467, Acceleration 171,170 and Strategic growth 8,000, which sum to 1,445,031. The June deck prints no 2025 group values.[365]

## Base case by market

**Table A.6.** Acceleration and mature market paths

**India and China + HK more than double by 2035 at 8% a year, while the six mature markets grow at 2% to 4% a year.**

| Market | 2025 | 2035 | Printed rate | CAGR | Model assumption |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **UK** | 182,398 | 233,485 | +3% p.a. | 2.5% | Outbound 2 to 3% p.a.; strong direct access |
| **Germany** | 130,475 | 159,049 | +2% p.a. | 2.0% | Weaker economic outlook; Lufthansa connectivity |
| **US** | 113,857 | 168,536 | +4% p.a. | 4.0% | Strong recent demand; favourable USD/ZAR |
| **Netherlands** | 107,938 | 138,169 | +2% p.a. | 2.5% | KLM Amsterdam hub |
| **France** | 21,495 | 28,888 | +3% p.a. | 3.0% | Low WC penetration; direct Air France |
| **Switzerland** | 31,124 | 37,940 | +2% p.a. | 2.0% | European hubs; seasonal Swiss direct service |

[363] Market Assessment, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, p20.
[364] Demand-Side Analysis, p21.
[365] Demand-Side Analysis, p21, sum computed.

| Market | 2025 | 2035 | Printed rate | CAGR | Model assumption |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mature total** | 587,287 | 766,067 | | 2.7% | Sum matches the group line |
| **India** | 76,547 | 165,260 | +8% p.a. | 8.0% | Outbound above 10% p.a.; low penetration |
| **China + HK** | 43,412 | 92,598 | +8% p.a. | 7.9% | Outbound 8 to 10% p.a.; no direct route |
| **Middle East** | 41,647 | 67,839 | +5% p.a. | 5.0% | GCC outbound about 5 to 6% p.a. |
| **Brazil** | 21,209 | 32,937 | +5% p.a. | 4.5% | Outbound 5%; low penetration |
| **Acceleration total** | 182,815 | 358,634 | | 7.0% | Group line prints 358,633 |
| **Japan** | 5,275 | 9,010 | +5% p.a. | 5.5% | Strategic importance, not current size |
| **South Korea** | 3,135 | 4,869 | +5% p.a. | 4.5% | Strategic importance, not current size |
| **Strategic total** | 8,410 | 13,879 | | 5.1% | Sum matches the group line |
| **Hubs** | 427,803 | 634,387 | Not printed | 4.0% | UAE, Ethiopia, Qatar and Turkey; group line only |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p21 and p22 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p22, p23 and p25 (values and assumptions). Hubs row: group values from Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20. CAGR and group totals are computed from the printed bars; assumptions are shortened from the printed text.

**Table A.7.** Regional market paths

**Regional lines grow at 2.0% to 5.0% a year with Kenya fastest, and the model carries no row for Nigeria or Ghana.**

| Market | 2025 | 2035 | Printed rate | Change |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Namibia** | 72,750 | 102,621 | 3.5% p.a. | +29,871 |
| **Zimbabwe** | 69,005 | 92,737 | 3.0% p.a. | +23,732 |
| **Zambia** | 19,638 | 27,701 | 3.5% p.a. | +8,063 |
| **Botswana** | 20,237 | 27,197 | 3.0% p.a. | +6,960 |
| **Kenya** | 23,394 | 38,106 | 5.0% p.a. | +14,712 |
| **Mauritius** | 25,844 | 33,083 | 2.5% p.a. | +7,239 |
| **Mozambique** | 12,642 | 16,183 | 2.5% p.a. | +3,541 |
| **Angola** | 43,609 | 58,507 | 3.0% p.a. | +14,898 |
| **Other Regional (Chad, St Helena, Eswatini)** | 5,394 | 6,575 | 2.0% p.a. | +1,181 |
| **Regional total** | 292,513 | 402,710 | | +110,197 |
| **Nigeria** | No row | No row | | |
| **Ghana** | No row | No row | | |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p23 (working analysis); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p24. Change and the regional total are computed from the printed bars; the group line prints 292,514 and 402,812 (Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20). The Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p30 names Nigeria the largest modelled African opportunity and Ghana a high-spend market with an established base.

Printed rates are rounded labels: UK and Netherlands recompute to 2.5% a year, Brazil and South Korea to 4.5% and Japan to 5.5% (computed). Bar sums miss the regional and acceleration group lines by 1 to 102 arrivals (computed). Lesotho and Malawi, with 40,266 and 12,682 tourist arrivals in 2024, also have no row.[366]

[366] Demand-Side Analysis, p27.

## Base-case spend

**Table A.8.** Base-case spend by group

**At fixed average spend per group, base-case tourism spend rises from a modelled R27.12bn in 2024 to R40.59bn in 2035.**

| Group | Average spend per arrival | 2024 | 2030 | 2035 | Change 2024 to 2035 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mature markets** | R24,500 | 14.01 | 16.42 | 18.77 | +4.76 |
| **Regional markets** | R8,500 | 2.41 | 2.92 | 3.42 | +1.01 |
| **Hubs** | R17,500 | 7.18 | 9.16 | 11.10 | +3.92 |
| **Acceleration** | R19,500 | 3.34 | 4.98 | 6.99 | +3.65 |
| **Strategic growth** | R22,000 | 0.18 | 0.24 | 0.31 | +0.13 |
| **Total** | Not printed | 27.12 | 33.71 | 40.59 | +13.47 |

Source: Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p24 (working analysis; comma decimals on the slide shown here as points). Values in R billion. Change is computed. The 2030 group cells sum to 33.72 against the printed 33.71 total, a rounding difference (computed).

The 2030 and 2035 values equal each group's arrivals times its average spend, so spend per arrival within a group stays fixed (computed). Dividing the 2024 values by the same assumptions implies 1,445,116 arrivals, close to the June base of 1,445,031 (computed). The slide calls the 2024 values modelled, and the same deck reports foreign direct spend of R22.7bn in FY2024. The June deck prints no spend projection.[367]

## Seat line and model limits

Both decks state that current air access places a hard ceiling at 1.8 million inbound seats, so the projected growth cannot be realised without additional capacity or frequency. Neither deck prints the seats behind the line or a load factor that converts seats into arrivals. At the international routes' 76.0% load factor, 1.8 million seats would carry about 1.37 million arrivals, below the 1.57 million recorded in FY25/26. This report therefore reads the line as the model's assumption, not a measured cap (section 1.2).[368]

The model prints its seat line and six base-case year points but no seat table, annual series or group split for the other scenarios. The seat line is 1.8 million inbound seats, drawn as a line labelled 1.8M and called current, with no year or seat definition. Neither deck states the year the line is crossed: 2028 (1,673,855) sits below the line and 2030 (1,802,929) is the first point above it.[369]

No seat table is printed: there are no seats by route or year, no load factors and no frequencies. Nor is an annual series: 2026, 2027, 2029, 2031 and 2033 are absent, and the June chart starts at 2024, not 2025. The conservative and accelerated scenarios appear at 2035 only, with no group split, no year points and no per-market rates.[370]

The calendar or financial basis and the source series of the 1,498,829 base are not stated, and the 2025 bars are not marked as actuals or model values. ACSA passenger arrivals (1.57m in FY25/26), SAT tourist arrivals, OAG air arrivals and model arrivals are not reconciled.[371]

## Arrivals figures and their bases

Twelve arrivals figures circulate around this study, and they count four things: ambitions, airport passengers, tourist arrivals and the model's arrivals. The table below fixes each figure and states how the

[367] Market Assessment, p10, p24.
[368] Market Assessment, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, p21.
[369] Market Assessment, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, p21.
[370] Market Assessment, p17, p20, p19; Demand-Side Analysis, p18, p21, p20.
[371] Market Assessment, p19, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, p22 to p25, p8, p11, p13, p20, p27.

report uses it. It keeps an airport count apart from a provincial tourist count, and an ambition apart from a projection. Three rules sit behind the last column.

The report keeps the series apart under three rules. International passenger arrivals at Cape Town International, by fiscal year, are the baseline and tracking series, with FY24/25 at 1.44 million. That series counts passengers, not tourists, and Cape Town air arrivals stand proxy for the province in the market shares. The model's 2025 base of 1,498,829 and its 2035 points are the target series. [Open item: Skift to confirm in writing what the model counts (SA Tourism tourist arrivals, ACSA passengers including returning residents or OAG origin-and-destination flows) and how the Hubs group is built.] South African Tourism's provincial count is used, through Wesgro Research's source market analysis, to measure the province's share of global and market travel from 2022 to 2024. The model also splits markets differently from South African Tourism. Over 2022 to 2024 South African Tourism's yearly averages for India and China were a quarter to a fifth of the model's 2025 values, and France's about three times, though the periods differ. The report quotes the series side by side and never adds one to the other [model owner to confirm the series and year basis behind the 2025 base of 1,498,829].[372]

**Table A.9.** Arrivals figures in circulation

**The report uses airport passenger arrivals for baselines and the demand model for targets; Wesgro's ambitions and the tourist counts serve as reference points.**

| Figure | What it counts | Year | Source | How this report uses it |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **1.44m** | International passenger arrivals at Cape Town International (ACSA), fiscal year | FY24/25 | Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p25 | Recovery baseline (1.1) and the baseline year for the M&E framework (Chapter 5) |
| **1.57m** | Same series | FY25/26 | Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10 | Latest actual; shown against the model, not substituted for its base |
| **3,293,615** | International and regional passenger movements at Cape Town International, arrivals plus departures, calendar year | 2025 | ACSA passenger traffic release, Sep 2026 (study team calculation) | Green-season trend only (section 2.2); a movement count, not an arrivals figure |
| **932,831** | Overnight tourist arrivals through Cape Town International, as the Provincial Treasury counts them | 2024 | Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68 | Reference only; a tourist count at the gateway, not a passenger count |
| **1,498,829** | Demand model base; the series and year basis are not labelled in the deck | 2025 | Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 | Base of the growth case; every 2035 figure in Chapters 3 to 5 is an increment on it |
| **2,175,778 and 2,516,282** | Model projections on the 2025 base: base case and accelerated case | 2035 | Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p19 | The report's two paths; growth to 2.5 million is the rounded accelerated case |
| **1,538,142** | International tourist arrivals to the Western Cape, South African Tourism basis | 2025 | Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; public source | Reference point for the South African Tourism basis of Wesgro's 3 million statements; not a baseline or a target |
| **3.6 million** | International tourist arrivals to the province over 2022 to 2024: a three-year total, about 1.2 million a year (computed) | 2022 to 2024 | Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p2 | Capture shares only (section 2.2); never read as an annual figure |
| **800,000 to 1 million** | New international tourist arrivals; the base year is not stated | FY26 to FY30 | Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20 | Set beside Wesgro's activity targets (Table 1.3) and mapped to initiative outputs at Gate 1 (section 4.7) |

[372] Diagnostic, p25, p26, p29, p41; the source uses Cape Town air arrivals as its provincial proxy; Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p4; Market Assessment, p21, p22, computed.

| Figure | What it counts | Year | Source | How this report uses it |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **3 million** | International tourist arrivals to the province, SAT basis, built as 2 million in 2019 plus 1 million | 2035 | Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026 (public source). Wesgro statement; G4J itself sets no arrivals target | Alignment reference under clause 1.1.14.2; a different measure from the airport series |
| **3 million** | International tourist arrivals, built as 2 million in 2019 plus 1 million | 2030 | Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20. Wesgro statement; G4J itself sets no arrivals target | Wesgro statement; G4J itself sets no arrivals target. The same figure dated 2030; both Wesgro statements are recorded here |
| **2.8m** | International visitors; measure and base not stated | 2035 | Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4 | Inception planning figure; recorded, not used |
| **5.7 million and R54.7 billion** | International arrivals and foreign direct spend; the Tourism Blueprint 2030's pre-COVID ten-year goal, dated 2035 in the Diagnostic, with the Blueprint's end year not confirmed | 2035 | Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4, p10 | The Diagnostic's statement of the ambition; superseded and quoted for the record |

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p5, p25; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p10, p19; Inception Report, Nov 2025, p4; Wesgro, presentation to the parliamentary committee, 1 Apr 2026 (public source); Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; public source. Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30, p20; Wesgro Research, Tourism Source Market Analysis, Nov 2025, p2 (2022 to 2024, three-year total); Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025, p68; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4, p10.

The two ambitions do not reconcile with each other or with the measured baseline. The 2.8 million names no series or base year. The 5.7 million arrivals and R54.7 billion of spend trace to the Tourism Blueprint 2030, which set them before COVID as a goal over ten years. The Diagnostic dates them to 2035; this report treats that statement as superseded and leaves the year open.[373]

The model's 2025 base of 1,498,829 sits just below South African Tourism's count of 1,538,142 for 2025. Yet each market group's 2025 value tracks its 2024 value grown at the model's own rate. The report therefore treats the base as a model value until its basis is confirmed.[374]

The airport count for FY25/26, 1.57 million, sits above the model's 2025 base and below its 2028 base-case point of 1,673,855. Yet the two differ in measure and period, so the gap is no evidence that the model is cautious.[375]

# A3 Benchmark cases

Six comparators were drawn from a 30-destination screen on twelve criteria, and each case reduces to a system type, two levers and the changes they require of the Western Cape.

## Evaluation criteria

Both the Inception Report and the Global Benchmarking Report screen destinations on twelve criteria in four groups. Each destination received one average score across all criteria.[376]

[373] Inception Report, p4; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4, p10; Diagnostic, p5, p25, computed.
[374] Wesgro Research, Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025; Market Assessment, p20; Demand-Side Analysis, p21; the steps match the growth rates to within 0.2 points, computed from the market-group values in this appendix.
[375] Market Assessment, p10, p20.
[376] Inception Report, p29, p30; Benchmarking, p11.

**Table A.10.** Benchmark selection criteria

| Group | Criterion | What it compares with the Western Cape |
|---|---|---|
| **Market & Access Dynamics** | Long-Haul Dependence & Connectivity | Reliance on long-haul aviation, hub relationships and seat-capacity volatility |
| | Source Market Portfolio | Fit with Wesgro's core and target markets (UK/EU, North America, China, India, Middle East, Africa) |
| | Ease of Access & Visa | Entry conditions, visa openness and visa-free access for Western Cape priority markets |
| **Destination & Product Structure** | City-Region Configuration | Fit with the model of a Cape Town gateway and a multi-regional Western Cape |
| | Product & Experience Mix | Fit with the mix of coast, city, nature, wine and agri-tourism, food, culture and soft adventure |
| | Cost & Price Positioning | Accommodation, dining and excursion costs against a mid to upper-mid price tier |
| **Growth, Inclusion & Sustainability** | Growth Pattern & Tourism Development Stage | Lifecycle stage, demand pressures, seasonality and infrastructure strain |
| | Inclusivity, Community Participation & SMME Landscape | SMME structure, community tourism footprint and local participation |
| | Sustainability, Climate & Environmental Conditions | Climate risks, coastal vulnerability, water availability and resource pressure |
| **Performance & Competitiveness** | Tourism Volume & Seasonality | Total arrivals, international share and seasonal concentration |
| | Tourism Yield & Spend Levels | Average daily spend, trip length and value profile |
| | Airport & Tourism Infrastructure | Airport quality, airside and landside capacity, ground transport and tourism infrastructure |

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11 (groups, criteria and definitions, shortened); Inception Report, Nov 2025, p29, p30. Two criteria are defined differently in the two sources: the Inception Report has Cruise & Multi-Modal Access, covering cruise arrivals, self-drive touring and regional mobility, and Tourism Infrastructure & Capacity, covering hotel mix, transport, visitor services and attraction capacity (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p30).

## How the six were chosen

The screen scored 30 destinations on the twelve criteria and ranked them on one average score. Chile, Melbourne and Victoria, Valencia and Singapore came from the top of the ranking. New Zealand, ranked seventh at 3.67, and Kenya, ranked eleventh at 3.50, joined for what the score could not weigh: a remote single-gateway case and an African case with community-based tourism.[377]

**Table A.11.** How the six comparators were chosen

**Four comparators came from the top of the screen, and New Zealand and Kenya joined for the remote-gateway and African cases they bring.**

| Destination | Screen rank and score | Printed rationale | What the case is read for |
|---|---|---|---|
| Chile | Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed | High comparability in dispersal challenges, product mix and long-haul reliance | Long-haul access treated as infrastructure |
| Melbourne & Victoria | Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed | Strong long-haul dependence and multi-regional tourism footprint | Events that spread demand across the year |
| Valencia Region | Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed | Comparable climate, product mix and price point | Quality governed across the destination |
| Singapore | Ranks 1 to 6; score not printed | Integrated approach to air access, service quality, food culture and visitor segmentation | Hub transit turned into stays |

[377] Inception Report, p29, p31, p32; Benchmarking, p12, p51; ranks 1 to 6 and their scores are not printed.

| Destination | Screen rank and score | Printed rationale | What the case is read for |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kenya | Rank 11, score 3.50 | Strong alignment in long-haul reliance, regional dispersal and community-based tourism | Gateway access, dispersal and community inclusion |
| Auckland & North Island, New Zealand | Rank 7, score 3.67 | Urban life closely intertwined with natural landscapes | A remote single gateway and marketing tied to routes |

Source: Inception Report, Nov 2025, p31 (ranks and scores), p32; Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p12 (rationales), p51. The screen prints ranks 7 to 30 only, so the four leading comparators sit among ranks 1 to 6 with no printed score. Rationales as printed, shortened only by cutting; what each case is read for follows section 2.1.

## Growth record and primary levers

The Global Benchmarking Report summarises the six cases in one table, reproduced here. Its global norm is growth of 3% to 5% a year under stable conditions.[378]

**Table A.12.** Comparator growth, recovery and levers

**Five of the six printed growth rates exceed the report's 3% to 5% norm, two clearly beat 2024's actual global growth of 11%, and four of the six cases pair structural demand creation with demand activation.**

| Destination | YoY growth % over 2023 to 2024 | % change vs 2019 (recovery depth) | Primary levers | Primary demand impact |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Chile** | ~+35% | ~82% recovered | 1) Gateway-led air concentration<br>2) Product diversification and immersive experience | 1) Demand Activation<br>2) Structural Demand Creation |
| **Kenya** | ~12.8% to 14.6% | ~102% recovered | 1) Conservation-led institutionalisation of wildlife<br>2) Nairobi Led Gateway Diversification | 1) Structural Demand Creation<br>2) Demand Activation |
| **Singapore** | ~19% | Slightly below, spend recovered | 1) Integrated Aviation Hub Strategy and Stopover Demand Conversion<br>2) Institutional Quality uplift of Visitor Economy | 1) Structural Demand Creation<br>2) Demand Activation and Acceleration |
| **Australia, Victoria Melbourne** | ~4.3% | Near full recovery, differentiation from yield, value density | 1) Event-led Demand<br>2) Knowledge Brand Strategy | 1) Structural Demand Creation<br>2) Demand Activation and Acceleration |
| **New Zealand** | ~12% | 90% recovery, increased yield per visitor | 1) Demand-Led Route Development Integration<br>2) Premiumisation | 1) System and Product Yield Optimisation<br>2) Demand Activation and Acceleration |
| **Spain, Valencia** | 13 to 14% | 124% recovered | 1) Institutionalised Quality Governance<br>2) Governance-led Demand Diversification | 1) System and Product Yield Optimisation<br>2) Demand Activation and Acceleration |

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p9, values and destination labels as printed. Ranges are written with 'to', decimal commas are shown as points and Valencia's second lever takes its p49 title in place of the p9 label. Melbourne's ~4.3% is a forecast average annual growth rate for short-term visitor arrivals to Australia, not a 2023 to 2024 actual (p17). New Zealand's ~12% matches holiday-arrivals growth of 12.1% for January to December 2025; total arrivals grew 5.9% over the same period (p53). Demand-impact classes (p8): structural demand creation expands total addressable demand; demand activation and acceleration converts latent or constrained demand; system and product yield optimisation raises value per traveller without increasing arrivals. Corrected 2024 figures: Chile 40.4% (116% of 2019), Singapore 21% (86% of 2019), Kenya 14.6% (section 2.1).

[378] Benchmarking, p9, p7.

## System type and its three components

The report treats sustained growth as the product of three reinforcing components: institutional coordination; strategic marketing and promotion; accessibility and connectivity. Without competitive access, latent demand does not convert.[379]

All six cases align coordination, marketing and access, but each builds its system around a different anchor.[380]

**Melbourne and Victoria: events-led.** Coordination institutionalises events and a knowledge-led brand as a cross-government economic development tool. Marketing integrates city branding, intellectual capital and events into a single demand proposition. The event calendar is used to de-risk and stimulate aviation demand.

**Chile: connectivity-led.** Coordination is anchored around a single strategic constraint, long-haul access. Marketing runs unified national branding with defined regional identities and multi-region itinerary packaging. Liberal aviation policy and major hub investment position Santiago as a single efficient long-haul hub.

**Kenya: product-led.** Coordination aligns tourism with national priorities in conservation, trade and diplomacy. Marketing is segment-specific and grounded in a designed product system. Access reduces entry friction, with Nairobi as a multipurpose regional and global hub.

**Singapore: orchestrated experience.** A centrally orchestrated system under STB works through structured public-private partnerships. Marketing packages experiences (events, precincts, lifestyle) into single high-value propositions. Aviation, infrastructure and visitor experience are integrated into a single gateway.

**Valencia: governance-led.** Governance is decentralised and sector-led. Marketing expands the reasons to visit: gastronomy, culture, sport, wellness and business events. Connectivity supports a multi-product destination system and dispersal.

**New Zealand: value-led.** Tourism, aviation and policy are integrated around shared demand objectives. Marketing shifts from volume to value by selling scarce, high-quality experiences. Long-haul demand converts only when marketing, aviation and distribution are aligned.

## Levers and required changes

Each case closes on a transferable-levers slide that names two levers and the change each requires locally. The table gives those bullets in the report's words, shortened only by cutting.[381]

[379] Benchmarking, p58, p59.
[380] Benchmarking, p61 for the system types; p59 to p60 for the three components, condensed.
[381] Benchmarking, p13.

**Table A.13.** Transferable levers by case

**The six cases yield twelve levers, and their required changes centre on air access, events, quality standards, regional product and governance.**

| Case | Lever 1 and required change for the Western Cape | Lever 2 and required change for the Western Cape |
|---|---|---|
| **Melbourne & Victoria (p20)** | **Event Led Demand Engine**<br>Proactive international bidding pipeline anchored in priority markets and sectors; unified event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, Convention Bureau, City and Province; integrate city branding, intellectual capital and sector strengths into event positioning; hotel and precinct readiness planning; activate community participation and cultural engagement | **Knowledge-Led Brand Strategy**<br>Strengthen coordination between Wesgro and Convention Bureau/Universities/Industry Bodies/Trade and Investment Teams; proactive international conference bidding pipeline aligned to sector strengths; sector aligned brand narrative link to priority industries; visibility and packaging across global distribution channels |
| **Chile (p28)** | **Gateway-Led Air Connectivity and Capacity Expansion**<br>Treat air access as core economic infrastructure, not a tourism add-on; establish a permanent, well-funded Public-Private Air Access Fund; lobby for air service liberalisation and simplified visa regimes; develop a unified Gateway Narrative | **Product Diversification and Immersive Regional Positioning**<br>Unify destination narrative across province, city and sectors; move from asset marketing to experience led packaging; enforce brand consistency and international quality standards |
| **Kenya (p35)** | **Wildlife-led Product Systematisation**<br>Shift from asset-led to system-led tourism development; strengthen coordination across public & private sector and communities; position WC as a demand anchor; integrate MICE and business travel into broader tourism system; build conservation and community inclusion into the tourism value proposition | **Nairobi-Led Gateway Repositioning and Demand Diversification**<br>Treat MICE as a system lever; align city, provincial and national actors around gateway strategy; infrastructure credibility and event-readiness must be protected; mitigate risk of MICE demand remaining disconnected |
| **Singapore (p42)** | **Integrated Aviation Hub Strategy and Stopover Demand Conversion**<br>Align government, aviation, events and private sector stakeholders under a coordinated strategy with shared KPIs; linking air access, major events and co-op marketing to convert connectivity into high-value demand | **Institutional Quality Uplift of the Visitor Economy**<br>Province-wide quality and standards framework led by Wesgro; targeted investment in service excellence, work-force capability and infrastructure; embed continuous performance measurement and public-private accountability |
| **Valencia (p49)** | **Integrated Quality & Sustainability Institutionalisation**<br>Establish a provincial-level quality authority or charter; phase implementation by district but embed in provincial policy; reduce SMME burden via subsidies and capability support; make certification visible across booking platforms; move from 'encouraged compliance' to institutionalised compliance | **Governance-led Demand Diversification**<br>Establish formal sector councils (Wine, MICE, Adventure, Culture etc.); embed tourism governance into permanent public-private structures; align infrastructure, promotion and policy by demand segment; integrate residents formally into planning forums |
| **New Zealand (p56)** | **Demand-Engineered Air Access**<br>Ring-fence budgets around priority long-haul corridors; formalise an Aviation Partnership Framework; introduce structured early-stage route support mechanisms | **Regional Value Engineering through Strategic De-Commoditisation**<br>Replace arrivals KPI with yield-based metrics; deliberate regional product curation frameworks; align conservation and premium access to protect pricing power; shape premium-ready regional circuits beyond Cape Town core; build partnerships with specialist distribution networks |

Source: Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p20 (Melbourne and Victoria), p28 (Chile), p35 (Kenya), p42 (Singapore), p49 (Valencia), p56 (New Zealand). Lever titles and bullets as printed, shortened by cutting, with one verb paraphrased; initial capitals, dashes and list commas follow this report's style.

## Additional comparators

Fourteen further cases support single actions in Chapter 3, outside the six system comparators. Each is read for one mechanism, not as a model for the province. Reported results are the sponsors' or evaluators' own figures and are not causal estimates. None is an expected return for the Western Cape.

**Table A.14.** Additional comparators

**Fourteen cases each lend one mechanism to a named action, and their reported results are not causal estimates.**

| Case | Mechanism | Reported result | What transfers |
|---|---|---|---|
| **VisitBritain** | National marketing measured beyond the best-known gateway, with regional identities kept | £562m of additional visitor spend reported for 2024/25 activity, 60% of it outside London | Regional test offers with completed regional bookings (objective 1, I1) |
| **Tourism New Zealand, Everyone Must Go** | Autumn campaign in a short-haul market, tied to operator offers | NZ$800,000 spend in 2024/25; 7,981 additional Australian arrivals and NZ$22m estimated spend reported; 800 offers from 450 operators | Campaigns that carry bookable offers and count arrivals against spend (objectives 1 and 2) |
| **Tasmania, Off Season** | Distinctive winter offers recruited ahead of the season, with booking and travel dates | 339,800 May to August visitors and A$701.26m spending reported for 2025; campaign effect not isolated | A named winter portfolio inside the green season (objective 2, I2) |
| **New Zealand, Events Boost Fund** | Published fund envelope and published individual awards | NZ$10m envelope in 2026; no outcome evaluation yet | One common appraisal for every publicly supported event (objective 2, I2) |
| **Melbourne Grand Prix** | Publicly funded major event with published accounts | A$219.241m expenditure against A$116.929m revenue for the 2024 race, needing A$102.313m of government investment; an audit found the 2005 event cost A$6.7m more than its benefits | Full public cost counted before any commitment, a Formula 1 bid included (objective 2, I2) |
| **Queensland, Attracting Aviation Investment Fund** | Matched public and partner funding, paid against delivered capacity | A$100m of government funding matched by A$100m from airports and regional bodies; 26 supported services and an estimated 1.97 million annual inbound seats (2023 scorecard) | Resilience conditions in the air access fund (objective 7, I6) |
| **Scottish route fund evaluation** | Independent evaluation using passenger surveys, a counterfactual and carbon costs | Nearly all supported services had positive transport benefit ratios; £47m to £52m of gross value added estimated; closed to new routes in 2007 | Tapering support, clawbacks and a documented funding gap (objective 7, I6) |
| **Edinburgh, Airlink 100** | 24-hour airport express bus | Runs as often as every 10 minutes by day and every 20 overnight; subsidy and tourism effect not disclosed | A funded airport service specification (objective 9, I8) |
| **Rocky Mountain, Arches and Yosemite** | Timed entry and day-use reservations at constrained parks | Rocky Mountain made day-use access permanent after pilots; Arches and Yosemite dropped reservations in 2026, and a commissioned study puts the earlier Arches system at US$41.4m to US$55.1m a year in foregone local spend | Flow pilots that protect walk-up and resident access, with a stop rule (objective 12, I11) |
| **Machu Picchu** | Fixed circuits with a stated daily capacity | Normal daily capacity of 4,500 and designated peak capacity of 5,600 in 2026; demand effect not established | Flow management at constrained sites (objective 12, I11) |
| **Namibia, communal conservancies** | Representative institutions, financial reporting and private tourism partners | N$1.075bn of net national income from community conservation reported for 2023, tourism and other activities together | An operator and rights register for each pilot (objective 13, I12) |

| Case | Mechanism | Reported result | What transfers |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Kenya, African Conservancies Fund** | Affordable loans that protect an existing tourism-linked lease income | More than US$2m lent to four conservancies between December 2020 and December 2022 | Transitional support only where a lawful contract and continuing revenue exist (objective 13, I12) |
| **Edinburgh, accommodation levy** | Statutory levy under national enabling law | 5% of the accommodation price before VAT, capped at five consecutive nights, from 24 July 2026; the council projects up to £50m a year, not yet an audited result | One levy case set against its legal route and timing (objective 15, I14) |
| **Kenya and Sri Lanka, entry reforms** | An ETA with published outcomes (Kenya); a free ETA for selected markets (Sri Lanka) | Kenya reports 2,186,816 authorisations at an average three-day turnaround in 2024/25; Sri Lanka offers a free 30-day tourist ETA to 40 nationalities, China and India included, from 25 May 2026 | An ask built on measured entry performance, since a visa issued is not an arrival (objective 19, I17) |

Note: Results are those each sponsor, agency or evaluator reports. They are not causal estimates and none is an expected return for the Western Cape. The transfer column is this report's reading.

# A4 Readiness scores

The infrastructure assessment classifies 50,332 assets in six districts and scores each district on attractiveness, readiness and accessibility; overall ratings fall from 4.5 in the Cape Metro to 1.9 in the Central Karoo.

## Method

The assessment models tourism supply in three layers (attractions, services and infrastructure) and holds that the weakest layer constrains destination performance. Its asset database sorts the layers into twelve categories with named subtypes. It draws on Wesgro, SANParks, StatsSA and CapeNature data, with Overpass, WikiQuery and tourism reports for 2023 to 2025 named as sources of geographical data points.[382]

**Table A.15.** Asset database structure

| Layer | Category | Subtypes |
|---|---|---|
| **Attraction** | Natural | Beach; mountain; park & reserve; scenic routes |
| **Attraction** | Cultural & heritage | Museum; historical site; monument; cultural precinct |
| **Attraction** | Commercial and leisure | Wine estate; theme park |
| **Attraction** | Events | Festival; sporting event; cultural event; business events |
| **Service** | Accommodation | Hotel; guest house; lodge; self catering |
| **Service** | Food & beverage | Restaurant; café; bar |
| **Service** | Tourism services | Tour operator; travel agency; car rental |
| **Service** | Visitor amenities | Fuel station; retail centre; visitor information centres |
| **Infrastructure** | Air access | Airport; airstrip |
| **Infrastructure** | Road network | National route; regional road |
| **Infrastructure** | Transport nodes | Bus terminal; train station |
| **Infrastructure** | Public services | Hospital; police station |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p10, as printed in sentence case.

[382] Infrastructure Report, p9, p10, p2, p4.

The comparative tables score a different set of eleven categories in three groups, and the district scorecards chart a similar set. Attractions cover activity, commercial & leisure, cultural & heritage, events and natural assets. Services cover accommodation, eatery and shopping. Transport and enabling structures cover transport, enabling structure and visitor amenities. The asset counts use five groups: accommodation, attractions, eateries, events and amenities.[383]

Attractiveness carries 40% of the stated weight and readiness and accessibility carry 30% each. Attractiveness and quality asks how compelling the tourism offer is, through visitor ratings, uniqueness, price positioning and experience depth. Readiness and capacity asks whether the region can service and convert demand, through capacity and digital discovery. Accessibility asks whether visitors can reach and move through the destination, through airport proximity, gateway travel time and public transport availability. The scale runs from 1 'Very weak' and 2 'Weak' through 3 'Functional' and 4 'Strong' to 5 'Leading'. The stated method is to average indicator scores within each dimension, then combine the dimensions using the agreed weights.[384]

Each dimension is the average of its indicator scores, and the dimensions are then combined at 40/30/30. All three use a common scale from 1 to 5, with Functional at 3 and Leading at 5. The report states four assumptions. Asset volume does not equal readiness, and one framework applies to all regions. Indicator scores are evidence informed rather than purely formula derived, and missing data is not treated as poor performance.[385]

The supply dataset behind the Infrastructure Report (Supply_Infrastructure.xlsx) holds no geography below district, and its 17,195 records added after May 2026 are generated placeholders, as the study team found when it checked the file. [Open item: confirm whether the Infrastructure Report's count of 50,332 assets includes those records; if it does, restate Tables 1.2, 2.6 and A.18 and the district shares drawn from them.]

**Overall rating.** The overall ratings are the Infrastructure Report's evidence-informed judgement, not a weighted formula, so this report does not re-derive them.

## Comparative regional scores

The comparative regional analysis scores every district on all three dimensions for each of the eleven categories. Each cell gives attractiveness, readiness and accessibility in that order. Each district's accessibility score is constant within each group, except West Coast natural attractions at 2.0 against 1.7. The Cape Metro scores 4.7 for accessibility on attractions and services and 5.0 on transport and enabling structures.[386]

**Table A.16.** Dimension scores by district

**Accessibility falls from 4.7 or 5.0 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo in every scored category, while natural attractiveness reaches 4.3 in three districts outside the Metro.**

| Category | Cape Metro | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast | Overberg | Central Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Attractions** | | | | | | |
| **Activity** | 4.8 / 4.7 / 4.7 | 4.3 / 3.7 / 3.0 | 3.3 / 3.0 / 3.3 | 2.8 / 2.0 / 1.7 | 3.5 / 3.0 / 2.0 | 2.5 / 1.7 / 1.0 |
| **Commercial & leisure** | 3.8 / 4.7 / 4.7 | 3.3 / 3.0 / 3.0 | 4.5 / 4.0 / 3.3 | 3.0 / 2.0 / 1.7 | 3.3 / 3.0 / 2.0 | 1.3 / 1.3 / 1.0 |
| **Cultural & heritage** | 4.5 / 4.3 / 4.7 | 3.8 / 4.0 / 3.0 | 4.0 / 3.7 / 3.3 | 3.8 / 3.0 / 1.7 | 3.5 / 3.0 / 2.0 | 3.5 / 2.3 / 1.0 |
| **Events** | 4.3 / 4.7 / 4.7 | No score | 4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3 | 3.8 / 3.0 / 1.7 | 3.8 / 3.3 / 2.0 | No score |

[383] Infrastructure Report, p88 to p90, p23, p67.
[384] Infrastructure Report, p17.
[385] Infrastructure Report, p17, p18.
[386] Infrastructure Report, p88 to p90, p88.

| Category | Cape Metro | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast | Overberg | Central Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Natural** | 4.8 / 4.7 / 4.7 | 4.3 / 4.0 / 3.0 | 4.0 / 3.7 / 3.3 | 4.3 / 3.0 / 2.0 | 4.3 / 3.3 / 2.0 | 3.3 / 2.3 / 1.0 |
| **Services** | | | | | | |
| **Accommodation** | 4.3 / 4.7 / 4.7 | 4.0 / 4.0 / 3.0 | 4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3 | 3.3 / 2.7 / 1.7 | 3.8 / 3.3 / 2.0 | 3.3 / 2.0 / 1.0 |
| **Eatery** | 4.5 / 5.0 / 4.7 | 4.0 / 3.7 / 3.0 | 4.0 / 4.0 / 3.3 | 3.3 / 2.3 / 1.7 | 3.3 / 3.0 / 2.0 | 2.8 / 2.0 / 1.0 |
| **Shopping** | 4.0 / 5.0 / 4.7 | 3.0 / 3.0 / 3.0 | 3.0 / 3.0 / 3.3 | 3.3 / 2.3 / 1.7 | 2.8 / 2.7 / 2.0 | 2.3 / 1.7 / 1.0 |
| **Transport and enabling** | | | | | | |
| **Transport** | 3.8 / 4.7 / 5.0 | 3.3 / 3.2 / 3.0 | 3.3 / 3.7 / 3.3 | 2.3 / 2.7 / 1.7 | 2.5 / 2.7 / 2.0 | 2.0 / 2.3 / 1.0 |
| **Enabling structure** | 3.3 / 4.0 / 5.0 | 2.8 / 3.0 / 3.0 | 2.5 / 2.7 / 3.3 | 2.5 / 2.3 / 1.7 | 2.3 / 2.7 / 2.0 | 2.3 / 2.0 / 1.0 |
| **Visitor amenities** | 3.8 / 4.7 / 5.0 | 3.3 / 3.7 / 3.0 | 2.3 / 2.7 / 3.3 | 2.5 / 2.3 / 1.7 | 2.3 / 2.7 / 2.0 | 2.3 / 2.0 / 1.0 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 (attractions), p89 (services), p90 (transport and enabling structures). Cells give attractiveness / readiness / accessibility as printed; 'No score' marks a printed dash.

## District scorecards

Each district section includes a scorecard that prints an overall rating out of 5, the three dimension scores and a bar score for each category. Three scorecards print all three dimension scores. The Cape Winelands prints no accessibility score, and the Overberg and Central Karoo print the dimension labels without numbers.[387]

**Table A.17.** Overall readiness by district

**Overall ratings fall from 4.5 in the Cape Metro to 1.9 in the Central Karoo, and only three of the six scorecards print all three dimension scores.**

| Score | Cape Metro | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast | Overberg | Central Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Overall rating** | 4.5/5 | 3.4/5 | 3.4/5 | 2.5/5 | 2.7/5 | 1.9/5 |
| **Attractiveness** | 4.0 | 4.3 | 4.5 | 3.2 | Not printed | Not printed |
| **Readiness** | 3.0 | 3.8 | 4.0 | 2.7 | Not printed | Not printed |
| **Accessibility** | 2.5 | 3.5 | Not printed | 1.7 | Not printed | Not printed |
| **Activity** | 4.7 | 3.7 | 3.6 | 2.2 | 2.9 | 1.8 |
| **Commercial & leisure** | 4.3 | 3.1 | 4.0 | 2.3 | 2.8 | 1.2 |
| **Cultural & heritage** | 4.5 | 3.6 | 3.5 | 2.9 | 2.9 | 2.4 |
| **Events** | 4.5 | No bar | No bar | 2.9 | 3.1 | No bar |
| **Natural** | 4.7 | 3.8 | 3.5 | 3.2 | 3.3 | 2.3 |
| **Accommodation** | 4.5 | 3.8 | 3.7 | 2.6 | 3.1 | 2 |
| **Eatery** | 4.7 | 3.7 | 3.8 | 2.5 | 2.8 | 2 |
| **Shopping** | 4.5 | 3.2 | 3.5 | 2.5 | 2.5 | 2.1 |
| **Transport** | 4.4 | 3.1 | 2.8 | 2.2 | 2.4 | 1.8 |
| **Enabling structure** | 4 | 2.9 | 3.0 | 2.2 | 2.3 | No bar |
| **Visitor amenities** | 4.3 | 3.0 | 3.2 | 2.4 | 2.5 | 1.7 |
| **Visitor services** | No bar | 3.3 | 3.3 | No bar | No bar | No bar |
| **Mean of bars (computed)** | 4.464 | 3.382 | 3.445 | 2.536 | 2.782 | 1.922 |
| **Weighted 40/30/30 (computed)** | 3.25 | 3.91 | Not computable | 2.60 | Not computable | Not computable |

[387] Infrastructure Report, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85.

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p28, p41, p52, p63, p74, p85 in column order. Bars as printed, decimal commas shown as points; bar labels vary by slide. 'Not printed': a dimension label without a number. 'No bar': a category absent from the chart. Computed: the mean of the printed bars (eleven, or nine for the Central Karoo) and the p17 weights applied to the printed dimension scores.

**Accessibility.** The scorecard dimension scores do not reconcile with the comparative tables. The Cape Metro scorecard prints accessibility of 2.5 and the Garden Route 3.5, while the comparative tables give them 4.7 to 5.0 and 3.0. The West Coast's 1.7 matches its comparative scores apart from natural attractions.[388]

## Touring routes

Each of the six touring routes has a route card with four metrics and a scorecard that rates four readiness dimensions. Ready means the route "meets international expectations now", Developing that it is "workable, with notable gaps" and Gap "a binding constraint to address". The method slide announces five dimensions but lists four, numbered 1, 2, 4 and 5. The West Coast overall score of Emerging is not one of the three defined ratings.[389]

**Table A.18.** Touring route scorecards

**Only the Cape Peninsula route rates Ready overall; four routes rate Developing and the West Coast / Cederberg route rates Emerging.**

| Measure | Cape Peninsula | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast / Cederberg | Whale Coast / Overberg | Route 62 / Klein Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **From Cape Town** | 0 km | 385 km | 50 km | 120 km | 120 km | 160 km |
| **Route length** | 160 km | 225 km | 80 km | 280 km | 230 km | 330 km |
| **End-to-end drive** | 3.0 h | 3.0 h | 1.5 h | 3.5 h | 3.5 h | 4.5 h |
| **Suggested stay** | 2 to 3 days | 5 to 7 days | 2 to 4 days | 2 to 4 days | 3 to 5 days | 3 to 5 days |
| **Air & road access** | Ready | Ready | Ready | Developing | Developing | Developing |
| **Accommodation range** | Ready | Ready | Ready | Gap | Developing | Developing |
| **Safety & support** | Developing | Developing | Developing | Ready | Developing | Developing |
| **Digital & bookability** | Ready | Ready | Ready | Gap | Developing | Gap |
| **Overall** | **Ready** | **Developing** | **Developing** | **Emerging** | **Developing** | **Developing** |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026: cards p29, p39, p50, p72, p61, p83 and scorecards p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84, in column order. Distances are printed as approximate; stays are printed in days, although p19 defines them in nights. The Garden Route pipeline slide lists 'Route fragmented across 300km' as an existing gap (p43).

## Tourism asset counts

The assessment counts 50,332 tourism assets across the six districts. The six district totals sum to exactly that figure, and their shares sum to 100.0% with the Cape Winelands at 15.4% (computed). On every district slide the five category counts fall short of the stated total, leaving 592 assets not broken out (computed).[390]

**Table A.19.** Asset counts by district

**The Cape Metro holds 20,281 of the province's 50,332 assets and the Central Karoo holds 1,518; the six district totals sum to the provincial figure.**

| Count (share) | Cape Metro | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast | Overberg | Central Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Total assets** | 20,281 | 9,875 | 7,730 | 4,752 | 6,176 | 1,518 |

[388] Infrastructure Report, p28, p41, p88 to p90.
[389] Infrastructure Report, p19, p62.
[390] Infrastructure Report, p2, p3.

| Count (share) | Cape Metro | Garden Route | Cape Winelands | West Coast | Overberg | Central Karoo |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Share of province** | 40.3% | 19.6% | 15.4% (gauge 40.3%) | 9.4% | 12.3% | 3.0% |
| **Accommodation** | 6,563 (32.2%) | 4,996 (24.3%) | 2,842 (13.8%) | 2,294 (11.2%) | 3,214 (11.2%) | 622 (3.0%) |
| **Attractions** | 5,544 (44.9%) | 2,136 (17.3%) | 2,298 (18.6%) | 908 (7.4%) | 1,183 (9.6%) | 281 (2.3%) |
| **Eateries** | 6,532 (50.2%) | 2,012 (15.5%) | 1,936 (14.5%) | 992 (7.6%) | 1,209 (9.4%) | 325 (2.5%) |
| **Events** | 638 (34.7%) | 297 (16.2%) | 276 (15.0%) | 247 (13.5%) | 254 (13.8%) | 124 (6.8%) |
| **Amenities** | 706 (34.7%) | 349 (17.1%) | 299 (14.7%) | 267 (13.1%) | 272 (13.4%) | 124 (7.0%) |
| **Sum of five (computed)** | 19,983 | 9,790 | 7,651 | 4,708 | 6,132 | 1,476 |
| **Not broken out (computed)** | 298 | 85 | 79 | 44 | 44 | 42 |

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p23, p34, p45, p56, p67, p78 in column order; province total p2, p3. Counts and gauge percentages as printed; the Central Karoo amenities share is printed '%7.0'. Computed: the last two rows. Accommodation shares as printed sum to 95.7%, against 99.7% to 100.1% for the other categories; the Overberg and West Coast shares are both printed as 11.2%.

**Cape Winelands share.** This appendix uses 15.4%, computed from the count (7,730 of 50,332).

# A5 Inclusion fact base

The Inclusion Plan scores 107 long-listed communities down to a shortlist of 20, rates their readiness, sizes the spend they could capture and takes its order of action from five benchmark cases.

## Long-list rule and scoring weights

The long-list takes every Census 2011 sub-place cluster with 1,500 people or more and official unemployment of 25% or more, plus named mission, fishing and farm settlements. The rule yields 107 township and rural communities with 2.81 million people in 2011 (48% of the province) and 3.79 million on the 2025 estimate. Of the 107, 93 sit within 45 minutes of one of 35 supply-report nodes or three corridors.[391]

By region the long-list holds Cape Metro 26, Cape Winelands 16, Overberg 19, Garden Route 23, West Coast 13 and Central Karoo 10. The shortlist takes five from Cape Metro and three from each other region. Need rests on Census 2011 because Census 2022 is not published below municipality and ward and asked no income question.[392]

The inclusion analysis runs on an OpenStreetMap asset layer, extracted on 16 September 2026, joined to Census 2011 sub-places, so its resident shares are fifteen years old.[393]

**Table A.20.** Community shortlist criteria

**Need carries the largest weight of the five criteria, and each criterion scores a community from 3 to 1 against printed thresholds.**

| Criterion | Weight | Score 3 | Score 2 | Score 1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Need** | 0.25 | Unemployment 32% or more (1.5 times the provincial rate) | 22% to 32% | Below 22% |
| **Tourism Potential** | 0.20 | Three or more attractions inside, or any cultural or heritage asset | One or two inside, or ten or more within 5 km | None |

[391] Inclusion Plan, p14, p16.
[392] Inclusion Plan, p16, p15.
[393] Inclusion Plan, p14 to p17, p22.

| Criterion | Weight | Score 3 | Score 2 | Score 1 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Proximity** | 0.20 | 20 min or less to a node or corridor | 21 to 45 min | Beyond 45 min |
| **Readiness** | 0.20 | Three or more of: LTO or community organisation; events; LED activity; corporate investment | One or two | None |
| **Access** | 0.15 | Rail station within 1.5 km | Bus stop or taxi rank within 500 m | Neither |

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p14. Thresholds as printed; the weights sum to 1.00 (computed). Shortlist composite scores run from 1.80 (Prince Albert North) to 3.00 (Langa and Khayelitsha) (p18). Regional counts sum to the printed 107 and 20 (computed); the p14 panel prints 18 shortlisted, three per region, against 20 on p3, p16, p18 and p28. Drive times are OSRM free-flow estimates (p16, p17).

## Archetypes and responses

Two tests set the archetype: a 45-minute drive time to the nearest node or corridor and whether any attraction sits inside the boundary. Atlantis is held remote by Wesgro naming at 26 minutes from Darling. For the largest group the plan's diagnosis is that the product and the node's demand are there and the seller is missing.[394]

**Table A.21.** Archetypes, responses and benchmarks

**Proximate communities with underused assets are the largest group on both lists, and the plan pairs each archetype with a response, a first move and a benchmark.**

| Archetype | Long-list | Shortlist | Response type (p15) | First move (p31) | Benchmark (p15) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Proximate, assets underused** | 49 | 11 | Integrate: itinerary slots, procurement, events; organise sellers | Package the existing product through the nearby tourism node and test demand before adding assets | Vilakazi Street; Rio |
| **Proximate, no assets** | 43 | 6 | Create one anchor asset with covenant, then integrate | Test a bookable route, experience or event before considering capital investment | Kliptown |
| **Remote, assets underused** | 7 | 2 | Open access and place asset on route product | Address the last-mile access constraint and connect the existing asset to a route already reaching the area | Comuna 13 |
| **Remote, no assets** | 8 | 1 | Procurement and skills first; asset only with route product | Begin with procurement and skills linked to nearby tourism establishments; defer assets until demand is demonstrated | Costa Rica |
| **Total** | 107 | 20 | | | |

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p15 and p17 (counts), p15 (response types and benchmarks) and p31 (first moves). The p4 slide prints long-list counts of 48 and 8 for the two assets-underused rows. Totals are computed.

The counts give 92 proximate communities against 93 within 45 minutes on p16 (computed). Doringbaai and Laingsburg (Bergsig) carry different archetypes on their profiles than on the shortlist. Knysna northern townships and Kwa-Mandlenkosi are scored as having no community-based product but with assets underused on the evidence.[395]

## Readiness of the shortlisted communities

The plan rates each shortlisted community Ready, Developing or Gap from the community side, with LTO confirmation outstanding. Digital and bookability comes from the 19 profile pages; Gugulethu has no profile.[396]

[394] Inclusion Plan, p4, p14, p17, p15.
[395] Inclusion Plan, p18, p25, p26, p56, p58.
[396] Inclusion Plan, p27, p28, p20 to p26, p40 to p51.

**Table A.22.** Shortlist readiness ratings

**Half the shortlist has no identified active tourism body, and no community is rated Ready on benefit visible to residents or on digital and bookability.**

| Community | Binding constraint | Organisation present | Benefit visible to residents | Assets protected | Safety perception | Digital and bookability |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Metro** | | | | | | |
| Langa | Organisation | Developing | Developing | Ready | Developing | Developing |
| Khayelitsha | Organisation | Developing | Developing | Gap | Gap | Developing |
| Atlantis | Organisation | Gap | Gap | Developing | Gap | Developing |
| Mitchells Plain | Organisation | Developing | Developing | Gap | Gap | Developing |
| Gugulethu | Attraction | Gap | Developing | Developing | Gap | No profile |
| **Cape Winelands** | | | | | | |
| Kayamandi | Safety | Developing | Developing | Developing | Gap | Developing |
| Mbekweni | Attraction | Developing | Gap | Gap | Gap | Gap |
| Nkqubela | Attraction | Gap | Gap | Developing | Gap | Gap |
| **Overberg** | | | | | | |
| Zwelihle | Organisation | Gap | Developing | Gap | Developing | Gap |
| Kassiesbaai | Organisation | Developing | Developing | Ready | Developing | Gap |
| Genadendal | Organisation | Developing | Gap | Ready | Developing | Gap |
| **Garden Route** | | | | | | |
| Thembalethu | Attraction | Gap | Developing | Developing | Gap | Gap |
| Knysna northern townships | Market link | Developing | Developing | Ready | Developing | Gap |
| De Rust | Infrastructure | Developing | Gap | Developing | Developing | Developing |
| **West Coast** | | | | | | |
| Laingville | Organisation | Gap | Gap | Developing | Developing | Gap |
| Doringbaai | Organisation | Gap | Developing | Developing | Ready | Developing |
| Elands Bay | Organisation | Gap | Gap | Developing | Ready | Developing |
| **Central Karoo** | | | | | | |
| Kwa-Mandlenkosi | Organisation | Gap | Gap | Gap | Gap | Gap |
| Prince Albert North | Attraction | Ready | Developing | Ready | Developing | Gap |
| Laingsburg (Bergsig) | Attraction | Gap | Gap | Developing | Developing | Gap |
| **Ready (count)** | | 1 | 0 | 5 | 2 | 0 |
| **Developing (count)** | | 9 | 11 | 10 | 9 | 8 |
| **Gap (count)** | | 10 | 9 | 5 | 9 | 11 |

Source: SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026: p53 to p58 for the binding constraint; p28 for organisation present, benefit visible to residents and assets protected or damaged; p27 for safety perception; p20 to p26 and p40 to p51 for digital and bookability. Rows follow the shortlist order on p18; section 2.4 prints each community's archetype, score and drive time. Counts are tallied from the printed cells (computed).

The remaining ratings are counted in the order Ready, Developing and Gap. On p27, extortion is 10, 5, 5; energy supply 6, 14, 0; water and sanitation 1, 14, 5; coach access 0, 20, 0; service delivery 1, 14, 5. In the 19 profiles, air and road access is 2, 16, 1; accommodation range 0, 5, 14; safety and support 0, 11, 8.[397]

Extortion is a Gap in Khayelitsha, Atlantis, Mitchells Plain, Gugulethu and Kayamandi. Binding constraints tally Organisation 11, Attraction 6, Safety 1, Market link 1 and Infrastructure 1. The p28 headline counts six

[397] Inclusion Plan, p27, computed, p20 to p26, p40 to p51.

communities with asset damage against five Gap cells. The plan names no pilot community and assigns no owner; it tests two to three of six profiled exemplars and lists stakeholders for validation only.[398]

## Spend capture scenarios

The 20 communities hold 18.4% of Western Cape residents but a documented floor of R4m to R10m a year in visitor spend, while 1% of FY2025 foreign direct spend would land R259m. They also hold 15.4% of employed residents; both shares come from Census 2011. Foreign direct spend traced to businesses trading inside the communities is a floor of 0.02% to 0.04%, which the plan documents as R4m to R10m landing in the 20 communities a year.[399]

At 1%, FY2025 foreign direct spend would land R259m in the communities, which implies R25.9 billion of FY2025 foreign direct spend (computed). At 1% of the 2035 spend ambition the figure is R547m, which implies R54.7 billion of spend in 2035 (computed). The plan cites the Demand-Side Analysis (16 Sep 2026) and Diagnostic Report v2 for that scenario. The Diagnostic sets the ambition as 5.7 million international arrivals and R54.7 billion of tourism spend by 2035, a different case from the 2.5 million this report carries. Both figures trace to the Tourism Blueprint 2030, which set them before COVID as a goal over ten years. Appendix A2 sets out the demand model's own 2035 cases.[400]

## Benchmark cases and the order of action

The five cases point to one order of action: a seller with a stake, a safe and workable visit, product that keeps spend in the community and only then exposure. The plan's six takeaways are that a sustainable local operator is essential, resident ownership matters, safety is a prerequisite, local spend should be captured, existing product should be sold and spending should be tracked.[401]

The plan finds that local selling mechanisms lasted while assets and training without a durable route to market did not, but Costa Rica's selling network did not survive donor exit.[402]

**Rio de Janeiro, Santa Marta and Rocinha.** The Rio Top Tour's first phase cost about R$230,000 (R$184,000 federal, R$46,000 state). The Cantagalo elevator cost about R$89 million and the Providência cable car R$75 million in a R$163 million package, and almost 10,000 officers were deployed at peak. The tours drew about 4,500 visitors in their first month in 2010, and about 20 resident guides were working by 2015. In 2014, 81% of foreign visitors spent up to R$10 in Rocinha. The cable car stood idle for eight years and security collapsed in 2017, yet Rocinha drew 544,000 visitors in 2023. Access and safety were preconditions, not product, and resident guides continued after the programme that launched them.[403]

**Medellín, Comuna 13.** Metrocable Line J (2008) cost about 96.9 billion pesos and the escalators (2011) about 10 billion pesos, with maintenance above 260 million pesos a year; the integrated urban programme passed 100 billion pesos by 2020. Comuna 13 drew 1.66 million visitors in 2022 and 1.98 million in 2025, 52% of them international, with more than 1,000 businesses and about 300 guides. A 2023 study put its capacity at 667 visitors a day. The lesson is to fund a mandate, a capacity ceiling and a community body alongside the escalator; residents developed the product first.[404]

**Soweto, Vilakazi Street.** The Hector Pieterson Museum cost R23.2 million, the Mandela House restoration about R9 million from corporate donors and Orlando Stadium about R280 million; the public-realm cost is not disclosed. The street drew about 1,000 tourists a day by January 2010. Sakhumzi grew from four employees in 2001 to about 110 in 2019, and the ten restaurants provide more than 800 jobs, though the Mandela House company was liquidated. Upgrades amplified existing assets but benefits

[398] Inclusion Plan, p27, p53 to p58, p32.
[399] Inclusion Plan, p5; values as printed, with no tracing method or denominator printed.
[400] Inclusion Plan, p5; Diagnostic, p5; Tourism Blueprint 2030, p4, p10.
[401] Inclusion Plan, p12.
[402] Inclusion Plan, p7 to p12, p30; the Rio, Medellín, Vilakazi Street and Kliptown cards print no source line, and the plan pools their sources on p12.
[403] Inclusion Plan, p7, p30.
[404] Inclusion Plan, p8, p30.

concentrated on street-front owners, so design governance and a resident precinct entity belong at the outset.[405]

**Costa Rica, ACTUAR.** UNDP GEF small grants funded the network from the 1990s. Law 8724 (2009) gave ICT duties without a budget, and no state funding for the selling network has been identified. ACTUAR, founded in 2001, turned over more than USD 800,000 in 2013 for more than 30 member communities and dissolved at the end of 2018; its benefits stopped at association members. A management entity with its own selling channel was the engine, and it did not survive donor exit.[406]

**Soweto, Kliptown.** Kliptown received R436 million in its first allocation. The JDA spent about R497 million from 2001 to 2010 plus R40 million to 2013, Walter Sisulu Square cost R160 million to R180 million and a 48-room hotel R24 million. The business case projected almost 200,000 international visitors a year, but the museum drew about 4,000 a year by 2017 and the hotel traded above break-even only during the 2010 FIFA World Cup. Local small businesses took 5% of construction contract value, and the site was looted in 2021. Heritage converts to local income only when operator, trader and guide product, security and services are funded before the ribbon is cut.[407]

# A6 Stakeholder inputs

Phase 1 engaged 16 organisations, whose 223 rated insight statements span all three goals of the framework and inform eight priority areas for deeper engagement.

## Engagement record and method

Engagement was planned in four phases: introduction and framing from January to March 2026, sense-making and validation in April and May, socialisation of draft recommendations in June and July and mobilisation from August into October. The March deck documents phase 1 and marks phase 2, a validation round with a select few stakeholders, as still to commence. [Phase 2 to 4 records not in hand: Letsema to supply the organisations engaged, session dates and outcomes for each phase.][408]

The project team held structured sessions with key stakeholders, extracted insights, mapped each to the study's framework of goals and objectives and aggregated them. Each insight is a concise statement written by the team, not a verbatim quotation. Every row carries a goal, a category of the framework and one impact rating of High, Medium or Low. The ratings are not defined, and no session dates, participants or roles are recorded, so this appendix attributes insights to organisations and does not quote them.[409]

## Organisations engaged in phase 1

**Table A.23.** Insights by organisation

**Sixteen organisations carry 223 rated insight rows, and CapeNature (17 of 24) and the Department of Economic Development (15 of 19) carry the most High ratings.**

| Organisation | Type | Pages | Rows | High | Medium | Low |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Mossel Bay** | Local or district tourism body | p20, p21 | 18 | 9 | 9 | 0 |
| **Department of Mobility** | Enabling environment | p22, p23 | 14 | 7 | 7 | 0 |
| **Dept of Economic Development** | Enabling environment | p24, p25 | 19 | 15 | 4 | 0 |
| **Overberg District** | Local or district tourism body | p26, p27 | 19 | 5 | 13 | 1 |

[405] Inclusion Plan, p9.
[406] Inclusion Plan, p10.
[407] Inclusion Plan, p11.
[408] Stakeholder Insights, p4, p17, p15.
[409] Stakeholder Insights, p5, p20 to p46.

| Organisation | Type | Pages | Rows | High | Medium | Low |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **C-BRTA** | Supply side | p28 | 7 | 2 | 5 | 0 |
| **Google** | Enabling environment | p29 | 8 | 1 | 6 | 1 |
| **Stats SA** | Enabling environment | p30 | 7 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| **FEDHASA** | Supply side | p31 | 9 | 2 | 6 | 1 |
| **Robben Island Museum** | Supply side | p32, p33 | 14 | 8 | 6 | 0 |
| **SATVITO** | Enabling environment | p34 | 11 | 9 | 2 | 0 |
| **Table Mountain Aerial Cableway** | Supply side | p35, p36 | 19 | 10 | 8 | 1 |
| **Department of Tourism** | National, not on p16 | p37 | 7 | 4 | 3 | 0 |
| **West Coast District Municipality** | Local or district tourism body | p38, p39 | 15 | 11 | 4 | 0 |
| **!Khwa ttu** | Supply side | p40, p41 | 16 | 7 | 9 | 0 |
| **CapeNature** | Supply side | p42 to p44 | 24 | 17 | 7 | 0 |
| **CTICC** | Supply side | p45, p46 | 16 | 7 | 9 | 0 |
| **Total** | | p20 to p46 | 223 | 115 | 102 | 6 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16 (type, where listed; the three local or district tourism bodies overlap the p16 supply-side entry Tourism offices of each District) and p20 to p46. Medium and Low are tallied from the transcribed rows (computed). The deck does not print the number 16.

## Organisations listed for later phases

The deck lists 13 supply-side stakeholders, 6 proposed demand-side engagements and 11 enabling-environment stakeholders engaged or in progress. No airline, online travel agency or tour operator is among the 16 phase 1 organisations.[410]

The later-phase list names the demand-side voices that phase 1 lacks, but marks all six demand-side engagements as proposed. The 13 supply-side stakeholders, seven of them with a phase 1 table, are: Tourism offices of each District; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; Robben Island Museum; Hospitality Providers; Conference Venue Operators; CapeNature; SANParks; CBRTA; Ikhwa ttu; CCID; CTICC; FEDHASA; V&A Waterfront.[411]

The 6 proposed demand-side engagements, none with a phase 1 table, are: Trip.com Group (China, ASEAN); Thomas Cook India (India, Middle East outbound); DNATA Travel (Middle East, India, ASEAN); China International Travel Service (China); Emirates (China, India, Middle East, ASEAN); SATSA. The 11 enabling-environment stakeholders engaged or in progress, five of them with a phase 1 table, are: Department of Economic Development and Tourism; Ministry of Mobility; South African Tourism; SouthAfrica.net; We Do Tourism; SATOvito; Statistics South Africa; Google (Government Affairs and Public Policy); Cape Town International Airport; Winelands Airport; George Airport. The appendix tables print SATVITO, C-BRTA, !Khwa ttu and Cape Nature.

SANParks, the V&A Waterfront, the CCID, hospitality providers, conference venue operators, South African Tourism, SouthAfrica.net, We Do Tourism and the three airports have no phase 1 table. The entry for district tourism offices overlaps the Mossel Bay, Overberg District and West Coast District Municipality tables.[412]

## Tally by objective

No tally is printed, so the table below is a reconstruction from the 16 appendix tables.[413]

[410] Stakeholder Insights, p16.
[411] Stakeholder Insights, p16; entries, spellings and markets in brackets as printed.
[412] Stakeholder Insights, p16.
[413] Stakeholder Insights, p20 to p46.

**Table A.24.** Insights by objective

**Policy and data sharing and industry-government collaboration each draw insights from 15 of the 16 organisations, and policy and data sharing carries the most rows and the most High ratings.**

| Objective (as coded) | Organisations | Rows | High | Medium | Low |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Reshape demand (goal, as coded)** | 12 | 64 | 23 | 40 | 1 |
| 1 Respond to growth segment traveller preferences | 10 | 14 | 6 | 8 | 0 |
| 2 Create green-season demand with MICE and events | 9 | 15 | 4 | 11 | 0 |
| 3 Make the whole province findable and bookable | 11 | 15 | 6 | 9 | 0 |
| 4 Convert India and China hub traffic (coded as growth markets generally) | 8 | 9 | 3 | 6 | 0 |
| 5 Increase yield in mature markets | 4 | 7 | 2 | 4 | 1 |
| 6 Build a regional foundation (Africa) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 2 | 0 |
| **Transform supply (goal, as coded)** | 14 | 68 | 44 | 24 | 0 |
| 7 and 8 Routes, seats and cruise (coded together) | 3 | 3 | 3 | 0 | 0 |
| 9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility | 8 | 18 | 10 | 8 | 0 |
| 19 Lead removal of infrastructure, visa and safety deficits (coded to supply) | 10 | 14 | 9 | 5 | 0 |
| 10 Support diversified route and product development | 11 | 18 | 11 | 7 | 0 |
| 11 Align visitor experience in-destination | 8 | 11 | 7 | 4 | 0 |
| 12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions | 3 | 4 | 4 | 0 | 0 |
| **Build enabling capability (goal, as coded)** | 16 | 91 | 48 | 38 | 5 |
| 13 Embed local destination bodies for community inclusion | 9 | 14 | 6 | 7 | 1 |
| 14 Embed sustainable tourism and manage climate risk | 4 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 0 |
| 15 Crowd in capital with targeted investment strategies | 6 | 8 | 6 | 2 | 0 |
| 16 Align institutional stakeholders across all three tiers | 5 | 11 | 9 | 2 | 0 |
| 17 Strengthen industry and government collaboration | 15 | 23 | 8 | 13 | 2 |
| 18 Expedite tourism-enabling policy and data sharing | 15 | 30 | 16 | 12 | 2 |
| **Total** | 16 | 223 | 115 | 102 | 6 |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p20 to p46. Reconstruction from the appendix tables, since the deck prints no tally (computed). Each coded category is shown against the objective it bears on. The tables code routes and cruise as one category and visa, safety and infrastructure under the supply goal. The Organisations column counts those of the 16 with at least one row under the category or goal.

The coding has no skills category, so skills insights from CapeNature, the West Coast District Municipality and the Overberg District sit under other categories.[414]

## Priority areas for deeper engagement

**Table A.25.** Lines of enquiry by area

| Priority area | Lines of enquiry (p14) |
|---|---|
| **Province-wide access, mobility and visitor movement** | Highest-friction transport bottlenecks affecting visitor movement; last-mile access gaps across priority routes and attractions; most feasible mobility interventions by corridor and destination; how to measure mobility impact on spread, stay and satisfaction |
| **International access friction: air access, visas and onward conversion** | Priority market access barriers across air, visa and onward travel; where the province is losing international access conversion; highest-impact interventions to ease international access friction; evidence required to support route and facilitation prioritisation |

[414] Stakeholder Insights, p27, p39, p43, p44.

| Priority area | Lines of enquiry (p14) |
|---|---|
| **Destination readiness, safety and resilience** | Safety issues most damaging to demand and destination confidence; destination infrastructure and service-readiness gaps; climate and utility risks facing priority tourism assets; peak-period visitor-management challenges and operating responses |
| **Product diversification and geographic spread beyond the Cape Town core** | Regions and products with strongest potential for incremental growth; barriers preventing secondary destinations from scaling; most credible route-development and multi-stop travel opportunities; how to balance investment between core and emerging destinations |
| **Inclusive tourism growth and SME/community participation** | Capability gaps limiting SME and community participation; why current support mechanisms are not scaling market-ready operators; partnership and mentoring models that could improve market access; how inclusion can support both equity and tourism differentiation |
| **Market prioritisation and demand development in mature and emerging source markets** | Priority source markets by scale, yield and strategic fit; market-specific barriers to stronger demand conversion; how to balance mature-market yield with growth-market expansion; which segment propositions are strongest by market |
| **Seasonality management, events and demand spread** | Where seasonality is most severe by region and segment; event opportunities with strongest off-peak and regional potential; constraints limiting event-led demand growth; how to embed seasonality and spread objectives into activation |
| **Digital conversion, packaging and tourism intelligence** | Where the Western Cape is losing travellers along the path to purchase; digital and content gaps weakening conversion; minimum tourism-data architecture needed for better decisions; realistic data-sharing partnerships across the tourism syst (truncated on the slide) |

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p14. Bullets as printed with initial capitals lowered, except the second bullet of the second area, reworded for this report's style; the last is truncated on the slide.

## A7 Initiative charters and action register

The 139 actions in Chapter 3 are listed here by initiative, so each lead can see every action the plan asks of it and of its partners.

Section 4.3 carries the eighteen charters in full, so this appendix does not repeat them. It lists the actions from the Chapter 3 action tables in initiative order, with the tier that acts and the proposed lead and partners. The programme office loads this register into the toolkit as the Tier 3 work plan.

**Table A.26.** Chapter 3 action register

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I1** | 1 | Wesgro | Set segment targets inside each priority market: Curious Explorers in the UK and USA, Reflective Adventurers in Germany, Creative Connectors in India, Discerning Connoisseurs in the UAE | Destination Marketing; Research |
| **I1** | 1 | Wesgro | Move spend from broad awareness to trade-led conversion through each segment's own channels, from luxury advisors to mobile-first OTAs | Destination Marketing; trade and OTA partners |
| **I1** | 1 | Wesgro | Test three brand presentations in priority markets (Cape Town as gateway endorsement, a Western Cape umbrella and regional brands leading specialist campaigns), and write regional product, inventory links and completed regional bookings into campaign and airline agreements | Destination Marketing; Air Access; Cape Town Tourism; regional tourism bodies |
| **I1** | 1 | Wesgro | Commission destination-specific research to validate the segments, extend it to the domestic and African markets, build the segments into brand tracking and measure aided and unaided awareness of the city, the province and its regions in the priority markets | Research |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I1** | 1 | Partners | Develop segment-matched product: heritage and township experiences, creative districts, private-access wine and food and a certified network of wellness retreats and trails | Product owners; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs |
| **I1** | 1 | Partners | Map the City's four segments onto the four used here, so Wesgro, the City and Cape Town Tourism sell to the same travellers | City of Cape Town; Cape Town Tourism |
| **I1** | 1 | National | Agree one segment frame with SA Tourism for long-haul campaigns, so provincial and national spend target the same travellers | SA Tourism |
| **I1** | 5 | Wesgro | Make the case to carriers on the five full routes for added frequency or larger aircraft, backed by green-season marketing | Air Access; airlines |
| **I1** | 5 | Wesgro | Sell Discerning Connoisseur product through luxury advisors and high-end operators in the UK, USA, Germany, France and Switzerland | Destination Marketing; trade |
| **I1** | 5 | Wesgro | Add two measures beside arrivals in Wesgro's own targets: spend per visitor by market with length of stay, and each market's share of air outbound trips | Research |
| **I1** | 5 | Partners | Invest in premium product outside the Metro and in the mid-market accommodation each place is shown to lack (objectives 11 and 15) | Accommodation investors; hospitality bodies |
| **I1** | 5 | National | Escalate the cap on US carriers, the absence of an Open Skies agreement and the bilateral agreements that limit airlift | Department of Transport |
| **I2** | 2 | Wesgro | Publish a green-season events calendar and aim Convention Bureau bids at May to August first, within the April to September season, in the province's strongest sectors | Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing |
| **I2** | 2 | Wesgro | Organise sales by buyer type: corporate midweek retreats, extensions to congresses already secured, new association bids, incentives, exhibitions with non-local buyers and leisure events with non-local attendance | Convention Bureau; Destination Marketing; CTICC |
| **I2** | 2 | Wesgro | Contract dated green-season offers for named low-demand weeks with airlines and trade, with rain alternatives and buyer commitments before any public support, and test cooler-season incentive packages with Indian and Gulf planners | Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines |
| **I2** | 2 | Wesgro | Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions, and build one monthly green-season baseline with accommodation partners: sold and available room nights by region and type, with the shoulder months split from May to August | Research; CTICC; Cape Town Tourism; LTOs |
| **I2** | 2 | Partners | Programme lifestyle events in December and January and keep peak dates for international events; sell food and wine, whale and wildflower product on its own calendar, within conservation limits | CTICC; Overberg and West Coast LTOs |
| **I2** | 2 | Partners | Agree one event acquisition and calendar strategy across Wesgro, the Convention Bureau, the City and the Province | City of Cape Town; DEDAT |
| **I2** | 2 | Partners | Apply one common appraisal, at full public cost, to every publicly supported event before commitment, any Formula 1 bid included | DEDAT; City of Cape Town; Cultural Affairs and Sport; Provincial Treasury |
| **I2** | 2 | National | Give regional African delegates, whose event demand the venue operator rates as visa-constrained, a delegate escalation channel for entry cases (objective 19) | Home Affairs; SA National Convention Bureau |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I3** | 3 | Wesgro | Run a discovery-to-sale audit by district, for accommodation and for experiences separately: a verified inventory of eligible supply, a stratified sample of platform presence, repeatable discovery searches, booking-route checks on common dates and consented sales returns | Research; LTOs |
| **I3** | 3 | Wesgro | Run a bounded support trial where the audit verifies a failure: a first booking route for unlisted product, and content, inventory, distribution terms or packaging for listed product, with a comparison group | Tourism; Research; district municipalities; LTOs |
| **I3** | 3 | Wesgro | Choose platform and trade partners from priority-market journey evidence, starting with the audit's findings on Trip.com, Almosafer and Booking.com, and list packaged regional itineraries on them | Destination Marketing; OTAs |
| **I3** | 3 | Partners | Give each pilot community one live booking route before any promotion (objective 13) | LTOs; community sellers |
| **I3** | 3 | Partners | Move CapeNature reservations online and complete cashless payments at reserve level | CapeNature |
| **I3** | 3 | National | Extend rural broadband under SA Connect, so operators outside the core can take online bookings and card payments | National government |
| **I4** | 4 | Wesgro | Secure added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, with joint market support tied to Indian and Chinese sales | Air Access; hub carriers |
| **I4** | 4 | Wesgro | Run a joint route, fare, visa and product diagnosis of the India and China markets with the hub carriers and the trade, and test direct services commercially before any route case goes forward | Air Access; Research; hub carriers; trade |
| **I4** | 4 | Wesgro | Activate inside Xiaohongshu, Douyin and MakeMyTrip with market-specific itineraries and Trip.com packages | Destination Marketing; OTAs; trade |
| **I4** | 4 | Wesgro | Build long-term route cases for the India and China corridors and keep a standing relationship with Indian carriers, Cathay Pacific, China Southern and China Eastern | Air Access |
| **I4** | 4 | Wesgro | Sell Johannesburg-gateway itineraries, with a flight to Cape Town added to the ticket, to Indian and Chinese visitors already bound for South Africa | Destination Marketing; inbound operators; airlines |
| **I4** | 4 | Partners | Ready the product for both markets: Mandarin and Indian-language guiding, Alipay and WeChat Pay, visible vegetarian options | Product owners; attractions; hospitality bodies |
| **I4** | 4 | National | Escalate ETA performance for China and India, and the route designation for China that is decided government to government | Home Affairs; Department of Transport |
| **I5** | 6 | Wesgro | Make the capacity case on the five full regional routes with Airlink, Ethiopian Airlines, Kenya Airways and the other regional carriers | Air Access (objective 7); airlines |
| **I5** | 6 | Wesgro | Run premium, trade-led activation in Nigeria and Kenya for leisure, weddings and conferences with leisure extensions | Destination Marketing; Convention Bureau; trade |
| **I5** | 6 | Wesgro | Add Nigeria and Ghana to the growth model and commission consumer research for Botswana, Zambia, Ghana and Rwanda | Research |
| **I5** | 6 | Partners | Convert rest-of-Africa travellers who stop in Johannesburg with onward packages, and give regional delegates leisure extensions | Cape Town Tourism; CTICC; tour operators; Cross-Border Road Transport Agency |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I5** | 6 | National | Escalate visas for African markets, building on the Ghana visa waiver of November 2023, and liberalisation of regional air routes | Home Affairs; Department of Transport |
| **I6** | 7 | Wesgro | Run a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes, with joint marketing tied to route performance | Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines |
| **I6** | 7 | Wesgro | Win Wesgro's 10 new routes by FY30 outside the peak hours, starting with regional and hub links; put belly cargo into each route case | Air Access; airlines; ACSA; exporters |
| **I6** | 7 | Wesgro | Scale and ring-fence Cape Town Air Access's route fund as a public-private fund for route support, with a set size, governance and resilience conditions: tapering support, matched airline marketing, minimum flown capacity, clawbacks, a documented funding gap and grants set after bids | Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; SA Tourism; private sector |
| **I6** | 7 | Wesgro | Treat runway delivery as the first risk: track approvals and milestones quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035 | Air Access; Research |
| **I6** | 7 | Wesgro | Model correlated hub-closure scenarios with flown-seat and itinerary data by hub, and weight route work toward routings outside any one region | Air Access; Research; airlines; ACSA |
| **I6** | 7 | Partners | Deliver the runway, terminals and George upgrade on the published dates; show financial close, aviation licensing and airline commitments at Cape Winelands before it enters the capacity plan | ACSA; Cape Winelands Airport |
| **I6** | 7 | National | Escalate bilateral air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing at Cape Town International | Department of Transport; Home Affairs |
| **I7** | 8 | Wesgro | Agree a circuit compact with partner ports and lines, so that itineraries east and west of Cape Town hold for a season | Cruise Cape Town; partner ports; cruise lines |
| **I7** | 8 | Wesgro | Agree a call-day flow plan with the flagship operators and build shore programmes beyond the flagship sites | Cruise Cape Town; flagship site operators; V&A Waterfront; City of Cape Town |
| **I7** | 8 | Wesgro | Market Cape Town as homeport to world-cruise, expedition and shoulder-season operators whose ships fit the berth, with pre- and post-cruise stays | Cruise Cape Town; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town |
| **I7** | 8 | Wesgro | Back Mossel Bay now with packaged excursions and line marketing; keep Saldanha Bay on watch until demand is proven | Cruise Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality |
| **I7** | 8 | Wesgro | Put community and regional product on cruise-operator channels, starting with a bookable walk in the Knysna townships | Cruise Cape Town; LTOs |
| **I7** | 8 | Partners | Manage berth scheduling and wind delays at Cape Town, plan for shore power and review the 300m limit | Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront |
| **I7** | 8 | National | Put cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries no cruise capacity | Transnet |
| **I7** | 8 | National | Run port and immigration processing consistently across South African ports, so that a circuit works for the line | Transnet National Ports Authority; national government |
| **I8** | 9 | Wesgro | Package the Southern Line as a visitor product, with refreshed branding and day passes, once PRASA signs a timetable with security and disruption obligations | Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; PRASA |
| **I8** | 9 | Wesgro | Aggregate demand and bookings for corridor shuttles, starting on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast | Tourism; district municipalities; private operators |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I8** | 9 | Wesgro | Sell the airport transfer and the corridor transfers on the N2 and R62 routes inside the itinerary, so visitors without a car can buy the trip | Destination Marketing; operators |
| **I8** | 9 | Partners | Write funded service specifications for the airport link and regional services, including for visitors without cars, and secure MyCiTi funding beyond the grant that ends in 2027/28 | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town; ACSA |
| **I8** | 9 | Partners | Complete the Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and the unfunded last mile to Cape Point, with integrated ticketing | City of Cape Town; PRASA; Department of Mobility |
| **I8** | 9 | Partners | Appraise cheaper options before any Cape Town to George rapid rail decision, and extend the George public transport model | Department of Mobility |
| **I8** | 9 | Partners | Revive the MyCiTi airport service, plan facilities for e-hailing and metered taxis at Cape Town International and publish one consistent set of airport pickup information | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town; ACSA |
| **I8** | 9 | National | Obtain from the Department of Transport and the payment provider the written technical or regulatory reason for refusing direct bank-card tapping on the George bus, and fund passenger rail beyond the Metro | Department of Transport; PRASA |
| **I9** | 10 | Wesgro | Package bookable multi-day itineraries on each of the six touring routes, delivering first on the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, then Route 62 and the West Coast | Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; LTOs |
| **I9** | 10 | Wesgro | Activate cold-zone assets with guided tours, interpretation and bookable product, beginning with the marine and wildflower assets | Tourism; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs |
| **I9** | 10 | Wesgro | Build regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George, with stays before and after Cape Town events | Convention Bureau |
| **I9** | 10 | Partners | Invest in accommodation and service depth beyond Hermanus, in Route 62's secondary towns and beyond Langebaan and Paternoster (objective 15) | Accommodation investors; municipalities |
| **I9** | 10 | Partners | Refresh flagship product: Robben Island beyond the prison tour; the Cableway's lower station | Robben Island Museum; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway |
| **I9** | 10 | National | Complete SANParks precinct projects such as the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct | SANParks |
| **I10** | 11 | Wesgro | Prepare for growth markets: multilingual guiding, digital payments, halal food and prayer facilities and culturally relevant product for Chinese, Indian and Gulf visitors, with halal and vegetarian claims verified against delivery | Tourism; Destination Marketing |
| **I10** | 11 | Wesgro | Run a destination-and-product test with I14 of which accommodation configuration, price point, location or capacity is missing in George and Mossel Bay, east of Hermanus and on Route 62 (objective 15) | Tourism; private investors |
| **I10** | 11 | Wesgro | Audit accommodation by district, counting hotel, guesthouse and short-term rental stock separately | Research; Tourism; municipalities |
| **I10** | 11 | Wesgro | Build accessible journeys as saleable itineraries, test them end to end with lived-experience partners and publish verified access information | Tourism; Destination Marketing; lived-experience partners; operators |
| **I10** | 11 | Partners | Set up a provincial quality charter, phased by district, as a supported condition for discretionary public promotion, with its status visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply | DEDAT, with Wesgro Tourism; industry bodies |
| **I10** | 11 | Partners | Close service and interpretation gaps at named sites: Robben Island interpretation, CapeNature service readiness, restaurant quality in Mossel Bay | Attraction operators; municipalities; CATHSSETA |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I10** | 11 | Partners | Publish guide-registration service performance and complete the committed workflow fixes | DEDAT |
| **I10** | 11 | National | Improve immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, and deliver the terminal relief due about 2032 | Home Affairs; ACSA |
| **I11** | 12 | Wesgro | Market receiving reserves, Stony Point included, and the Southern Line towns only once each passes its own readiness assessment, as alternatives to peak-hour visits at Boulders and the Cableway | Destination Marketing; CapeNature; SANParks; PRASA |
| **I11** | 12 | Wesgro | Request carrying capacity for the flagship sites and publish it beside the Treasury's visitor counts as the baseline | Research; site operators; Provincial Treasury |
| **I11** | 12 | Wesgro | Report spend per visitor and length of stay for nature product alongside visitor numbers | Research |
| **I11** | 12 | Partners | Assess each receiving reserve, Stony Point included, for ecological capacity and coach readiness before any dispersal marketing | CapeNature; Overberg LTOs |
| **I11** | 12 | Partners | Compile a costed condition register for reserve and attraction assets, and repair verified assets before adding new product | CapeNature; SANParks; site operators |
| **I11** | 12 | Partners | Run two flow pilots, at Boulders and one other constrained site, from summer 2027/28 at the earliest, protecting walk-up and resident access and carrying a stop rule; then extend digital flow management and tiered pricing where mandates allow | SANParks; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; CapeNature |
| **I11** | 12 | Partners | Make reserve product climate-resilient by reassessing asset formats and siting | CapeNature |
| **I11** | 12 | National | Agree a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders with the City and the operators | SANParks |
| **I12** | 13 | Wesgro | Put pilot community product into the itineraries, calendars and channels Wesgro already runs, such as the Langa and Kayamandi routes and the Mal'va festival listing | Tourism; Destination Marketing |
| **I12** | 13 | Wesgro | Choose the two or three pilots with partners on the plan's readiness criteria, and keep the record of bookings, visitors and locally retained revenue | Research; Tourism |
| **I12** | 13 | Partners | Form or fund a local selling body in each pilot community, with one live booking route, published dates, a named customer contact and an operator and rights register | Municipalities, with the City of Cape Town in Metro pilots; LTOs; community sellers |
| **I12** | 13 | Partners | Secure paid departures with buyer commitments on net rate, schedule, commission, cancellation and settlement before any promotion | LTOs; community sellers; inbound operators |
| **I12** | 13 | Partners | Attach maintenance and marketing covenants to public assets before any re-letting or upgrade | Municipalities |
| **I12** | 13 | Partners | Keep LTO services running through lawful procurement with a development mandate, written into IDPs from 2029 with reporting, using the Provincial Treasury's district reviews | Municipalities; district municipalities; DEDAT; Provincial Treasury |
| **I12** | 13 | Partners | Issue a provincial practice note on the procurement route that Circular 131 leaves open for tourism services | DEDAT; Provincial Treasury |
| **I12** | 13 | National | Commit SAPS to the launch safety plans the pilots need, with a named referral for extortion reports, and open ACSA and other national procurement to businesses trading inside the communities | SAPS; ACSA |
| **I12** | 13 | National | Clarify the points of MFMA Circular No. 131 that remain in dispute for tourism services | National Treasury |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I13** | 14 | Wesgro | Keep a climate and weather risk register for tourism sites and routes, starting with the Robben Island, Cableway and CapeNature losses and the Meiringspoort closure | Research; DEDAT; site operators |
| **I13** | 14 | Wesgro | Build sustainability checks into the provincial quality charter (objective 11) on the Mossel Bay model | Tourism; LTOs |
| **I13** | 14 | Wesgro | Route itineraries and marketing around closures, starting with alternatives to Meiringspoort until the pass reopens | Destination Marketing; Garden Route and Klein Karoo LTOs |
| **I13** | 14 | Wesgro | Report absolute resource use and emissions for tourism beside per-night intensity | Research; DEDAT; operators |
| **I13** | 14 | Partners | Make reserve and attraction assets climate-resilient, with off-grid power at remote sites | CapeNature; site operators |
| **I13** | 14 | Partners | Assess readiness by node or supply zone and test continuity arrangements before publicly supported demand expansion | DEDAT; municipalities; site operators |
| **I13** | 14 | National | Complete the Meiringspoort rebuild | The road authority |
| **I14** | 15 | Wesgro | Build a tourism investment pipeline from the gap-closure tables, scored for return, jobs and inclusion, and take it to investors | Wesgro investment promotion; Tourism; DEDAT |
| **I14** | 15 | Wesgro | Run the destination-and-product test with I10, then prepare investment cases for the conference-capable and mid-market product it confirms in secondary nodes and for accommodation at De Hoop and on Route 62, comparing refurbishment with new build on lifecycle cost | Wesgro investment promotion; private investors |
| **I14** | 15 | Wesgro | Scale Cape Town Air Access's route fund into the public-private air access fund, with ring-fenced corridor budgets (objective 7) | Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; ACSA; Cape Town Tourism; SA Tourism; private sector |
| **I14** | 15 | Partners | Make one levy case for the visitor economy that covers destination management and tourist transport, set against its legal route and timing, with no levy proceeds assumed for essential near-term operations; test blended-finance vehicles | DEDAT; Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town |
| **I14** | 15 | Partners | Route tourism investment cases through the Red Tape Reduction service, recording stage times and reasons for delay | DEDAT; municipalities |
| **I14** | 15 | Partners | Attach covenants to public assets before re-letting or upgrading them, and invest in community assets only after demand is proven | Municipalities |
| **I14** | 15 | National | Hold ACSA, PRASA and Transnet to their published capital dates, and add tourism use to the port plans | ACSA; PRASA; Transnet |
| **I15** | 16 | Wesgro | Constitute the Tourism Growth Steerco, co-chaired with DEDAT and with Cape Town Tourism as a standing member, and agree a decision-rights map by tier, building on the tier split in section 1.1 | Wesgro CEO's office; DEDAT; Cape Town Tourism |
| **I15** | 16 | Wesgro | Hold standing relationships with Indian carriers and authorities, with China Southern and China Eastern and with Riyadh Air | Air Access |
| **I15** | 16 | Wesgro | Track the national capital programmes that bind the plan (runway, ports and rail) and report on them each quarter | Air Access; Research |
| **I15** | 16 | Partners | Settle district, local and LTO mandates, testing the Blueprint's district model for regional tourism organisations, restore a tourism development function where it has lapsed and revisit the Discover Garden Route partnership | District municipalities; municipalities; LTOs |
| **I15** | 16 | Partners | Test a dedicated transport authority model for tourism-enabling mobility | Department of Mobility |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I15** | 16 | National | Agree with the province how marketing and data roles divide between national and provincial bodies | SA Tourism; Department of Tourism |
| **I15** | 17 | Wesgro | Use JAMMS as the single consultation channel to the associations, and add the Tour Guides Association | Wesgro CEO's office; FEDHASA |
| **I15** | 17 | Wesgro | Set up sector councils for wine, business events, adventure and culture inside Steerco's structure | Tourism; Convention Bureau; industry bodies |
| **I15** | 17 | Wesgro | Bring airlines, online travel agencies and tour operators into the joint plan, starting with Trip.com Group, Thomas Cook India, dnata Travel, China International Travel Service and Emirates | Destination Marketing; Air Access |
| **I15** | 17 | Partners | Supply academic and sector champions for international bids | CTICC; universities |
| **I15** | 17 | Partners | Give regional forums a development agenda and tailor provincial support to district needs | District municipalities; DEDAT; LTOs |
| **I15** | 17 | National | Include provincial assets in SA Tourism's campaigns for emerging source markets | SA Tourism |
| **I16** | 18 | Wesgro | Agree data-sharing terms with ACSA, SA Tourism, Stats SA, Cape Town Tourism, the Provincial Treasury, the Department of Mobility, the site operators and the booking platforms | Research |
| **I16** | 18 | Wesgro | Run one indicator register and dashboard, with quarterly digital tracking and annual brand research | Research; programme office |
| **I16** | 18 | Wesgro | Measure meetings, incentives and exhibitions | Research; Convention Bureau |
| **I16** | 18 | Partners | Close the provincial tourism policy gap and embed tourism in IDPs and spatial plans, with reporting | DEDAT; municipalities |
| **I16** | 18 | Partners | Share visitor-level data from ticketing and reservation systems | Attraction operators; CapeNature |
| **I16** | 18 | Partners | Agree a lawful property-level short-term rental evidence agreement with platforms and municipal valuers | Municipalities; City of Cape Town; booking platforms; Research |
| **I16** | 18 | National | Approve a provincial tourism GDP and jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account | Department of Tourism; Stats SA |
| **I17** | 19 | Wesgro | Table an escalation agenda at Steerco: entry through the ETA for China, India, the Middle East and Africa; air service agreements; immigration throughput at Cape Town International | Wesgro CEO's office; Advocacy and Advisory unit; DEDAT |
| **I17** | 19 | Wesgro | Build the market-by-market evidence for each ask, including an African passport matrix, from the reforms DEDAT's visa study ranks to safety perception in source markets | Research; Destination Marketing |
| **I17** | 19 | Wesgro | Run a delegate escalation channel for stalled applications from delegates to confirmed congresses | Convention Bureau; Advocacy and Advisory unit; Home Affairs |
| **I17** | 19 | Wesgro | Carry a visitor-safety narrative in marketing, and apply the four launch gates set in objective 13 to any community product Wesgro sells | Destination Marketing; Tourism |
| **I17** | 19 | Partners | Build on the running safety services with one referral pathway, named aftercare for serious cases, worker safeguards and tested handoffs; review at the end of 2028 before expansion; safety compacts in pilot communities | City of Cape Town; Western Cape Government; DEDAT; municipalities; SAPS; SANParks; Cape Town Tourism |
| **I17** | 19 | Partners | Fix basic services, water and connectivity at remote reserves and in tourism towns | Municipalities; CapeNature |

| Initiative | Objective | Who acts | Action | Lead and partners |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **I17** | 19 | Partners | Study congestion on the N2 from Cape Town International and sustain the highway patrols on the airport corridor, with their cost carried once, in this initiative | Department of Mobility; City of Cape Town |
| **I17** | 19 | National | Publish monthly ETA performance by priority nationality: applications, completions, decision times, refusals, appeals and authorisations matched to arrivals; decide on air service agreements and immigration counters; make station security a rail line item | Home Affairs; Department of Transport; PRASA |
| **I18** | 20 | Wesgro | Commission an employer-linked labour analysis with DEDAT, by occupation, place and season: baseline, definition, the training pipeline and skills gaps separated from pay, seasonal contracts and commuting | Research; DEDAT; employers |
| **I18** | 20 | Wesgro | Extract the tourism employment table from the Pero 2025 | Research |
| **I18** | 20 | Wesgro | Build a workforce strand into the provincial quality charter (objective 11) | Tourism |
| **I18** | 20 | Partners | Run training partnerships around reserves and in pilot communities, building on the CATHSSETA guide certification and the Prince Albert academy, and trace paid placements and retention | CapeNature; CATHSSETA; training providers; municipalities |
| **I18** | 20 | Partners | Help newly trained guides stay in the sector with bookings from existing itineraries | LTOs; tour operators |
| **I18** | 20 | National | Approve a provincial tourism jobs methodology and resource the tourism satellite account | Department of Tourism; Stats SA |

Source: Chapter 3 action tables; initiative mapping from the traceability table. Leads and partners are proposals for Steerco to confirm.

## A8 M&E toolkit

The toolkit register adds the source, frequency, owner and target to each Tier 2 indicator in section 5.2.

Targets come from the growth model where it prints them and from the Inclusion Plan where it sets a pilot count. Wesgro's FY26 to FY30 plan sets them for bids, routes and cruise calls. Elsewhere the target is a direction or a milestone, marked proposed where it is this report's choice; Steerco fixes the levels at Gate 1 once the 2027 baselines exist. Tier 1 targets are in section 5.3 and Tier 3 outputs in the charters.

**Table A.27.** Tier 2 indicator register

| Code | Indicator | Source | Frequency | Owner | Target or direction to 2035 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-01** | Arrivals from the UK, Germany, USA and India | SA Tourism; growth model | Annual | Research | 726,330 (2035, base; computed from MA p21, p22) |
| **T2-02** | ICCA association meetings and bids secured | ICCA; Convention Bureau | Annual | Convention Bureau | Above 36 bids secured a year; Wesgro's 161 over FY26 to FY30 (WSP p20) as the floor; meetings rising, level set at Gate 1 |
| **T2-03** | April to September share of international seats | ACSA; OAG | Quarterly | Air Access | Rising |
| **T2-04** | Regional product with a verified listing and a usable booking route, by district and channel; exposure reported beside it | Discovery-to-sale audit | Every two years | Research | Baseline in 2027; rising |
| **T2-05** | CapeNature reservations made online | CapeNature | Annual | Research | Rising |

| Code | Indicator | Source | Frequency | Owner | Target or direction to 2035 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-06** | India and China arrivals via hubs | GDS bookings; growth model | Annual | Air Access | India 165,260; China and Hong Kong 92,598 (2035, base, model) |
| **T2-07** | Spend per visitor, mature markets | SA Tourism | Annual | Research | Rising in real terms |
| **T2-08** | African arrivals and spend | SA Tourism | Annual | Research | Regional group 402,812 (2035, base) |
| **T2-09** | International seats and routes | ACSA; OAG | Quarterly | Air Access | 10 new routes by FY30 (WSP p20, p59), each tested on load factor and survival; seats from the capacity-against-demand model (I6) |
| **T2-10** | Seats added on routes above 80% load | GDS bookings | Annual | Air Access | Seats added on each full route |
| **T2-11** | Cruise calls, unique passengers and GDP-R | Cruise Cape Town; StratEcon season study | Each season | Cruise Cape Town | At or above the 79 vessel visits of 2024/25, from 64 in 2025/26; Wesgro's 250 over FY26 to FY30 (WSP p20) as the floor; GDP-R rising |
| **T2-12** | Accessibility score by district | Readiness re-score | 2029 and 2032 | Research | Rising outside the Metro |
| **T2-13** | Corridor transfer products on sale | I8 records | Annual | Tourism | One per corridor by 2031 (proposed) |
| **T2-14** | Overall readiness by district | Readiness re-score | 2029 and 2032 | Research | Rising at each re-score |
| **T2-15** | Touring routes rated Ready | Readiness re-score | 2029 and 2032 | Research | Three of six by 2031; none below Developing (proposed) |
| **T2-16** | Peak queue at the Cableway; visitors at six flagships | Operator; Treasury district reviews | Annual | Research | Queue falling; visitor counts tracked, with no cap until capacity is known |
| **T2-17** | Communities with a live booking route | Pilot records | Quarterly | Tourism | Two or three pilots (SCIP p32), by 2028 (proposed) |
| **T2-18** | LTOs with a service agreement | LTO survey | Annual | DEDAT | Baseline in 2027; rising |
| **T2-19** | Weather losses at flagship sites | Site operators | Annual | Research | Tracked; no target |
| **T2-20** | Tourism projects at financial close | I14 records | Annual | Wesgro investment promotion | First projects by 2031 |
| **T2-21** | Escalation items answered | Steerco records | Quarterly | Wesgro CEO's office | Each item answered within a year (proposed) |
| **T2-22** | Industry partners in the joint plan | Steerco records | Annual | Wesgro CEO's office | Plan agreed in 2027; partners rising |
| **T2-23** | Automated feeds in the dashboard | Programme office | Quarterly | Research | Arrivals, seats and cruise automated by 2028 |
| **T2-24** | ETA decision times and authorisations matched to arrivals, priority markets | Home Affairs; SA Tourism | Quarterly, from monthly data | Wesgro CEO's office | Decision times falling; authorisations matched to arrivals rising |
| **T2-25** | Tourism labour analysis published | Research | Once | DEDAT, with Wesgro Research | Published by the end of 2028 |
| **T2-26** | Share of visitors staying overnight, by district | Treasury district reviews; Wesgro visitor tracking | Annual | Research | Rising outside the Metro (proposed) |

| Code | Indicator | Source | Frequency | Owner | Target or direction to 2035 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **T2-27** | Tourist spend as a share of GDPR, by district | Treasury district reviews | Annual | Research | Tracked beside T1-06; no target |
| **T2-28** | Visitors who report feeling safe, priority markets | Wesgro visitor tracking | Annual | Research | Baseline once the survey asks; rising (proposed) |
| **T2-29** | Tourism safety response and completed handoffs in pilot hotspots | Referral pathway records | Quarterly | DEDAT, with the City of Cape Town | Baseline in 2027; handoffs completed in every tested scenario by the 2028 review (proposed) |

Source: Indicator register, section 5.2; Market Assessment Report, May 2026, p20 to p23 (model values, working analysis); SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p32. T2-01 is the sum of the four printed market values (computed). Wesgro, Strategic Plan 2025/26 to 2029/30 (WSP).

### Scorecard and dashboard templates

The quarterly scorecard carries one row per indicator: code, name, baseline and year, latest value and date, direction against the path, target, source and owner. The annual Board outlook adds the Tier 1 chart against both paths and the gate status. The dashboard data model lists each feed, its refresh frequency and the manual-entry form for indicators without a feed. The templates themselves are delivered with the Excel toolkit [M&E toolkit workbook: Letsema to deliver with the final report].

## A9 Glossary and references

Fourteen terms carry a specific meaning in this report, and forty-four documents support it, cited by the date on their covers.

Abbreviations are listed in the front matter. Footnotes cite each deliverable by a short title, keyed below; the table gives its full title and the date printed on its cover, and where the file date differs, both are shown. Working analyses rank below the deliverables. Wesgro's, the province's and the City's own documents are cited directly by page, slide or chapter. Other public sources are used only where no deliverable carries the figure.

**Table A.28.** Glossary of terms

| Term | Meaning in this report |
|---|---|
| **Accelerated case** | The growth model's upside path: direct India and China routes secured with dedicated activation; 2,516,282 arrivals in 2035 |
| **Base case** | The growth model's most likely path: Wesgro's current activity continues and hub carriers add capacity; 2,175,778 arrivals in 2035 |
| **Cold zone** | The Infrastructure Report's term for an area with tourism assets but little or no tourism use |
| **Objective** | One of the twenty strategic objectives beneath the three goals |
| **Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA)** | South Africa's digital entry authorisation, launched on 12 August 2026 as the eVisa platform closes |
| **Green season** | April to September, the months of lower overseas demand. May to August is the first winter portfolio; April and September are shoulders. It is not the low season for every destination |
| **International arrivals** | On the growth model's basis, which Skift is to confirm; distinct from international passenger arrivals at Cape Town International, which ACSA reports |
| **New route** | Wesgro's term, in its FY26 to FY30 plan, for a scheduled international service flying to and from Cape Town for the first time; counted in T2-09 |
| **Readiness** | The Infrastructure Report's score for how ready a district's assets are to receive visitors, beside attractiveness and accessibility |
| **Seat line** | The 1.8 million inbound seats the growth model draws as current air access, as drawn in the Demand-Side Analysis; a model assumption, not a measured cap (section 1.2) |

| Term | Meaning in this report |
|---|---|
| **MyCiTi** | The City of Cape Town's bus network, whose airport service is suspended |
| **Seller with a stake** | The Inclusion Plan's term for a local body that sells community product and keeps the revenue in the community |
| **Tier 1, 2 and 3** | Impact, outcome and output indicators (section 5.2) |
| **Trusted Tour Operator Scheme (TTOS)** | The national scheme under which listed tour operators obtain visas for their groups |

Source: Letsema, from Chapters 1 to 5.

**Table A.29.** Documents and sources cited

| Document | Author | Date cited | Status | Version in hand and SLA clauses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Inception Report** | Study team | Nov 2025 (27 November 2025) | Deliverable | 37 slides; working session of 28 November 2025. SLA clauses: [to confirm against Annexure B] |
| **Current State Diagnostic, version 2** | Study team | Dec 2025 | Deliverable | v2 in the file name. SLA clauses: [to confirm against Annexure B] |
| **Skift Digital and Search Insights memo** | Skift Advisory | 10 Dec 2025 | Working analysis | |
| **Stakeholder Insights Report, phase 1** | Study team | Mar 2026 (12 March 2026) | Deliverable | File dated 12 March 2026; sixteen organisation tables. SLA clauses: 1.1.6, 3.2.8 |
| **Skift Segmentation Analysis, version 2.0** | Skift Advisory | Mar 2026 (12 March 2026) | Working analysis | |
| **Skift African Market Analysis, version 1** | Skift Advisory | 16 Mar 2026 | Working analysis | |
| **Global Benchmarking Report** | Study team | Mar 2026 (cover prints 2026 only; file 24 March 2026) | Deliverable | Cover prints 2026 only; file dated 24 March 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.5, 1.1.11, 3.2.7 |
| **MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, final draft** | MIDAS | Mar 2026 (file 20 April 2026) | Deliverable | Word file marked final draft, dated 20 April 2026; no page numbers. SLA clauses: 1.1.1.2 |
| **Market Assessment Report** | Study team | May 2026 | Working analysis | Working analysis; predecessor of the Demand-Side Analysis; prints the 2025 model base. SLA clauses: Working analysis under 1.1.1 [to confirm] |
| **Demand-Side Analysis, final** | Study team | Jun 2026 (file 1 October 2026) | Deliverable | Final; file dated 1 October 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.1, 1.1.7, 3.2.3 |
| **Infrastructure Report, final** | Study team | Jul 2026 (file 22 September 2026) | Deliverable | Final of 114 slides, file dated 22 September 2026; June 2026 draft of 42 slides superseded. SLA clauses: 1.1.2, 1.1.8, 3.2.4 |
| **SME and Community Inclusion Plan** | Study team | Sep 2026 (file 9 October 2026) | Deliverable | File dated 9 October 2026. SLA clauses: 1.1.3, 1.1.9, 3.2.5 |
| **Unlocking Tourism Summary of Findings, working session** | Study team | 14 Oct 2026 (not in this evidence base) | Deck | |
| **Economic Value of Tourism in Cape Town for the 2024 year** | City of Cape Town (Futureneer Advisors) | June 2025 | Public source | |

| Document | Author | Date cited | Status | Version in hand and SLA clauses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Tourism Satellite Account release, as reported** | Statistics South Africa | 2026, provisional | Public source | |
| **Air access releases: jobs and spend per 100 international passengers** | Wesgro and Cape Town Air Access | 2023 to 2024 | Public source | |
| **Presentation to the parliamentary committee** | Wesgro | 1 April 2026 | Public source | |
| **Western Cape tourism is booming, but can locals afford to enjoy it?** | Hypertext | April 2026 | Public source | |
| **Western Cape Tourism Performance: Annual 2025** | Wesgro Research (SA Tourism data) | 2026 | Public source | |
| **Q1 2026/27 performance presentation to the Portfolio Committee on Transport, as reported by Travel News** | ACSA | August 2026 | Public source | |
| **Parliamentary reply on Cape Town International runway capacity** | Minister of Transport | April 2025 | Public source | |
| **Anuario de Turismo 2024** | Sernatur, Chile | December 2025 | Public source | |
| **Singapore achieves historical high in tourism receipts in 2024** | Singapore Tourism Board | February 2025 | Public source | |
| **World Tourism Barometer** | UN Tourism | January 2025 and January 2026 | Public source | |
| **Magenta Book Supplementary Guide: Handling Complexity in Policy Evaluation** | HM Treasury (prepared by CECAN) | 2020 | Public source | GOV.UK page shows an update of 15 May 2026; cited in sections 1.4 and 5.6 |
| **OECD Tourism Trends and Policies 2026** | OECD (OECD Publishing, Paris) | 2026 | Public source | DOI 10.1787/3fd3cd75-en; cited in section 1.4 |
| **George Airport expansion reporting** | George Herald | July 2026 | Public source | |
| **Meiringspoort temporary reinstatement** | Western Cape Government | July 2026 | Public source | |
| **Kenya 2024 tourism performance, as reported** | The Star (Kenya) | May 2025 | Public source | |
| **Service Level Agreement, Annexure B** | Wesgro and Letsema | December 2025 (not in this evidence base) | Contract | |
| **Five-Year Strategic Plan 2026 to 2030: Cape Town and Western Cape, a Leading Regional Economy** | Wesgro | Undated; covers FY26 to FY30 (2025/26 to 2029/30) | Wesgro document | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Tourism Source Market Analysis** | Wesgro Research (Economic Knowledge Hub) | Nov 2025 | Wesgro document | Data for 2022 to 2024, as three-year totals |

| Document | Author | Date cited | Status | Version in hand and SLA clauses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Cape Town Air Access: Letsema Update** | Cape Town Air Access (City, province, ACSA, Cape Town Tourism, SA Tourism, Wesgro, private sector) | Nov 2025 | Wesgro document | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Western Cape Cruise Liner Industry: Economic Contribution 2024/25 Season, final report** | StratEcon for Wesgro | Oct 2025 (9 October 2025) | Wesgro document | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Why Cruise to Cape Town & the Western Cape: A Guide for Itinerary Planners** | Wesgro (Cruise Cape Town) | October 2026 | Wesgro document | 32 pages; prints the 2025/26 season results (p29); the 2025 edition is no longer online [Wesgro to supply the 2025 edition if its page references are preferred] |
| **2024/25 Cruise Season Injects R1.79 Billion into Western Cape Economy** | Wesgro (Cruise Cape Town) | 13 September 2025 | Wesgro document | Media release; counts 79 cruise ship arrivals and 83 vessel arrivals |
| **Tourism Blueprint 2030** | Western Cape Department of Economic Development and Tourism | Undated; set before COVID | Public source | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Western Cape Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023 to 2035 (G4J)** | Western Cape Government | 2023 (approved by Cabinet) | Public source | Cabinet-approved PDF, 196 pages. Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Provincial Economic Review and Outlook 2025** | Western Cape Provincial Treasury | 2025 | Public source | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Municipal Economic Review and Outlook 2024/25: Cape Metro, Cape Winelands, Garden Route, Overberg, West Coast and Central Karoo** | Western Cape Provincial Treasury | 2024/25 (2023 data) | Public source | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **Tourism Development Framework 2019 to 2024** | City of Cape Town, Department of Enterprise and Investment | 2019 to 2024 | Public source | Received at inception (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p34) |
| **All hands on deck to manage cruise liner congestion** | City of Cape Town | 11 March 2025 | Public source | Media release |
| **Assessment of the Economic Impact of South Africa's Visa Regime Administration and Policy Reform Proposals, executive summary** | BDO for the Western Cape Department of Economic Development and Tourism | Jul 2024 | DEDAT document | |
| **Draft Western Cape Land Transport Framework 2024/25 to 2028/29** | Western Cape Department of Mobility | Apr 2025 | Public source | |

Source: Letsema, document register. Study team: Letsema in partnership with Skift Advisory. Versions in hand from the cover pages and file dates of each document; SLA Annexure B clause numbers [to be checked against the signed Annexure B].

The SLA clause numbers in the last column are those each document answers. [Clause wording to be checked against the signed Annexure B.]

Short titles used in the footnotes: Inception Report; Diagnostic (Current State Diagnostic); Digital Insights (Skift Digital and Search Insights memo); Stakeholder Insights (Stakeholder Insights Report); Segmentation (Skift Segmentation Analysis); African Markets (Skift African Market Analysis); Benchmarking (Global Benchmarking Report); MIDAS (MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment); Market Assessment (Market Assessment Report); Demand-Side Analysis; Infrastructure Report; Inclusion Plan (SME and Community Inclusion Plan); G4J (Western Cape Growth for Jobs Strategy 2023 to 2035). Public sources are cited by full title and date. Wesgro, provincial and City documents are cited by short title and page, the Cape Town Air Access update by slide and the draft land transport framework by chapter or chapter page.

WESGRO
cape town & western cape
tourism, trade & investment

# Contact us

hello@wesgro.co.za

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